

Oedipus Rex

Sophocles · -429

Francis Storr translation (1912) as edited by Standard Ebooks (app text)

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

Common Core edition (standards shown for this framework only)

11 scene lessons plus 1 seminar day(s), a test day and an essay day: 13 class days of 90 minutes, 5 per unit (block schedule), 3 units
Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

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Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson 1: introduction (author, context, reception, overview)
4. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–11), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
5. Unit test (eleven rigor versions) with answer keys and scoring guides
6. Final paper
7. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Edition: Sections follow the Greek structure (prologue, parodos, episodes, stasima, exodos). Line numbers are Storr's English lines, not Greek. Suicide-method lines 1278–1281 are cited by number only; self-blinding lines may be quoted as drama with context.

Grades: Grades 10–12 (scales to AP via rigor levels). **Units:** 3. **Class days:** 13 × 90 minutes (11 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

Essential questions

- What does Oedipus Rex suggest about knowledge and blindness?
- What does Oedipus Rex suggest about fate and responsibility?
- What does Oedipus Rex suggest about pride and fall?
- What does Oedipus Rex suggest about leadership and the city?
- What does Oedipus Rex suggest about mercy?

Objectives

- Students will cite at least 2 quotations, with locations, to support each written claim about what the text says explicitly and implicitly (scored on the writing-prompt rubric).
- Students will trace one theme across at least 3 sections of the play in the final paper, earning at least 70 of 100 rubric points.
- Students will explain how characters, setting and point of view interact in at least 3 exit tickets, each meeting the claim-evidence-reasoning criteria.
- Students will determine the in-context meaning of taught vocabulary, scoring at least 80% on the vocabulary items of the scene quizzes.
- Students will write an argument with a clear claim, reasons and relevant evidence, scoring at least 80% on the unit test's short-answer scoring guides.

Standards: Common Core

RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4

Common Core State Standards (ELA-Literacy), thecorestandards.org

Assessments: Daily scene quizzes (auto-graded); Writing prompt each unit (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-book test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five
Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has four rigor levels (HS Sophomore through AP); each level offers three writing options (individual analytical, individual creative, group) on one rubric; the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Scene lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary with etymology notes	We do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80
8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Unit	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	*Introduction: author, context and reception* Prologue (lines 1–155) Parodos (lines 156–213) Episode 1 (lines 214–479) Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511) (20-minute preview) and Episode 2 (lines 512–880)	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*knowledge and blindness* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Introduction: author, context and reception • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per unit)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
2	Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921) (20-minute preview) and Episode 3 (lines 922–1102) *Socratic seminar on knowledge and blindness* Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114) (20-minute preview) and Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200) Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232) Exodos (lines 1233–1544)	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*fate and responsibility* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Socratic seminar on knowledge and blindness • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per unit)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
3	*Whole-book test (90 minutes)* *Final paper writing workshop (drafting in class; finish the draft as homework)* *Final paper: peer review, revision and submission*	3 × 90 min (270 min)	*pride and fall* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Whole-book test (90 minutes) • Final paper writing workshop (drafting in class; finish the draft as homework) • Final paper: peer review, revision and submission • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per unit)	Whole-book test and final essay

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: Introduction to Oedipus Rex

Objective: Students will explain, in a 3-sentence exit ticket, how one fact about Sophocles's life or times connects to knowledge and blindness in “Oedipus Rex”, and will set up a reading journal with a prediction and a question for each of 3 themes (knowledge and blindness, fate and responsibility, pride and fall).

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2

Author biography

Sophocles (about 497/6 to 406/5 B.C.E.) was one of the three great tragic poets of Athens, with Aeschylus and Euripides. He was born at Colonus, just outside the city, served Athens as a general and a treasurer, and is said to have written more than 120 plays, of which seven survive complete. He won first prize at the City Dionysia many times and is credited with adding a third actor to the stage.

Historical and cultural context

Sophocles was an Athenian tragedian whose plays were staged at the City Dionysia in Athens; Oedipus Rex is usually dated to about 429 B.C.E., soon after the plague at Athens began during the Peloponnesian War.

Publication and reception, then and now

The play is usually dated to the 420s B.C.E. Aristotle's Poetics treats it as the model tragedy, praising how its reversal and recognition arrive together. This app uses Francis Storr's 1912 verse translation as edited by Standard Ebooks.

Then: No record of the first staging survives; the play is usually dated to the 420s B.C.E., and an ancient tradition says Sophocles's entry that year lost first prize to Philocles (Jebb, 1893/1902, Introduction, § 15).

Now: Aristotle's Poetics already treated it as the model tragedy, and it has been retold ever since, from Corneille's Œdipe (1659) and Voltaire's Oedipe (1718) to a Greek-language staging at Harvard in 1881 (Jebb, § 29).

Overview (spoiler-free)

Thebes is dying of a plague, and King Oedipus, who once saved the city by answering the Sphinx's riddle, promises to find the cause. The oracle says the killer of the former king, Laius, must be driven out, and Oedipus sets out to find him.

Main themes

- knowledge and blindness: Watch how often characters speak of seeing and not seeing, and ask who in the play really knows the truth.
- fate and responsibility: The play keeps asking whether people can escape what the gods foretell, and whether they are to blame for deeds they did not knowingly do.

- pride and fall: The Chorus warns that pride climbs high and then falls; watch whom that warning comes to fit.
- leadership and the city: Oedipus measures himself by what he does for Thebes, a city dying of plague.
- mercy: Watch for moments when one character pities or spares another, and for what those choices cost.

Why it matters

The play asks how much we can know about ourselves, whether we are responsible for what we did not knowingly do, and what a leader owes the people. Its detective structure has shaped tragedy, psychology and crime fiction ever since.

Spoilers · teacher only

Oedipus learns that he himself killed Laius, his father, and married Jocasta, his mother, fulfilling the prophecy his parents tried to escape. Jocasta dies offstage; Oedipus blinds himself and asks to be exiled, and Creon takes charge of Thebes and of his daughters.

Content framing, teacher guidance: Have the school counselor's contact ready and follow school protocol if a student discloses risk. The Lifeline offers call, text and chat, free and confidential, 24/7.

Lesson plan (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Say: Before we start, I want to tell you about some hard parts of this play. It is an ancient Greek tragedy about a king who searches for the cause of a plague on his city and for the killer of the king before him. Along the way the play includes a killing, a baby left to die, incest (a marriage within one family that no one knew about), deaths, including a death by suicide, and serious self-harm. These events happen offstage and are reported by others, and Sophocles shows them as a catastrophe, not as brave or as a solution. In real life, hurting yourself is wrong and is never the answer. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide or self-harm, call or text 988, or chat at 988lifeline.org (the 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or talk to a school counselor or a trusted adult. You don't have to handle it alone. Before we open Oedipus Rex: which matters more, knowledge and blindness or fate and responsibility? Write for five minutes.
Prompt: Before we open Oedipus Rex: which matters more, knowledge and blindness or fate and responsibility? Write for five minutes.

8–18 min · Key terms · We do (10 min)
Key literary terms for the unit.
Key terms for Oedipus Rex: knowledge and blindness, fate and responsibility, pride and fall, leadership and the city, mercy.

18–28 min · Mini-lecture: author, context, reception · I do (10 min)

Mini-lecture on the author, the historical context and the reception (read or adapt the script).

About the author. Sophocles (about 497/6 to 406/5 B.C.E.) was one of the three great tragic poets of Athens, with Aeschylus and Euripides. He was born at Colonus, just outside the city, served Athens as a general and a treasurer, and is said to have written more than 120 plays, of which seven survive complete. He won first prize at the City Dionysia many times and is credited with adding a third actor to the stage. The world of the book. Sophocles was an Athenian tragedian whose plays were staged at the City Dionysia in Athens; Oedipus Rex is usually dated to about 429 B.C.E., soon after the plague at Athens began during the Peloponnesian War. Publication and reception. The play is usually dated to the 420s B.C.E. Aristotle's Poetics treats it as the model tragedy, praising how its reversal and recognition arrive together. This app uses Francis Storr's 1912 verse translation as edited by Standard Ebooks. Then: No record of the first staging survives; the play is usually dated to the 420s B.C.E., and an ancient tradition says Sophocles's entry that year lost first prize to Philocles (Jebb, 1893/1902, Introduction, § 15). Now: Aristotle's Poetics already treated it as the model tragedy, and it has been retold ever since, from Corneille's Œdipe (1659) and Voltaire's Oedipe (1718) to a Greek-language staging at Harvard in 1881 (Jebb, § 29).

28–40 min · I do: the book in one passage · I do (12 min)

Model a close reading of one passage using the written think-aloud below.

First, meaning. I read "My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool" slowly and put it in my own words: In these lines Oedipus speaks at a turning point of the section, which is about a king who promises to find the killer. Next, craft. I notice how the lines use characterization, irony to make the audience feel the pressure of the moment on Oedipus. The strongest word is "suppliants": the word "suppliants" carries the weight of the lines and points to the section's big idea. Then, effect. What do lines 1–3 reveal about a king who promises to find the killer? My answer: The man who solves riddles sets out to solve one more, and every promise he makes will turn back on him. The audience knows the myth; the king does not. That gap is dramatic irony. These lines show a king who promises to find the killer, and that matters for what follows in the play.

> *My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool* (*Prologue (lines 1–155), Oedipus)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool" slowly and put it in my own words: In these lines Oedipus speaks at a turning point of the section, which is about a king who promises to find the killer. Next, craft. I notice how the lines use characterization, irony to make the audience feel the pressure of the moment on Oedipus. The strongest word is "suppliants": the word "suppliants" carries the weight of the lines and points to the section's big idea. Then, effect. What do lines 1–3 reveal about a king who promises to find the killer? My answer: The man who solves riddles sets out to solve one more, and every promise he makes will turn back on him. The audience knows the myth; the king does not. That gap is dramatic irony. These lines show a king who promises to find the killer, and that matters for what follows in the play.

40–55 min · We do: overview and themes · We do (15 min)
Read the spoiler-free overview together and name the themes to track.
What the book is about (no spoilers): Thebes is dying of a plague, and King Oedipus, who once saved the city by answering the Sphinx's riddle, promises to find the cause. The oracle says the killer of the former king, Laius, must be driven out, and Oedipus sets out to find him. Themes to track: knowledge and blindness: Watch how often characters speak of seeing and not seeing, and ask who in the play really knows the truth. fate and responsibility: The play keeps asking whether people can escape what the gods foretell, and whether they are to blame for deeds they did not knowingly do. pride and fall: The Chorus warns that pride climbs high and then falls; watch whom that warning comes to fit. leadership and the city: Oedipus measures himself by what he does for Thebes, a city dying of plague. mercy: Watch for moments when one character pities or spares another, and for what those choices cost.

55–70 min · You do: reading journal · You do (15 min)
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme, with a prediction and a question (example given).
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme with a prediction and a question. Theme page, knowledge and blindness: my prediction is that the play will test this idea against a hard choice, and my question is whether anyone in it can see the whole truth before it is too late to act on it.
Task: Set up a reading journal for Oedipus Rex: one page per theme, each with a prediction and a question.
Exemplar: Theme page, knowledge and blindness: my prediction is that the play will test this idea against a hard choice, and my question is whether anyone in it can see the whole truth before it is too late to act on it.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Whole-class discussion: why the book is still taught.
Why does Oedipus Rex still matter? The play asks how much we can know about ourselves, whether we are responsible for what we did not knowingly do, and what a leader owes the people. Its detective structure has shaped tragedy, psychology and crime fiction ever since.
Anchor question: Why might Oedipus Rex still be taught today?
Facilitation: The play asks how much we can know about ourselves, whether we are responsible for what we did not knowingly do, and what a leader owes the people. Its detective structure has shaped tragedy, psychology and crime fiction ever since.

80–87 min · Exit ticket · You do (7 min)
Exit ticket on the author and context (answer given).
Sophocles staged Oedipus Rex in Athens around the time of the plague at Athens during the Peloponnesian War. How might an audience living through a plague in Athens hear the play's opening lines? Answer: Accept answers such as: they would recognise the dying city and the people begging their leader for help, so the play's questions about blame and leadership would feel urgent rather than distant.
Exit ticket: Sophocles staged Oedipus Rex in Athens around the time of the plague at Athens during the Peloponnesian War. How might an audience living through a plague in Athens hear the play's opening lines?
Answer: Accept answers such as: they would recognise the dying city and the people begging their leader for help, so the play's questions about blame and leadership would feel urgent rather than distant.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Preview the first reading.
Tomorrow we begin reading: Prologue (lines 1–155).

Teacher notes · sources: Standard Ebooks, Sophocles, translated by Francis Storr (https://standardebooks.org/ebooks/sophocles); R. C. Jebb, Sophocles: The Plays and Fragments (Cambridge University Press), Internet Archive (https://archive.org/details/sophocles02soph_0)

Lesson 2: Prologue (lines 1–155)

Focus: a king who promises to find the killer

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in "Prologue (lines 1–155)" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

Thebes is dying of a plague. Suppliants and a Priest beg King Oedipus, who once saved the city from the Sphinx, to save it again. Creon returns from Delphi: Apollo says the city must drive out the killer of the former king, Laius. Oedipus vows to "make dark things clear" and calls the people together.

Background: There is no outside record of the first performance; the Standard Ebooks edition dates it to about 429 B.C.E. (Sophocles, ca. 429 B.C.E./2025). Jebb reports the modern theory that the plague of Thebes reflects the Athenian plague of 430 B.C.E. and sets it aside (Jebb, 1893/1902, Introduction, § 15). Storr's line numbers are English lines, not Greek.

Significance: The man who solves riddles sets out to solve one more, and every promise he makes will turn back on him. The audience knows the myth; the king does not. That gap is dramatic irony.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Is a leader responsible for problems he did not knowingly cause? Why or why not? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to leadership and the city because....*
> **Prompt:** Is a leader responsible for problems he did not knowingly cause? Why or why not?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to leadership and the city because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Oedipus treats the city's sickness as his own and promises public action, so the Prologue measures him as a leader by what he vows to do for Thebes.

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary · We do (10 min)**
> Two key words in context.
> *Today's words: surmise — a guess made without proof; suppliant — a person who humbly begs for help, especially at an altar.*
> **Words:** surmise: a guess made without proof · suppliant: a person who humbly begs for help, especially at an altar

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
There is no outside record of the first performance; the Standard Ebooks edition dates it to about 429 B.C.E. (Sophocles, ca. 429 B.C.E./2025). Jebb reports the modern theory that the plague of Thebes reflects the Athenian plague of 430 B.C.E. and sets it aside (Jebb, 1893/1902, Introduction, § 15). Storr's line numbers are English lines, not Greek. The man who solves riddles sets out to solve one more, and every promise he makes will turn back on him. The audience knows the myth; the king does not. That gap is dramatic irony. Characterization: Oedipus answers the suppliants himself rather than through a messenger, and he has already sent Creon to Delphi before anyone asked: a king who acts first and speaks of the city's pain as his own. Irony: Oedipus promises to hunt down the killer of Laius "as though he were my sire" and to "make dark things clear", words an audience that knows the myth hears very differently from the way he means them. Setting: The play opens at the palace altar of a city in crisis: crops, herds and births are failing, and the people sit as suppliants holding wool-wrapped olive branches, the sign of a formal plea to a god or king. Watch for light and darkness: Dark things that must be made clear: the Prologue frames the inquiry as bringing a hidden matter into the light.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool" slowly and put it in my own words: In these lines Oedipus speaks at a turning point of the section, which is about a king who promises to find the killer. Next, craft. I notice how the lines use characterization, irony to make the audience feel the pressure of the moment on Oedipus. The strongest word is "suppliants": the word "suppliants" carries the weight of the lines and points to the section's big idea. Then, effect. What do lines 1–3 reveal about a king who promises to find the killer? My answer: The man who solves riddles sets out to solve one more, and every promise he makes will turn back on him. The audience knows the myth; the king does not. That gap is dramatic irony. These lines show a king who promises to find the killer, and that matters for what follows in the play.

> *My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool (Prologue, lines 1–3)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool" slowly and put it in my own words: In these lines Oedipus speaks at a turning point of the section, which is about a king who promises to find the killer. Next, craft. I notice how the lines use characterization, irony to make the audience feel the pressure of the moment on Oedipus. The strongest word is "suppliants": the word "suppliants" carries the weight of the lines and points to the section's big idea. Then, effect. What do lines 1–3 reveal about a king who promises to find the killer? My answer: The man who solves riddles sets out to solve one more, and every promise he makes will turn back on him. The audience knows the myth; the king does not. That gap is dramatic irony. These lines show a king who promises to find the killer, and that matters for what follows in the play.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Battlements" and "galleys" name the city's walls and ships, and "men" names its people. Setting them side by side shows that stone and ships are worthless without living citizens, so the Priest reminds the king that his first duty is to the people. Ask: How does this line connect to leadership and the city? Expected student answer: Oedipus treats the city's sickness as his own and promises public action, so the Prologue measures him as a leader by what he vows to do for Thebes. (The Priest reminds the king that walls and ships protect nothing without people, so a ruler's first duty is to the living city.)

> *Nor battlements nor galleys aught avail, / If men to man and guards to guard them fail* (Prologue, lines 62–63)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Battlements" and "galleys" name the city's walls and ships, and "men" names its people. Setting them side by side shows that stone and ships are worthless without living citizens, so the Priest reminds the king that his first duty is to the people.
Ask: How does this line connect to leadership and the city?
Expected student answer: Oedipus treats the city's sickness as his own and promises public action, so the Prologue measures him as a leader by what he vows to do for Thebes. (The Priest reminds the king that walls and ships protect nothing without people, so a ruler's first duty is to the living city.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about a king who promises to find the killer? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Prologue (lines 1–155) develops the idea of a king who promises to find the killer. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Oedipus opens the play as a confident, caring king who acts quickly for his city. When the text says "Well, I will start afresh and once again / Make dark things clear" (Prologue, lines 138–139), it shows this directly. He has sent Creon to Delphi before the suppliants arrive, he calls the people his children, and he promises to start afresh and "make dark things clear", so his first acts are those of a leader who takes the city's pain on himself.
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about a king who promises to find the killer? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Prologue (lines 1–155) develops the idea of a king who promises to find the killer. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Oedipus opens the play as a confident, caring king who acts quickly for his city. When the text says "Well, I will start afresh and once again / Make dark things clear" (Prologue, lines 138–139), it shows this directly. He has sent Creon to Delphi before the suppliants arrive, he calls the people his children, and he promises to start afresh and "make dark things clear", so his first acts are those of a leader who takes the city's pain on himself.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Is a leader responsible for problems he did not knowingly cause? Why or why not? Ask: Is a leader responsible for problems he did not knowingly cause? Why or why not?
Anchor question: Is a leader responsible for problems he did not knowingly cause? Why or why not?
Facilitation: Ask: Is a leader responsible for problems he did not knowingly cause? Why or why not?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about a king who promises to find the killer? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Oedipus opens the play as a confident, caring king who acts quickly for his city. ("Well, I will start afresh and once again / Make dark things clear", Prologue, lines 138–139). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about a king who promises to find the killer? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Oedipus opens the play as a confident, caring king who acts quickly for his city. ("Well, I will start afresh and once again / Make dark things clear", Prologue, lines 138–139). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes a king who promises to find the killer. Key takeaway: Oedipus treats the city's sickness as his own and promises public action, so the Prologue measures him as a leader by what he vows to do for Thebes.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Oedipus answers the suppliants himself rather than through a messenger, and he has already sent Creon to Delphi before anyone asked: a king who acts first and speaks of the city's pain as his own.
- **Irony:** Oedipus promises to hunt down the killer of Laius "as though he were my sire" and to "make dark things clear", words an audience that knows the myth hears very differently from the way he means them.
- **Setting:** The play opens at the palace altar of a city in crisis: crops, herds and births are failing, and the people sit as suppliants holding wool-wrapped olive branches, the sign of a formal plea to a god or king.

Themes and how they develop

- **leadership and the city:** Oedipus treats the city's sickness as his own and promises public action, so the Prologue measures him as a leader by what he vows to do for Thebes.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and darkness:** Dark things that must be made clear: the Prologue frames the inquiry as bringing a hidden matter into the light.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool" (Prologue, lines 1–3) Oedipus calls the citizens his children, so his first words present him as a parent to the city as well as its king.
- "Nor battlements nor galleys aught avail, / If men to man and guards to guard them fail" (Prologue, lines 62–63) The Priest reminds the king that walls and ships protect nothing without people, so a ruler's first duty is to the living city.
- "In this land, said the god; "who seeks shall find; / Who sits with folded hands or sleeps is blind" (Prologue, lines 116–117) Creon reports the oracle's rule that searching finds what it seeks and idleness keeps people in the dark, which is the rule the king adopts for his inquiry.
- "Well, I will start afresh and once again / Make dark things clear" (Prologue, lines 138–139) Oedipus promises to bring hidden things into the light, a vow that sets up the play's language of darkness and clarity.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Oedipus opens the play as a confident, caring king who acts quickly for his city.
Evidence: "Well, I will start afresh and once again / Make dark things clear" (Prologue, lines 138–139)
Reasoning: He has sent Creon to Delphi before the suppliants arrive, he calls the people his children, and he promises to start afresh and "make dark things clear", so his first acts are those of a leader who takes the city's pain on himself.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 1–3

1 **Oedipus:** My children, latest born to Cadmus old,
2 **Oedipus:** Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands
3 **Oedipus:** Branches of olive filleted with wool?

Lines 1–15

1 **Oedipus:** My children, latest born to Cadmus old,
2 **Oedipus:** Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands
3 **Oedipus:** Branches of olive filleted with wool?
4 **Oedipus:** What means this reek of incense everywhere,
5 **Oedipus:** And everywhere laments and litanies?
6 **Oedipus:** Children, it were not meet that I should learn
7 **Oedipus:** From others, and am hither come, myself,
8 **Oedipus:** I Oedipus, your world-renownèd king.
9 **Oedipus:** Ho! aged sire, whose venerable locks
10 **Oedipus:** Proclaim thee spokesman of this company,

11 **Oedipus:** Explain your mood and purport. Is it dread
12 **Oedipus:** Of ill that moves you or a boon ye crave?
13 **Oedipus:** My zeal in your behalf ye cannot doubt;
14 **Oedipus:** Ruthless indeed were I and obdurate
15 **Oedipus:** If such petitioners as you I spurned.

Line 8
8 **Oedipus:** I Oedipus, your world-renownèd king.

Line 25
25 **Priest:** For, as thou seest thyself, our ship of State,

Line 27
27 **Priest:** Foundered beneath a weltering surge of blood.

Lines 28–30
28 **Priest:** A blight is on our harvest in the ear,
29 **Priest:** A blight upon the grazing flocks and herds,
30 **Priest:** A blight on wives in travail; and withal

Lines 30–31
30 **Priest:** A blight on wives in travail; and withal
31 **Priest:** Armed with his blazing torch the God of Plague

Lines 36–37
36 **Priest:** I and these children; not as deeming thee
37 **Priest:** A new divinity, but the first of men;

Lines 38–39
38 **Priest:** First in the common accidents of life,
39 **Priest:** And first in visitations of the Gods.

Lines 44–45
44 **Priest:** No, by a god inspired (so all men deem,
45 **Priest:** And testify) didst thou renew our life.

Lines 62–63
62 **Priest:** Nor battlements nor galleys aught avail,
63 **Priest:** If men to man and guards to guard them fail.

Lines 88–89
88 **Priest:** As I surmise, 'tis welcome; else his head
89 **Priest:** Had scarce been crowned with berry-laden bays.

Line 101
101 **Creon:** Let me report then all the god declared.

Line 102
102 **Creon:** King Phoebus bids us straitly extirpate

Lines 103–104
103 **Creon:** A fell pollution that infests the land,
104 **Creon:** And no more harbour an inveterate sore.

Lines 114–115
114 **Oedipus:** Where are they? Where in the wide world to find
115 **Oedipus:** The far, faint traces of a bygone crime?

Lines 116–117
116 **Creon:** In this land, said the god; "who seeks shall find;
117 **Creon:** Who sits with folded hands or sleeps is blind."

Lines 138–139
138 **Oedipus:** Well, I will start afresh and once again
139 **Oedipus:** Make dark things clear. Right worthy the concern

Lines 141–142
141 **Oedipus:** I also, as is meet, will lend my aid
142 **Oedipus:** To avenge this wrong to Thebes and to the god.

Lines 143–144
143 **Oedipus:** Not for some far-off kinsman, but myself,
144 **Oedipus:** Shall I expel this poison in the blood;

Lines 145–146
145 **Oedipus:** For whoso slew that king might have a mind
146 **Oedipus:** To strike me too with his assassin hand.

Line 147
147 **Oedipus:** Therefore in righting him I serve myself.

Lines 150–151
150 **Oedipus:** The Theban commons. With the god's good help
151 **Oedipus:** Success is sure; 'tis ruin if we fail. Exeunt Oedipus and Creon.

Vocabulary

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context
surmise (verb)	a guess made without proof	*As I surmise, 'tis welcome; else his head Had scarce been crowned with berry-laden bays.*
suppliant (noun)	a person who humbly begs for help, especially at an altar	*Up, children, haste ye, quit these altar stairs, Take hence your suppliant wands, go summon hither The Theban commons.*

Discussion questions

1. Is a leader responsible for problems he did not knowingly cause? Why or why not?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate and responsibility?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What does Oedipus promise in lines 138–139? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** To start afresh and "make dark things clear."
   Answer guidance: To start afresh and "make dark things clear.".
2. What is destroying Thebes at the start of the play? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A plague
   Answer guidance: A plague.
3. Why do the people trust Oedipus to help? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** He once freed the city from the Sphinx
   Answer guidance: He once freed the city from the Sphinx.
4. Where has Creon been? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** At the oracle of Apollo at Delphi
   Answer guidance: At the oracle of Apollo at Delphi.
5. What does the god say Thebes must do? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Banish or punish the killer of Laius
   Answer guidance: Banish or punish the killer of Laius.
6. What rule does the oracle give for finding what is hidden (lines 116–117)? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Whoever seeks shall find, and whoever sits idle stays in the dark
   Answer guidance: Whoever seeks shall find, and whoever sits idle stays in the dark.
7. Retell the most important events of “Prologue (lines 1–155)” in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Thebes is dying of a plague. Suppliants and a Priest beg King Oedipus, who once saved the city from the Sphinx, to save it again. Creon returns from Delphi: Apollo says the city must drive out the killer of the former king, Laius. Oedipus vows to "make dark things clear" and calls the people together.
   Answer guidance: Thebes is dying of a plague. Suppliants and a Priest beg King Oedipus, who once saved the city from the Sphinx, to save it again. Creon returns from Delphi: Apollo says the city must drive out the killer of the former king, Laius. Oedipus vows to "make dark things clear" and calls the people together.

8. Who is on stage in "Prologue (lines 1–155)", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.

   Answer guidance: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when is "Prologue (lines 1–155)" set? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.

   Answer guidance: A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "As I surmise, 'tis welcome; else his head Had scarce been crowned with berry-laden bays." What does "surmise" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** surmise: a guess made without proof.

    Answer guidance: surmise: a guess made without proof.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does the Priest say walls and ships are useless without men (lines 62–63)? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** A city is its people; Oedipus must act as a leader, not rely on defences.

   Answer guidance: A city is its people; Oedipus must act as a leader, not rely on defences.
2. What does "Prologue (lines 1–155)" suggest about a king who promises to find the killer? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** The man who solves riddles sets out to solve one more, and every promise he makes will turn back on him. The audience knows the myth; the king does not. That gap is dramatic irony.

   Answer guidance: The man who solves riddles sets out to solve one more, and every promise he makes will turn back on him. The audience knows the myth; the king does not. That gap is dramatic irony. Evidence to accept: "My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool" (Prologue, lines 1–3): Oedipus calls the citizens his children, so his first words present him as a parent to the city as well as its king. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
3. Find one example of characterization in "Prologue (lines 1–155)". What does it reveal about a king who promises to find the killer that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them. Evidence to accept: "Nor battlements nor galleys aught avail, / If men to man and guards to guard them fail" (Prologue, lines 62–63): The Priest reminds the king that walls and ships protect nothing without people, so a ruler's first duty is to the living city. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
4. How does the irony in "Prologue (lines 1–155)" shape what we understand about a king who promises to find the killer? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Oedipus opens the play as a confident, caring king who

acts quickly for his city. Useful evidence: “My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool” (Prologue, lines 1–3): Oedipus calls the citizens his children, so his first words present him as a parent to the city as well as its king. On irony: Oedipus promises to hunt down the killer of Laius "as though he were my sire" and to "make dark things clear", words an audience that knows the myth hears very differently from the way he means them. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that opens with “My children, latest born to Cadmus old, Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands Branches of olive filleted with wool?”, why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: “In this land, said the god; “who seeks shall find; / Who sits with folded hands or sleeps is blind” (Prologue, lines 116–117): Creon reports the oracle's rule that searching finds what it seeks and idleness keeps people in the dark, which is the rule the king adopts for his inquiry. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

6. What causes the main turn in “Prologue (lines 1–155)”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Look for: Creon's report that Apollo demands the killer of Laius be driven out; Oedipus's vow to make dark things clear; the effect, a public hunt for the killer that the king himself will lead.

   Answer guidance: Look for: Creon's report that Apollo demands the killer of Laius be driven out; Oedipus's vow to make dark things clear; the effect, a public hunt for the killer that the king himself will lead. Evidence to accept: “Well, I will start afresh and once again / Make dark things clear” (Prologue, lines 138–139): Oedipus promises to bring hidden things into the light, a vow that sets up the play's language of darkness and clarity. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

7. As the opening scene, what does “Prologue (lines 1–155)” set up that the rest of Oedipus Rex will need? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Oedipus opens the play as a confident, caring king who acts quickly for his city. Useful evidence: “Nor battlements nor galleys aught avail, / If men to man and guards to guard them fail” (Prologue, lines 62–63): The Priest reminds the king that walls and ships protect nothing without people, so a ruler's first duty is to the living city. Theme link: Oedipus treats the city's sickness as his own and promises public action, so the Prologue measures him as a leader by what he vows to do for Thebes. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. In “Prologue (lines 1–155)”, what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about a king who promises to find the killer, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Oedipus opens the play as a confident, caring king who acts quickly for his city. Useful evidence: “In this land, said the god; “who seeks shall find; / Who sits with folded hands or sleeps is blind” (Prologue, lines 116–117): Creon reports the oracle's rule that searching finds what it seeks and idleness keeps people in the dark, which is the rule the king adopts for his inquiry. On characterization: Oedipus answers the suppliants himself rather than through a messenger, and he has

already sent Creon to Delphi before anyone asked: a king who acts first and speaks of the city's pain as his own. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (Is a leader responsible for problems he did not knowingly cause? Why or why not?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.
   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: “My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool” (Prologue, lines 1–3): Oedipus calls the citizens his children, so his first words present him as a parent to the city as well as its king. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
10. Where does setting appear in “Prologue (lines 1–155)”, and how does it connect a king who promises to find the killer to the larger concern with fate and responsibility? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Oedipus opens the play as a confident, caring king who acts quickly for his city. Useful evidence: “Well, I will start afresh and once again / Make dark things clear” (Prologue, lines 138–139): Oedipus promises to bring hidden things into the light, a vow that sets up the play's language of darkness and clarity. On setting: The play opens at the palace altar of a city in crisis: crops, herds and births are failing, and the people sit as suppliants holding wool-wrapped olive branches, the sign of a formal plea to a god or king. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Oedipus a good king in the Prologue? Take a position using two quoted lines. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Yes, in the Prologue he is a caring and decisive king. He calls the suppliants "My children" (lines 1–3) and says he has already sent Creon to Delphi before they asked. He vows to "Make dark things clear" (lines 138–139), so his first acts serve the city. A strong answer may add that his certainty is untested, since he has not yet heard anything he does not want to hear.
   Answer guidance: Yes, in the Prologue he is a caring and decisive king. He calls the suppliants "My children" (lines 1–3) and says he has already sent Creon to Delphi before they asked. He vows to "Make dark things clear" (lines 138–139), so his first acts serve the city. A strong answer may add that his certainty is untested, since he has not yet heard anything he does not want to hear.
2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): The man who solves riddles sets out to solve one more, and every promise he makes will turn back on him. The audience knows the myth; the king does not. That gap is dramatic irony. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Oedipus opens the play as a confident, caring king who acts quickly for his city. Useful evidence: “Nor battlements nor galleys aught avail, / If men to man and guards to guard them fail” (Prologue, lines 62–63): The Priest reminds the king that walls and ships protect nothing without people, so a ruler's first duty is to the living city. Theme link: Oedipus treats the city's

sickness as his own and promises public action, so the Prologue measures him as a leader by what he vows to do for Thebes. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in "Prologue (lines 1–155)" acts most wisely in the matter of a king who promises to find the killer, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Oedipus opens the play as a confident, caring king who acts quickly for his city. Useful evidence: "In this land, said the god; "who seeks shall find; / Who sits with folded hands or sleeps is blind" (Prologue, lines 116–117): Creon reports the oracle's rule that searching finds what it seeks and idleness keeps people in the dark, which is the rule the king adopts for his inquiry. On characterization: Oedipus answers the suppliants himself rather than through a messenger, and he has already sent Creon to Delphi before anyone asked: a king who acts first and speaks of the city's pain as his own. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing "Prologue (lines 1–155)". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of a king who promises to find the killer. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Oedipus opens the play as a confident, caring king who acts quickly for his city. Useful evidence: "Well, I will start afresh and once again / Make dark things clear" (Prologue, lines 138–139): Oedipus promises to bring hidden things into the light, a vow that sets up the play's language of darkness and clarity. Theme link: Oedipus treats the city's sickness as his own and promises public action, so the Prologue measures him as a leader by what he vows to do for Thebes. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write your own questions about "Prologue (lines 1–155)": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Oedipus opens the play as a confident, caring king who acts quickly for his city. Useful evidence: "My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool" (Prologue, lines 1–3): Oedipus calls the citizens his children, so his first words present him as a parent to the city as well as its king. Theme link: Oedipus treats the city's sickness as his own and promises public action, so the Prologue measures him as a leader by what he vows to do for Thebes. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect "Prologue (lines 1–155)", with its focus on a king who promises to find the killer, to pride and fall: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Oedipus opens the play as a confident, caring king who acts quickly for his city. Useful evidence: "Nor battlements nor galleys aught avail, / If men to man and

guards to guard them fail" (Prologue, lines 62–63): The Priest reminds the king that walls and ships protect nothing without people, so a ruler's first duty is to the living city. Theme link: Oedipus treats the city's sickness as his own and promises public action, so the Prologue measures him as a leader by what he vows to do for Thebes. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in "Prologue (lines 1–155)" effective in presenting a king who promises to find the killer, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Oedipus opens the play as a confident, caring king who acts quickly for his city. Useful evidence: "In this land, said the god; "who seeks shall find; / Who sits with folded hands or sleeps is blind" (Prologue, lines 116–117): Creon reports the oracle's rule that searching finds what it seeks and idleness keeps people in the dark, which is the rule the king adopts for his inquiry. On characterization: Oedipus answers the suppliants himself rather than through a messenger, and he has already sent Creon to Delphi before anyone asked: a king who acts first and speaks of the city's pain as his own. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how "Prologue (lines 1–155)" treats a king who promises to find the killer with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus Rex see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Oedipus opens the play as a confident, caring king who acts quickly for his city. Useful evidence: "Well, I will start afresh and once again / Make dark things clear" (Prologue, lines 138–139): Oedipus promises to bring hidden things into the light, a vow that sets up the play's language of darkness and clarity. Theme link: Oedipus treats the city's sickness as his own and promises public action, so the Prologue measures him as a leader by what he vows to do for Thebes. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what "Parodos (lines 156–213)" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Oedipus opens the play as a confident, caring king who acts quickly for his city. Useful evidence: "My children, latest born to Cadmus old, / Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool" (Prologue, lines 1–3): Oedipus calls the citizens his children, so his first words present him as a parent to the city as well as its king. Theme link: Oedipus treats the city's sickness as his own and promises public action, so the Prologue measures him as a leader by what he vows to do for Thebes. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of "Prologue (lines 1–155)" (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about a king who promises to find the killer? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Oedipus opens the play as a confident, caring king who

acts quickly for his city. Useful evidence: “Nor battlements nor galleys aught avail, / If men to man and guards to guard them fail” (Prologue, lines 62–63): The Priest reminds the king that walls and ships protect nothing without people, so a ruler's first duty is to the living city. Theme link: Oedipus treats the city's sickness as his own and promises public action, so the Prologue measures him as a leader by what he vows to do for Thebes. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] According to the Priest, what has the blight struck?

   A. Crops in the field, flocks and herds, and women in childbirth

   B. The olive groves, the vineyards, and the city's wells and springs

   C. Temples, the royal palace, and the busy market-places

   D. Ships in the harbour, the city walls, and the soldiers

   Key: A (Crops in the field, flocks and herds, and women in childbirth)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whom has Oedipus already sent to ask the god how to save Thebes?

   A. The aged Priest of Zeus

   B. Creon, his consort's brother

   C. A herald from the palace

   D. A soldier of the royal guard

   Key: B (Creon, his consort's brother)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Creon say the god names as the source of the city's suffering?

   A. A curse laid on the city long ago by a foreign king who was wronged

   B. A curse laid on the city by a foreign king

   C. A pollution in the land that must be driven out

   D. A drought sent because the sacrifices stopped

   Key: C (A pollution in the land that must be driven out)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the Priest's image: “For, as thou seest thyself, our ship of _____, Sore buffeted, can no more lift her head”

   Key: State

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Oedipus's promise: “I also, as is meet, will lend my aid To _____ this wrong to Thebes and to the god.”

   Key: avenge

6. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Oedipus says he has come out to the suppliants "myself" rather than learn of their trouble from others. What does this choice suggest about him?

   A. He distrusts the Priest and wants to test him

   B. He has been ordered to appear by the god

   C. He hopes the crowd will praise him in public

   D. He wants to hear the city's trouble firsthand

   Key: D (He wants to hear the city's trouble firsthand)

7. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] The Priest says the people come to Oedipus "not as deeming thee A new divinity, but the first of men". What is the Priest doing in this line?

   A. Honoring him as the best of mortals, not as a god

   B. Warning him that the gods have turned against him

   C. Suggesting that a priest should rule the city

   D. Admitting the people no longer trust his judgment

   Key: A (Honoring him as the best of mortals, not as a god)

8. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] The Priest says the city's ship has "Foundered beneath a weltering surge of blood". What does this image suggest about the condition of Thebes?

   Sample answer: Thebes is like a storm-battered ship that has gone under: "Foundered beneath a weltering surge of blood" (line 27). The "surge of blood" turns the storm into the toll of the plague. The image shows a city overwhelmed and helpless, so it needs the king who steers it to act at once.

9. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] The Priest opens each of lines 28–30 with "A blight". What is the effect of this repetition?

   Sample answer: The repetition hammers home that the disaster is everywhere at once: "A blight is on our harvest in the ear, / A blight upon the grazing flocks and herds, / A blight on wives in travail". Each line adds a new victim (crops, animals, mothers and unborn children), so the list builds a sense of a city whose whole future is dying, and it makes the plea sound urgent and ritual.

10. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Oedipus's first words to the suppliants are "My children". What does this form of address show about how he sees his role as king?

    Sample answer: He speaks as a parent to the city, not as a distant ruler. Calling the citizens "My children, latest born to Cadmus old" (line 1) presents him as responsible for them and close to them; he later says "Ruthless indeed were I and obdurate / If such petitioners as you I spurned" (lines 14–15). The address shows a king who feels their suffering is his to answer.

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] According to Creon, why did Thebes never fully investigate the murder of its former king?

    A. The riddling Sphinx kept the city busy with urgent troubles

    B. The king's guards had all been slain in the attack, so no one was left to ask

    C. The priests forbade any search for a full year

    D. The elders could not agree on who should judge it

    Key: A (The riddling Sphinx kept the city busy with urgent troubles)

12. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What did the escaped witness report about the attackers of Laius?

    A. A single bandit attacked the king alone

B. A troop of robbers attacked, not one bandit

C. Soldiers from a rival city ambushed him

D. Wild beasts attacked the travellers at night

Key: B (A troop of robbers attacked, not one bandit)

13. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Creon's report of the oracle: “A fell pollution that infests the land, And no more harbour an _____ sore.”

Key: inveterate

14. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] When Creon names Laius as the land's earlier king, what does Oedipus reply?

A. That Laius had once named him as heir to the throne

B. That he had fought beside Laius in a war

C. That he had heard of him but never saw him

D. That Laius had once named him as his heir

Key: C (That he had heard of him but never saw him)

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Oedipus tell Creon to report the oracle in front of everyone instead of privately in the palace?

A. He thinks Creon may be hiding bad news and wants the crowd to hear it

B. He wants witnesses in case Creon lies later

C. He is too impatient to walk back to the palace

D. He carries the burden more for his subjects than for himself

Key: D (He carries the burden more for his subjects than for himself)

16. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Oedipus asks, “Where in the wide world to find The far, faint traces of a bygone crime?” What does his question reveal about the task the oracle has set?

Sample answer: The task looks almost impossible: the crime is old (“bygone”), the evidence is “far, faint”, and no one knows where to look. The question shows Oedipus seeing the difficulty clearly, which makes his decision to take the search on anyway a sign of determination; Creon's answer that the god says it is “In this land” gives him a starting point.

17. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Oedipus think that whoever attacked Laius was paid by someone in Thebes?

A. No bandit would dare strike a king unless someone powerful hired him

B. The survivor named a Theban who had paid the robbers

C. The oracle said the killer was a Theban noble

D. Robbers near Thebes usually worked for a master

Key: A (No bandit would dare strike a king unless someone powerful hired him)

18. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Oedipus says, “Not for some far-off kinsman, but myself, Shall I expel this poison in the blood” (lines 143–144). Analyze how he presents his own stake in finding the killer.

Sample answer: He makes the search personal: he is not avenging a distant relative but protecting himself, because “whoso slew that king might have a mind / To strike me too with his assassin hand”. The speech joins public duty and self-interest (“in righting him I serve myself”), and the image of expelling “poison in the blood” carries the Priest's disease language into his vow, so the hunt becomes a cure for the city and a defence of the king.

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Creon reports, “King Phoebus bids us straitly extirpate” what infests the land. Analyze how the oracle's language of disease and cleansing shapes the way the god's command is understood.

    Sample answer: The god speaks of the crime as an infection to be rooted out: “extirpate” means to pull up by the roots, and the thing to be removed is a pollution and a long-standing sore (lines 102–104). This matches the plague the Priest described, so the city's sickness becomes a symptom of guilt. The cure is purification rather than medicine or prayer, which turns the search for a slayer into the city's only treatment.

20. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Trace how the city's trouble is described first by the Priest and then by the oracle. How does the second description change what Oedipus must do?

    Sample answer: The Priest describes a natural disaster: “A blight is on our harvest in the ear” and the God of Plague empties the house of Cadmus (lines 28–33), and he asks only for “succour”. Creon's oracle explains the cause: “This stain of blood makes shipwreck of our state” (line 107). The problem moves from relief to justice, so Oedipus must now find and punish a killer instead of simply easing suffering.

21. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the Priest's list: “A blight on wives in _____; and withal Armed with his blazing torch the God of Plague”

    Key: travail

22. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] According to Creon, who survived the attack on Laius's party?

    A. One man, who fled for his life

    B. Two of the king's guards

    C. No one; the bodies were found later

    D. A priest who was travelling with the king

    Key: A (One man, who fled for his life)

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] From what burden does the Priest say Oedipus once freed the city?

    A. A toll on every ship entering the harbour

    B. The tax they paid to the fell songstress

    C. A war debt owed to a neighbouring king

    D. A yearly tithe owed to the temple of Zeus

    Key: B (The tax they paid to the fell songstress)

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] The Priest says Oedipus acted “by a god inspired (so all men deem, And testify)”. What does the parenthesis add to his praise?

    A. It shows that the Priest privately doubts the king's wisdom and his luck

    B. It quotes the oracle of Delphi word for word

    C. It reports a shared public belief rather than the Priest's own certain knowledge

    D. It asks Oedipus to confess that the gods helped him

    Key: C (It reports a shared public belief rather than the Priest's own certain knowledge)

25. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Oedipus introduces himself as “I Oedipus, your world-renownèd king” (line 8). What does this self-introduction suggest about how he sees himself and his relationship to the city?

    Sample answer: He presents himself as famous and public, a king whose name alone should reassure the people. The line shows confidence and some pride: he assumes his reputation is a resource the city can rely on. Because he has come himself

rather than hear from others (lines 6–7), the boast is also a promise that the renowned king will personally take up their cause.

26. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] The Prologue moves from the Priest's plea, to Creon's report, to Oedipus's vow. Analyze how this order builds the question the rest of the play must answer.
Sample answer: The plea establishes the crisis (the blight and plague), Creon's report converts it into a mystery (the god demands that whoever slew Laius be found and punished: "Punish his takers-off, whoe'er they be"), and the vow commits the king to solve it ("Well, I will start afresh and once again / Make dark things clear"). Each step narrows the problem, so the scene ends on one open question: who slew Laius, and what happens when he is found?

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Creon reports that Phoebus bids the city "straitly extirpate A fell pollution". Which pair of words best describes the tone of the god's command?
A. Gentle and hopeful
B. Playful and teasing
C. Doubtful and confused
D. Severe and urgent
Key: D (Severe and urgent)

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Oedipus ends his vow with "With the god's good help Success is sure; 'tis ruin if we fail". Analyze what this closing line reveals about his confidence and the stakes he sets.
Sample answer: The line pairs total confidence ("Success is sure") with a stark alternative ("'tis ruin if we fail"). Oedipus trusts the god and himself, but he also tells the city there is no middle outcome: the search will save Thebes or destroy it. The balanced, all-or-nothing phrasing raises the stakes for everything that follows and shows a leader who commits publicly before he knows the facts.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] The Priest pictures the city as a ship that "Foundered beneath a weltering surge of blood", and the oracle's messenger later reports, "This stain of blood makes shipwreck of our state." How does the repeated ship image deepen the Prologue's sense of the city's danger?
Sample answer: Both speakers see Thebes as a ship going down, but the second use explains the first. The Priest's "weltering surge of blood" describes the toll of the plague (lines 25–27); the oracle's "stain of blood" (line 107) names an old murder as the cause. The repeated image ties suffering to guilt and makes the king, who took "the helm of State", the one who must steer the city out of the wreck.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Using one line spoken by the Priest and one spoken by Oedipus, explain how the Prologue presents the bond between the king and his people.
Sample answer: The Priest says, "Therefore, O King, here at thy hearth we sit, / I and these children" (lines 35–36): the people come to the king's own hearth as dependants. Oedipus answers like a parent, "My children, latest born to Cadmus old" (line 1), and promises to act. The bond is close and mutual: they trust him because he saved them before, and he accepts their suffering as his own duty.

31. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Oedipus's reasoning: "For whoso slew that king might have a mind To strike me too with his _____ hand."
Key: assassin

32. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] According to Creon, what two ways of cleansing the city does the god permit?
A. Banishment, or the shedding of blood for blood
B. A heavy fine, or a year of service in the temple

C. Prison, or public penance at the altar

D. Slavery, or the loss of all property

Key: A (Banishment, or the shedding of blood for blood)

33. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] The Priest calls Oedipus “First in the common accidents of life, And first in visitations of the Gods”. What does he mean?

    A. He was the first in Thebes to see the plague arriving and to warn the people of it

    B. He is the best person to meet both ordinary troubles and disasters sent from heaven

    C. He was the first to see the plague arriving in the city

    D. He should be worshipped first, ahead of the gods

    Key: B (He is the best person to meet both ordinary troubles and disasters sent from heaven)

34. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Creon says, “Let me report then all the god declared,” and Oedipus soon asks, “What expiation means he? What’s amiss?” What does this exchange suggest about the way the god communicates?

    Sample answer: The god speaks in general terms, not names: Creon reports a command to drive out “A fell pollution”, and Oedipus has to ask what cleansing is meant and what is wrong. Divine knowledge reaches the city only through interpretation, so human questioning is needed to turn the oracle into action. The exchange sets up a play in which the meaning of what the gods say has to be dug out.

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Which literary device is most at work when the Priest describes the God of Plague as “Armed with his blazing torch”?

    A. Characterization

    B. Understatement

    C. Personification

    D. Alliteration

    Key: C (Personification)

36. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze Creon's report of the god's words, “who seeks shall find; Who sits with folded hands or sleeps is blind”, as a statement about knowledge in the Prologue.

    Sample answer: The couplet makes knowledge something won by effort: finding depends on seeking, while idleness (“folded hands”) and sleep leave one unable to see. The rhyme of “find” and “blind” sets active inquiry against passive ignorance. It authorizes Oedipus's method (questions, a public search) and links seeing with understanding, an idea the Prologue already uses when Oedipus vows to “Make dark things clear”.

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Analyze how the Priest's speech (lines 35–45) both flatters Oedipus and puts pressure on him.

    Sample answer: The Priest praises him as “the first of men” and credits him with freeing the city from “the tax we paid / To the fell songstress”, saying he did it “by a god inspired”. That praise sets a standard: a man who saved Thebes once is expected to do it again. Flattery becomes obligation, because the city's trust (“here at thy hearth we sit”) allows the king no room to refuse.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Across the Prologue, how does Sophocles link the city's physical sickness to a moral cause? Use one quotation from the Priest and one from Creon.

    Sample answer: The Priest describes the sickness physically: “Armed with his blazing torch the God of Plague / Hath swooped upon our city” (lines 31–32), emptying the house of Cadmus. Creon's oracle gives its cause: “King Phoebus bids us straitly extirpate / A fell pollution that infests the land” (lines 102–103), a pollution of blood-guilt. Plague becomes a sign of an unpunished crime, so healing the city requires justice, not just prayer.

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Oedipus says, “Therefore in righting him I serve myself.” Considering the whole Prologue, evaluate whether his motives are mainly public or private.

    Sample answer: Mainly public, with a private edge. He has already sent Creon to Delphi “How I might save the State by act or word”, insists on hearing the oracle before everyone, and grieves “for the general and myself and you”. Yet he openly adds self-protection: the killer “might have a mind / To strike me too”. The Prologue presents a king whose duty and self-interest point the same way, which strengthens his resolve.

40. [mc · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which statement best captures how the Prologue as a whole defines good kingship?

    A. A good king keeps hard news from the people so that the city does not panic

    B. A good king keeps hard news from the people to avoid panic

    C. A good king waits for the gods rather than acting himself

    D. A good king treats the city's suffering as his own and acts on it

    Key: D (A good king treats the city's suffering as his own and acts on it)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 3, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 2
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 2, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Prologue (lines 1–155) develops the idea of a king who promises to find the killer. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Prologue (lines 1–155)” could deliver about a king who promises to find the killer. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for a king who promises to find the killer in “Prologue (lines 1–155)”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to fate and responsibility and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Prologue (lines 1–155) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of a king who promises to find the killer. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Prologue (lines 1–155)" could deliver about a king who promises to find the killer. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for a king who promises to find the killer in "Prologue (lines 1–155)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to fate and responsibility and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Prologue (lines 1–155) suggests about a king who promises to find the killer. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Prologue (lines 1–155)" could deliver about a king who promises to find the killer. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for a king who promises to find the killer in "Prologue (lines 1–155)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to fate and responsibility and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses characterization in Prologue (lines 1–155) to complicate the reader's understanding of a king who promises to find the killer. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Prologue (lines 1–155)" could deliver about a king who promises to find the killer. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for a king who promises to find the killer in "Prologue (lines 1–155)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to fate and responsibility and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *My children, latest born to Cadmus old, Why sit ye here as suppliants, in your hands Branches of olive filleted with wool? What means this reek of incense everywhere, And everywhere laments and litanies? Children, it were not meet that I should learn From others, and am hither come, myself, I Oedipus, your world-renownèd king. Ho! aged sire, whose venerable locks Proclaim thee spokesman of this company, Explain your mood and*

purport. Is it dread Of ill that moves you or a boon ye crave? My zeal in your behalf ye cannot doubt; Ruthless indeed were I and obdurate If such petitioners as you I spurned.

Which choice best states a central concern of "Prologue (lines 1–155)"?

A. The curse and the prophet

B. A king who promises to find the killer

C. A hopeful guess

D. Responsibility, mercy and the end

SAT key: 1. B (A king who promises to find the killer)

Lesson 3: Parodos (lines 156–213)

Focus: a city praying for rescue

Objective: Students will analyze how imagery develops in "Parodos (lines 156–213)" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.4; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

The Chorus of Theban elders enters singing. They ask what Apollo's oracle will bring, describe the plague (crops failing, the dead lying unburied) and pray to Athenè, Artemis and Apollo to drive the destroying god away.

Background: The Chorus sang and danced in the orchestra. Its songs divide the play into episodes; this first entrance song is the parodos.

Significance: The city speaks as one voice. The unburied dead show how far the plague has spread, and why the king must act.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *How does a whole community react when it is afraid? Give a modern example. Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to leadership and the city because....*
> **Prompt:** How does a whole community react when it is afraid? Give a modern example.
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to leadership and the city because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: The Chorus speaks for the whole city at once, so the plague is shown as a shared suffering that the king and the gods are asked to end.

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)**
> One key word in context, with verified word histories.
> *Today's words: infection — the spread of disease. "infection": Origin: Old French infection; earlier Late Latin īnfectiō.*
> **Words:** infection: the spread of disease

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The Chorus sang and danced in the orchestra. Its songs divide the play into episodes; this first entrance song is the parodos. The city speaks as one voice. The unburied dead show how far the plague has spread, and why the king must act. Imagery: The Parodos fills the city with sensory pictures of the plague: corpses lying where they fell, infection spreading, wives and grandmothers wailing at the altars. Tone / mood: The Chorus sings in fear and urgent prayer, piling up appeals to the gods ("hear", "defend", "befriend") in a voice that sounds close to panic. Structure: The Parodos is the Chorus's entrance song; it turns from the action of the Prologue to the feeling of the whole city, and it moves from a question about the oracle, through a picture of the plague, to a string of prayers. Watch for plague: The plague stands for a sickness in the whole community; the Chorus treats it as something only the gods and a just answer can cure.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found" slowly and put it in my own words: In these lines Chorus speaks at a turning point of the section, which is about a city praying for rescue. Next, craft. I notice how the lines use imagery, tone to make the audience feel the pressure of the moment on Chorus. The strongest word is "perisheth": the word "perisheth" carries the weight of the lines and points to the section's big idea. Then, effect. What do lines 180–183 reveal about a city praying for rescue? My answer: The city speaks as one voice. The unburied dead show how far the plague has spread, and why the king must act. These lines show a city praying for rescue, and that matters for what follows in the play.

> *Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found (Parodos, lines 180–183)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found" slowly and put it in my own words: In these lines Chorus speaks at a turning point of the section, which is about a city praying for rescue. Next, craft. I notice how the lines use imagery, tone to make the audience feel the pressure of the moment on Chorus. The strongest word is "perisheth": the word "perisheth" carries the weight of the lines and points to the section's big idea. Then, effect. What do lines 180–183 reveal about a city praying for rescue? My answer: The city speaks as one voice. The unburied dead show how far the plague has spread, and why the king must act. These lines show a city praying for rescue, and that matters for what follows in the play.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Wailing", "piercing cries" and "litanies" stand out. Cries of grief are blended with prayers, so the lines show a whole city, from wives to grandmothers, calling on the gods at once. Ask: How does this line connect to leadership and the city? Expected student answer: The Chorus speaks for the whole city at once, so the plague is shown as a shared suffering that the king and the gods are asked to end. (The sound of grief and prayer fills the scene, so the Chorus makes the reader hear the city's despair as well as see it.)

> *Wailing on the altar stair / Wives and grandams rend the air— / Long-drawn moans and piercing cries / Blent with prayers and litanies (Parodos, lines 184–187)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Wailing", "piercing cries" and "litanies" stand out. Cries of grief are blended with prayers, so the lines show a whole city, from wives to grandmothers, calling on the gods at once.
Ask: How does this line connect to leadership and the city?
Expected student answer: The Chorus speaks for the whole city at once, so the plague is shown as a shared suffering that the king and the gods are asked to end. (The sound of grief and prayer fills the scene, so the Chorus makes the reader hear the city's despair as well as see it.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for imagery, tone / mood (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about a city praying for rescue? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Parodos (lines 156–213) develops the idea of a city praying for rescue. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The Parodos turns the plague into the suffering of a whole people, which raises the stakes of the king's search. When the text says "Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found" (Parodos, lines 180–183), it shows this directly. The Chorus describes corpses with "None to tend or mourn" and women wailing on the altar stair, and it prays to god after god; by making the city's pain vivid, the ode shows why the oracle's command has to be obeyed.
Task: Annotate the scene for imagery, tone / mood (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about a city praying for rescue? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Parodos (lines 156–213) develops the idea of a city praying for rescue. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The Parodos turns the plague into the suffering of a whole people, which raises the stakes of the king's search. When the text says "Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found" (Parodos, lines 180–183), it shows this directly. The Chorus describes corpses with "None to tend or mourn" and women wailing on the altar stair, and it prays to god after god; by making the city's pain vivid, the ode shows why the oracle's command has to be obeyed.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: How does a whole community react when it is afraid? Give a modern example. Ask: How does a whole community react when it is afraid? Give a modern example.
Anchor question: How does a whole community react when it is afraid? Give a modern example.
Facilitation: Ask: How does a whole community react when it is afraid? Give a modern example.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about a city praying for rescue? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The Parodos turns the plague into the suffering of a whole people, which raises the stakes of the king's search. ("Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found", Parodos, lines 180–183). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about a city praying for rescue? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The Parodos turns the plague into the suffering of a whole people, which raises the stakes of the king's search. ("Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found", Parodos, lines 180–183). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how imagery shapes a city praying for rescue. Key takeaway: The Chorus speaks for the whole city at once, so the plague is shown as a shared suffering that the king and the gods are asked to end.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Imagery:** The Parodos fills the city with sensory pictures of the plague: corpses lying where they fell, infection spreading, wives and grandmothers wailing at the altars.
- **Tone / mood:** The Chorus sings in fear and urgent prayer, piling up appeals to the gods ("hear", "defend", "befriend") in a voice that sounds close to panic.
- **Structure:** The Parodos is the Chorus's entrance song; it turns from the action of the Prologue to the feeling of the whole city, and it moves from a question about the oracle, through a picture of the plague, to a string of prayers.

Themes and how they develop

- **leadership and the city:** The Chorus speaks for the whole city at once, so the plague is shown as a shared suffering that the king and the gods are asked to end.

Symbols and motifs

- **plague:** The plague stands for a sickness in the whole community; the Chorus treats it as something only the gods and a just answer can cure.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found" (Parodos, lines 180–183) So many have died that the living cannot bury or mourn them, which shows how far the plague has broken the ordinary life of the city.
- "Wailing on the altar stair / Wives and grandams rend the air— / Long-drawn moans and piercing cries / Blent with prayers and litanies" (Parodos, lines 184–187) The sound of grief and prayer fills the scene, so the Chorus makes the reader hear the city's despair as well as see it.
- "Sweet-voiced daughter of Zeus from thy gold-paved Pythian shrine / Wafted to Thebes divine" (Parodos, lines 156–157) The Chorus opens by asking what the oracle from Delphi will mean, mixing hope in the god with fear of his answer.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The Parodos turns the plague into the suffering of a whole people, which raises the stakes of the king's search.
Evidence: "Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found" (Parodos, lines 180–183)
Reasoning: The Chorus describes corpses with "None to tend or mourn" and women wailing on the altar stair, and it prays to god after god; by making the city's pain vivid, the ode shows why the oracle's command has to be obeyed.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 156–157
156 **Chorus:** Sweet-voiced daughter of Zeus from thy gold-paved Pythian shrine
157 **Chorus:** Wafted to Thebes divine,

Line 158
158 **Chorus:** What dost thou bring me? My soul is racked and shivers with fear.

Lines 164–165
164 **Chorus:** Goddess and sister, befriend,
165 **Chorus:** Artemis, Lady of Thebes, high-throned in the midst of our mart!

Lines 167–168
167 **Chorus:** Your threefold aid I crave
168 **Chorus:** From death and ruin our city to save.

Line 171
171 **Chorus:** Ah me, what countless woes are mine!

Lines 171–189
171 **Chorus:** Ah me, what countless woes are mine!

172 **Chorus:** All our host is in decline;
173 **Chorus:** Weaponless my spirit lies.
174 **Chorus:** Earth her gracious fruits denies;
175 **Chorus:** Women wail in barren throes;
176 **Chorus:** Life on life downstriken goes,
177 **Chorus:** Swifter than the wind bird's flight,
178 **Chorus:** Swifter than the Fire-God's might,
179 **Chorus:** To the westering shores of Night.
180 **Chorus:** Wasted thus by death on death
181 **Chorus:** All our city perisheth.
182 **Chorus:** Corpses spread infection round;
183 **Chorus:** None to tend or mourn is found.
184 **Chorus:** Wailing on the altar stair
185 **Chorus:** Wives and grandams rend the air—
186 **Chorus:** Long-drawn moans and piercing cries
187 **Chorus:** Blent with prayers and litanies.
188 **Chorus:** Golden child of Zeus, O hear
189 **Chorus:** Let thine angel face appear!

Lines 174–175
174 **Chorus:** Earth her gracious fruits denies;
175 **Chorus:** Women wail in barren throes;

Lines 176–177
176 **Chorus:** Life on life downstriken goes,
177 **Chorus:** Swifter than the wind bird's flight,

Line 177
177 **Chorus:** Swifter than the wind bird's flight,

Lines 177–178
177 **Chorus:** Swifter than the wind bird's flight,
178 **Chorus:** Swifter than the Fire-God's might,

Lines 180–181
180 **Chorus:** Wasted thus by death on death
181 **Chorus:** All our city perisheth.

Lines 180–183
180 **Chorus:** Wasted thus by death on death
181 **Chorus:** All our city perisheth.
182 **Chorus:** Corpses spread infection round;
183 **Chorus:** None to tend or mourn is found.

Lines 182–183
182 **Chorus:** Corpses spread infection round;
183 **Chorus:** None to tend or mourn is found.

Lines 184–187
184 **Chorus:** Wailing on the altar stair
185 **Chorus:** Wives and grandams rend the air—
186 **Chorus:** Long-drawn moans and piercing cries
187 **Chorus:** Blent with prayers and litanies.

Lines 186–187
186 **Chorus:** Long-drawn moans and piercing cries
187 **Chorus:** Blent with prayers and litanies.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
infection (noun)	the spread of disease	*Corpses spread infection round; None to tend or mourn is found.*	"infection": Origin: Old French infection; earlier Late Latin īnfectiō. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/infection#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. How does a whole community react when it is afraid? Give a modern example.
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with pride and fall?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What does "None to tend or mourn is found" tell us about the city? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** So many have died that no one is left to care for the dead.
   Answer guidance: So many have died that no one is left to care for the dead.
2. Who are the Chorus in this play? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Elders of Thebes
   Answer guidance: Elders of Thebes.
3. What do the Chorus describe in lines 180–183? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The dead lying untended and

spreading infection

Answer guidance: The dead lying untended and spreading infection.

4. Where, besides the Thracian waters, do the elders hope Ares will be driven? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** To Amphitrite's bed, the sea

   Answer guidance: To Amphitrite's bed, the sea.

5. What is the mood of the Parodos? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Fearful and pleading

   Answer guidance: Fearful and pleading.

6. What is a parodos? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The Chorus's entrance song

   Answer guidance: The Chorus's entrance song.

7. Retell the most important events of "Parodos (lines 156–213)" in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The Chorus of Theban elders enters singing. They ask what Apollo's oracle will bring, describe the plague (crops failing, the dead lying unburied) and pray to Athenè, Artemis and Apollo to drive the destroying god away.

   Answer guidance: The Chorus of Theban elders enters singing. They ask what Apollo's oracle will bring, describe the plague (crops failing, the dead lying unburied) and pray to Athenè, Artemis and Apollo to drive the destroying god away.

8. Who is on stage in "Parodos (lines 156–213)", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.

   Answer guidance: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.

9. Where and when is "Parodos (lines 156–213)" set? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.

   Answer guidance: A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.

10. Reread: "Corpses spread infection round; None to tend or mourn is found." What does "infection" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** infection: the spread of disease.

    Answer guidance: infection: the spread of disease.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why might Sophocles open with the city's suffering before the investigation? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** It raises the stakes: finding the killer is a matter of life and death for everyone.

   Answer guidance: It raises the stakes: finding the killer is a matter of life and death for everyone.

2. What does "Parodos (lines 156–213)" suggest about a city praying for rescue? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** The city speaks as one voice. The unburied dead show how far the plague has spread, and why the king must act.

   Answer guidance: The city speaks as one voice. The unburied dead show how far the plague has spread,

and why the king must act. Evidence to accept: “Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found” (Parodos, lines 180–183): So many have died that the living cannot bury or mourn them, which shows how far the plague has broken the ordinary life of the city. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

3. Find one example of imagery in “Parodos (lines 156–213)”. What does it reveal about a city praying for rescue that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.

   Answer guidance: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create. Evidence to accept: “Wailing on the altar stair / Wives and grandams rend the air— / Long-drawn moans and piercing cries / Blent with prayers and litanies” (Parodos, lines 184–187): The sound of grief and prayer fills the scene, so the Chorus makes the reader hear the city's despair as well as see it. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

4. How does the tone / mood in “Parodos (lines 156–213)” shape what we understand about a city praying for rescue? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Look for word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Parodos turns the plague into the suffering of a whole people, which raises the stakes of the king's search. Useful evidence: “Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found” (Parodos, lines 180–183): So many have died that the living cannot bury or mourn them, which shows how far the plague has broken the ordinary life of the city. On tone / mood: The Chorus sings in fear and urgent prayer, piling up appeals to the gods ("hear", "defend", "befriend") in a voice that sounds close to panic. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that opens with “Ah me, what countless woes are mine!”, why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: “Sweet-voiced daughter of Zeus from thy gold-paved Pythian shrine / Wafted to Thebes divine” (Parodos, lines 156–157): The Chorus opens by asking what the oracle from Delphi will mean, mixing hope in the god with fear of his answer. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

6. What causes the main turn in “Parodos (lines 156–213)”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Look for: the turn from describing the plague to prayer; the elders' call on Athenè, Artemis and Apollo; the effect, a city waiting on the gods and on its king.

   Answer guidance: Look for: the turn from describing the plague to prayer; the elders' call on Athenè, Artemis and Apollo; the effect, a city waiting on the gods and on its king. Evidence to accept: “Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found” (Parodos, lines 180–183): So many have died that the living cannot bury or mourn them, which shows how far the plague has broken the ordinary life of the city. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

7. How does “Parodos (lines 156–213)” build on “Prologue (lines 1–155)”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Parodos turns the plague into the suffering of a whole people, which raises the stakes of the king's search. Useful evidence: “Wailing on the altar stair / Wives and grandams rend the air— / Long-drawn moans and piercing cries / Blent with prayers and litanies” (Parodos, lines 184–187): The sound of grief and prayer fills the scene, so the Chorus makes the reader hear the city's despair as well as see it. On structure: The Parodos is the Chorus's entrance song; it turns from the action of the Prologue to the feeling of the whole city, and it moves from a question about the oracle, through a picture of the plague, to a string of prayers. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. In “Parodos (lines 156–213)”, what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about a city praying for rescue, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Parodos turns the plague into the suffering of a whole people, which raises the stakes of the king's search. Useful evidence: “Sweet-voiced daughter of Zeus from thy gold-paved Pythian shrine / Wafted to Thebes divine” (Parodos, lines 156–157): The Chorus opens by asking what the oracle from Delphi will mean, mixing hope in the god with fear of his answer. Theme link: The Chorus speaks for the whole city at once, so the plague is shown as a shared suffering that the king and the gods are asked to end. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (How does a whole community react when it is afraid? Give a modern example.?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.

   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: “Wailing on the altar stair / Wives and grandams rend the air— / Long-drawn moans and piercing cries / Blent with prayers and litanies” (Parodos, lines 184–187): The sound of grief and prayer fills the scene, so the Chorus makes the reader hear the city's despair as well as see it. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

10. Where does structure appear in “Parodos (lines 156–213)”, and how does it connect a city praying for rescue to the larger concern with pride and fall? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Parodos turns the plague into the suffering of a whole people, which raises the stakes of the king's search. Useful evidence: “Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found” (Parodos, lines 180–183): So many have died that the living cannot bury or mourn them, which shows how far the plague has broken the ordinary life of the city. On structure: The Parodos is the Chorus's entrance song; it turns from the action of the Prologue to the feeling of the whole city, and it moves from a question about the oracle, through a picture of the plague, to a string of prayers. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is the Chorus a character or a commentator? Argue with evidence from the Parodos. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** The Chorus is both. As a group of Theban elders, it acts like a character: it fears, prays and pleads, as in "Wailing on the altar stair / Wives and grandams rend the air" (lines 184–185). It also comments on the action for the audience, describing the whole city's state, "None to tend or mourn is found" (line 183). A strong answer weighs which role the Parodos stresses and explains why.

   Answer guidance: The Chorus is both. As a group of Theban elders, it acts like a character: it fears, prays and pleads, as in "Wailing on the altar stair / Wives and grandams rend the air" (lines 184–185). It also comments on the action for the audience, describing the whole city's state, "None to tend or mourn is found" (line 183). A strong answer weighs which role the Parodos stresses and explains why.
2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): The city speaks as one voice. The unburied dead show how far the plague has spread, and why the king must act. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Parodos turns the plague into the suffering of a whole people, which raises the stakes of the king's search. Useful evidence: “Sweet-voiced daughter of Zeus from thy gold-paved Pythian shrine / Wafted to Thebes divine” (Parodos, lines 156–157): The Chorus opens by asking what the oracle from Delphi will mean, mixing hope in the god with fear of his answer. Theme link: The Chorus speaks for the whole city at once, so the plague is shown as a shared suffering that the king and the gods are asked to end. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in “Parodos (lines 156–213)” acts most wisely in the matter of a city praying for rescue, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Parodos turns the plague into the suffering of a whole people, which raises the stakes of the king's search. Useful evidence: “Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found” (Parodos, lines 180–183): So many have died that the living cannot bury or mourn them, which shows how far the plague has broken the ordinary life of the city. Theme link: The Chorus speaks for the whole city at once, so the plague is shown as a shared suffering that the king and the gods are asked to end. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Parodos (lines 156–213)”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of a city praying for rescue. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Parodos turns the plague into the suffering of a whole people, which raises the stakes of the king's search. Useful evidence: “Wailing on the altar stair / Wives and grandams rend the air— / Long-drawn moans and piercing cries / Blent with prayers and litanies” (Parodos, lines 184–187): The sound of grief and prayer fills the scene, so the Chorus makes the

reader hear the city's despair as well as see it. On structure: The Parodos is the Chorus's entrance song; it turns from the action of the Prologue to the feeling of the whole city, and it moves from a question about the oracle, through a picture of the plague, to a string of prayers. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write your own questions about "Parodos (lines 156–213)": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Parodos turns the plague into the suffering of a whole people, which raises the stakes of the king's search. Useful evidence: "Sweet-voiced daughter of Zeus from thy gold-paved Pythian shrine / Wafted to Thebes divine" (Parodos, lines 156–157): The Chorus opens by asking what the oracle from Delphi will mean, mixing hope in the god with fear of his answer. Theme link: The Chorus speaks for the whole city at once, so the plague is shown as a shared suffering that the king and the gods are asked to end. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect "Parodos (lines 156–213)", with its focus on a city praying for rescue, to leadership and the city: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Parodos turns the plague into the suffering of a whole people, which raises the stakes of the king's search. Useful evidence: "Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found" (Parodos, lines 180–183): So many have died that the living cannot bury or mourn them, which shows how far the plague has broken the ordinary life of the city. Theme link: The Chorus speaks for the whole city at once, so the plague is shown as a shared suffering that the king and the gods are asked to end. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the imagery in "Parodos (lines 156–213)" effective in presenting a city praying for rescue, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Parodos turns the plague into the suffering of a whole people, which raises the stakes of the king's search. Useful evidence: "Wailing on the altar stair / Wives and grandams rend the air— / Long-drawn moans and piercing cries / Blent with prayers and litanies" (Parodos, lines 184–187): The sound of grief and prayer fills the scene, so the Chorus makes the reader hear the city's despair as well as see it. On imagery: The Parodos fills the city with sensory pictures of the plague: corpses lying where they fell, infection spreading, wives and grandmothers wailing at the altars. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how "Parodos (lines 156–213)" treats a city praying for rescue with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus Rex see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Parodos turns the plague into the suffering of a whole people, which raises the stakes of the king's search. Useful evidence: “Sweet-voiced daughter of Zeus from thy gold-paved Pythian shrine / Wafted to Thebes divine” (Parodos, lines 156–157): The Chorus opens by asking what the oracle from Delphi will mean, mixing hope in the god with fear of his answer. Theme link: The Chorus speaks for the whole city at once, so the plague is shown as a shared suffering that the king and the gods are asked to end. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Episode 1 (lines 214–479)” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Parodos turns the plague into the suffering of a whole people, which raises the stakes of the king's search. Useful evidence: “Wasted thus by death on death / All our city perisheth. / Corpses spread infection round; / None to tend or mourn is found” (Parodos, lines 180–183): So many have died that the living cannot bury or mourn them, which shows how far the plague has broken the ordinary life of the city. Theme link: The Chorus speaks for the whole city at once, so the plague is shown as a shared suffering that the king and the gods are asked to end. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of “Parodos (lines 156–213)” (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about a city praying for rescue? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Parodos turns the plague into the suffering of a whole people, which raises the stakes of the king's search. Useful evidence: “Wailing on the altar stair / Wives and grandams rend the air— / Long-drawn moans and piercing cries / Blent with prayers and litanies” (Parodos, lines 184–187): The sound of grief and prayer fills the scene, so the Chorus makes the reader hear the city's despair as well as see it. Theme link: The Chorus speaks for the whole city at once, so the plague is shown as a shared suffering that the king and the gods are asked to end. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] From which shrine does the Chorus picture the god's message coming?
   A. The gold-paved Pythian shrine
   B. A temple of Ares far off in Thrace
   C. The altar of Zeus in the Theban market

D. A mountain shrine of the god Bacchus

Key: A (The gold-paved Pythian shrine)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whom does the Chorus first call on for help?

   A. Zeus, Hera and Poseidon of the sea

   B. Athenè, Artemis and Apollo

   C. Ares, Bacchus and Hera

   D. Pluto, Persephone and the Furies

   Key: B (Athenè, Artemis and Apollo)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does the Chorus describe the dead in the city?

   A. They are buried with honour by the priests

   B. They are carried out of the city to the sea

   C. They lie unmourned and spread infection

   D. They are burned on pyres at the city gates

   Key: C (They lie unmourned and spread infection)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the Chorus's prayer: "Your threefold aid I crave From death and _____ our city to save."

   Key: ruin

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the Chorus's lament: "Earth her gracious fruits denies; Women wail in _____ throes"

   Key: barren

6. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] The Chorus asks whether the god brings "some pain unknown before" or renews an old penance. What does this question show?

   A. They already know exactly what the god commands

   B. They doubt that the oracle has any power at all

   C. They are eager for a festival in honour of the god

   D. They dread the oracle without knowing what it will ask

   Key: D (They dread the oracle without knowing what it will ask)

7. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Why does the Chorus remind the gods that they once drove a fiery plague from the land?

   A. To argue that the gods helped before and can again

   B. To boast that Thebes has hardly suffered at all

   C. To blame the gods for letting the plague come back

   D. To prove that the plague will end on its own soon

   Key: A (To argue that the gods helped before and can again)

8. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] The Chorus says, "Weaponless my spirit lies." What does this line suggest about how the people feel?

   Sample answer: The people feel helpless. Their courage and strength are gone, and they have nothing to fight the plague with, so they can only pray to the gods. The line also prepares for the prayers that follow, since a people without weapons of its own must ask stronger powers to fight for it.

9. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the effect of the short, rhymed lines in "Wasted thus by death on death All our city perisheth".

    Sample answer: The short lines and quick rhymes make the lament sound like a chant of grief. The phrase death on death piles loss upon loss, and the rhyme snaps shut on perisheth, so the couplet sounds final and relentless, like the plague itself. The form itself enacts the speed of the dying it describes.

10. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does the comparison "Swifter than the wild bird's flight" convey the nature of the plague?

    Sample answer: Death moves faster than a bird can fly, so the plague seems impossible to escape. The simile also makes the souls of the dead look like birds leaving the city, which turns the speed of the disease into an image of the whole city emptying.

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] According to the Chorus, where are the souls of the dead swept away to?

    A. To the westering shores of Night
    B. To the bright halls of Zeus on the mountain
    C. Across the far Thracian waters
    D. Up to the gold-paved shrine

    Key: A (To the westering shores of Night)

12. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Where do the wives and grandams wail, according to the Chorus?

    A. At the gates of the city wall
    B. On the altar stair
    C. In the crowded market square
    D. Beside the river Ismenus

    Key: B (On the altar stair)

13. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does the Chorus ask Father Zeus to do to Ares?

    A. Make peace with him for the sake of the city
    B. Send him back home to lead the Thracian army
    C. Slay him with the lightning
    D. Bind him in chains below the earth

    Key: C (Slay him with the lightning)

14. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the lament: "Life on life downstricken goes, Swifter than the wild bird's _____"

    Key: flight

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] The Chorus pictures the plague as Ares, the war god, attacking without shield or sword. What does this image suggest?

    A. The city is about to be invaded by a real army
    B. The soldiers of Thebes have run from the battle
    C. Ares wants the city to offer him a sacrifice
    D. The plague slays like a war no weapon can resist

    Key: D (The plague slays like a war no weapon can resist)

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the Chorus's appeal to many gods at once suggest about the city?

    A. It is desperate for help from any power

    B. It wants to hold a festival for every god

    C. It cannot remember which god founded Thebes

    D. It trusts the gods more than it trusts the king

    Key: A (It is desperate for help from any power)

17. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Why does the Chorus open by asking what the oracle from the Pythian shrine will bring, rather than by praising the god?

    Sample answer: The Chorus has not yet heard the oracle, so its first feeling is fear of what the god may demand. Opening with questions shows a city waiting anxiously for judgment rather than celebrating. The questions also build suspense for the audience, who will soon hear what the god has commanded.

18. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the closing lines of the lament, “Long-drawn moans and piercing cries Blent with prayers and litanies”.

    Sample answer: The lines mix two kinds of sound: the raw noise of grief and the ordered words of prayer. Blending them shows that worship in Thebes has become part of mourning, so even the city's religion sounds like a cry of pain. The lament ends on prayer, which leads straight into the Chorus's next appeal to the gods.

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the Parodos turn the plague described in the Prologue into a religious crisis?

    Sample answer: The Chorus treats the plague as the work of hostile powers and answers it with prayer, calling on Athenè, Artemis and Apollo. Disease becomes a matter between the city and its gods, which prepares for an oracle that demands purification rather than medicine.

20. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Compare the Priest's description of the blight in the Prologue with the Chorus's in the Parodos. What does the Chorus add?

    Sample answer: The Priest reports the facts to the king: “A blight on wives in travail”. The Chorus voices the grief from within the city: “Women wail in barren throes”, and it adds unburied corpses and wailing at the altars. The Chorus turns the Priest's report into lament and prayer.

21. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the prayer: “Goddess and sister, befriend, Artemis, Lady of Thebes, high-throned in the midst of our _____!”

    Key: mart

22. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does the Chorus call the voice that comes from the Pythian shrine?

    A. Offspring of golden Hope

    B. Daughter of dark Night

    C. The herald of the war god Ares

    D. The child of the Sphinx

    Key: A (Offspring of golden Hope)

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Which god does the Chorus call on last, asking him to come with his bright torch?

    A. Hera

    B. Bacchus

C. Poseidon

D. Demeter

Key: B (Bacchus)

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] The Chorus prays that Ares be driven away to distant seas. What does this wish reveal?

A. They hope Ares will conquer a rival city for them

B. They believe the plague came from the sea

C. They want the plague sent far from Thebes

D. They want the god punished for an old insult

Key: C (They want the plague sent far from Thebes)

25. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the line “My soul is racked and shivers with fear” reveal about how the Chorus waits for the oracle?

Sample answer: The Chorus waits in dread rather than hope. It does not know whether the god will bring relief or a new penalty, and the physical words racked and shivers show fear felt in the body. Its fear also prepares the audience to take the oracle's command as a matter of life and death for the whole city.

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Which device is most prominent in “Swifter than the wild bird’s flight, Swifter than the Fire-God’s might”?

A. Understatement

B. Onomatopoeia

C. Flashback

D. Anaphora

Key: D (Anaphora)

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze how the Chorus moves from prayer (lines 156–170) to lament (lines 171–187).

Sample answer: The first lines are addressed to gods, with requests and reminders of past help. Then the Chorus turns to its own suffering and lists it line by line. The shift shows that prayer alone cannot hold back the horror, and the lament gives the gods the reason they should act.

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does “Corpses spread infection round; None to tend or mourn is found” deepen the horror of the plague?

Sample answer: The dead are left unburied, which for the Greeks was a religious horror as well as a danger to health. The line shows that the plague has broken even the rites owed to the dead, so the city is losing its order and its piety along with its people.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the Chorus's fear in the Parodos echo the Priest's plea in the Prologue? Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: The Priest says the city's ship “can no more lift her head”, and the Chorus says “All our host is in decline”. Both describe a city too weak to save itself. The Priest turns to the king, while the Chorus turns to the gods, so together they show a people seeking help from every power.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does the Parodos change the audience's sense of what Oedipus's search must achieve, compared with his vow at the end of the Prologue?

Sample answer: Oedipus vows to find the guilty man as a matter of justice. The Parodos shows that the whole city's survival

and its standing with the gods depend on that search. His task grows from an investigation into a rescue of Thebes from divine anger.

31. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the lament: “All our host is in _____; Weaponless my spirit lies.”

    Key: decline

32. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does the Chorus call Athenè when it asks her to show her face?

    A. Golden child of Zeus

    B. Lady of the Lycian steeps

    C. Mother of the Theban kings

    D. The sea's daughter

    Key: A (Golden child of Zeus)

33. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] The Chorus ends by calling on gods to destroy a god whom the other gods hate. What does this suggest about how they understand the plague?

    A. As a natural sickness that doctors will cure

    B. As a divine enemy only other gods can defeat

    C. As a punishment they have fully deserved

    D. As a trick played on them by a rival city

    Key: B (As a divine enemy only other gods can defeat)

34. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Why does the Chorus address the oracle as “thou voice immortal” (line 162)?

    Sample answer: The oracle is the god's word reaching human beings, so the Chorus treats it as something divine that will outlast them. The address shows reverence and fear, because an immortal voice cannot be argued with once it has spoken. The phrase also links the oracle to hope, since the Chorus has just called it the offspring of golden Hope.

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What is the main effect of the shift from long, flowing lines (156–170) to short, rhymed lines (171–187)?

    A. The verse slows down to show the city's calm

    B. The verse turns comic to relieve the tension

    C. The verse quickens to mirror panic and rapid dying

    D. The verse imitates the oracle's riddling speech

    Key: C (The verse quickens to mirror panic and rapid dying)

36. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze the Chorus's request for “threefold aid” (line 167).

    Sample answer: The Chorus asks Athenè, Artemis and Apollo to act together, as if one god were not enough against the plague. The request measures how great the danger is, and it shows the city gathering every protector it has, which makes the later reliance on one human king more striking.

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze how the Parodos joins the gods of Thebes with the god of Delphi.

    Sample answer: The Chorus addresses the voice from the Pythian shrine and then Athenè, Artemis, Apollo, Zeus and Bacchus, whose name the land bears. Local gods and the god of the oracle are asked to act together. The song makes the crisis both civic and religious, and it ties the city's fate to the oracle's command.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Across the Prologue and the Parodos, how does Sophocles show that Thebes's suffering is both physical and spiritual? Use one quotation from each section.
    Sample answer: The Priest describes physical ruin: “A blight is on our harvest in the ear”. The Chorus describes spiritual ruin as well: “Corpses spread infection round; None to tend or mourn is found”, so even the rites of the dead have failed. Together the sections show a city sick in body and in its relation to the gods.
39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] The Prologue ends with Oedipus's confident vow, and the Parodos follows with the Chorus's fear. Evaluate how this sequence shapes the audience's expectations.
    Sample answer: Placing fear directly after confidence creates tension. The king promises success, but the Chorus shows how great and how divine the danger is. The audience is left doubting whether human resolve is enough, which makes every step of the search feel uncertain.
40. [mc · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Which statement best describes the role of the Chorus in the Parodos?
    A. It argues against the king's plan to search for the guilty
    B. It describes Creon's journey to Delphi in detail
    C. It mocks the gods for failing to protect the city
    D. It voices the whole city's fear and its prayers

    Key: D (It voices the whole city's fear and its prayers)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 3, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 2
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 2, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Parodos (lines 156–213) develops the idea of a city praying for rescue. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4; W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Parodos (lines 156–213)” could deliver about a city praying for rescue. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4; W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for a city praying for rescue in “Parodos (lines 156–213)”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to fate and responsibility and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Parodos (lines 156–213) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of a

city praying for rescue. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Parodos (lines 156–213)" could deliver about a city praying for rescue. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for a city praying for rescue in "Parodos (lines 156–213)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to fate and responsibility and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Parodos (lines 156–213) suggests about a city praying for rescue. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Parodos (lines 156–213)" could deliver about a city praying for rescue. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for a city praying for rescue in "Parodos (lines 156–213)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to fate and responsibility and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses imagery in Parodos (lines 156–213) to complicate the reader's understanding of a city praying for rescue. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Parodos (lines 156–213)" could deliver about a city praying for rescue. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for a city praying for rescue in "Parodos (lines 156–213)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to fate and responsibility and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Ah me, what countless woes are mine! All our host is in decline; Weaponless my spirit lies. Earth her gracious fruits denies; Women wail in barren throes; Life on life downstricken goes, Swifter than the wild bird's flight, Swifter than the Fire-God's might, To the westering shores of Night. Wasted thus by death on death All our city perisheth. Corpses spread infection round; None to tend or mourn is found. Wailing on the altar stair*

Wives and grandams rend the air— Long-drawn moans and piercing cries Blent with prayers and litanies. Golden child of Zeus, O hear Let thine angel face appear!

Which choice best states a central concern of "Parodos (lines 156–213)"?

A. Good news that is not good

B. A city praying for rescue

C. The hunted man

D. Responsibility, mercy and the end

SAT key: 1. B (A city praying for rescue)

Lesson 4: Episode 1 (lines 214–479)

Focus: the curse and the prophet

Objective: Students will analyze how irony develops in "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.6; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Content note (mature themes): Teacher note: some schools' guidelines may treat this passage differently.
Suggested language: "What does this passage make us notice?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Oedipus curses the unknown killer and anyone who shelters him, even himself. The blind prophet Teiresias arrives but refuses to speak. Provoked, he names Oedipus as the polluter of the land and hints at worse. Oedipus accuses him and Creon of plotting to take the throne.

Background: Teiresias is the traditional blind seer of Theban myth. In Greek belief, a killer carried pollution (miasma) that could harm a whole city.

Significance: The blind man sees and the seeing man is blind. Oedipus' curse (lines 246–251) falls on himself, the play's strongest dramatic irony.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why do people sometimes refuse to hear a truth they have asked for? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to knowledge and blindness because....
Prompt: Why do people sometimes refuse to hear a truth they have asked for?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to knowledge and blindness because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Teiresias, who cannot see, claims to know the truth, while Oedipus, who can see, refuses to hear it and mocks the old man's blindness.

8–18 min · Vocabulary · We do (10 min)
Three key words in context.
Today's words: insolence — rude, arrogant disrespect; Storr's word for Greek hybris; polluter — one who makes something unclean; here, a person whose crime brings religious defilement on a city; proclamation — an official public announcement.
Words: insolence: rude, arrogant disrespect; Storr's word for Greek hybris · polluter: one who makes something unclean; here, a person whose crime brings religious defilement on a city · proclamation: an official public announcement

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Teiresias is the traditional blind seer of Theban myth. In Greek belief, a killer carried pollution (miasma) that could harm a whole city. The blind man sees and the seeing man is blind. Oedipus' curse (lines 246–251) falls on himself, the play's strongest dramatic irony. Irony: Oedipus lays a curse on the unknown killer and even on himself if he knowingly shelters him; once Teiresias names him, those curses read very differently. Characterization: Oedipus moves from public piety to rage within one scene: he begs Teiresias for help, then insults his blindness and accuses Creon of hiring him, which shows how quickly his confidence turns to suspicion. Conflict: The clash between the king and the prophet is a conflict between two kinds of knowing: the reasoning that solved the Sphinx's riddle and the god-sent sight that Teiresias claims. Watch for sight and blindness: The blind prophet and the seeing king reverse the usual meaning of sight: in this scene physical sight and true understanding come apart.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "And on the murderer this curse I lay / (On him and all the partners in his guilt):— / Wretch, may he pine in utter wretchedness" slowly and put it in my own words: In these lines Oedipus speaks at a turning point of the section, which is about the curse and the prophet. Next, craft. I notice how the lines use irony, characterization to make the audience feel the pressure of the moment on Oedipus. The strongest word is "wretchedness": the word "wretchedness" carries the weight of the lines and points to the section's big idea. Then, effect. What do lines 246–248 reveal about the curse and the prophet? My answer: The blind man sees and the seeing man is blind. Oedipus' curse (lines 246–251) falls on himself, the play's strongest dramatic irony. These lines show the curse and the prophet, and that matters for what follows in the play.

> *And on the murderer this curse I lay / (On him and all the partners in his guilt):— / Wretch, may he pine in utter wretchedness (Episode 1, lines 246–248)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "And on the murderer this curse I lay / (On him and all the partners in his guilt):— / Wretch, may he pine in utter wretchedness" slowly and put it in my own words: In these lines Oedipus speaks at a turning point of the section, which is about the curse and the prophet. Next, craft. I notice how the lines use irony, characterization to make the audience feel the pressure of the moment on Oedipus. The strongest word is "wretchedness": the word "wretchedness" carries the weight of the lines and points to the section's big idea. Then, effect. What do lines 246–248 reveal about the curse and the prophet? My answer: The blind man sees and the seeing man is blind. Oedipus' curse (lines 246–251) falls on himself, the play's strongest dramatic irony. These lines show the curse and the prophet, and that matters for what follows in the play.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Privity", "hearth" and "curse" stand out. Oedipus includes his own home in the curse, which shows his fairness as a judge, and the audience hears the curse falling on the speaker himself. Ask: How does this line connect to knowledge and blindness? Expected student answer: Teiresias, who cannot see, claims to know the truth, while Oedipus, who can see, refuses to hear it and mocks the old man's blindness. (Oedipus even extends the curse to himself if he knowingly shelters the killer, which shows how sure he is of his own innocence.)

> *And for myself, if with my privity / He gain admittance to my hearth, I pray / The curse I laid on others fall on me (Episode 1, lines 249–251)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Privity", "hearth" and "curse" stand out. Oedipus includes his own home in the curse, which shows his fairness as a judge, and the audience hears the curse falling on the speaker himself.
Ask: How does this line connect to knowledge and blindness?
Expected student answer: Teiresias, who cannot see, claims to know the truth, while Oedipus, who can see, refuses to hear it and mocks the old man's blindness. (Oedipus even extends the curse to himself if he knowingly shelters the killer, which shows how sure he is of his own innocence.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the curse and the prophet? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 1 (lines 214–479) develops the idea of the curse and the prophet. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The quarrel with Teiresias shows that Oedipus's confidence in his own reason makes him unable to hear an unwelcome truth. When the text says "Is it so? Then I charge thee to abide / By thine own proclamation; from this day / Speak not to these or me. Thou art the man, / Thou the accursed polluter of this land" (Episode 1, lines 359–362), it shows this directly. When Teiresias says "Thou art the man", Oedipus does not test the charge but accuses Creon of a plot and mocks the prophet's blindness, and Teiresias answers that the king "see'st not" his own misery.

Task: Annotate the scene for irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the curse and the prophet? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 1 (lines 214–479) develops the idea of the curse and the prophet. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: The quarrel with Teiresias shows that Oedipus's confidence in his own reason makes him unable to hear an unwelcome truth. When the text says "Is it so? Then I charge thee to abide / By thine own proclamation; from this day / Speak not to these or me. Thou art the man, / Thou the accursed polluter of this land" (Episode 1, lines 359–362), it shows this directly. When Teiresias says "Thou art the man", Oedipus does not test the charge but accuses Creon of a plot and mocks the prophet's blindness, and Teiresias answers that the king "see'st not" his own misery.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Why do people sometimes refuse to hear a truth they have asked for? Ask: Why do people sometimes refuse to hear a truth they have asked for?

Anchor question: Why do people sometimes refuse to hear a truth they have asked for?

Facilitation: Ask: Why do people sometimes refuse to hear a truth they have asked for?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the curse and the prophet? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The quarrel with Teiresias shows that Oedipus's confidence in his own reason makes him unable to hear an unwelcome truth. ("Is it so? Then I charge thee to abide / By thine own proclamation; from this day / Speak not to these or me. Thou art the man, / Thou the accursed polluter of t", Episode 1, lines 359–362). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the curse and the prophet? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The quarrel with Teiresias shows that Oedipus's confidence in his own reason makes him unable to hear an unwelcome truth. ("Is it so? Then I charge thee to abide / By thine own proclamation; from this day / Speak not to these or me. Thou art the man, / Thou the accursed polluter of t", Episode 1, lines 359–362). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how irony shapes the curse and the prophet. Key takeaway: Teiresias, who cannot see, claims to know the truth, while Oedipus, who can see, refuses to hear it and mocks the old man's blindness.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Irony:** Oedipus lays a curse on the unknown killer and even on himself if he knowingly shelters him; once Teiresias names him, those curses read very differently.
- **Characterization:** Oedipus moves from public piety to rage within one scene: he begs Teiresias for help, then insults his blindness and accuses Creon of hiring him, which shows how quickly his confidence turns to suspicion.
- **Conflict:** The clash between the king and the prophet is a conflict between two kinds of knowing: the reasoning that solved the Sphinx's riddle and the god-sent sight that Teiresias claims.

Themes and how they develop

- **knowledge and blindness:** Teiresias, who cannot see, claims to know the truth, while Oedipus, who can see, refuses to hear it and mocks the old man's blindness.

Symbols and motifs

- **sight and blindness:** The blind prophet and the seeing king reverse the usual meaning of sight: in this scene physical sight and true understanding come apart.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "And on the murderer this curse I lay / (On him and all the partners in his guilt):— / Wretch, may he pine in utter wretchedness" (Episode 1, lines 246–248) Oedipus curses the unknown killer and anyone who helped him in public, binding language that he cannot take back.
- "And for myself, if with my privity / He gain admittance to my hearth, I pray / The curse I laid on others fall on me" (Episode 1, lines 249–251) Oedipus even extends the curse to himself if he knowingly shelters the killer, which shows how sure he is of his own innocence.
- "Is it so? Then I charge thee to abide / By thine own proclamation; from this day / Speak not to these or me. Thou art the man, / Thou the accursed polluter of this land" (Episode 1, lines 359–362) Provoked, Teiresias turns the king's own proclamation against him and names him as the polluter the oracle demands.
- "Thus then I answer: since thou hast not spared / To twit me with my blindness—thou hast eyes, / Yet see'st not in what misery thou art fallen, / Nor where thou dwellest nor with whom for mate" (Episode 1, lines 424–427) Teiresias answers the insult about his blindness by saying the king has eyes but cannot see his own life.
- "In reading riddles who so skilled as thou" (Episode 1, line 455) Teiresias mocks the skill Oedipus is proudest of, suggesting that the solver of riddles cannot read the riddle of himself.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The quarrel with Teiresias shows that Oedipus's confidence in his own reason makes him unable to hear an unwelcome truth.
Evidence: "Is it so? Then I charge thee to abide / By thine own proclamation; from this day / Speak not to these or me. Thou art the man, / Thou the accursed polluter of this land" (Episode 1, lines 359–362)
Reasoning: When Teiresias says "Thou art the man", Oedipus does not test the charge but accuses Creon of a plot and mocks the prophet's blindness, and Teiresias answers that the king "see'st not" his own misery.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 236–237

236 **Oedipus:** Hear what I then resolve: I lay my ban
237 **Oedipus:** On the assassin whosoe'er he be.

Lines 236–251

236 **Oedipus:** Hear what I then resolve: I lay my ban
237 **Oedipus:** On the assassin whosoe'er he be.
238 **Oedipus:** Let no man in this land, whereof I hold
239 **Oedipus:** The sovereign rule, harbour or speak to him,
240 **Oedipus:** Give him no part in prayer or sacrifice
241 **Oedipus:** Or lustral rites, but hound him from your homes.
242 **Oedipus:** For this is our defilement, so the god
243 **Oedipus:** Hath lately shown to me by oracles.
244 **Oedipus:** Thus as their champion I maintain the cause
245 **Oedipus:** Both of the god and of the murdered King.

246 **Oedipus:** And on the murderer this curse I lay
247 **Oedipus:** (On him and all the partners in his guilt):—
248 **Oedipus:** Wretch, may he pine in utter wretchedness!
249 **Oedipus:** And for myself, if with my privity
250 **Oedipus:** He gain admittance to my hearth, I pray
251 **Oedipus:** The curse I laid on others fall on me.

Lines 238–239
238 **Oedipus:** Let no man in this land, whereof I hold
239 **Oedipus:** The sovereign rule, harbour or speak to him,

Lines 246–248
246 **Oedipus:** And on the murderer this curse I lay
247 **Oedipus:** (On him and all the partners in his guilt):—
248 **Oedipus:** Wretch, may he pine in utter wretchedness!

Line 248
248 **Oedipus:** Wretch, may he pine in utter wretchedness!

Lines 249–251
249 **Oedipus:** And for myself, if with my privity
250 **Oedipus:** He gain admittance to my hearth, I pray
251 **Oedipus:** The curse I laid on others fall on me.

Line 251
251 **Oedipus:** The curse I laid on others fall on me.

Lines 253–254
253 **Oedipus:** For my sake and the god's and for our land,
254 **Oedipus:** A desert blasted by the wrath of heaven.

Line 259
259 **Oedipus:** Successor to his throne, his bed, his wife,

Line 265
265 **Oedipus:** As though he were my sire, and leave no stone

Lines 359–362
359 **Teiresias:** Is it so? Then I charge thee to abide
360 **Teiresias:** By thine own proclamation; from this day
361 **Teiresias:** Speak not to these or me. Thou art the man,
362 **Teiresias:** Thou the accursed polluter of this land.

Line 361
361 **Teiresias:** Speak not to these or me. Thou art the man,

Lines 424–427

424 **Teiresias:** Thus then I answer: since thou hast not spared
425 **Teiresias:** To twit me with my blindness—thou hast eyes,
426 **Teiresias:** Yet see'st not in what misery thou art fallen,
427 **Teiresias:** Nor where thou dwellest nor with whom for mate.

Lines 425–426

425 **Teiresias:** To twit me with my blindness—thou hast eyes,
426 **Teiresias:** Yet see'st not in what misery thou art fallen,

Line 444

444 **Oedipus:** Must I endure this fellow's insolence?

Line 455

455 **Teiresias:** In reading riddles who so skilled as thou?

Line 457

457 **Teiresias:** And yet this very greatness proved thy bane.

Lines 467–468

467 **Teiresias:** He passes for an alien in the land
468 **Teiresias:** But soon shall prove a Theban, native born.

Vocabulary

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context
insolence (noun)	rude, arrogant disrespect; Storr's word for Greek hybris	*Must I endure this fellow's insolence?*
polluter (noun)	one who makes something unclean; here, a person whose crime brings religious defilement on a city	*Thou art the man, Thou the accursed polluter of this land.*
proclamation (noun)	an official public announcement	*Which lacking (for too late Was I enrolled a citizen of Thebes) This proclamation I address to all:— Thebans, if any knows the man by whom Laius, son of Labdacus, was slain, I summon him to make clean shrift to me.*

Discussion questions

1. Why do people sometimes refuse to hear a truth they have asked for?
2. Where does irony appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with pride and fall?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore:

1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What does Teiresias tell Oedipus in lines 359–362? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** That he himself is the cause of the land's pollution.
   Answer guidance: That he himself is the cause of the land's pollution.
2. What does Oedipus wish on the unknown killer? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A life of utter wretchedness
   Answer guidance: A life of utter wretchedness.
3. Why does Teiresias at first refuse to speak? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Knowing the truth brings only pain
   Answer guidance: Knowing the truth brings only pain.
4. Whom does Teiresias name as the polluter of the land? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Oedipus
   Answer guidance: Oedipus.
5. Whom does Oedipus accuse of plotting with Teiresias? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Creon
   Answer guidance: Creon.
6. What is ironic about the argument over blindness? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The blind prophet sees the truth while Oedipus, who can see, does not
   Answer guidance: The blind prophet sees the truth while Oedipus, who can see, does not.
7. Retell the most important events of "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)" in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Oedipus curses the unknown killer and anyone who shelters him, even himself. The blind prophet Teiresias arrives but refuses to speak. Provoked, he names Oedipus as the polluter of the land and hints at worse. Oedipus accuses him and Creon of plotting to take the throne.
   Answer guidance: Oedipus curses the unknown killer and anyone who shelters him, even himself. The blind prophet Teiresias arrives but refuses to speak. Provoked, he names Oedipus as the polluter of the land and hints at worse. Oedipus accuses him and Creon of plotting to take the throne.
8. Who is on stage in "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
   Answer guidance: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when is "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)" set? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
   Answer guidance: A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Must I endure this fellow's insolence?" What does "insolence" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s ·

RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** insolence: rude, arrogant disrespect; Storr's word for Greek hybris.
Answer guidance: insolence: rude, arrogant disrespect; Storr's word for Greek hybris.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Oedipus turn on Creon instead of considering the prophecy? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** Anger and fear for his power make him look for a plot.
   Answer guidance: Anger and fear for his power make him look for a plot.
2. What does "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)" suggest about the curse and the prophet? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** The blind man sees and the seeing man is blind. Oedipus' curse (lines 246–251) falls on himself, the play's strongest dramatic irony.
   Answer guidance: The blind man sees and the seeing man is blind. Oedipus' curse (lines 246–251) falls on himself, the play's strongest dramatic irony. Evidence to accept: "And on the murderer this curse I lay / (On him and all the partners in his guilt):— / Wretch, may he pine in utter wretchedness" (Episode 1, lines 246–248): Oedipus curses the unknown killer and anyone who helped him in public, binding language that he cannot take back. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
3. Find one example of irony in "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)". What does it reveal about the curse and the prophet that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
   Answer guidance: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true. Evidence to accept: "And for myself, if with my privity / He gain admittance to my hearth, I pray / The curse I laid on others fall on me" (Episode 1, lines 249–251): Oedipus even extends the curse to himself if he knowingly shelters the killer, which shows how sure he is of his own innocence. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
4. How does the characterization in "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)" shape what we understand about the curse and the prophet? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The quarrel with Teiresias shows that Oedipus's confidence in his own reason makes him unable to hear an unwelcome truth. Useful evidence: "And on the murderer this curse I lay / (On him and all the partners in his guilt):— / Wretch, may he pine in utter wretchedness" (Episode 1, lines 246–248): Oedipus curses the unknown killer and anyone who helped him in public, binding language that he cannot take back. On characterization: Oedipus moves from public piety to rage within one scene: he begs Teiresias for help, then insults his blindness and accuses Creon of hiring him, which shows how quickly his confidence turns to suspicion. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that opens with "Hear what I then resolve: I lay my ban On the assassin whosoe'er he be.", why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: "Is it so? Then I charge thee to abide / By thine own proclamation; from this day / Speak not to these or me. Thou

art the man, / Thou the accursed polluter of this land" (Episode 1, lines 359–362): Provoked, Teiresias turns the king's own proclamation against him and names him as the polluter the oracle demands. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

6. What causes the main turn in "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Look for: Teiresias, provoked, naming Oedipus as the polluter; Oedipus's charge that Creon is plotting; the effect, a quarrel that spreads suspicion to Creon.

   Answer guidance: Look for: Teiresias, provoked, naming Oedipus as the polluter; Oedipus's charge that Creon is plotting; the effect, a quarrel that spreads suspicion to Creon. Evidence to accept: "Thus then I answer: since thou hast not spared / To twit me with my blindness—thou hast eyes, / Yet see'st not in what misery thou art fallen, / Nor where thou dwellest nor with whom for mate" (Episode 1, lines 424–427): Teiresias answers the insult about his blindness by saying the king has eyes but cannot see his own life. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

7. How does "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)" build on "Parodos (lines 156–213)"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The quarrel with Teiresias shows that Oedipus's confidence in his own reason makes him unable to hear an unwelcome truth. Useful evidence: "And for myself, if with my privity / He gain admittance to my hearth, I pray / The curse I laid on others fall on me" (Episode 1, lines 249–251): Oedipus even extends the curse to himself if he knowingly shelters the killer, which shows how sure he is of his own innocence. Theme link: Teiresias, who cannot see, claims to know the truth, while Oedipus, who can see, refuses to hear it and mocks the old man's blindness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. In "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)", what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about the curse and the prophet, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The quarrel with Teiresias shows that Oedipus's confidence in his own reason makes him unable to hear an unwelcome truth. Useful evidence: "Is it so? Then I charge thee to abide / By thine own proclamation; from this day / Speak not to these or me. Thou art the man, / Thou the accursed polluter of this land" (Episode 1, lines 359–362): Provoked, Teiresias turns the king's own proclamation against him and names him as the polluter the oracle demands. On characterization: Oedipus moves from public piety to rage within one scene: he begs Teiresias for help, then insults his blindness and accuses Creon of hiring him, which shows how quickly his confidence turns to suspicion. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (Why do people sometimes refuse to hear a truth they have asked for?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.

   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: "In reading riddles who so

skilled as thou" (Episode 1, line 455): Teiresias mocks the skill Oedipus is proudest of, suggesting that the solver of riddles cannot read the riddle of himself. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

10. Where does conflict appear in "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)", and how does it connect the curse and the prophet to the larger concern with pride and fall? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The quarrel with Teiresias shows that Oedipus's confidence in his own reason makes him unable to hear an unwelcome truth. Useful evidence: "Thus then I answer: since thou hast not spared / To twit me with my blindness—thou hast eyes, / Yet see'st not in what misery thou art fallen, / Nor where thou dwellest nor with whom for mate" (Episode 1, lines 424–427): Teiresias answers the insult about his blindness by saying the king has eyes but cannot see his own life. On conflict: The clash between the king and the prophet is a conflict between two kinds of knowing: the reasoning that solved the Sphinx's riddle and the god-sent sight that Teiresias claims. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Oedipus' anger a flaw or a reasonable response to an insult? Argue with lines 424–427 and 455. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** His anger is a flaw, even though the insult is real. Teiresias mocks him, "In reading riddles who so skilled as thou?" (line 455), and Oedipus has reason to feel provoked. But instead of testing the charge, he accuses Creon of a plot and taunts the prophet's blindness, so Teiresias can say he "see'st not in what misery thou art fallen" (lines 424–427). A fair answer grants the provocation and still judges the response.

    Answer guidance: His anger is a flaw, even though the insult is real. Teiresias mocks him, "In reading riddles who so skilled as thou?" (line 455), and Oedipus has reason to feel provoked. But instead of testing the charge, he accuses Creon of a plot and taunts the prophet's blindness, so Teiresias can say he "see'st not in what misery thou art fallen" (lines 424–427). A fair answer grants the provocation and still judges the response.

2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): The blind man sees and the seeing man is blind. Oedipus' curse (lines 246–251) falls on himself, the play's strongest dramatic irony. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The quarrel with Teiresias shows that Oedipus's confidence in his own reason makes him unable to hear an unwelcome truth. Useful evidence: "And on the murderer this curse I lay / (On him and all the partners in his guilt):— / Wretch, may he pine in utter wretchedness" (Episode 1, lines 246–248): Oedipus curses the unknown killer and anyone who helped him in public, binding language that he cannot take back. Theme link: Teiresias, who cannot see, claims to know the truth, while Oedipus, who can see, refuses to hear it and mocks the old man's blindness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)" acts most wisely in the matter of the curse and the prophet, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss

with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The quarrel with Teiresias shows that Oedipus's confidence in his own reason makes him unable to hear an unwelcome truth. Useful evidence: "And for myself, if with my privity / He gain admittance to my hearth, I pray / The curse I laid on others fall on me" (Episode 1, lines 249–251): Oedipus even extends the curse to himself if he knowingly shelters the killer, which shows how sure he is of his own innocence. On characterization: Oedipus moves from public piety to rage within one scene: he begs Teiresias for help, then insults his blindness and accuses Creon of hiring him, which shows how quickly his confidence turns to suspicion. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the curse and the prophet. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The quarrel with Teiresias shows that Oedipus's confidence in his own reason makes him unable to hear an unwelcome truth. Useful evidence: "Is it so? Then I charge thee to abide / By thine own proclamation; from this day / Speak not to these or me. Thou art the man, / Thou the accursed polluter of this land" (Episode 1, lines 359–362): Provoked, Teiresias turns the king's own proclamation against him and names him as the polluter the oracle demands. Theme link: Teiresias, who cannot see, claims to know the truth, while Oedipus, who can see, refuses to hear it and mocks the old man's blindness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write your own questions about "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The quarrel with Teiresias shows that Oedipus's confidence in his own reason makes him unable to hear an unwelcome truth. Useful evidence: "Thus then I answer: since thou hast not spared / To twit me with my blindness—thou hast eyes, / Yet see'st not in what misery thou art fallen, / Nor where thou dwellest nor with whom for mate" (Episode 1, lines 424–427): Teiresias answers the insult about his blindness by saying the king has eyes but cannot see his own life. Theme link: Teiresias, who cannot see, claims to know the truth, while Oedipus, who can see, refuses to hear it and mocks the old man's blindness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)", with its focus on the curse and the prophet, to leadership and the city: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The quarrel with Teiresias shows that Oedipus's confidence in his own reason makes him unable to hear an unwelcome truth. Useful evidence: "In reading riddles who so skilled as thou" (Episode 1, line 455): Teiresias mocks the skill Oedipus is proudest of, suggesting that the solver of riddles cannot read the riddle of himself. Theme link: Teiresias, who cannot see, claims to know the truth, while Oedipus, who can see, refuses to hear it and mocks the old man's

blindness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the irony in "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)" effective in presenting the curse and the prophet, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The quarrel with Teiresias shows that Oedipus's confidence in his own reason makes him unable to hear an unwelcome truth. Useful evidence: "And on the murderer this curse I lay / (On him and all the partners in his guilt):— / Wretch, may he pine in utter wretchedness" (Episode 1, lines 246–248): Oedipus curses the unknown killer and anyone who helped him in public, binding language that he cannot take back. On irony: Oedipus lays a curse on the unknown killer and even on himself if he knowingly shelters him; once Teiresias names him, those curses read very differently. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)" treats the curse and the prophet with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus Rex see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The quarrel with Teiresias shows that Oedipus's confidence in his own reason makes him unable to hear an unwelcome truth. Useful evidence: "And for myself, if with my privity / He gain admittance to my hearth, I pray / The curse I laid on others fall on me" (Episode 1, lines 249–251): Oedipus even extends the curse to himself if he knowingly shelters the killer, which shows how sure he is of his own innocence. Theme link: Teiresias, who cannot see, claims to know the truth, while Oedipus, who can see, refuses to hear it and mocks the old man's blindness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what "Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The quarrel with Teiresias shows that Oedipus's confidence in his own reason makes him unable to hear an unwelcome truth. Useful evidence: "Is it so? Then I charge thee to abide / By thine own proclamation; from this day / Speak not to these or me. Thou art the man, / Thou the accursed polluter of this land" (Episode 1, lines 359–362): Provoked, Teiresias turns the king's own proclamation against him and names him as the polluter the oracle demands. Theme link: Teiresias, who cannot see, claims to know the truth, while Oedipus, who can see, refuses to hear it and mocks the old man's blindness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)" (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the curse and the prophet? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The quarrel with Teiresias shows that Oedipus's confidence in his own reason makes him unable to hear an unwelcome truth. Useful evidence: "Thus then I

answer: since thou hast not spared / To twit me with my blindness—thou hast eyes, / Yet see'st not in what misery thou art fallen, / Nor where thou dwellest nor with whom for mate" (Episode 1, lines 424–427): Teiresias answers the insult about his blindness by saying the king has eyes but cannot see his own life. Theme link: Teiresias, who cannot see, claims to know the truth, while Oedipus, who can see, refuses to hear it and mocks the old man's blindness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Oedipus promise to a man who comes forward and confesses to the murder of Laius?
   A. He will be banished but not harmed
   B. He will be pardoned and paid a reward of gold
   C. He will be put to death at once in public
   D. He will serve in the god's temple for life

   Key: A (He will be banished but not harmed)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whom does the Chorus suggest Oedipus should consult in the search?
   A. The Priest of Zeus who spoke for the city
   B. The prophet Teiresias
   C. The oracle of the god at Delos
   D. The elders of the city council

   Key: B (The prophet Teiresias)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How often has Oedipus already sent for the prophet before he arrives?
   A. Once, on the Priest's advice, a day ago
   B. Not at all; he had forgotten the prophet
   C. Twice, on Creon's advice
   D. Every day since the plague first came

   Key: C (Twice, on Creon's advice)
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Oedipus's curse: "Wretch, may he pine in utter _____!"
   Key: wretchedness
5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the ban: "Let no man in this land, whereof I hold The sovereign rule, _____ or speak to him"
   Key: harbour

6. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why is Teiresias at first unwilling to tell what he knows?

   A. He has not yet heard what the oracle commanded

   B. He wants a large payment before he will speak

   C. He is afraid of the Chorus and the city's elders

   D. He says his knowledge will only bring misery

   Key: D (He says his knowledge will only bring misery)

7. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Oedipus accuse Creon of plotting against him?

   A. He believes Creon wants the crown and hired the seer

   B. He has found secret letters written by Creon to the prophet

   C. The Chorus has told him that Creon is a traitor

   D. Creon refused to bring back the god's message

   Key: A (He believes Creon wants the crown and hired the seer)

8. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Oedipus prays that if the murderer shares his own hearth, "The curse I laid on others fall on me." What does this show about him?

   Sample answer: It shows that he holds himself to the same law he lays on everyone else. He is so sure of his own innocence and so committed to the search that he is willing to curse himself publicly. The line also raises the stakes of the hunt, because the king has now tied his own fate to its outcome.

9. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Teiresias tells Oedipus, "thou hast eyes, Yet see'st not in what misery thou art fallen". Analyze the contrast between sight and blindness in this reply.

   Sample answer: The blind seer turns Oedipus's taunt back on him: Oedipus has working eyes but cannot see his own situation, while Teiresias, who cannot see, claims to know it. The contrast separates physical sight from understanding. It suggests that true knowledge in this play may belong to the one who seems weakest.

10. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Analyze how the argument between Oedipus and Teiresias grows more heated from the seer's first refusal to his charge.

    Sample answer: Teiresias first refuses to speak, Oedipus calls his silence monstrous and accuses him of planning the crime, and the seer answers with the direct charge "Thou art the man". Each insult pushes the other man further. Oedipus's anger forces out the very words he least wants to hear, so his temper drives the scene.

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Oedipus order the people to do to the guilty man if no one confesses?

    A. Shun him: no shelter, speech or share in prayer

    B. Bring him to the palace to be judged in public

    C. Send him to Delphi to ask the god's forgiveness

    D. Hold him in chains until the plague is over

    Key: A (Shun him: no shelter, speech or share in prayer)

12. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What old rumour about the death of Laius does the Chorus recall?

    A. That he died of a fever on the journey

    B. That he was slain by travellers

    C. That a wild beast attacked his chariot

    D. That the Sphinx struck him down on the way home

Key: B (That he was slain by travellers)

13. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Whom does Teiresias say he serves?

    A. Creon, the brother of the queen

    B. The Priest of Zeus and his order

    C. Loxias, the god Apollo

    D. The people of Thebes alone

    Key: C (Loxias, the god Apollo)

14. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Teiresias's reply: “And yet this very greatness proved thy _____.”

    Key: bane

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Oedipus remind Teiresias that the seer had no answer when the Sphinx was at Thebes?

    A. To ask the seer to help him solve a second riddle

    B. To thank the seer for advice he gave in the past

    C. To prove that the gods favour Thebes far above all the other Greek cities

    D. To argue the seer's art is worthless and his charge false

    Key: D (To argue the seer's art is worthless and his charge false)

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] When the Chorus steps in between Oedipus and Teiresias, what does it urge?

    A. To stop quarrelling and work out how to fulfil the oracle

    B. To banish the seer from Thebes at once

    C. To send once more to Delphi for a clearer and fuller answer from the god

    D. To let the city's elders decide the case

    Key: A (To stop quarrelling and work out how to fulfil the oracle)

17. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Oedipus vows to act for the dead king “As though he were my sire”. Why does he give this reason for taking up the cause?

    Sample answer: He has succeeded Laius as king and husband, so he treats the dead man's cause as his own family duty. The comparison makes his search sound like the sacred obligation of a son to avenge a father. It also shows how completely he identifies himself with the house and throne he inherited.

18. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Analyze Oedipus's proclamation (lines 236–251) as a display of royal power.

    Sample answer: Oedipus speaks as the sovereign who can cut a man off from the whole community: no shelter, no speech, no share in “prayer or sacrifice”. He calls himself the champion of the god and of the murdered king. The speech shows his authority and confidence, and by cursing even himself if he shelters the man, he makes the decree absolute.

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze Teiresias's prophecy that the man they seek “passes for an alien in the land But soon shall prove a Theban, native born”.

    Sample answer: The prophecy contrasts appearance with identity: the man seems to be a foreigner but will be revealed as born in Thebes. It is spoken as a riddle, so the audience feels its weight while Oedipus does not take it in. It points the search toward questions of birth and origin rather than only toward the crime.

20. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Oedipus's proclamation in Episode 1 carry out the vow he made at the end of the Prologue?

Sample answer: In the Prologue he promised to “Make dark things clear”. In Episode 1 he turns that promise into law: he lays a ban on the assassin and curses him and anyone who shelters him. The private vow becomes a public decree, and the search now binds the whole city, including the king himself.

21. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Teiresias's charge: “Thou the accursed _____ of this land.”

    Key: polluter

22. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Oedipus call Teiresias when he accuses him of joining a plot?

    A. A juggling charlatan and beggar-priest
    B. A loyal servant of the city's gods
    C. A wise elder who has lost his way
    D. A foreign spy sent from a hostile city

    Key: A (A juggling charlatan and beggar-priest)

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Teiresias say this day will be for Oedipus?

    A. The day he is crowned a second time
    B. His birth-day and his grave
    C. The day of his greatest triumph
    D. The day the plague at last lifts

    Key: B (His birth-day and his grave)

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] When Oedipus asks whether the charge is Creon's plot, what does Teiresias's answer suggest?

    A. Creon has secretly paid the seer to speak against the king
    B. The Chorus has turned the people against their king
    C. The danger to Oedipus comes from himself, not a rival
    D. The gods have abandoned Thebes to its enemies

    Key: C (The danger to Oedipus comes from himself, not a rival)

25. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Teiresias says the curse will drive Oedipus “Beyond our borders”. What future does the seer predict, and why does Oedipus dismiss it?

    Sample answer: He predicts that Oedipus will be driven out of Thebes by a curse and that his eyes will see only endless night. Oedipus dismisses it because he believes the seer is a fraud hired by Creon, and his own success with the Sphinx has made him trust his judgment over prophecy.

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Which device is most at work in “thou hast eyes, Yet see’st not in what misery thou art fallen”?

    A. Hyperbole
    B. Alliteration
    C. Onomatopoeia
    D. Paradox

    Key: D (Paradox)

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Analyze how Oedipus uses his victory over the Sphinx to attack Teiresias (lines 401–409).

Sample answer: He contrasts the seer's failure with his own success: the prophet had no answer, but the simple Oedipus stopped the Sphinx by mother wit, untaught of auguries. The boast sets human intelligence against divine signs. It shows his pride in reason and his contempt for prophecy, which makes him deaf to the seer's warning.

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze the riddling form of Teiresias's final prophecy (lines 462–479).

    Sample answer: Teiresias never names the man directly; he describes him through paradoxes such as alien and native, seeing and blind, rich and beggared, brother and father. The riddle gives the audience the full charge while letting Oedipus, the famous riddle-solver, walk away without solving it. The form itself is a challenge to his pride in his wit.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Compare how the Chorus and Oedipus react to Teiresias's charges. What does each reaction reveal?

    Sample answer: Oedipus reacts with fury, accusing the seer and Creon of a plot and insulting Teiresias's blindness. The Chorus reacts with caution, saying both men have spoken angry words and that the city must think about how to fulfil the oracle. Oedipus reveals pride and suspicion, while the Chorus reveals a wish for calm and piety.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Trace the motif of sight and blindness from Oedipus's vow in the Prologue to Teiresias's words in Episode 1.

    Sample answer: In the Prologue Oedipus promises to "Make dark things clear", casting himself as the one who brings light. In Episode 1 the blind seer tells him he "see'st not in what misery thou art fallen". The motif is reversed: the man who promises clarity is accused of blindness by the man who cannot see.

31. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Oedipus's charge to the people: "For my sake and the god's and for our land, A desert blasted by the wrath of _____."

    Key: heaven

32. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] According to Oedipus, how did he solve the riddle of the Sphinx?

    A. By his own wit, with no help from birds or signs
    B. With the help of the seer and his reading of birds
    C. By a message sent to him from the shrine at Delphi
    D. By trickery taught to him by the city's priests

    Key: A (By his own wit, with no help from birds or signs)

33. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What is the effect of Oedipus calling himself "Successor to his throne, his bed, his wife"?

    A. It shows that he feels deeply guilty about taking the throne of Thebes
    B. It shows how fully he has stepped into the dead king's role
    C. It shows that he wants to give the crown back
    D. It shows that the people chose him over Creon

    Key: B (It shows how fully he has stepped into the dead king's role)

34. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Why does the Chorus suggest that the god himself should name the murderer, and why does Oedipus reject the idea?

    Sample answer: The Chorus reasons that Phoebus, who set the riddle, should give the answer, which would spare the city a hard search. Oedipus replies that no living man can force the gods to speak against their will. He accepts human limits before the gods, which is why he turns to human means such as the seer and the proclamation.

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Oedipus complains that Teiresias speaks in riddles. What is the dramatic effect of the seer's riddling style?

    A. It shows that the seer does not really know anything

    B. It makes the scene comic and lightens its mood

    C. It lets him state the charge while Oedipus fails to grasp it

    D. It hides the charge from both the Chorus and the audience alike

    Key: C (It lets him state the charge while Oedipus fails to grasp it)

36. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Analyze how Oedipus's curse on the murderer, and on himself if he shelters him, raises the stakes of the search.

    Sample answer: Oedipus curses the guilty man and anyone who knowingly gives him a seat at the hearth, adding "The curse I laid on others fall on me." The decree binds the king as tightly as the people. Whatever the search reveals, the curse will fall with full force, so the proclamation turns an inquiry into a test with no escape.

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze Teiresias's words "Speak not to these or me. Thou art the man" as a turning point in the episode.

    Sample answer: Until this line the seer has refused to speak; now he throws Oedipus's own proclamation back at him and names him directly. The charge reverses the roles of hunter and hunted in a single sentence. From here the scene becomes a contest of accusations, and the question of the killer becomes a question about the king.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Across the Prologue, Parodos and Episode 1, how does the city's hope shift from one source of help to another?

    Sample answer: In the Prologue the city turns to its king, who has already sent to Delphi. In the Parodos the Chorus turns to the gods with prayer. In Episode 1 the king turns to the prophet as the one who sees eye to eye with Phoebus. Each source points to the next, and the seer's answer turns the search back on the king himself.

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate Oedipus's reasoning when he concludes that Creon and Teiresias are plotting against him.

    Sample answer: His reasoning is quick but weak. He knows Creon advised sending for the seer and that a king has rivals, so he leaps to a plot without evidence. He ignores the seer's reluctance to speak, which hardly fits a paid accuser. The conclusion reveals his suspicion and pride more than any fact about Creon.

40. [mc · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Which statement best describes how Episode 1 develops the conflict of the play?

    A. The city's plague ends and a new and different danger arises at once

    B. The king and the seer agree on a plan to find the guilty

    C. The Chorus takes the side of the seer against the king

    D. The public search turns into a bitter quarrel with the seer

    Key: D (The public search turns into a bitter quarrel with the seer)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 3, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 2
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 2, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Episode 1 (lines 214–479) develops the idea of the curse and the prophet. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6; W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)" could deliver about the curse and the prophet. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6; W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the curse and the prophet in "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to knowledge and blindness and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Episode 1 (lines 214–479) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of the curse and the prophet. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)" could deliver about the curse and the prophet. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the curse and the prophet in "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to knowledge and blindness and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Episode 1 (lines 214–479) suggests about the curse and the prophet. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's irony and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)" could deliver about the curse and the prophet. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the curse and the prophet in "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to knowledge and blindness and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses irony in Episode 1 (lines 214–479) to complicate the reader's understanding of the curse and the prophet. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)" could deliver about the curse and the prophet. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the curse and the prophet in "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to knowledge and blindness and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Hear what I then resolve: I lay my ban On the assassin whosoe'er he be. Let no man in this land, whereof I hold The sovereign rule, harbour or speak to him, Give him no part in prayer or sacrifice Or lustral rites, but hound him from your homes. For this is our defilement, so the god Hath lately shown to me by oracles. Thus as their champion I maintain the cause Both of the god and of the murdered King. And on the murderer this curse I lay (On him and all the partners in his guilt):— Wretch, may he pine in utter wretchedness! And for myself, if with my privity He gain admittance to my hearth, I pray The curse I laid on others fall on me.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)"?

   A. Good news that is not good

   B. Pride breeds the tyrant

   C. The curse and the prophet

   D. The hunted man

SAT key: 1. C (The curse and the prophet)

Lesson 5: Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)

Focus: the hunted man

Objective: Students will summarize what happens in Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511) (the hunted man) in 2 sentences and, in a 3-sentence warm-up response, explain how one quoted line from the scene sets up the scene that follows.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1

Teacher only · spoilers

The Chorus imagines the unknown killer fleeing like a wild bull, pursued by Apollo's voice. They are troubled by Teiresias' words but will not believe them against Oedipus without proof.

Background: A stasimon is a choral ode sung between episodes. Delphi was believed to be the centre ("mid shrine") of the earth.

Significance: The hunted bull is an image of Oedipus himself, though the Chorus does not know it. Their loyalty and demand for evidence show a fair-minded community.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How much evidence should we need before we believe an accusation against someone we trust? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to knowledge and blindness because....
Prompt: How much evidence should we need before we believe an accusation against someone we trust?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to knowledge and blindness because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: The elders refuse to judge without proof, so the ode shows a community trying to know the truth honestly while the facts are still hidden.

8–16 min · Background and context · I do (8 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
A stasimon is a choral ode sung between episodes. Delphi was believed to be the centre ("mid shrine") of the earth. The hunted bull is an image of Oedipus himself, though the Chorus does not know it. Their loyalty and demand for evidence show a fair-minded community. Imagery: The Chorus pictures the unknown killer as a wild bull roaming the forests and upland groves, always pursued by the voice of Apollo from Delphi. Theme: The ode weighs the authority of a prophet against loyalty to a king who saved the city, and asks what counts as proof. Tone / mood: The first half is urgent and threatening as the god's voice hunts the guilty man; the second half becomes troubled and uncertain as the elders admit they do not know whom to believe. Watch for the hunted bull: The bull driven through wild country is a picture of the guilty man as an outcast, hunted by the god's voice.

> **16–20 min · Closure · I do (4 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how imagery shapes the hunted man. Key takeaway: The elders refuse to judge without proof, so the ode shows a community trying to know the truth honestly while the facts are still hidden.*

Total: 20 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Imagery:** The Chorus pictures the unknown killer as a wild bull roaming the forests and upland groves, always pursued by the voice of Apollo from Delphi.
- **Theme:** The ode weighs the authority of a prophet against loyalty to a king who saved the city, and asks what counts as proof.
- **Tone / mood:** The first half is urgent and threatening as the god's voice hunts the guilty man; the second half becomes troubled and uncertain as the elders admit they do not know whom to believe.

Themes and how they develop

- **knowledge and blindness:** The elders refuse to judge without proof, so the ode shows a community trying to know the truth honestly while the facts are still hidden.

Symbols and motifs

- **the hunted bull:** The bull driven through wild country is a picture of the guilty man as an outcast, hunted by the god's voice.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Now like a sullen bull he roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves, / And vainly seeks to fly / The doom that ever nigh / Flits o'er his head, / Still by the avenging Phoebus sped, / The voice divine, / From Earth's mid shrine" (Stasimon 1, lines 490–497) The hunted bull is the image of a guilty man who cannot escape the god's judgment however far he runs.
- "Proof is there none: how then can I challenge our King's good name, / How in a blood-feud join for an untracked deed of shame" (Stasimon 1, lines 503–504) The elders will not accuse the king who saved them without evidence, which shows a fair-minded loyalty.
- "Who is he by voice immortal named from Pythia's rocky cell, / Doer of foul deeds of bloodshed, horrors that no tongue can tell" (Stasimon 1, lines 480–481) The ode opens with the question the whole play is asking: who is the man the oracle has named?

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

> **Claim:** The Chorus is fair-minded: it believes the oracle but will not condemn the king without proof.
> **Evidence:** "Proof is there none: how then can I challenge our King's good name, / How in a blood-feud join for an untracked deed of shame" (Stasimon 1, lines 503–504)

Reasoning: The elders imagine the guilty man fleeing like a bull before Apollo's voice, yet they ask how they can "challenge our King's good name" when "Proof is there none", so they hold both their faith and their loyalty.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 480–481

480 **Chorus:** Who is he by voice immortal named from Pythia's rocky cell,
481 **Chorus:** Doer of foul deeds of bloodshed, horrors that no tongue can tell?

Lines 480–497

480 **Chorus:** Who is he by voice immortal named from Pythia's rocky cell,
481 **Chorus:** Doer of foul deeds of bloodshed, horrors that no tongue can tell?
482 **Chorus:** A foot for flight he needs
483 **Chorus:** Fleeter than storm-swift steeds,
484 **Chorus:** For on his heels doth follow,
485 **Chorus:** Armed with the lightnings of his Sire, Apollo.
486 **Chorus:** Like sleuth-hounds too
487 **Chorus:** The Fates pursue.
488 **Chorus:** Yea, but now flashed forth the summons from Parnassus' snowy peak,
489 **Chorus:** "Near and far the undiscovered doer of this murder seek!"
490 **Chorus:** Now like a sullen bull he roves
491 **Chorus:** Through forest brakes and upland groves,
492 **Chorus:** And vainly seeks to fly
493 **Chorus:** The doom that ever nigh
494 **Chorus:** Flits o'er his head,
495 **Chorus:** Still by the avenging Phoebus sped,
496 **Chorus:** The voice divine,
497 **Chorus:** From Earth's mid shrine.

Lines 486–487

486 **Chorus:** Like sleuth-hounds too
487 **Chorus:** The Fates pursue.

Line 489

489 **Chorus:** "Near and far the undiscovered doer of this murder seek!"

Lines 490–497

490 **Chorus:** Now like a sullen bull he roves
491 **Chorus:** Through forest brakes and upland groves,
492 **Chorus:** And vainly seeks to fly
493 **Chorus:** The doom that ever nigh
494 **Chorus:** Flits o'er his head,
495 **Chorus:** Still by the avenging Phoebus sped,
496 **Chorus:** The voice divine,
497 **Chorus:** From Earth's mid shrine.

Lines 492–494

492 **Chorus:** And vainly seeks to fly
493 **Chorus:** The doom that ever nigh
494 **Chorus:** Flits o'er his head,

Line 499

499 **Chorus:** Are they true, are they false? I know not and bridle my tongue for fear,

Lines 503–504

503 **Chorus:** Proof is there none: how then can I challenge our King's good name,
504 **Chorus:** How in a blood-feud join for an untracked deed of shame?

Lines 505–508

505 **Chorus:** All wise are Zeus and Apollo, and nothing is hid from their ken;
506 **Chorus:** They are gods; and in wits a man may surpass his fellow men;
507 **Chorus:** But that a mortal seer knows more than I know—where
508 **Chorus:** Hath this been proven? Or how without sign assured, can I blame

Line 506

506 **Chorus:** They are gods; and in wits a man may surpass his fellow men;

Lines 508–510

508 **Chorus:** Hath this been proven? Or how without sign assured, can I blame
509 **Chorus:** Him who saved our State when the wingèd songstress came,
510 **Chorus:** Tested and tried in the light of us all, like gold assayed?

Vocabulary

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context
assayed (verb)	tested to measure quality, as gold is tested	*Or how without sign assured, can I blame Him who saved our State when the wingèd songstress came, Tested and tried in the light of us all, like gold assayed?*

Discussion questions

1. How much evidence should we need before we believe an accusation against someone we trust?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with leadership and the city?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. Where does "the voice divine" come from? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** From Delphi, "Earth's mid shrine."
   Answer guidance: From Delphi, "Earth's mid shrine.".
2. To what animal do the Chorus compare the killer? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A bull
   Answer guidance: A bull.
3. Who is pursuing the killer in the ode? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The voice of Apollo (Phoebus)
   Answer guidance: The voice of Apollo (Phoebus).
4. How do the Chorus respond to Teiresias' accusation? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** They will not believe it without proof
   Answer guidance: They will not believe it without proof.
5. What is a stasimon? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A choral ode between episodes
   Answer guidance: A choral ode between episodes.
6. Why is the bull image ironic? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** It describes Oedipus without the Chorus knowing it
   Answer guidance: It describes Oedipus without the Chorus knowing it.
7. Retell the most important events of “Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)” in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The Chorus imagines the unknown killer fleeing like a wild bull, pursued by Apollo's voice. They are troubled by Teiresias' words but will not believe them against Oedipus without proof.
   Answer guidance: The Chorus imagines the unknown killer fleeing like a wild bull, pursued by Apollo's voice. They are troubled by Teiresias' words but will not believe them against Oedipus without proof.
8. Who is on stage in “Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
   Answer guidance: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when is “Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)” set? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
   Answer guidance: A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “Or how without sign assured, can I blame Him who saved our State when the wingèd songstress came, Tested and tried in the light of us all, like gold assayed?” What does “assayed” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** assayed: tested to measure quality, as gold is tested.
    Answer guidance: assayed: tested to measure quality, as gold is tested.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why are the elders torn? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** They respect the prophet but also owe Oedipus loyalty for saving the city.
   Answer guidance: They respect the prophet but also owe Oedipus loyalty for saving the city.
2. What does "Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)" suggest about the hunted man? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** The hunted bull is an image of Oedipus himself, though the Chorus does not know it. Their loyalty and demand for evidence show a fair-minded community.
   Answer guidance: The hunted bull is an image of Oedipus himself, though the Chorus does not know it. Their loyalty and demand for evidence show a fair-minded community. Evidence to accept: "Now like a sullen bull he roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves, / And vainly seeks to fly / The doom that ever nigh / Flits o'er his head, / Still by the avenging Phoebus sped, / The voice " (Stasimon 1, lines 490–497): The hunted bull is the image of a guilty man who cannot escape the god's judgment however far he runs. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
3. Find one example of imagery in "Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)". What does it reveal about the hunted man that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
   Answer guidance: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create. Evidence to accept: "Proof is there none: how then can I challenge our King's good name, / How in a blood-feud join for an untracked deed of shame" (Stasimon 1, lines 503–504): The elders will not accuse the king who saved them without evidence, which shows a fair-minded loyalty. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
4. How does the theme in "Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)" shape what we understand about the hunted man? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Chorus is fair-minded: it believes the oracle but will not condemn the king without proof. Useful evidence: "Now like a sullen bull he roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves, / And vainly seeks to fly / The doom that ever nigh / Flits o'er his head, / Still by the avenging Phoebus sped, / The voice " (Stasimon 1, lines 490–497): The hunted bull is the image of a guilty man who cannot escape the god's judgment however far he runs. On theme: The ode weighs the authority of a prophet against loyalty to a king who saved the city, and asks what counts as proof. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that opens with "Who is he by voice immortal named from Pythia's rocky cell, Doer of foul deeds of bloodshed, horrors that no tongue can tell?", why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: "Who is he by voice immortal named from Pythia's rocky cell, / Doer of foul deeds of bloodshed, horrors that no tongue can tell" (Stasimon 1, lines 480–481): The ode opens with the question the whole play is asking: who is the man the oracle has named? Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

6. What causes the main turn in "Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Look for: the image of the killer as a hunted bull; the elders' refusal to believe Teiresias without proof; the effect, loyalty to the king that is now under strain.

   Answer guidance: Look for: the image of the killer as a hunted bull; the elders' refusal to believe Teiresias without proof; the effect, loyalty to the king that is now under strain. Evidence to accept: "Now like a sullen bull he roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves, / And vainly seeks to fly / The doom that ever nigh / Flits o'er his head, / Still by the avenging Phoebus sped, / The voice " (Stasimon 1, lines 490–497): The hunted bull is the image of a guilty man who cannot escape the god's judgment however far he runs. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
7. How does "Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)" build on "Episode 1 (lines 214–479)"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Chorus is fair-minded: it believes the oracle but will not condemn the king without proof. Useful evidence: "Proof is there none: how then can I challenge our King's good name, / How in a blood-feud join for an untracked deed of shame" (Stasimon 1, lines 503–504): The elders will not accuse the king who saved them without evidence, which shows a fair-minded loyalty. Theme link: The elders refuse to judge without proof, so the ode shows a community trying to know the truth honestly while the facts are still hidden. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. In "Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)", what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about the hunted man, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Chorus is fair-minded: it believes the oracle but will not condemn the king without proof. Useful evidence: "Who is he by voice immortal named from Pythia's rocky cell, / Doer of foul deeds of bloodshed, horrors that no tongue can tell" (Stasimon 1, lines 480–481): The ode opens with the question the whole play is asking: who is the man the oracle has named? Theme link: The elders refuse to judge without proof, so the ode shows a community trying to know the truth honestly while the facts are still hidden. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (How much evidence should we need before we believe an accusation against someone we trust?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.

   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: "Proof is there none: how then can I challenge our King's good name, / How in a blood-feud join for an untracked deed of shame" (Stasimon 1, lines 503–504): The elders will not accuse the king who saved them without evidence, which shows a fair-minded loyalty. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
10. Where does tone / mood appear in "Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)", and how does it connect the hunted man to the larger concern with leadership and the city? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Look for word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Chorus is fair-minded: it believes the oracle but will not condemn the king without proof. Useful evidence: “Now like a sullen bull he roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves, / And vainly seeks to fly / The doom that ever nigh / Flits o’er his head, / Still by the avenging Phoebus sped, / The voice ” (Stasimon 1, lines 490–497): The hunted bull is the image of a guilty man who cannot escape the god's judgment however far he runs. On tone / mood: The first half is urgent and threatening as the god's voice hunts the guilty man; the second half becomes troubled and uncertain as the elders admit they do not know whom to believe. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Are the Chorus wise or naive to wait for proof? Defend your view. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** They are wise to wait. The ode shows they take the oracle seriously, picturing the guilty man fleeing like "a sullen bull" before the god's voice (lines 490–497). Yet they will not ruin a man who saved the city on one accusation: "Proof is there none: how then can I challenge our King's good name" (line 503). A strong answer may note the cost of waiting while the plague continues.
   Answer guidance: They are wise to wait. The ode shows they take the oracle seriously, picturing the guilty man fleeing like "a sullen bull" before the god's voice (lines 490–497). Yet they will not ruin a man who saved the city on one accusation: "Proof is there none: how then can I challenge our King's good name" (line 503). A strong answer may note the cost of waiting while the plague continues.
2. Which image in Stasimon 1 best captures the murderer's plight: the sullen bull or the sleuth-hounds? Defend your choice. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** The sleuth-hounds capture it best. The bull shows the killer's isolation as he "roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves" (lines 490–491), but the Fates that hunt "Like sleuth-hounds" (lines 486–487) show why he cannot escape: the gods follow a scent until they find their prey. A strong answer may prefer the bull for its loneliness, but it should explain which image better fits the ode's claim that the doom "ever nigh / Flits o'er his head" (lines 493–494).
   Answer guidance: The sleuth-hounds capture it best. The bull shows the killer's isolation as he "roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves" (lines 490–491), but the Fates that hunt "Like sleuth-hounds" (lines 486–487) show why he cannot escape: the gods follow a scent until they find their prey. A strong answer may prefer the bull for its loneliness, but it should explain which image better fits the ode's claim that the doom "ever nigh / Flits o'er his head" (lines 493–494).
3. Does Stasimon 1 show more faith in the gods or in Oedipus? Argue with evidence. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** It shows faith in both, but more in the gods. The elders grant that "All wise are Zeus and Apollo, and nothing is hid from their ken" (line 505), yet they doubt that "a mortal seer knows more than I know" (line 507). They trust Oedipus because he was "Tested and tried in the light of us all, like gold assayed" (line 510). A strong answer separates trust in the gods from trust in their human spokesman.
   Answer guidance: It shows faith in both, but more in the gods. The elders grant that "All wise are Zeus and Apollo, and nothing is hid from their ken" (line 505), yet they doubt that "a mortal seer knows more than I know" (line 507). They trust Oedipus because he was "Tested and tried in the light of us all, like gold assayed" (line 510). A strong answer separates trust in the gods from trust in their human spokesman.
4. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): The hunted bull is an image of Oedipus himself, though the Chorus does not know it. Their loyalty and demand for evidence show a fair-

minded community. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Chorus is fair-minded: it believes the oracle but will not condemn the king without proof. Useful evidence: "Proof is there none: how then can I challenge our King's good name, / How in a blood-feud join for an untracked deed of shame" (Stasimon 1, lines 503–504): The elders will not accuse the king who saved them without evidence, which shows a fair-minded loyalty. On theme: The ode weighs the authority of a prophet against loyalty to a king who saved the city, and asks what counts as proof. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Which character in "Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)" acts most wisely in the matter of the hunted man, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Chorus is fair-minded: it believes the oracle but will not condemn the king without proof. Useful evidence: "Who is he by voice immortal named from Pythia's rocky cell, / Doer of foul deeds of bloodshed, horrors that no tongue can tell" (Stasimon 1, lines 480–481): The ode opens with the question the whole play is asking: who is the man the oracle has named? Theme link: The elders refuse to judge without proof, so the ode shows a community trying to know the truth honestly while the facts are still hidden. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. You are directing "Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the hunted man. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Chorus is fair-minded: it believes the oracle but will not condemn the king without proof. Useful evidence: "Now like a sullen bull he roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves, / And vainly seeks to fly / The doom that ever nigh / Flits o'er his head, / Still by the avenging Phoebus sped, / The voice " (Stasimon 1, lines 490–497): The hunted bull is the image of a guilty man who cannot escape the god's judgment however far he runs. Theme link: The elders refuse to judge without proof, so the ode shows a community trying to know the truth honestly while the facts are still hidden. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Write your own questions about "Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Chorus is fair-minded: it believes the oracle but will not condemn the king without proof. Useful evidence: "Proof is there none: how then can I challenge our King's good name, / How in a blood-feud join for an untracked deed of shame" (Stasimon 1, lines 503–504): The elders will not accuse the king who saved them without evidence, which shows a fair-minded loyalty. On theme: The ode weighs the authority of a prophet against loyalty to a king who saved the city, and asks what counts as proof. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Connect "Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)", with its focus on the hunted man, to mercy: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Chorus is fair-minded: it believes the oracle but will not condemn the king without proof. Useful evidence: "Who is he by voice immortal named from Pythia's rocky cell, / Doer of foul deeds of bloodshed, horrors that no tongue can tell" (Stasimon 1, lines 480–481): The ode opens with the question the whole play is asking: who is the man the oracle has named? On theme: The ode weighs the authority of a prophet against loyalty to a king who saved the city, and asks what counts as proof. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Is the imagery in "Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)" effective in presenting the hunted man, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Chorus is fair-minded: it believes the oracle but will not condemn the king without proof. Useful evidence: "Now like a sullen bull he roves / Through forest brakes and upland groves, / And vainly seeks to fly / The doom that ever nigh / Flits o'er his head, / Still by the avenging Phoebus sped, / The voice " (Stasimon 1, lines 490–497): The hunted bull is the image of a guilty man who cannot escape the god's judgment however far he runs. On imagery: The Chorus pictures the unknown killer as a wild bull roaming the forests and upland groves, always pursued by the voice of Apollo from Delphi. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Compare how "Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)" treats the hunted man with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus Rex see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Chorus is fair-minded: it believes the oracle but will not condemn the king without proof. Useful evidence: "Proof is there none: how then can I challenge our King's good name, / How in a blood-feud join for an untracked deed of shame" (Stasimon 1, lines 503–504): The elders will not accuse the king who saved them without evidence, which shows a fair-minded loyalty. On theme: The ode weighs the authority of a prophet against loyalty to a king who saved the city, and asks what counts as proof. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In the first strophe of the ode, who follows the unknown murderer armed with lightning?
   A. Apollo, armed with his father's lightnings
   B. Zeus himself, hurling bolts from Olympus
   C. Ares, the god of war and of the plague
   D. Artemis, with her bright and flaring torches

   Key: A (Apollo, armed with his father's lightnings)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] To what animal does the Chorus compare the fleeing murderer?
   A. A wounded deer
   B. A sullen bull
   C. A hungry wolf
   D. A frightened hare

   Key: B (A sullen bull)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] From where does the Chorus say the summons to seek the murderer flashed forth?
   A. The walls of the city of Thebes
   B. The temple of Zeus by the river
   C. Parnassus' snowy peak
   D. The sea-cliffs beyond the harbour

   Key: C (Parnassus' snowy peak)
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the Chorus's image: “Like sleuth-hounds too The _____ pursue.”
   Key: Fates
5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the line: “Still by the avenging _____ sped”
   Key: Phoebus
6. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does the Chorus say the murderer needs a foot swifter than storm-swift steeds?
   A. He has been seen near the city gates
   B. The people of Thebes are chasing him
   C. An oracle has promised him a safe escape
   D. Apollo himself is close on his heels

   Key: D (Apollo himself is close on his heels)
7. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] In the second half of the ode, why does the Chorus refuse to believe the seer's charge yet?
   A. Nothing yet shows that the king is guilty
   B. The seer has been wrong many times before
   C. Creon has told them that the seer is lying
   D. The god at Delphi has cleared Oedipus by name

Key: A (Nothing yet shows that the king is guilty)

8. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] The Chorus says the murderer “vainly seeks to fly The doom that ever nigh Flits o’er his head”. What does this suggest about his chances of escape?
   Sample answer: It suggests that he has no real chance of escape. However far he runs, the doom sent by Apollo stays right above his head, so his flight is useless. The Chorus pictures the god's punishment as something that follows him everywhere, which makes the hunt for the guilty man seem certain to succeed in the end.
9. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the hunting imagery in the first strophe of the ode (lines 480–487).
   Sample answer: The ode pictures the murderer as prey and the gods as hunters: he needs feet faster than horses, Apollo follows armed with lightning, and the Fates pursue like sleuth-hounds. The imagery makes the search a divine chase rather than only a human inquiry. It also suggests that the hunted man cannot outrun powers that never tire.
10. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Analyze the Chorus's attitude toward the seer's words in the second half of the ode.
    Sample answer: The Chorus is torn: it says it is sore perplexed and does not know whether the seer's words are true or false. It respects the knowledge of the gods but doubts that a mortal seer knows more than other men. In the end it refuses to condemn Oedipus without proof, so its attitude is an uneasy loyalty to the king.
11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does the Chorus say it does because it is afraid to judge the seer's words?
    A. It holds back and will not speak
    B. It prays to Apollo for a clear sign
    C. It calls on the king to answer the charge
    D. It weeps aloud for the dead king

    Key: A (It holds back and will not speak)
12. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Which two gods does the Chorus call all wise, with nothing hidden from them?
    A. Ares and Athenè
    B. Zeus and Apollo
    C. Artemis and Bacchus
    D. Poseidon and Hera

    Key: B (Zeus and Apollo)
13. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does the Chorus say it knows of any quarrel between Oedipus and the house of Labdacus?
    A. An old quarrel over land and cattle
    B. A recent dispute over the throne
    C. It knows of none, old or new
    D. A feud that started at a wedding feast

    Key: C (It knows of none, old or new)
14. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: “A foot for _____ he needs”
    Key: flight

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Why does the Chorus compare the murderer to a bull roving through forest and upland?

    A. He is strong enough to fight off his hunters

    B. He has hidden himself among the city's cattle

    C. He is a proud king who rules the hill country

    D. He is a lonely outcast, wild and driven

    Key: D (He is a lonely outcast, wild and driven)

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] When the Chorus asks how it could join "in a blood-feud" against the king, what does it mean?

    A. It will not seek vengeance on Oedipus without proof

    B. It fears a war between Thebes and a neighbouring city

    C. It wants the royal family to settle the matter alone

    D. It plans to punish the seer for his false charges

    Key: A (It will not seek vengeance on Oedipus without proof)

17. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does the Chorus recall Oedipus's victory over the Sphinx in the last lines of the ode?

    Sample answer: The Chorus remembers how Oedipus saved the city from the Sphinx in full public view. That memory is its strongest evidence of his worth. Because he was tested and proved true then, the elders cannot easily believe a charge against him now, and they will not accept it without clear proof that he is guilty.

18. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze how the ode moves from certainty in its first half to doubt in its second half.

    Sample answer: The first half speaks with confidence: the god's summons has gone out, and Apollo and the Fates are sure to run the murderer down. The second half turns to the seer's charge against the king and becomes uncertain and full of questions. The shift shows that the elders trust divine justice but cannot tell how it applies to Oedipus.

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze the distinction the Chorus draws between the gods and a mortal seer in lines 505–508.

    Sample answer: The Chorus grants that Zeus and Apollo are all wise and that nothing is hidden from them. But it insists that a seer is only a man, and one man may be wiser than another without being proven right. By separating divine knowledge from human prophecy, the elders give themselves a reason to doubt the seer without doubting the gods.

20. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does the Chorus's view of Oedipus in Stasimon 1 compare with the city's view of him in the Prologue and Episode 1?

    Sample answer: In the Prologue the city honours Oedipus as the man who freed it from the Sphinx and begs him to save it again. In Episode 1 the Chorus stays loyal but tries to calm his quarrel with the seer. In Stasimon 1 that loyalty holds under strain: the elders are troubled by the charge, but they still trust the king who was tested and proved like gold.

21. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: "Are they true, are they false? I know not and _____ my tongue for fear"

    Key: bridle

22. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does the Chorus call the Sphinx in this ode?

    A. The wingèd songstress

    B. The riddling beast

    C. The maiden of the rock

D. The hound of the dead

Key: A (The wingèd songstress)

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does the Chorus say is not clear to it after hearing the seer?

A. Whether the plague will ever end in Thebes

B. Neither the present nor the future

C. Who the rightful king of Thebes is

D. Why the god has chosen to speak at all

Key: B (Neither the present nor the future)

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the Chorus mean by calling the crime an "untracked deed of shame"?

A. No one in Thebes thinks it was wrong

B. It happened far away in a foreign land

C. No one has yet traced who did it

D. The gods have chosen to forget it

Key: C (No one has yet traced who did it)

25. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does the Chorus say it cannot "challenge our King's good name"?

Sample answer: It says there is no proof against him, and it knows of no old or new quarrel that would give him a motive against the house of Labdacus. Without evidence, the elders will not accuse a king who has served them well. They choose to keep their judgment open rather than accept the seer's charge on his word alone.

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Which device is most at work in "Like sleuth-hounds too The Fates pursue"?

A. Paradox

B. Apostrophe

C. Understatement

D. Simile

Key: D (Simile)

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Analyze the comparison of Oedipus to gold that has been assayed (line 510).

Sample answer: Gold is assayed by testing it to prove that it is pure. The Chorus says Oedipus was tested in public when he faced the Sphinx and proved genuine, so his worth already seems established. The image makes their loyalty seem reasonable, but it also hints that he may be tested again, and the result of a new trial is not yet known.

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze the questions the Chorus asks in the second strophe and antistrophe. What do they reveal?

Sample answer: The elders ask whether the seer's words are true or false, how they can challenge the king without proof, where it has been shown that a seer knows more than they do, and how they can assent to the charge. The questions reveal real uncertainty, but they lean toward defending Oedipus. Each one asks for proof that no one has yet offered.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does Stasimon 1 respond to the quarrel between Oedipus and the seer in Episode 1?

Sample answer: In Episode 1 the seer names Oedipus as the polluter and the king accuses him of a plot. Stasimon 1 lets the

Chorus think the quarrel over. It holds to its faith that the gods will hunt down the guilty man, but it will not take the seer's word against the king without proof. The ode stands between the two men, as the Chorus did in the scene.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Compare the picture of Apollo in Stasimon 1 with the way Oedipus speaks of the god in Episode 1.

    Sample answer: In Episode 1 Oedipus calls himself the champion of the god and vows to carry out the oracle by finding the murderer. In Stasimon 1 Apollo is himself the hunter, armed with lightning and following hard on the murderer's heels. Both pictures make the search a divine command, but the ode shows the god as far more certain of success than any human searcher.

31. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: "They are gods; and in wits a man may _____ his fellow men"

    Key: surpass

32. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In the first antistrophe, through what country does the murderer roam?

    A. Forest brakes and upland groves

    B. Dry plains and desert sands

    C. City streets and crowded markets

    D. Sea-cliffs and lonely harbours

    Key: A (Forest brakes and upland groves)

33. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Why does the Chorus think a mortal seer might be wrong even though the gods know all?

    A. The seer has openly admitted he is unsure

    B. A seer is a man, and men differ in wit

    C. The oracle at Delphi forbids seers to speak

    D. The seer is blind and cannot read the birds

    Key: B (A seer is a man, and men differ in wit)

34. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the Chorus mean when it says it is "Fluttered with vague surmise"?

    Sample answer: It means the elders are unsettled by guesses they cannot settle one way or the other. The seer's words have stirred fear and doubt, but they have nothing firm to hold on to, so their thoughts flutter like birds. The phrase shows a state of anxious uncertainty rather than either belief or disbelief in the charge.

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What is the effect of the quoted summons "Near and far the undiscovered doer of this murder seek!"?

    A. It shows the Chorus doubts the god's word

    B. It names the murderer for the first time

    C. It sounds the god's command as a direct cry

    D. It reveals that the summons came from Creon

    Key: C (It sounds the god's command as a direct cry)

36. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the Chorus pictures divine justice as inescapable in the first strophe and antistrophe.

    Sample answer: The murderer is hunted by Apollo with his father's lightnings and by the Fates like sleuth-hounds, and the

god's summons has gone out near and far. Even when he roves like a bull through forests and hills, doom still hovers over his head. Every image of flight is matched by an image of pursuit, so justice seems certain to overtake him.

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] Analyze the irony of the Chorus defending Oedipus by pointing to his victory over the Sphinx.

    Sample answer: The elders use the Sphinx victory as proof of his goodness: he was tested in public and found true like gold. But the seer has just warned that this same greatness will prove the king's bane, and that the solver of riddles cannot read his own story. The audience can see that the evidence the Chorus trusts may be the very thing that blinds Oedipus.

38. [mc · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Which statement best describes the function of Stasimon 1 within the play so far?

    A. It reports a new event that has happened offstage in the city

    B. It announces with joy the end of the plague in the city of Thebes

    C. It introduces a new character to the audience

    D. It pauses to weigh the seer's charge before the drama moves on

    Key: D (It pauses to weigh the seer's charge before the drama moves on)

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate the Chorus's reasoning for refusing to accept the seer's charge.

    Sample answer: The reasoning is careful and fair on its own terms: there is no proof, no known motive, and a seer, unlike a god, can be wrong. Yet it rests heavily on past success, assuming that a man proven once is proven forever. The elders weigh evidence wisely but trust a reputation that the play has already begun to question.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Stasimon 1 deepen the theme of knowledge that runs through the Prologue and Episode 1?

    Sample answer: The Prologue showed Oedipus as the man who knows, and Episode 1 set his reason against the seer's prophecy. Stasimon 1 asks who can be trusted to know: the gods know everything, but men, including seers, know only in part. By admitting that neither present nor future is clear, the Chorus makes uncertainty itself the subject of the ode.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 3, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 2
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 2, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511) develops the idea of the hunted man. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4; W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)” could deliver about the hunted man. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4; W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the hunted man in "Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to knowledge and blindness and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of the hunted man. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)" could deliver about the hunted man. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the hunted man in "Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to knowledge and blindness and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511) suggests about the hunted man. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)" could deliver about the hunted man. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the hunted man in "Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to knowledge and blindness and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses imagery in Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511) to complicate the reader's understanding of the hunted man. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)" could deliver about the hunted man. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the hunted man in "Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to knowledge and blindness and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Who is he by voice immortal named from Pythia's rocky cell, Doer of foul deeds of bloodshed, horrors that no tongue can tell? A foot for flight he needs Fleeter than storm-swift steeds, For on his heels doth follow, Armed with the lightnings of his Sire, Apollo. Like sleuth-hounds too The Fates pursue. Yea, but now flashed forth the summons from Parnassus' snowy peak, "Near and far the undiscovered doer of this murder seek!" Now like a sullen bull he roves Through forest brakes and upland groves, And vainly seeks to fly The doom that ever nigh Flits o'er his head, Still by the avenging Phoebus sped, The voice divine, From Earth's mid shrine.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Stasimon 1 (lines 480–511)"?

   A. The hunted man

   B. The curse and the prophet

   C. Good news that is not good

   D. Responsibility, mercy and the end

SAT key: 1. A (The hunted man)

Lesson 6: Episode 2 (lines 512–880)

Focus: Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear

Objective: Students will analyze how irony develops in "Episode 2 (lines 512–880)" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.6; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Content note (mature themes, alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): Teacher note: some schools' guidelines may treat this passage differently. This section mentions drinking or a drug ("…stirred. A roisterer at some banquet, flown with wine, Shouted "Thou art not true son of thy…"). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Suggested language: "What does this passage make us notice?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Creon defends himself against Oedipus' charge. Jocasta stops the quarrel and, to prove oracles false, tells how Laius was told he would die by his son, how the infant was cast away, and how Laius was killed by robbers where three roads meet. The detail terrifies Oedipus: he tells of leaving Corinth after an oracle that he would kill his father and marry his mother, and of killing an old man and his servants at a crossroads. One hope remains: the surviving witness said "robbers."

Background: Exposing (abandoning) unwanted infants happened in the ancient Greek world. It was cruel and wrong; the play treats it as the root of the disaster.

Significance: Jocasta's comfort produces the evidence that destroys them. The crossroads is a symbol of choice that Oedipus could not see clearly.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
When someone tries to reassure you, can it make things worse? Give an example. Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and responsibility because....
Prompt: When someone tries to reassure you, can it make things worse? Give an example.
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to fate and responsibility because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Jocasta and Oedipus each describe trying to escape a terrible prophecy, which raises the question of whether human choices can defeat what the gods have foretold.

8–18 min · Vocabulary · We do (10 min)
Two key words in context.
Today's words: infatuate — (archaic adjective) foolish; carried away by passion; prophetic — foretelling the future.
Words: infatuate: (archaic adjective) foolish; carried away by passion · prophetic: foretelling the future

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Exposing (abandoning) unwanted infants happened in the ancient Greek world. It was cruel and wrong; the play treats it as the root of the disaster. Jocasta's comfort produces the evidence that destroys them. The crossroads is a symbol of choice that Oedipus could not see clearly. Irony: Jocasta tells the story of Laius's oracle to prove that prophecies fail, and the details she offers (a son, the place where three roads meet) are the very facts that frighten Oedipus. Plot: The episode moves from a quarrel to an investigation: Creon defends himself, Jocasta intervenes, and her account of Laius's death leads Oedipus to tell his own story and to send for the surviving witness. Characterization: Creon argues like a calm, practical man who already has influence without the burdens of rule, while Oedipus's anger at him gives way to fear as Jocasta speaks. Watch for the crossroads: The place where three roads meet links Jocasta's story to Oedipus's memory and stands for a choice whose meaning was hidden at the time.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "I am not so infatuate as to grasp / The shadow when I hold the substance fast" slowly and put it in my own words: In these lines Creon speaks at a turning point of the section, which is about Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. Next, craft. I notice how the lines use irony, plot to make the audience feel the pressure of the moment on Creon. The strongest word is "infatuate": the word "infatuate" carries the weight of the lines and points to the section's big idea. Then, effect. What do lines 596–597 reveal about Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear? My answer: Jocasta's comfort produces the evidence that destroys them. The crossroads is a symbol of choice that Oedipus could not see clearly. These lines show Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear, and that matters for what follows in the play.

> *I am not so infatuate as to grasp / The shadow when I hold the substance fast (Episode 2, lines 596–597)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "I am not so infatuate as to grasp / The shadow when I hold the substance fast" slowly and put it in my own words: In these lines Creon speaks at a turning point of the section, which is about Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. Next, craft. I notice how the lines use irony, plot to make the audience feel the pressure of the moment on Creon. The strongest word is "infatuate": the word "infatuate" carries the weight of the lines and points to the section's big idea. Then, effect. What do lines 596–597 reveal about Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear? My answer: Jocasta's comfort produces the evidence that destroys them. The crossroads is a symbol of choice that Oedipus could not see clearly. These lines show Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear, and that matters for what follows in the play.

40–50 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (10 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Convince", "scot or lot" and "prophetic art" stand out. Jocasta promises proof that no human has any share in prophecy; her confident words of comfort make the evidence that follows more frightening. Ask: How does this line connect to fate and responsibility? Expected student answer: Jocasta and Oedipus each describe trying to escape a terrible prophecy, which raises the question of whether human choices can defeat what the gods have foretold. (Jocasta sets out to comfort Oedipus by proving that no human can foretell the future.)

> *Listen and I'll convince thee that no man / Hath scot or lot in the prophetic art* (Episode 2, lines 715–716)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Convince", "scot or lot" and "prophetic art" stand out. Jocasta promises proof that no human has any share in prophecy; her confident words of comfort make the evidence that follows more frightening.
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and responsibility?
Expected student answer: Jocasta and Oedipus each describe trying to escape a terrible prophecy, which raises the question of whether human choices can defeat what the gods have foretold. (Jocasta sets out to comfort Oedipus by proving that no human can foretell the future.)

50–55 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (5 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for irony, plot (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 2 (lines 512–880) develops the idea of Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and plot shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Jocasta's attempt to comfort Oedipus produces the evidence that frightens him most. When the text says "Listen and I'll convince thee that no man / Hath scot or lot in the prophetic art" (Episode 2, lines 715–716), it shows this directly. To show that "no man / Hath scot or lot in the prophetic art", she describes Laius's death where three roads meet, and Oedipus answers with his own story of a killing at a crossroads and the fear that the curse was "laid by none but me".
Task: Annotate the scene for irony, plot (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 2 (lines 512–880) develops the idea of Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and plot shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Jocasta's attempt to comfort Oedipus produces the evidence that frightens him most. When the text says "Listen and I'll convince thee that no man / Hath scot or lot in the prophetic art" (Episode 2, lines 715–716), it shows this directly. To show that "no man / Hath scot or lot in the prophetic art", she describes Laius's death where three roads meet, and Oedipus answers with his own story of a killing at a crossroads and the fear that the curse was "laid by none but me".

55–60 min · Discussion · We do (5 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: When someone tries to reassure you, can it make things worse? Give an example. Ask: When someone tries to reassure you, can it make things worse? Give an example.
Anchor question: When someone tries to reassure you, can it make things worse? Give an example.
Facilitation: Ask: When someone tries to reassure you, can it make things worse? Give an example.

60–67 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Jocasta's attempt to comfort Oedipus produces the evidence that frightens him most. ("Listen and I'll convince thee that no man / Hath scot or lot in the prophetic art", Episode 2, lines 715–716). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Jocasta's attempt to comfort Oedipus produces the evidence that frightens him most. ("Listen and I'll convince thee that no man / Hath scot or lot in the prophetic art", Episode 2, lines 715–716). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

67–70 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how irony shapes Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. Key takeaway: Jocasta and Oedipus each describe trying to escape a terrible prophecy, which raises the question of whether human choices can defeat what the gods have foretold.

Total: 70 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Irony:** Jocasta tells the story of Laius's oracle to prove that prophecies fail, and the details she offers (a son, the place where three roads meet) are the very facts that frighten Oedipus.
- **Plot:** The episode moves from a quarrel to an investigation: Creon defends himself, Jocasta intervenes, and her account of Laius's death leads Oedipus to tell his own story and to send for the surviving witness.
- **Characterization:** Creon argues like a calm, practical man who already has influence without the burdens of rule, while Oedipus's anger at him gives way to fear as Jocasta speaks.

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and responsibility:** Jocasta and Oedipus each describe trying to escape a terrible prophecy, which raises the question of whether human choices can defeat what the gods have foretold.

Symbols and motifs

- **the crossroads:** The place where three roads meet links Jocasta's story to Oedipus's memory and stands for a choice whose meaning was hidden at the time.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "I am not so infatuate as to grasp / The shadow when I hold the substance fast" (Episode 2, lines 596–597) Creon argues that he already has real power and ease, so it would be foolish to plot for the mere appearance of a crown.
- "Listen and I'll convince thee that no man / Hath scot or lot in the prophetic art" (Episode 2, lines 715–716) Jocasta sets out to comfort Oedipus by proving that no human can foretell the future.
- "As for the child, it was but three days old, / When Laius, its ankles pierced and pinned / Together, gave it to be cast away / By others on the trackless mountain side" (Episode 2, lines 726–729) Jocasta describes how the infant was left to die so that the prophecy could not come true, a story she tells as proof that prophecy failed.
- "Yet was I quits with him and more; one stroke / Of my good staff sufficed to fling him clean / Out of the chariot seat and laid him prone. / And so I slew them every one" (Episode 2, lines 827–830) Oedipus tells how he killed an old man and his servants at a crossroads in anger, the memory Jocasta's story has stirred.
- "And this same curse / Was laid on me, and laid by none but me" (Episode 2, lines 836–837) Oedipus sees that if he is the killer, the curse he pronounced has fallen on himself.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Jocasta's attempt to comfort Oedipus produces the evidence that frightens him most.
Evidence: "Listen and I'll convince thee that no man / Hath scot or lot in the prophetic art" (Episode 2, lines 715–716)
Reasoning: To show that "no man / Hath scot or lot in the prophetic art", she describes Laius's death where three roads meet, and Oedipus answers with his own story of a killing at a crossroads and the fear that the curse was "laid by none but me".

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 596–597
596 **Creon:** I am not so infatuate as to grasp
597 **Creon:** The shadow when I hold the substance fast.

Line 617
617 **Creon:** The truth, for time alone reveals the just;

Lines 619–620
619 **Chorus:** To one who walketh warily his words
620 **Chorus:** Commend themselves; swift counsels are not sure.

Lines 646–647

646 **Jocasta:** Go home, my brother, and forebear to make
647 **Jocasta:** A public scandal of a petty grief.

Line 714

714 **Jocasta:** Then thou mayest ease thy conscience on that score.

Lines 714–736

714 **Jocasta:** Then thou mayest ease thy conscience on that score.
715 **Jocasta:** Listen and I'll convince thee that no man
716 **Jocasta:** Hath scot or lot in the prophetic art.
717 **Jocasta:** Here is the proof in brief. An oracle
718 **Jocasta:** Once came to Laius (I will not say
719 **Jocasta:** 'Twas from the Delphic god himself, but from
720 **Jocasta:** His ministers) declaring he was doomed
721 **Jocasta:** To perish by the hand of his own son,
722 **Jocasta:** A child that should be born to him by me.
723 **Jocasta:** Now Laius—so at least report affirmed—
724 **Jocasta:** Was murdered on a day by highwaymen,
725 **Jocasta:** No natives, at a spot where three roads meet.
726 **Jocasta:** As for the child, it was but three days old,
727 **Jocasta:** When Laius, its ankles pierced and pinned
728 **Jocasta:** Together, gave it to be cast away
729 **Jocasta:** By others on the trackless mountain side.
730 **Jocasta:** So then Apollo brought it not to pass
731 **Jocasta:** The child should be his father's murderer,
732 **Jocasta:** Or the dread terror find accomplishment,
733 **Jocasta:** And Laius be slain by his own son.
734 **Jocasta:** Such was the prophet's horoscope. O king,
735 **Jocasta:** Regard it not. Whate'er the god deems fit
736 **Jocasta:** To search, himself unaided will reveal.

Lines 715–716

715 **Jocasta:** Listen and I'll convince thee that no man
716 **Jocasta:** Hath scot or lot in the prophetic art.

Lines 717–736

717 **Jocasta:** Here is the proof in brief. An oracle
718 **Jocasta:** Once came to Laius (I will not say
719 **Jocasta:** 'Twas from the Delphic god himself, but from
720 **Jocasta:** His ministers) declaring he was doomed
721 **Jocasta:** To perish by the hand of his own son,
722 **Jocasta:** A child that should be born to him by me.
723 **Jocasta:** Now Laius—so at least report affirmed—
724 **Jocasta:** Was murdered on a day by highwaymen,

725 **Jocasta:** No natives, at a spot where three roads meet.
726 **Jocasta:** As for the child, it was but three days old,
727 **Jocasta:** When Laius, its ankles pierced and pinned
728 **Jocasta:** Together, gave it to be cast away
729 **Jocasta:** By others on the trackless mountain side.
730 **Jocasta:** So then Apollo brought it not to pass
731 **Jocasta:** The child should be his father's murderer,
732 **Jocasta:** Or the dread terror find accomplishment,
733 **Jocasta:** And Laius be slain by his own son.
734 **Jocasta:** Such was the prophet's horoscope. O king,
735 **Jocasta:** Regard it not. Whate'er the god deems fit
736 **Jocasta:** To search, himself unaided will reveal.

Lines 726–729
726 **Jocasta:** As for the child, it was but three days old,
727 **Jocasta:** When Laius, its ankles pierced and pinned
728 **Jocasta:** Together, gave it to be cast away
729 **Jocasta:** By others on the trackless mountain side.

Lines 755–756
755 **Oedipus:** O woe is me! Mehtinks unwittingly
756 **Oedipus:** I laid but now a dread curse on myself.

Line 760
760 **Oedipus:** That in the end the seer will prove not blind.

Lines 827–830
827 **Oedipus:** Yet was I quits with him and more; one stroke
828 **Oedipus:** Of my good staff sufficed to fling him clean
829 **Oedipus:** Out of the chariot seat and laid him prone.
830 **Oedipus:** And so I slew them every one. But if

Lines 830–845
830 **Oedipus:** And so I slew them every one. But if
831 **Oedipus:** Betwixt this stranger there was aught in common
832 **Oedipus:** With Laius, who more miserable than I,
833 **Oedipus:** What mortal could you find more god-abhorred?
834 **Oedipus:** Wretch whom no sojourner, no citizen
835 **Oedipus:** May harbour or address, whom all are bound
836 **Oedipus:** To harry from their homes. And this same curse
837 **Oedipus:** Was laid on me, and laid by none but me.
838 **Oedipus:** Yea with these hands all gory I pollute
839 **Oedipus:** The bed of him I slew. Say, am I vile?
840 **Oedipus:** Am I not utterly unclean, a wretch
841 **Oedipus:** Doomed to be banished, and in banishment

842 **Oedipus:** Forgo the sight of all my dearest ones,
843 **Oedipus:** And never tread again my native earth;
844 **Oedipus:** Or else to wed my mother and slay my sire,
845 **Oedipus:** Polybus, who begat me and upreared?

Lines 836–837
836 **Oedipus:** To harry from their homes. And this same curse
837 **Oedipus:** Was laid on me, and laid by none but me.

Line 876
876 **Jocasta:** Will look for signs neither to right nor left.

Vocabulary

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context
infatuate (adjective)	(archaic adjective) foolish; carried away by passion	*I am not so infatuate as to grasp The shadow when I hold the substance fast.*
prophetic (adjective)	foretelling the future	*Listen and I'll convince thee that no man Hath scot or lot in the prophetic art.*

Discussion questions

1. When someone tries to reassure you, can it make things worse? Give an example.
2. Where does irony appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with mercy?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What did the oracle tell Oedipus in Corinth? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** That he would kill his father and marry his mother (lines 805–809).
   Answer guidance: That he would kill his father and marry his mother (lines 805–809).
2. What does Creon say Oedipus should do if a plot with the seer is proved (lines 605–610)? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Sentence him to death, by both their voices and not the king's alone.
   Answer guidance: Sentence him to death, by both their voices and not the king's alone.
3. How did Oedipus's parents in Corinth respond when he asked them about the drunken insult (lines 796–801)? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1,

RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** They were indignant and tried to comfort him, but the scandal kept spreading.

Answer guidance: They were indignant and tried to comfort him, but the scandal kept spreading.

4. What does Oedipus say will clear him if the herdsman's story holds (lines 860–863)? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** If the herdsman still speaks of many robbers, not one lone traveller.

   Answer guidance: If the herdsman still speaks of many robbers, not one lone traveller.

5. Why does Creon say he would not want the throne? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** He already has power and ease without its burdens

   Answer guidance: He already has power and ease without its burdens.

6. Why does Jocasta tell the story of Laius' oracle? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** To prove that prophecies cannot be trusted

   Answer guidance: To prove that prophecies cannot be trusted.

7. Who brought the report of Laius's death back to Thebes? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A serf, the sole survivor

   Answer guidance: A serf, the sole survivor.

8. What did happen to the infant in Jocasta's story? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** His ankles were pinned and he was given to be cast away on a mountain

   Answer guidance: His ankles were pinned and he was given to be cast away on a mountain.

9. What is Oedipus' remaining hope at the end of the episode? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The witness said Laius was killed by robbers, more than one

   Answer guidance: The witness said Laius was killed by robbers, more than one.

10. Retell the most important events of “Episode 2 (lines 512–880)” in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Creon defends himself against Oedipus' charge. Jocasta stops the quarrel and, to prove oracles false, tells how Laius was told he would die by his son, how the infant was cast away, and how Laius was killed by robbers where three roads meet. The detail terrifies Oedipus: he tells of leaving Corinth after an oracle that he would kill his father and marry his mother, and of killing an old man and…

    Answer guidance: Creon defends himself against Oedipus' charge. Jocasta stops the quarrel and, to prove oracles false, tells how Laius was told he would die by his son, how the infant was cast away, and how Laius was killed by robbers where three roads meet. The detail terrifies Oedipus: he tells of leaving Corinth after an oracle that he would kill his father and marry his mother, and of killing an old man and…

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Jocasta's comfort backfire? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** Her details match Oedipus' own memory of the crossroads.

   Answer guidance: Her details match Oedipus' own memory of the crossroads.

2. Why does Jocasta rebuke Oedipus and Creon for quarrelling in public? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** The city is sick with plague, so a private feud between its two leading men is shameful and only adds to the people's suffering.

Answer guidance: The city is sick with plague, so a private feud between its two leading men is shameful and only adds to the people's suffering.

3. Why does Oedipus let Creon go even though he still believes Creon is guilty? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** He yields to the elders' plea and to Creon's oath, yet he warns that sparing Creon may cost him his own life or his throne.
   Answer guidance: He yields to the elders' plea and to Creon's oath, yet he warns that sparing Creon may cost him his own life or his throne.
4. Why does Oedipus insist on sending for the surviving herdsman? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** The herdsman's word about one traveller or many robbers is the single fact that can still prove him innocent or guilty of the killing.
   Answer guidance: The herdsman's word about one traveller or many robbers is the single fact that can still prove him innocent or guilty of the killing.
5. Why did Oedipus leave Corinth and never go back to the city he thought was his home? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** Apollo foretold that he would kill his father and marry his mother, so he fled the parents he believed were his to make the prophecy impossible.
   Answer guidance: Apollo foretold that he would kill his father and marry his mother, so he fled the parents he believed were his to make the prophecy impossible.
6. What does "Episode 2 (lines 512–880)" suggest about Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Jocasta's comfort produces the evidence that destroys them. The crossroads is a symbol of choice that Oedipus could not see clearly.
   Answer guidance: Jocasta's comfort produces the evidence that destroys them. The crossroads is a symbol of choice that Oedipus could not see clearly. Evidence to accept: "I am not so infatuate as to grasp / The shadow when I hold the substance fast" (Episode 2, lines 596–597): Creon argues that he already has real power and ease, so it would be foolish to plot for the mere appearance of a crown. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
7. Find one example of irony in "Episode 2 (lines 512–880)". What does it reveal about Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
   Answer guidance: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true. Evidence to accept: "Listen and I'll convince thee that no man / Hath scot or lot in the prophetic art" (Episode 2, lines 715–716): Jocasta sets out to comfort Oedipus by proving that no human can foretell the future. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
8. How does the plot in "Episode 2 (lines 512–880)" shape what we understand about Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Look for key events and the causes linking them.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Jocasta's attempt to comfort Oedipus produces the evidence that frightens him most. Useful evidence: "I am not so infatuate as to grasp / The shadow when I hold the substance fast" (Episode 2, lines 596–597): Creon argues that he already has real power and ease, so it would be foolish to plot for the mere appearance of a crown. On plot: The episode moves from a quarrel to an investigation: Creon defends himself, Jocasta intervenes, and her account of Laius's death

leads Oedipus to tell his own story and to send for the surviving witness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. In the passage that opens with “Then thou mayest ease thy conscience on that score.”, why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: “As for the child, it was but three days old, / When Laius, its ankles pierced and pinned / Together, gave it to be cast away / By others on the trackless mountain side” (Episode 2, lines 726–729): Jocasta describes how the infant was left to die so that the prophecy could not come true, a story she tells as proof that prophecy failed. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

10. What causes the main turn in “Episode 2 (lines 512–880)”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Look for: the detail of the place where three roads meet; Oedipus's memory of killing an old man at a crossroads; the effect, his first fear, held off only by the word "robbers".

    Answer guidance: Look for: the detail of the place where three roads meet; Oedipus's memory of killing an old man at a crossroads; the effect, his first fear, held off only by the word "robbers". Evidence to accept: “Yet was I quits with him and more; one stroke / Of my good staff sufficed to fling him clean / Out of the chariot seat and laid him prone. / And so I slew them every one” (Episode 2, lines 827–830): Oedipus tells how he killed an old man and his servants at a crossroads in anger, the memory Jocasta's story has stirred. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is the killing at the crossroads (lines 827–830) self-defence, rage or fate? Argue with evidence. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** The text supports more than one reading. Oedipus says the old man struck first, so he claims a kind of self-defence, but he also says "one stroke / Of my good staff sufficed" and "I slew them every one" (lines 827–830), which sounds like rage that went far beyond defence. Fate is present because he left Corinth to avoid the oracle, yet his own hand acted. A strong answer chooses a reading and answers the strongest objection.

   Answer guidance: The text supports more than one reading. Oedipus says the old man struck first, so he claims a kind of self-defence, but he also says "one stroke / Of my good staff sufficed" and "I slew them every one" (lines 827–830), which sounds like rage that went far beyond defence. Fate is present because he left Corinth to avoid the oracle, yet his own hand acted. A strong answer chooses a reading and answers the strongest objection.

2. Who handles the quarrel in Episode 2 better, Creon or Oedipus? Argue with evidence. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Creon handles it better. He answers the charge with reasons and offers a test: "first to Delphi go, / There ascertain if my report was true" and, if a plot is proved, "sentence me to death" (lines 605–609). Oedipus answers with threats, "I would not have thee banished, no, but dead" (line 626), and only gives way when the Chorus and Jocasta plead. A strong answer may grant that Oedipus fears for the city, but weighs reasoned defence against anger.

   Answer guidance: Creon handles it better. He answers the charge with reasons and offers a test: "first to Delphi go, / There ascertain if my report was true" and, if a plot is proved, "sentence me to death" (lines 605–609). Oedipus answers with threats, "I would not have thee banished, no, but dead" (line 626), and

only gives way when the Chorus and Jocasta plead. A strong answer may grant that Oedipus fears for the city, but weighs reasoned defence against anger.

3. Is Jocasta's dismissal of oracles at the end of Episode 2 brave scepticism or dangerous impiety? Argue with evidence. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** It can be read either way. She reasons from what she knows: Loxias said Laius "was doomed / To die by my child's hand", yet the child "perished first himself" (lines 872–874), so she concludes "So much for divination" (line 875). That looks like brave thinking against fear. But the Chorus has just begged the gods to keep faith alive, and the audience senses that her proof is false. A strong answer chooses a reading and answers the strongest objection.
   Answer guidance: It can be read either way. She reasons from what she knows: Loxias said Laius "was doomed / To die by my child's hand", yet the child "perished first himself" (lines 872–874), so she concludes "So much for divination" (line 875). That looks like brave thinking against fear. But the Chorus has just begged the gods to keep faith alive, and the audience senses that her proof is false. A strong answer chooses a reading and answers the strongest objection.
4. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): Jocasta's comfort produces the evidence that destroys them. The crossroads is a symbol of choice that Oedipus could not see clearly. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Jocasta's attempt to comfort Oedipus produces the evidence that frightens him most. Useful evidence: “And this same curse / Was laid on me, and laid by none but me” (Episode 2, lines 836–837): Oedipus sees that if he is the killer, the curse he pronounced has fallen on himself. Theme link: Jocasta and Oedipus each describe trying to escape a terrible prophecy, which raises the question of whether human choices can defeat what the gods have foretold. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Which character in “Episode 2 (lines 512–880)” acts most wisely in the matter of Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Jocasta's attempt to comfort Oedipus produces the evidence that frightens him most. Useful evidence: “I am not so infatuate as to grasp / The shadow when I hold the substance fast” (Episode 2, lines 596–597): Creon argues that he already has real power and ease, so it would be foolish to plot for the mere appearance of a crown. On characterization: Creon argues like a calm, practical man who already has influence without the burdens of rule, while Oedipus's anger at him gives way to fear as Jocasta speaks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. You are directing “Episode 2 (lines 512–880)”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Jocasta's attempt to comfort Oedipus produces the evidence that frightens him most. Useful evidence: “Listen and I’ll convince thee that no man / Hath scot or lot in the prophetic art” (Episode 2, lines 715–716): Jocasta sets out to comfort Oedipus by proving that no

human can foretell the future. Theme link: Jocasta and Oedipus each describe trying to escape a terrible prophecy, which raises the question of whether human choices can defeat what the gods have foretold. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Write your own questions about "Episode 2 (lines 512–880)": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Jocasta's attempt to comfort Oedipus produces the evidence that frightens him most. Useful evidence: "As for the child, it was but three days old, / When Laius, its ankles pierced and pinned / Together, gave it to be cast away / By others on the trackless mountain side" (Episode 2, lines 726–729): Jocasta describes how the infant was left to die so that the prophecy could not come true, a story she tells as proof that prophecy failed. Theme link: Jocasta and Oedipus each describe trying to escape a terrible prophecy, which raises the question of whether human choices can defeat what the gods have foretold. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Connect "Episode 2 (lines 512–880)", with its focus on Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear, to knowledge and blindness: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Jocasta's attempt to comfort Oedipus produces the evidence that frightens him most. Useful evidence: "Yet was I quits with him and more; one stroke / Of my good staff sufficed to fling him clean / Out of the chariot seat and laid him prone. / And so I slew them every one" (Episode 2, lines 827–830): Oedipus tells how he killed an old man and his servants at a crossroads in anger, the memory Jocasta's story has stirred. Theme link: Jocasta and Oedipus each describe trying to escape a terrible prophecy, which raises the question of whether human choices can defeat what the gods have foretold. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Is the irony in "Episode 2 (lines 512–880)" effective in presenting Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Jocasta's attempt to comfort Oedipus produces the evidence that frightens him most. Useful evidence: "And this same curse / Was laid on me, and laid by none but me" (Episode 2, lines 836–837): Oedipus sees that if he is the killer, the curse he pronounced has fallen on himself. On irony: Jocasta tells the story of Laius's oracle to prove that prophecies fail, and the details she offers (a son, the place where three roads meet) are the very facts that frighten Oedipus. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Compare how "Episode 2 (lines 512–880)" treats Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus Rex see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Jocasta's attempt to comfort Oedipus produces the evidence that frightens him most. Useful evidence: "I am not so infatuate as to grasp / The shadow when I hold the substance fast" (Episode 2, lines 596–597): Creon argues that he already has real power and ease, so it would be foolish to plot for the mere appearance of a crown. Theme link: Jocasta and Oedipus each describe trying to escape a terrible prophecy, which raises the question of whether human choices can defeat what the gods have foretold. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Plot**: key events and the causes linking them
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why does Creon come before the Chorus at the start of Episode 2?

   A. To protest the king's charge that he plotted
   B. To report a new message from the god at Delphi
   C. To announce that the seer has fled from Thebes
   D. To ask the elders to make him king in Oedipus's stead

   Key: A (To protest the king's charge that he plotted)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What punishment does Oedipus first say he wants for Creon?

   A. A heavy fine of gold
   B. Death, not banishment
   C. Prison in the palace
   D. Loss of all his lands

   Key: B (Death, not banishment)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who comes from the palace to stop the quarrel between Oedipus and Creon?

   A. The Priest of Zeus
   B. The prophet himself
   C. Jocasta, the queen
   D. A herald from Delphi

   Key: C (Jocasta, the queen)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the queen's rebuke: "Go home, my brother, and forebear to make A public _____ of a petty grief."

   Key: scandal

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Creon's claim: "I am not so infatuate as to grasp The shadow when I hold the _____ fast."

   Key: substance

6. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Oedipus agree in the end to let Creon go?

   A. Creon has proved his innocence beyond doubt

   B. The god at Delphi orders him to spare Creon

   C. He fears the people will rise against him

   D. The Chorus and the queen plead for him

   Key: D (The Chorus and the queen plead for him)

7. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does Jocasta say the servant who survived did when he came back to Thebes?

   A. He begged to be sent to the far pastures

   B. He became a guard at the royal palace

   C. He died of his wounds a few days later

   D. He sailed away to seek his fortune abroad

   Key: A (He begged to be sent to the far pastures)

8. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does Jocasta hope to prove by recalling the oracle given to Laius?

   Sample answer: She wants to calm him by proving that prophecy cannot be trusted. The oracle said Laius would die by his own son's hand, yet she says he was killed by highwaymen and the child was left to die on a mountain. If that oracle failed, she reasons, the seer's charge need not be feared either.

9. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Analyze how Jocasta's attempt to comfort Oedipus has the opposite effect.

   Sample answer: She tells the story of Laius's death to prove that oracles fail, but one detail, that he was killed where three roads meet, shocks Oedipus. Instead of calming him, her proof sends him into questions about the spot, the time, and Laius's looks. The speech meant to end his fear becomes the start of a new and deeper one.

10. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Analyze the test Oedipus sets for the survivor's story near the end of the episode.

    Sample answer: Oedipus says that if the survivor still speaks of robbers, many men, then he himself is not the killer, because one cannot be many. If the man speaks of one lonely traveller, the last link in the chain is forged. The test shows that Oedipus still reasons carefully, but it hangs his fate on a single word in a servant's report.

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Creon say he would feel if the charge against him were believed?

    A. He would not wish to go on living

    B. He would leave Thebes and not come back

    C. He would give all his wealth to the king

    D. He would confess before the god's altar

    Key: A (He would not wish to go on living)

12. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] How many men were travelling with Laius, according to Jocasta?

    A. A pair of armed guards

    B. Five, including a herald

    C. Twenty armed retainers on horseback

    D. Only a single driver

Key: B (Five, including a herald)

13. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What did the oracle that Oedipus received at Delphi foretell?

    A. He would rule Thebes and save it from a plague

    B. He would die young in a distant foreign land

    C. He would wed his mother and slay his father

    D. He would be killed by a son of his own

    Key: C (He would wed his mother and slay his father)

14. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Creon's warning: "The truth, for time alone reveals the _____"

    Key: just

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Creon say he has no wish to be king?

    A. He is too old to bear the weight of rule

    B. He has promised the throne to his own son

    C. He fears the god would punish him for it

    D. Kingship would make him act against his will

    Key: D (Kingship would make him act against his will)

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Oedipus send for the surviving servant at once?

    A. To learn whether one man or many killed Laius

    B. To reward him well for bringing the news back to Thebes

    C. To punish him for running away and leaving the king to die

    D. To ask him where the robbers had fled

    Key: A (To learn whether one man or many killed Laius)

17. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why did the servant who survived beg Jocasta to send him away from Thebes?

    Sample answer: When he returned and found Oedipus reigning in the stead of the slain Laius, he asked to be sent to the pastures, as far from Thebes as possible. The text does not explain his reason, but his request suggests that he knew something about the new king that frightened him. It leaves a question hanging over the search.

18. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Analyze Creon's argument that a sensible man would not choose to be king (lines 583–597).

    Sample answer: Creon argues that he already shares power and enjoys influence without the fears that come with a crown. He contrasts the shadow, the title of king, with the real power he holds. The argument is calm and logical, and it shows Creon as a careful, practical man, quite unlike the hasty and angry Oedipus of this scene.

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze how Oedipus's account of the meeting at the triple-branching roads builds tension.

    Sample answer: He tells the story step by step: the herald, the old man in the car drawn by colts, the attempt to push him from the path, the blow with the goad, and his own blow with the staff. Each detail matches Jocasta's account more closely. The calm telling of violence makes the audience wait for the moment he must face what the match may mean.

20. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Jocasta's view of prophecy in Episode 2 compare with the Chorus's view in Stasimon 1?

    Sample answer: In Stasimon 1 the Chorus says the gods know everything but doubts that a mortal seer knows more than

other men. Jocasta goes further: she says no man has any share in the prophetic art and uses a failed oracle as proof. Both doubt human seers, but Jocasta's doubt is bolder and comes close to scorn for prophecy itself.

21. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Oedipus's fear: "That in the end the seer will prove not _____."

    Key: blind

22. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Creon advise Oedipus to do if he doubts him?

    A. Go to Delphi and check his report

    B. Ask the Chorus to vote on his guilt

    C. Put him in chains until the seer speaks

    D. Question the queen about his loyalty

    Key: A (Go to Delphi and check his report)

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Why did Oedipus leave Corinth as a young man?

    A. To seek his fortune as a soldier abroad

    B. To escape the fate Apollo had foretold

    C. To find the Sphinx and win the crown

    D. To run from a quarrel with his brother

    Key: B (To escape the fate Apollo had foretold)

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Oedipus mean when he says, "Methinks unwittingly I laid but now a dread curse on myself"?

    A. He regrets that he insulted the seer in public

    B. He believes the gods have cursed his marriage

    C. He fears the killer he cursed may be himself

    D. He thinks Creon has turned his curse against him

    Key: C (He fears the killer he cursed may be himself)

25. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Oedipus insist on questioning the servant who survived the attack on Laius?

    Sample answer: He wants to learn whether Laius was killed by a band of robbers or by one man. The servant is the only witness, and his report is the one fact that can either clear Oedipus or make his fear certain. Questioning him turns the search from an argument about prophecy into a test of plain evidence.

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Oedipus says he must be quick with his "counterplot" against Creon. What does this reasoning show?

    A. He has found clear proof of Creon's guilt

    B. He trusts the Chorus to judge the case

    C. He plans to wait patiently for the god's answer

    D. He treats suspicion as enough reason to act

    Key: D (He treats suspicion as enough reason to act)

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the significance of the detail that the infant of the oracle was cast away with its ankles pierced and pinned together.

    Sample answer: The detail shows how determined Laius was to defeat the oracle: the child was not only left on the

mountain but maimed so that it could not survive. Jocasta offers it as proof that the oracle failed. For the audience, the vivid physical detail is hard to forget, and it lingers as a clue the play may return to.

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how Oedipus describes the effect of the drunken guest's taunt in Corinth (lines 793–801).

    Sample answer: A roisterer at a banquet shouted that he was not his father's true son. Oedipus says he bore the insult for a day, then questioned his parents, who were indignant and comforted him. Yet the venomed barb rankled and the scandal grew. The image of a poisoned wound shows how one word kept working on his mind until he went to Delphi.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does Oedipus's own curse from Episode 1 return in his speech at lines 830–845?

    Sample answer: In Episode 1 he decreed that no one should shelter or speak to the murderer and that everyone should drive him from their homes. Now he repeats those terms, a wretch whom no citizen may harbour or address, and admits that the curse was laid by none but himself. The proclamation he made as judge now threatens to fall on him as the accused.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Compare the way Oedipus treats Creon with the way he treated the seer in Episode 1.

    Sample answer: With both men he leaps from an unwelcome charge to a theory of conspiracy. He called the seer a hired fraud, and now he calls Creon his murderer and the filcher of his crown and wants him dead. In both scenes he refuses to listen and acts on suspicion. Only the pleas of others, not evidence, make him stop short with Creon.

31. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the Chorus's caution: "To one who walketh warily his words Commend themselves; swift _____ are not sure."

    Key: counsels

32. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In which land, according to Jocasta, was Laius killed?

    A. Phocis

    B. Boeotia

    C. Attica

    D. Thessaly

    Key: A (Phocis)

33. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Jocasta tell Oedipus he "mayest ease thy conscience on that score"?

    A. She knows who the real killer of Laius was

    B. She believes no man truly has the prophetic art

    C. She thinks Creon will soon confess to the plot

    D. She has asked the god and been told he is innocent

    Key: B (She believes no man truly has the prophetic art)

34. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Oedipus says that one cannot square with many when he thinks about the servant's report. What does he mean, and why does it matter?

    Sample answer: He means that if Laius was killed by a band of robbers, as the first report said, then he, a single man, cannot be the killer. It matters because this one number is now his only hope. The case against him, which had been a matter of prophecy, now depends on whether a witness said robbers or a robber.

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What is the dramatic effect of Oedipus asking Jocasta about Laius's height and looks?

    A. It shows his growing interest in the old history of Thebes

B. It lightens the mood of the scene with a moment of calm

C. It shows him testing his fear against hard facts

D. It proves to Jocasta that Creon is guilty

Key: C (It shows him testing his fear against hard facts)

36. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze Jocasta's reasoning about oracles in lines 717–736. Where is it strong and where is it weak?

Sample answer: Her reasoning seems strong because it uses a case she knows firsthand: the oracle said Laius would die by his son, yet the child was cast away and Laius was killed by strangers. Its weakness is that it rests on a report and on the belief that the child died. She judges all prophecy by one case whose facts she has never tested.

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze how the Chorus's lyric pleas (lines 658–676 and 697–704) shape the outcome of the quarrel.

Sample answer: The Chorus begs Oedipus to respect Creon's oath, swears by the Sun that it wishes the king no harm, and calls him the pilot who brought the city to a quiet haven. By pairing loyalty with pleading, it lets Oedipus give way without losing face. He yields, he says, for their sake and not Creon's, so the Chorus's voice decides the scene.

38. [mc · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Which statement best describes the shift in Oedipus across Episode 2?

A. From humble ruler of Thebes to a proud and confident tyrant

B. From a doubter of oracles to their loudest and most faithful defender

C. From friend of Creon to his loyal follower

D. From angry accuser to a man who fears his own guilt

Key: D (From angry accuser to a man who fears his own guilt)

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate Jocasta's vow that she "Will look for signs neither to right nor left". Is her rejection of prophecy justified by what she knows?

Sample answer: From what she knows, her rejection seems reasonable: the oracle that came to Laius appears to have failed, since the child died and robbers killed the king. But she has heard Oedipus's story of the triple roads and still clings to one detail of a servant's report. Her confidence rests on a hope she will not test, which makes her rejection seem rash.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Trace how the search for the killer of Laius changes from Episode 1 to the end of Episode 2.

Sample answer: In Episode 1 the search is a public duty: Oedipus proclaims a curse on an unknown man and dismisses the seer's charge as a plot. In Episode 2 it turns private and frightening, as Jocasta's account of the three roads leads Oedipus to tell his own story. By the end, the king who led the hunt is waiting for one witness to say whether he is the man he cursed.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 3, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 2
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 2, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Episode 2 (lines 512–880) develops the idea of Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and plot shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6; W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 2 (lines 512–880)" could deliver about Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6; W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear in "Episode 2 (lines 512–880)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to knowledge and blindness and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Episode 2 (lines 512–880) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 2 (lines 512–880)" could deliver about Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear in "Episode 2 (lines 512–880)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to knowledge and blindness and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Episode 2 (lines 512–880) suggests about Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's irony and plot), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 2 (lines 512–880)" could deliver about Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear in "Episode 2 (lines 512–880)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to knowledge and blindness and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses irony in Episode 2 (lines 512–880) to complicate the reader's understanding of Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 2 (lines 512–880)" could deliver about Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear in "Episode 2 (lines 512–880)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to knowledge and blindness and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Then thou mayest ease thy conscience on that score. Listen and I'll convince thee that no man Hath scot or lot in the prophetic art. Here is the proof in brief. An oracle Once came to Laius (I will not say 'Twas from the Delphic god himself, but from His ministers) declaring he was doomed To perish by the hand of his own son, A child that should be born to him by me. Now Laius—so at least report affirmed— Was murdered on a day by highwaymen, No natives, at a spot where three roads meet. As for the child, it was but three days old, When Laius, its ankles pierced and pinned Together, gave it to be cast away By others on the trackless mountain side. So then Apollo brought it not to pass The child should be his father's murderer, Or the dread terror find accomplishment, And Laius be slain by his own son. Such was the prophet's horoscope. O king, Regard it not. Whate'er the god deems fit To search, himself unaided will reveal.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Episode 2 (lines 512–880)"?

   A. A hopeful guess

   B. Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear

   C. Pride breeds the tyrant

   D. A city praying for rescue

SAT key: 1. B (Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear)

Lesson 7: Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)

Focus: pride breeds the tyrant

Objective: Students will summarize what happens in Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921) (pride breeds the tyrant) in 2 sentences and, in a 3-sentence warm-up response, explain how one quoted line from the scene sets up the scene that follows.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1

Teacher only · spoilers

The Chorus prays for reverence in word and deed and warns that insolence (hubris) breeds the tyrant. They fear that if oracles fail, religion itself is failing.

Background: "Tyrant" (Greek tyrannos) first meant a ruler who took power by his own means, not necessarily a cruel one; the word's meaning darkened over time (Online Etymology Dictionary, n.d.-e).

Significance: The ode turns from the plot to a general law of pride and fall, and raises the question of whether the gods' words still hold.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What is the difference between confidence and arrogance? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to pride and fall because....
Prompt: What is the difference between confidence and arrogance?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to pride and fall because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: The Chorus states the pattern of pride and fall as a law of the world and asks whether the gods still punish those who break it.

8–16 min · Background and context · I do (8 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
"Tyrant" (Greek tyrannos) first meant a ruler who took power by his own means, not necessarily a cruel one; the word's meaning darkened over time (Online Etymology Dictionary, n.d.-e). The ode turns from the plot to a general law of pride and fall, and raises the question of whether the gods' words still hold. Theme: The ode sets out a general law: arrogance, swollen with wealth, climbs to the top and then falls, while reverence in word and deed keeps a person safe. Diction / vocabulary: The ode's key word is "insolence" (Storr's word for the Greek hybris), set against "reverence" and "innocence", so the vocabulary itself sorts people into the proud and the humble. Tone / mood: The tone is solemn and anxious: the elders state rules about pride and the gods but end in fear that the oracles, and religion itself, may be failing. Watch for the precipitous height: The steep height that insolence climbs stands for overreaching power, from which the only way is down.

> **16–20 min · Closure · I do (4 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how theme shapes pride breeds the tyrant. Key takeaway: The Chorus states the pattern of pride and fall as a law of the world and asks whether the gods still punish those who break it.*

Total: 20 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Theme:** The ode sets out a general law: arrogance, swollen with wealth, climbs to the top and then falls, while reverence in word and deed keeps a person safe.
- **Diction / vocabulary:** The ode's key word is "insolence" (Storr's word for the Greek hybris), set against "reverence" and "innocence", so the vocabulary itself sorts people into the proud and the humble.
- **Tone / mood:** The tone is solemn and anxious: the elders state rules about pride and the gods but end in fear that the oracles, and religion itself, may be failing.

Themes and how they develop

- **pride and fall:** The Chorus states the pattern of pride and fall as a law of the world and asks whether the gods still punish those who break it.

Symbols and motifs

- **the precipitous height:** The steep height that insolence climbs stands for overreaching power, from which the only way is down.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Of insolence is bred / The tyrant; insolence full blown, / With empty riches surfeited, / Scales the precipitous height and grasps the throne" (Stasimon 2, lines 890–893) Arrogance grows on wealth until it seizes power, an image of climbing too high that prepares for a fall.
- "Who when such deeds are done / Can hope heaven's bolts to shun" (Stasimon 2, lines 907–908) The elders insist that the gods will strike down wrongdoers, but they phrase it as an anxious question.
- "My lot be still to lead / The life of innocence and fly" (Stasimon 2, lines 881–882) The Chorus prays for a humble, reverent life, the opposite of the arrogance the ode condemns.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The ode turns from the plot to a general law that pride leads to a fall, and it ties that law to faith in the oracles.
Evidence: "Of insolence is bred / The tyrant; insolence full blown, / With empty riches surfeited, / Scales the precipitous height and grasps the throne" (Stasimon 2, lines 890–893)
Reasoning: It says "Of insolence is bred / The tyrant" and asks who "Can hope heaven's bolts to shun?", then fears that if the oracles fail, reverence for the gods will fail with them.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 881–882

881 **Chorus:** My lot be still to lead
882 **Chorus:** The life of innocence and fly

Lines 881–885

881 **Chorus:** My lot be still to lead
882 **Chorus:** The life of innocence and fly
883 **Chorus:** Irreverence in word or deed,
884 **Chorus:** To follow still those laws ordained on high
885 **Chorus:** Whose birthplace is the bright ethereal sky.

Lines 881–898

881 **Chorus:** My lot be still to lead
882 **Chorus:** The life of innocence and fly
883 **Chorus:** Irreverence in word or deed,
884 **Chorus:** To follow still those laws ordained on high
885 **Chorus:** Whose birthplace is the bright ethereal sky.
886 **Chorus:** No mortal birth they own,
887 **Chorus:** Olympus their progenitor alone:
888 **Chorus:** Ne'er shall they slumber in oblivion cold,
889 **Chorus:** The god in them is strong and grows not old.
890 **Chorus:** Of insolence is bred
891 **Chorus:** The tyrant; insolence full blown,
892 **Chorus:** With empty riches surfeited,
893 **Chorus:** Scales the precipitous height and grasps the throne.
894 **Chorus:** Then topples o'er and lies in ruin prone;
895 **Chorus:** No foothold on that dizzy steep.
896 **Chorus:** But O may Heaven the true patriot keep
897 **Chorus:** Who burns with emulous zeal to serve the State.
898 **Chorus:** God is my help and hope, on him I wait.

Line 889

889 **Chorus:** The god in them is strong and grows not old.

Lines 890–893

890 **Chorus:** Of insolence is bred
891 **Chorus:** The tyrant; insolence full blown,
892 **Chorus:** With empty riches surfeited,
893 **Chorus:** Scales the precipitous height and grasps the throne.

Lines 890–895

890 **Chorus:** Of insolence is bred
891 **Chorus:** The tyrant; insolence full blown,

892 **Chorus:** With empty riches surfeited,
893 **Chorus:** Scales the precipitous height and grasps the throne.
894 **Chorus:** Then topples o'er and lies in ruin prone;
895 **Chorus:** No foothold on that dizzy steep.

Line 893
893 **Chorus:** Scales the precipitous height and grasps the throne.

Line 894
894 **Chorus:** Then topples o'er and lies in ruin prone;

Lines 907–908
907 **Chorus:** Who when such deeds are done
908 **Chorus:** Can hope heaven's bolts to shun?

Lines 907–910
907 **Chorus:** Who when such deeds are done
908 **Chorus:** Can hope heaven's bolts to shun?
909 **Chorus:** If sin like this to honor can aspire,
910 **Chorus:** Why dance I still and lead the sacred choir?

Line 910
910 **Chorus:** Why dance I still and lead the sacred choir?

Line 915
915 **Chorus:** If before all God's truth be not bade plain.

Line 920
920 **Chorus:** His weird, men heed it not;

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
surfeited (adjective)	overfed; having too much of something	*Of insolence is bred The tyrant; insolence full blown, With empty riches surfeited, Scales the precipitous height and grasps the throne.*	"surfeited": Origin of "surfeit": Anglo-Norman surfet. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/surfeit#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. What is the difference between confidence and arrogance?
2. Where does theme appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with knowledge and blindness?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What does the Chorus pray its own life will be (lines 881–883)? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A life of innocence that shuns irreverence in word or deed.
   Answer guidance: A life of innocence that shuns irreverence in word or deed.
2. In lines 890–895, which two stages of the tyrant's career does the Chorus describe? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** His rise to grasp the throne and his fall into ruin.
   Answer guidance: His rise to grasp the throne and his fall into ruin.
3. Which shrines does the Chorus say it will stop visiting (lines 911–914)? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Earth's central oracle, Abae's hallowed cell and Olympia.
   Answer guidance: Earth's central oracle, Abae's hallowed cell and Olympia.
4. On what does the proud sinner lay an impious hand (line 906)? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** On the holiest things.
   Answer guidance: On the holiest things.
5. Who sings Stasimon 2? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The Chorus of Theban elders
   Answer guidance: The Chorus of Theban elders.
6. What happens to insolence that climbs too high? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** It falls
   Answer guidance: It falls.
7. What do the elders fear if the oracles prove false? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** That reverence for the gods will fail
   Answer guidance: That reverence for the gods will fail.
8. In what mood does Stasimon 2 end? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Solemn and anxious
   Answer guidance: Solemn and anxious.
9. Which word in the ode names excessive pride? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Insolence
   Answer guidance: Insolence.
10. Retell the most important events of "Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)" in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The Chorus prays for reverence in word and deed and warns that insolence (hubris) breeds the tyrant. They fear that if oracles fail, religion itself is failing.

Answer guidance: The Chorus prays for reverence in word and deed and warns that insolence (hubris) breeds the tyrant. They fear that if oracles fail, religion itself is failing.

Inferential / analytical

1. Does the Chorus mean Oedipus by "the tyrant"? Explain. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Possibly a warning to him, though not named; open to argument.
   Answer guidance: Possibly a warning to him, though not named; open to argument.
2. What does “Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)” suggest about pride breeds the tyrant? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** The ode turns from the plot to a general law of pride and fall, and raises the question of whether the gods' words still hold.
   Answer guidance: The ode turns from the plot to a general law of pride and fall, and raises the question of whether the gods' words still hold. Evidence to accept: “Of insolence is bred / The tyrant; insolence full blown, / With empty riches surfeited, / Scales the precipitous height and grasps the throne” (Stasimon 2, lines 890–893): Arrogance grows on wealth until it seizes power, an image of climbing too high that prepares for a fall. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
3. Find one example of theme in “Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)”. What does it reveal about pride breeds the tyrant that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
   Answer guidance: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas. Evidence to accept: “Who when such deeds are done / Can hope heaven’s bolts to shun” (Stasimon 2, lines 907–908): The elders insist that the gods will strike down wrongdoers, but they phrase it as an anxious question. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
4. How does the diction / vocabulary in “Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)” shape what we understand about pride breeds the tyrant? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Look for precise or unusual word choices and their connotations.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode turns from the plot to a general law that pride leads to a fall, and it ties that law to faith in the oracles. Useful evidence: “Of insolence is bred / The tyrant; insolence full blown, / With empty riches surfeited, / Scales the precipitous height and grasps the throne” (Stasimon 2, lines 890–893): Arrogance grows on wealth until it seizes power, an image of climbing too high that prepares for a fall. On diction / vocabulary: The ode's key word is "insolence" (Storr's word for the Greek hybris), set against "reverence" and "innocence", so the vocabulary itself sorts people into the proud and the humble. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that opens with “My lot be still to lead The life of innocence and fly Irreverence in word or deed, To follow still those laws ordained on high Whose birthplace is the bright ethereal sky.”, why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: “My lot be still to lead / The life of innocence and fly” (Stasimon 2, lines 881–882): The Chorus prays for a humble,

reverent life, the opposite of the arrogance the ode condemns. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

6. What causes the main turn in "Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Look for: the warning that insolence breeds the tyrant; the fear that if oracles fail, religion fails; the effect, an ode that turns doubt into a demand for the gods to act.

   Answer guidance: Look for: the warning that insolence breeds the tyrant; the fear that if oracles fail, religion fails; the effect, an ode that turns doubt into a demand for the gods to act. Evidence to accept: "Of insolence is bred / The tyrant; insolence full blown, / With empty riches surfeited, / Scales the precipitous height and grasps the throne" (Stasimon 2, lines 890–893): Arrogance grows on wealth until it seizes power, an image of climbing too high that prepares for a fall. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

7. How does "Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)" build on "Episode 2 (lines 512–880)"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode turns from the plot to a general law that pride leads to a fall, and it ties that law to faith in the oracles. Useful evidence: "Who when such deeds are done / Can hope heaven's bolts to shun" (Stasimon 2, lines 907–908): The elders insist that the gods will strike down wrongdoers, but they phrase it as an anxious question. Theme link: The Chorus states the pattern of pride and fall as a law of the world and asks whether the gods still punish those who break it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. In "Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)", what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about pride breeds the tyrant, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode turns from the plot to a general law that pride leads to a fall, and it ties that law to faith in the oracles. Useful evidence: "My lot be still to lead / The life of innocence and fly" (Stasimon 2, lines 881–882): The Chorus prays for a humble, reverent life, the opposite of the arrogance the ode condemns. Theme link: The Chorus states the pattern of pride and fall as a law of the world and asks whether the gods still punish those who break it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (What is the difference between confidence and arrogance?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.

   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: "Who when such deeds are done / Can hope heaven's bolts to shun" (Stasimon 2, lines 907–908): The elders insist that the gods will strike down wrongdoers, but they phrase it as an anxious question. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

10. Where does tone / mood appear in "Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)", and how does it connect pride breeds the tyrant to the larger concern with knowledge and blindness? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Look for word choices that reveal the

speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode turns from the plot to a general law that pride leads to a fall, and it ties that law to faith in the oracles. Useful evidence: “Of insolence is bred / The tyrant; insolence full blown, / With empty riches surfeited, / Scales the precipitous height and grasps the throne” (Stasimon 2, lines 890–893): Arrogance grows on wealth until it seizes power, an image of climbing too high that prepares for a fall. On tone / mood: The tone is solemn and anxious: the elders state rules about pride and the gods but end in fear that the oracles, and religion itself, may be failing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Does the play show Oedipus as guilty of hubris? Use this ode and one other scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A case can be made that he is. The ode says "Of insolence is bred / The tyrant" and pictures insolence climbing "the precipitous height" (lines 890–893). Oedipus's treatment of Teiresias and Creon in the earlier episodes, accusing both of a plot without proof, fits that warning. Against this, he acts for the city and seeks the truth, so a strong answer weighs pride against public duty.

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2. Is the Chorus's threat to stop worshipping at the oracles an act of faith or of doubt? Argue with evidence. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** It is an act of anxious faith. The elders say they will no longer seek "earth's central oracle" or bring offerings to Olympia (lines 911–914) if the god's truth is not made plain. Yet they end by praying, "O Zeus, reveal thy might" (line 916), which means they still expect the god to answer. Their threat shows how much they need the oracles to be true. A strong answer weighs the doubt in the threat against the hope in the prayer.

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3. Which matters more to the Chorus in Stasimon 2: the safety of Thebes or the honour of the gods? Argue with evidence. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** The honour of the gods matters more. The ode prays for the "true patriot" who serves the State (lines 896–897), but most of it defends the "laws ordained on high" (line 884) and fears that "Apollo is forsook and faith grows cold" (line 921). The elders even ask, "Why dance I still and lead the sacred choir?" (line 910). A strong answer may argue that for the Chorus the two cannot be separated, since a city without reverence cannot be safe.

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4. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): The ode turns from the plot to a general law of pride and fall, and raises the question of whether the gods' words still hold. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode turns from the plot to a general law that pride leads to a fall, and it ties that law to faith in the oracles. Useful evidence: "Who when such deeds are done / Can hope heaven's bolts to shun" (Stasimon 2, lines 907–908): The elders insist that the gods will strike down wrongdoers, but they phrase it as an anxious question. On theme: The ode sets out a general law: arrogance, swollen with wealth, climbs to the top and then falls, while reverence in word and deed keeps a person safe. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Which character in "Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)" acts most wisely in the matter of pride breeds the tyrant, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode turns from the plot to a general law that pride leads to a fall, and it ties that law to faith in the oracles. Useful evidence: "My lot be still to lead / The life of innocence and fly" (Stasimon 2, lines 881–882): The Chorus prays for a humble, reverent life, the opposite of the arrogance the ode condemns. Theme link: The Chorus states the pattern of pride and fall as a law of the world and asks whether the gods still punish those who break it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. You are directing "Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of pride breeds the tyrant. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode turns from the plot to a general law that pride leads to a fall, and it ties that law to faith in the oracles. Useful evidence: "Of insolence is bred / The tyrant; insolence full blown, / With empty riches surfeited, / Scales the precipitous height and grasps the throne" (Stasimon 2, lines 890–893): Arrogance grows on wealth until it seizes power, an image of climbing too high that prepares for a fall. Theme link: The Chorus states the pattern of pride and fall as a law of the world and asks whether the gods still punish those who break it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Write your own questions about "Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode turns from the plot to a general law that pride leads to a fall, and it ties that law to faith in the oracles. Useful evidence: "Who when such deeds are done / Can hope heaven's bolts to shun" (Stasimon 2, lines 907–908): The elders insist that the gods will strike down wrongdoers, but they phrase it as an anxious question. On theme: The ode sets out a general law: arrogance, swollen with wealth, climbs to the top and then falls, while reverence in word and deed keeps a person safe. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Connect "Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)", with its focus on pride breeds the tyrant, to fate and responsibility: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode turns from the plot to a general law that pride leads to a fall, and it ties that law to faith in the oracles. Useful evidence: "My lot be still to lead / The life of innocence and fly" (Stasimon 2, lines 881–882): The Chorus prays for a humble, reverent life, the opposite of the arrogance the ode condemns. On theme: The ode sets out a general law: arrogance, swollen with wealth, climbs to the top and then falls, while reverence in word and deed keeps a person safe. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Is the theme in "Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)" effective in presenting pride breeds the tyrant, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode turns from the plot to a general law that pride leads to a fall, and it ties that law to faith in the oracles. Useful evidence: "Of insolence is bred / The tyrant; insolence full blown, / With empty riches surfeited, / Scales the precipitous height and grasps the throne" (Stasimon 2, lines 890–893): Arrogance grows on wealth until it seizes power, an image of climbing too high that prepares for a fall. On theme: The ode sets out a general law: arrogance, swollen with wealth, climbs to the top and then falls, while reverence in word and deed keeps a person safe. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Compare how "Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)" treats pride breeds the tyrant with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus Rex see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode turns from the plot to a general law that pride leads to a fall, and it ties that law to faith in the oracles. Useful evidence: "Who when such deeds are done / Can hope heaven's bolts to shun" (Stasimon 2, lines 907–908): The elders insist that the gods will strike down wrongdoers, but they phrase it as an anxious question. On theme: The ode sets out a general law: arrogance, swollen with wealth, climbs to the top and then falls, while reverence in word and deed keeps a person safe. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Theme:** look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Diction / vocabulary**: precise or unusual word choices and their connotations
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where does the Chorus say the eternal laws were born?
   A. In the bright ethereal sky
   B. In the halls of ancient kings
   C. In the city's oldest temple
   D. In the depths beneath the earth

   Key: A (In the bright ethereal sky)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the Chorus say the proud sinner grasps at?
   A. A golden crown
   B. Ill-got gain
   C. A sacred sword
   D. A stolen horse

   Key: B (Ill-got gain)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which shrines does the Chorus say it will no longer visit if God's truth is not made plain?
   A. Delos, Dodona and Athens
   B. Thebes, Sparta and Argos
   C. Delphi, Abae and Olympia
   D. Crete, Rhodes and Samos

   Key: C (Delphi, Abae and Olympia)
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the line: “The god in them is strong and grows not _____.”

   Key: old
5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the line: “Then topples o’er and lies in _____ prone”

   Key: ruin
6. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Why does the Chorus ask, “Why dance I still and lead the sacred choir?”
   A. The dance has been forbidden by the king
   B. The plague has already killed most of the city's dancers
   C. Apollo himself has commanded the Chorus to stop dancing
   D. Worship seems pointless if sin goes unpunished

   Key: D (Worship seems pointless if sin goes unpunished)
7. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What does the Chorus fear when it says “faith grows cold”?
   A. People are ceasing to trust the oracles
   B. The coming winter will be long and cruel for the city
   C. The king will stop all the city's sacred festivals
   D. The gods have left Thebes for good

   Key: A (People are ceasing to trust the oracles)

8. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What kind of life does the Chorus pray for at the start of the ode?

   Sample answer: It prays for a life of innocence and reverence, avoiding any irreverence in word or deed. It wants to follow the laws that come from the gods rather than from men. The prayer sets a standard of piety that the rest of the ode uses to judge pride and to judge those who scorn the oracles.

9. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the image of the tyrant climbing and falling in lines 890–895.

   Sample answer: Insolence is pictured as a climber who scales a steep height and seizes the throne, only to topple and lie in ruin with no foothold. The image shows pride rising quickly and falling just as fast. It warns that power built on insolence has nothing firm beneath it, so its collapse is certain sooner or later.

10. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Analyze why the Chorus says it will stop visiting the oracles if God's truth is not made plain.

    Sample answer: The Chorus means that if the oracles are proved false, there is no reason to honour them. Jocasta has just mocked prophecy, and the elders fear that if her view wins, faith will collapse. Their threat is really a prayer: they ask Zeus to prove the oracles true so that worship still has meaning for them.

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In Stasimon 2, what does the Chorus say the laws ordained on high will never do?

    A. Slumber in cold oblivion
    B. Change from age to age
    C. Bend to the will of kings
    D. Speak to mortal men

    Key: A (Slumber in cold oblivion)

12. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Whom does the Chorus call on to reveal his might at the end of the ode?

    A. Ares
    B. Zeus
    C. Hades
    D. Poseidon

    Key: B (Zeus)

13. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Whose fate does the Chorus say men no longer heed?

    A. The Sphinx's
    B. Creon's
    C. Laius's
    D. Polybus's

    Key: C (Laius's)

14. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: “Who burns with emulous _____ to serve the State.”

    Key: zeal

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Whom does the Chorus ask Heaven to protect?

    A. The proud man who seizes the throne
    B. The traveller who is far from his own home

C. The seer who reads the birds

D. The true patriot who serves the State

Key: D (The true patriot who serves the State)

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What kind of person does the Chorus say perdition should seize?

A. The proud sinner who scorns Justice and the gods

B. The poor man who cannot pay the debts he owes to others

C. The stranger who comes to Thebes

D. The soldier who flees in fear from the field of battle

Key: A (The proud sinner who scorns Justice and the gods)

17. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Why does the Chorus say "Apollo is forsook"?

Sample answer: It means people are turning away from Apollo and his oracles. Jocasta has just argued that prophecy is worthless, and the old oracle about Laius seems forgotten. The Chorus fears that if oracles are mocked and nothing happens, men will stop honouring the god altogether, and the city's faith will fade.

18. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze the contrast between the eternal laws in the first strophe and the tyrant in the first antistrophe.

Sample answer: The laws are born in the sky, have no mortal birth, and never grow old or sleep. The tyrant is bred from insolence, climbs a dizzy height and falls into ruin. The contrast sets lasting divine order against short-lived human pride. It suggests that anyone who sets himself against the laws of heaven will not last.

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze the questions the Chorus asks in lines 907–910.

Sample answer: The Chorus asks who can hope to escape heaven's bolts when such deeds are done, and why it should keep dancing in the sacred choir if sin can win honour. The questions show that its faith depends on seeing justice done. If wrongdoing goes unpunished, the elders feel that worship itself would lose its point.

20. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Stasimon 2 respond to Jocasta's rejection of prophecy at the end of Episode 2?

Sample answer: Jocasta said she would look for signs neither to right nor left. The Chorus answers with a prayer that the oracles be proved true, warning that if they fail, men will stop honouring the gods. Its fear that faith grows cold is a direct reply to her scorn, and it sides with the gods even against the queen.

21. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: "Olympus their _____ alone"

Key: progenitor

22. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does the Chorus say the falling tyrant has no hold on?

A. A foothold on the dizzy steep

B. A friend left among all his people

C. A claim to the royal throne

D. A share in the city's wealth

Key: A (A foothold on the dizzy steep)

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does the Chorus say it will no longer bring to Olympia?

A. Its crowns of olive and laurel

B. Its votive offering

C. Its finest horses for the games

D. Its songs of victory

Key: B (Its votive offering)

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the Chorus mean by saying the laws have "No mortal birth"?

    A. They were written down by the very first kings

    B. They were born in the city of Thebes

    C. They come from the gods, not from men

    D. They change with every new ruler

    Key: C (They come from the gods, not from men)

25. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the Chorus mean when it says "Laius is forgot"?

    Sample answer: It means that the old oracle about Laius, that he would die by his son's hand, is being treated as if it had failed and no longer mattered. Jocasta has just mocked it. The Chorus fears that forgetting this prophecy means forgetting the gods who gave it, which would weaken faith across the whole city.

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Which device is most at work in "Scales the precipitous height and grasps the throne"?

    A. Onomatopoeia

    B. Understatement

    C. Rhetorical question

    D. Personification

    Key: D (Personification)

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Analyze the possible link between the ode's portrait of the tyrant and Oedipus's behaviour in Episode 2.

    Sample answer: The ode does not name Oedipus, but its tyrant who grasps and topples recalls the king who threatened Creon with death on bare suspicion and scorned the seer. The Chorus may be warning him, or warning anyone who acts with such pride. The link is left open, which makes the ode a quiet judgment on the scene before it.

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze the ode's shift from general moral statements to a direct prayer to Zeus.

    Sample answer: The ode begins with general truths about eternal laws and the fall of the proud, then turns in its last stanza to the speaker's own worship and to a direct prayer that Zeus reveal his might. The shift makes the issue urgent. The elders are no longer describing how the world works; they are asking the god to prove that it still does.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Compare the Chorus's attitude to the oracles in Stasimon 1 with its attitude in Stasimon 2.

    Sample answer: In Stasimon 1 the Chorus trusted the gods but doubted the mortal seer and defended the king. In Stasimon 2 it worries that the oracles themselves are losing honour, and it prays that they be proved true even if that means trouble for the royal house. Its loyalty has moved from the king toward the gods.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Trace the theme of pride from Oedipus's boast over the Sphinx in Episode 1 to the tyrant in Stasimon 2.

    Sample answer: In Episode 1 Oedipus boasted that his mother wit defeated the Sphinx when the seer's art failed, and in Episode 2 he threatened Creon with death. Stasimon 2 turns pride into a general warning: insolence breeds the tyrant, who climbs high and falls. The theme moves from one man's confidence to a law about how pride ends.

31. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the question: "Can hope heaven's _____ to shun?"

    Key: bolts

32. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In the final stanza, how does the Chorus describe Zeus?

    A. Omnipotent, all-seeing

    B. Merciful and slow to anger

    C. Young and fond of the hunt

    D. Distant and careless of men

    Key: A (Omnipotent, all-seeing)

33. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the Chorus mean by "If before all God's truth be not bade plain"?

    A. The gods must explain their laws in writing

    B. The oracles must be shown true for all to see

    C. The king must confess his crimes before the city

    D. The seer must repeat his words in public

    Key: B (The oracles must be shown true for all to see)

34. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the ode suggest the Chorus fears most at this point in the play?

    Sample answer: It fears that the oracles will be proved false and that faith in the gods will collapse. The fear is sharpened by Jocasta's scorn for prophecy. The elders would rather see the oracles fulfilled, even with terrible results, than live in a world where the gods' words mean nothing and sin goes unpunished.

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What is the effect of the phrase "His weird, men heed it not"?

    A. It mocks Laius for his strange behaviour as king

    B. It praises the people of Thebes for forgetting their old quarrels

    C. It mourns that Laius's foretold fate is being ignored

    D. It warns that a new oracle is about to arrive

    Key: C (It mourns that Laius's foretold fate is being ignored)

36. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the word insolence as the ode uses it in lines 890–895.

    Sample answer: Insolence here means proud, lawless self-assertion that ignores the limits set by the gods. The ode makes it the parent of the tyrant: it fills a man with empty riches, drives him to scale a dizzy height and seize the throne, and then lets him fall. Insolence is both the cause of his rise and the reason for his ruin.

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze how the ode's structure moves from what the Chorus wants for itself to what it demands of the gods.

    Sample answer: It opens with the Chorus's wish to live in innocence and follow the eternal laws. It then condemns the insolent tyrant and the proud sinner, and asks why it should still worship if such men prosper. It ends by demanding that Zeus show his might. The ode moves from personal piety through moral judgment to an urgent challenge to heaven.

38. [mc · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Which statement best describes the role of Stasimon 2 in the play at this point?

    A. It announces that the plague has been lifted from the city

    B. It tells the full story of how Laius first came to rule over Thebes

    C. It praises the queen for her wise words about oracles

    D. It turns doubts about prophecy into a test of faith in the gods

Key: D (It turns doubts about prophecy into a test of faith in the gods)

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate whether the Chorus's prayer that the oracles be proved true is a loyal or a disloyal wish toward Oedipus and Jocasta.
    Sample answer: The wish is loyal to the gods but risky for the royal house. If the oracles must prove true, then Jocasta's comfort fails and the seer's charge may stand. The Chorus does not seem to want the king ruined, but it puts the honour of the gods above its loyalty to him, which shows how deep its piety runs.
40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Stasimon 2 develop the conflict between human reason and divine prophecy that runs through Episodes 1 and 2?
    Sample answer: In Episode 1 Oedipus set his mother wit above the seer's art, and in Episode 2 Jocasta argued that no man has a share in prophecy. Stasimon 2 answers both: it insists that the laws of the gods are eternal and asks Zeus to prove the oracles true. The ode makes the play's central question plain: will reason or prophecy prevail?

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 3, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 2
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 2, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.2; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921) develops the idea of pride breeds the tyrant. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and diction / vocabulary shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.2; W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)" could deliver about pride breeds the tyrant. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.2; W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for pride breeds the tyrant in "Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to knowledge and blindness and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its theme shape the reader's understanding of pride breeds the tyrant. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)" could deliver about pride breeds the tyrant. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for pride breeds the tyrant in "Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to knowledge and blindness and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921) suggests about pride breeds the tyrant. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's theme and diction / vocabulary), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)" could deliver about pride breeds the tyrant. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for pride breeds the tyrant in "Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to knowledge and blindness and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses theme in Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921) to complicate the reader's understanding of pride breeds the tyrant. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)" could deliver about pride breeds the tyrant. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for pride breeds the tyrant in "Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to knowledge and blindness and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *My lot be still to lead The life of innocence and fly Irreverence in word or deed, To follow still those laws ordained on high Whose birthplace is the bright ethereal sky. No mortal birth they own, Olympus their progenitor alone: Ne'er shall they slumber in oblivion cold, The god in them is strong and grows not old. Of insolence is bred The tyrant; insolence full blown, With empty riches surfeited, Scales the precipitous height and grasps the throne. Then topples o'er and lies in ruin prone; No foothold on that dizzy steep. But O may Heaven the true patriot keep Who burns with emulous zeal to serve the State. God is my help and hope, on him I wait.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Stasimon 2 (lines 881–921)"?

   A. A hopeful guess

   B. Pride breeds the tyrant

   C. The shadow of a shade

D. Jocasta, the three roads and the first fear

SAT key: 1. B (Pride breeds the tyrant)

Lesson 8: Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)

Focus: good news that is not good

Objective: Students will analyze how irony develops in "Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.6; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Content note (mature themes): Teacher note: some schools' guidelines may treat this passage differently.
Suggested language: "What does this passage make us notice?"

Teacher only · spoilers

A messenger from Corinth brings news that King Polybus has died, and that Corinth wants Oedipus as king. Oedipus and Jocasta rejoice that the oracle seems false, but Oedipus still fears his mother, Merope. To calm him, the messenger reveals that Oedipus was not Polybus' son: he himself received the infant on Mount Cithaeron from a herdsman of Laius. Jocasta begs Oedipus to stop searching and leaves. Oedipus thinks she is ashamed of his low birth and calls himself the child of Fortune.

Background: Slavery was legal and common in ancient Greece. Owning a person is wrong; the play's casual talk of a "bondwoman" and of being "triply a slave" (lines 1078–1080) reflects that society. Slavery still exists today (International Labour Organization et al., 2022).

Significance: Each piece of good news is a step toward catastrophe. Jocasta understands first; her silence comes before Oedipus understands.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why might someone prefer not to know a painful truth about themselves? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to knowledge and blindness because....
Prompt: Why might someone prefer not to know a painful truth about themselves?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to knowledge and blindness because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Jocasta urges a life without questions, "Best live a careless life", while Oedipus chooses to know the truth whatever it costs.

8–18 min · Vocabulary · We do (10 min)
Two key words in context.
Today's words: bondwoman — (archaic) an enslaved woman; foreknowledge — knowledge of something before it happens.
Words: bondwoman: (archaic) an enslaved woman · foreknowledge: knowledge of something before it happens

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Slavery was legal and common in ancient Greece. Owning a person is wrong; the play's casual talk of a "bondwoman" and of being "triply a slave" (lines 1078–1080) reflects that society. Slavery still exists today (International Labour Organization et al., 2022). Each piece of good news is a step toward catastrophe. Jocasta understands first; her silence comes before Oedipus understands. Irony: The Corinthian comes with good news, that Polybus has died naturally and Corinth wants Oedipus as king, and every attempt to reassure Oedipus brings the truth about his birth closer. Plot: News of Polybus's death seems to free Oedipus from the oracle, but his remaining fear about Merope leads the messenger to reveal that Polybus was not his father and that he received the infant from a herdsman of Laius. Characterization: Jocasta and Oedipus react to the same facts in opposite ways: she begs him to stop searching, while he insists on knowing his birth even if he turns out to be of low or enslaved parents. Watch for the child of Fortune: Oedipus names Chance as his mother, turning the mystery of his birth into a source of pride.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "But, as they stand, the oracles are dead— / Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus" slowly and put it in my own words: In these lines Oedipus speaks at a turning point of the section, which is about good news that is not good. Next, craft. I notice how the lines use irony, plot to make the audience feel the pressure of the moment on Oedipus. The strongest word is "oracles": the word "oracles" carries the weight of the lines and points to the section's big idea. Then, effect. What do lines 985–986 reveal about good news that is not good? My answer: Each piece of good news is a step toward catastrophe. Jocasta understands first; her silence is a recognition before Oedipus' recognition. These lines show good news that is not good, and that matters for what follows in the play.

> *But, as they stand, the oracles are dead— / Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus* *(Episode 3, lines 985–986)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "But, as they stand, the oracles are dead— / Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus" slowly and put it in my own words: In these lines Oedipus speaks at a turning point of the section, which is about good news that is not good. Next, craft. I notice how the lines use irony, plot to make the audience feel the pressure of the moment on Oedipus. The strongest word is "oracles": the word "oracles" carries the weight of the lines and points to the section's big idea. Then, effect. What do lines 985–986 reveal about good news that is not good? My answer: Each piece of good news is a step toward catastrophe. Jocasta understands first; her silence is a recognition before Oedipus' recognition. These lines show good news that is not good, and that matters for what follows in the play.

40–50 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (10 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Sport of chance", "foreknowledge" and "careless" stand out. Jocasta pictures people as playthings of chance who cannot know the future, so she urges Oedipus to stop fearing prophecy just as the truth closes in. Ask: How does this line connect to knowledge and blindness? Expected student answer: Jocasta urges a life without questions, "Best live a careless life", while Oedipus chooses to know the truth whatever it costs. (Jocasta argues that chance rules human life, so worrying about prophecy is pointless.)

> *Why should a mortal man, the sport of chance, / With no assured foreknowledge, be afraid? / Best live a careless life from hand to mouth (Episode 3, lines 991–993)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Sport of chance", "foreknowledge" and "careless" stand out. Jocasta pictures people as playthings of chance who cannot know the future, so she urges Oedipus to stop fearing prophecy just as the truth closes in.
Ask: How does this line connect to knowledge and blindness?
Expected student answer: Jocasta urges a life without questions, "Best live a careless life", while Oedipus chooses to know the truth whatever it costs. (Jocasta argues that chance rules human life, so worrying about prophecy is pointless.)

50–55 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (5 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for irony, plot (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about good news that is not good? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 3 (lines 922–1102) develops the idea of good news that is not good. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and plot shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Each piece of good news in the episode moves Oedipus closer to the truth he is looking for. When the text says "But, as they stand, the oracles are dead— / Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus" (Episode 3, lines 985–986), it shows this directly. Polybus's death seems to prove "the oracles are dead", but the messenger's attempt to calm Oedipus reveals the infant from Laius's house, and Jocasta's plea "mayst thou ne'er discover who thou art" shows she has understood before he has.
Task: Annotate the scene for irony, plot (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about good news that is not good? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 3 (lines 922–1102) develops the idea of good news that is not good. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and plot shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Each piece of good news in the episode moves Oedipus closer to the truth he is looking for. When the text says "But, as they stand, the oracles are dead— / Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus" (Episode 3, lines 985–986), it shows this directly. Polybus's death seems to prove "the oracles are dead", but the messenger's attempt to calm Oedipus reveals the infant from Laius's house, and Jocasta's plea "mayst thou ne'er discover who thou art" shows she has understood before he has.

55–60 min · Discussion · We do (5 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Why might someone prefer not to know a painful truth about themselves? Ask: Why might someone prefer not to know a painful truth about themselves?
Anchor question: Why might someone prefer not to know a painful truth about themselves?
Facilitation: Ask: Why might someone prefer not to know a painful truth about themselves?

60–67 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about good news that is not good? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Each piece of good news in the episode moves Oedipus closer to the truth he is looking for. ("But, as they stand, the oracles are dead— / Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus", Episode 3, lines 985–986). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about good news that is not good? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Each piece of good news in the episode moves Oedipus closer to the truth he is looking for. ("But, as they stand, the oracles are dead— / Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus", Episode 3, lines 985–986). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

67–70 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how irony shapes good news that is not good. Key takeaway: Jocasta urges a life without questions, "Best live a careless life", while Oedipus chooses to know the truth whatever it costs.

Total: 70 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Irony:** The Corinthian comes with good news, that Polybus has died naturally and Corinth wants Oedipus as king, and every attempt to reassure Oedipus brings the truth about his birth closer.
- **Plot:** News of Polybus's death seems to free Oedipus from the oracle, but his remaining fear about Merope leads the messenger to reveal that Polybus was not his father and that he received the infant from a herdsman of Laius.
- **Characterization:** Jocasta and Oedipus react to the same facts in opposite ways: she begs him to stop searching, while he insists on knowing his birth even if he turns out to be of low or enslaved parents.

Themes and how they develop

- **knowledge and blindness:** Jocasta urges a life without questions, "Best live a careless life", while Oedipus chooses to know the truth whatever it costs.

Symbols and motifs

- **the child of Fortune:** Oedipus names Chance as his mother, turning the mystery of his birth into a source of pride.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "But, as they stand, the oracles are dead— / Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus" (Episode 3, lines 985–986) Relief makes Oedipus scorn the oracles, a moment of confidence that the scene quickly reverses.
- "Why should a mortal man, the sport of chance, / With no assured foreknowledge, be afraid? / Best live a careless life from hand to mouth" (Episode 3, lines 991–993) Jocasta argues that chance rules human life, so worrying about prophecy is pointless.
- "Be of good cheer; though I be proved the son / Of a bondwoman, aye, through three descents / Triply a slave, thy honor is unsmirched" (Episode 3, lines 1078–1080) Oedipus misreads Jocasta's distress as shame about his birth, which shows how far he is from guessing her real fear.
- "Ah mayst thou ne'er discover who thou art" (Episode 3, line 1085) Jocasta's last plea shows that she now fears the answer and wants him never to learn who he is.
- "She is my mother and the changing moons / My brethren, and with them I wax and wane. / Thus sprung why should I fear to trace my birth? / Nothing can make me other than I am" (Episode 3, lines 1099–1102) Oedipus calls himself the child of Fortune and insists on tracing his birth, a proud claim that no discovery can change him.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Each piece of good news in the episode moves Oedipus closer to the truth he is looking for.
Evidence: "But, as they stand, the oracles are dead— / Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus" (Episode 3, lines 985–986)
Reasoning: Polybus's death seems to prove "the oracles are dead", but the messenger's attempt to calm Oedipus reveals the infant from Laius's house, and Jocasta's plea "mayst thou ne'er discover who thou art" shows she has understood before he has.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 978–997

978 **Oedipus:** Out on it, lady! why should one regard
979 **Oedipus:** The Pythian hearth or birds that scream i' the air?
980 **Oedipus:** Did they not point at me as doomed to slay
981 **Oedipus:** My father? but he's dead and in his grave
982 **Oedipus:** And here am I who ne'er unsheathed a sword;
983 **Oedipus:** Unless the longing for his absent son
984 **Oedipus:** Killed him and so I slew him in a sense.
985 **Oedipus:** But, as they stand, the oracles are dead—
986 **Oedipus:** Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus.
987 **Jocasta:** Say, did not I foretell this long ago?
988 **Oedipus:** Thou didst: but I was misled by my fear.

989 **Jocasta:** Then let it no more weigh upon thy soul.
990 **Oedipus:** Must I not fear my mother's marriage bed?
991 **Jocasta:** Why should a mortal man, the sport of chance,
992 **Jocasta:** With no assured foreknowledge, be afraid?
993 **Jocasta:** Best live a careless life from hand to mouth.
994 **Jocasta:** This wedlock with thy mother fear not thou.
995 **Jocasta:** How oft it chances that in dreams a man
996 **Jocasta:** Has wed his mother! He who least regards
997 **Jocasta:** Such brainsick fantasies lives most at ease.

Line 984
984 **Oedipus:** Killed him and so I slew him in a sense.

Lines 985–986
985 **Oedipus:** But, as they stand, the oracles are dead—
986 **Oedipus:** Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus.

Lines 991–993
991 **Jocasta:** Why should a mortal man, the sport of chance,
992 **Jocasta:** With no assured foreknowledge, be afraid?
993 **Jocasta:** Best live a careless life from hand to mouth.

Line 993
993 **Jocasta:** Best live a careless life from hand to mouth.

Line 1020
1020 **Messenger:** Was hope to profit by thy coming home.

Lines 1030–1050
1030 **Messenger:** Since Polybus was naught to thee in blood.
1031 **Oedipus:** What say'st thou? was not Polybus my sire?
1032 **Messenger:** As much thy sire as I am, and no more.
1033 **Oedipus:** My sire no more to me than one who is naught!
1034 **Messenger:** Since I begat thee not, no more did he.
1035 **Oedipus:** What reason had he then to call me son?
1036 **Messenger:** Know that he took thee from my hands, a gift.
1037 **Oedipus:** Yet, if no child of his, he loved me well.
1038 **Messenger:** A childless man till then, he warmed to thee.
1039 **Oedipus:** A foundling or a purchased slave, this child?
1040 **Messenger:** I found thee in Cithaeron's wooded glens.
1041 **Oedipus:** What led thee to explore those upland glades?
1042 **Messenger:** My business was to tend the mountain flocks.
1043 **Oedipus:** A vagrant shepherd journeying for hire?
1044 **Messenger:** True, but thy saviour in that hour, my son.
1045 **Oedipus:** My saviour? from what harm? what ailed me then?
1046 **Messenger:** Those ankle joints are evidence enow.

1047 **Oedipus:** Ah, why remind me of that ancient sore?
1048 **Messenger:** I loosed the pin that riveted thy feet.
1049 **Oedipus:** Yes, from my cradle that dread brand I bore.
1050 **Messenger:** Whence thou deriv'st the name that still is thine.

Lines 1063–1064
1063 **Oedipus:** Doth any bystander among you know
1064 **Oedipus:** The herd he speaks of, or by seeing him

Line 1075
1075 **Oedipus:** To bring to light the secret of my birth.

Lines 1078–1080
1078 **Oedipus:** Be of good cheer; though I be proved the son
1079 **Oedipus:** Of a bondwoman, aye, through three descents
1080 **Oedipus:** Triply a slave, thy honor is unsmirched.

Line 1085
1085 **Jocasta:** Ah mayst thou ne'er discover who thou art!

Line 1092
1092 **Chorus:** From this dead calm will burst a storm of woes.

Line 1099
1099 **Oedipus:** She is my mother and the changing moons

Lines 1099–1102
1099 **Oedipus:** She is my mother and the changing moons
1100 **Oedipus:** My brethren, and with them I wax and wane.
1101 **Oedipus:** Thus sprung why should I fear to trace my birth?
1102 **Oedipus:** Nothing can make me other than I am.

Line 1100
1100 **Oedipus:** My brethren, and with them I wax and wane.

Line 1102
1102 **Oedipus:** Nothing can make me other than I am.

Vocabulary

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context
bondwoman (noun)	(archaic) an enslaved woman	*Be of good cheer; though I be proved the son Of a bondwoman, aye, through three descents Triply a slave, thy honor is unsmirched.*
foreknowledge (noun)	knowledge of something before it happens	*Why should a mortal man, the sport of chance, With no assured foreknowledge, be afraid?*

Discussion questions

1. Why might someone prefer not to know a painful truth about themselves?
2. Where does irony appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate and responsibility?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What does Jocasta say about chance in lines 991–993? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A mortal is the sport of chance and should live carelessly, without fear.
   Answer guidance: A mortal is the sport of chance and should live carelessly, without fear.
2. What does the Corinthian messenger ask the elders when he arrives (lines 937–938)? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Where the palace of Oedipus is, or better, where the king himself is.
   Answer guidance: Where the palace of Oedipus is, or better, where the king himself is.
3. How does the messenger say Polybus died (lines 976–977)? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Of sickness, after living out the full span of his years.
   Answer guidance: Of sickness, after living out the full span of his years.
4. What does the messenger wish for the queen when he greets her (lines 941–942)? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** All happiness for her and the house, and a blessing on her husband and her marriage-bed.
   Answer guidance: All happiness for her and the house, and a blessing on her husband and her marriage-bed.
5. What news does the Corinthian messenger bring? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Polybus is dead and Corinth wants Oedipus as king
   Answer guidance: Polybus is dead and Corinth wants Oedipus as king.
6. Why does Oedipus still fear going to Corinth? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** He fears the prophecy about his mother
   Answer guidance: He fears the prophecy about his mother.
7. Where did the messenger receive the infant Oedipus? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** On Mount Cithaeron, from a herdsman of Laius
   Answer guidance: On Mount Cithaeron, from a herdsman of Laius.

8. Why does Jocasta beg Oedipus to stop searching? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** She has realized the truth
   Answer guidance: She has realized the truth.
9. Whom does Oedipus call his mother in lines 1099–1102? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Fortune (Chance)
   Answer guidance: Fortune (Chance).
10. Retell the most important events of "Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)" in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A messenger from Corinth brings news that King Polybus has died, and that Corinth wants Oedipus as king. Oedipus and Jocasta rejoice that the oracle seems false, but Oedipus still fears his mother, Merope. To calm him, the messenger reveals that Oedipus was not Polybus' son: he himself received the infant on Mount Cithaeron from a herdsman of Laius. Jocasta begs Oedipus to stop searching and…
    Answer guidance: A messenger from Corinth brings news that King Polybus has died, and that Corinth wants Oedipus as king. Oedipus and Jocasta rejoice that the oracle seems false, but Oedipus still fears his mother, Merope. To calm him, the messenger reveals that Oedipus was not Polybus' son: he himself received the infant on Mount Cithaeron from a herdsman of Laius. Jocasta begs Oedipus to stop searching and…

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Oedipus misread Jocasta's distress? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** He thinks she fears he is of low or enslaved birth.
   Answer guidance: He thinks she fears he is of low or enslaved birth.
2. Why does Jocasta, who scorned oracles, now bring offerings to Apollo? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** Her own counsel can no longer calm Oedipus, so she turns to the god as the city's present help, which shows that fear has shaken her confidence.
   Answer guidance: Her own counsel can no longer calm Oedipus, so she turns to the god as the city's present help, which shows that fear has shaken her confidence.
3. Why does the news of Polybus's death seem at first like good news to Oedipus? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** If the man he calls his father died of age and sickness, the oracle that named him a parricide seems false, and his long dread is lifted.
   Answer guidance: If the man he calls his father died of age and sickness, the oracle that named him a parricide seems false, and his long dread is lifted.
4. Why does Jocasta urge Oedipus to live a careless life, from hand to mouth? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** She argues that chance rules human life and no one can know the future, so fearing prophecies only brings misery without any gain.
   Answer guidance: She argues that chance rules human life and no one can know the future, so fearing prophecies only brings misery without any gain.
5. Why does Jocasta cry "Ah mayst thou ne'er discover who thou art!" before she leaves? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** She has begun to grasp what the search will uncover and fears the truth will destroy him, so she begs him one last time to stop.
   Answer guidance: She has begun to grasp what the search will uncover and fears the truth will destroy him, so she begs him one last time to stop.

6. What does "Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)" suggest about good news that is not good? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Each piece of good news is a step toward catastrophe. Jocasta understands first; her silence comes before Oedipus understands.

   Answer guidance: Each piece of good news is a step toward catastrophe. Jocasta understands first; her silence comes before Oedipus understands. Evidence to accept: "But, as they stand, the oracles are dead— / Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus" (Episode 3, lines 985–986): Relief makes Oedipus scorn the oracles, a moment of confidence that the scene quickly reverses. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

7. Find one example of irony in "Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)". What does it reveal about good news that is not good that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

   Answer guidance: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true. Evidence to accept: "Why should a mortal man, the sport of chance, / With no assured foreknowledge, be afraid? / Best live a careless life from hand to mouth" (Episode 3, lines 991–993): Jocasta argues that chance rules human life, so worrying about prophecy is pointless. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

8. How does the plot in "Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)" shape what we understand about good news that is not good? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Look for key events and the causes linking them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Each piece of good news in the episode moves Oedipus closer to the truth he is looking for. Useful evidence: "But, as they stand, the oracles are dead— / Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus" (Episode 3, lines 985–986): Relief makes Oedipus scorn the oracles, a moment of confidence that the scene quickly reverses. On plot: News of Polybus's death seems to free Oedipus from the oracle, but his remaining fear about Merope leads the messenger to reveal that Polybus was not his father and that he received the infant from a herdsman of Laius. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. In the passage that opens with "Out on it, lady!", why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: "Be of good cheer; though I be proved the son / Of a bondwoman, aye, through three descents / Triply a slave, thy honor is unsmirched" (Episode 3, lines 1078–1080): Oedipus misreads Jocasta's distress as shame about his birth, which shows how far he is from guessing her real fear. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

10. What causes the main turn in "Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Look for: the messenger's revelation that Polybus was not Oedipus's father; Jocasta's plea to stop searching; the effect, Oedipus pressing on and calling himself the child of Fortune.

    Answer guidance: Look for: the messenger's revelation that Polybus was not Oedipus's father; Jocasta's plea to stop searching; the effect, Oedipus pressing on and calling himself the child of Fortune. Evidence to accept: "Ah mayst thou ne'er discover who thou art" (Episode 3, line 1085): Jocasta's last plea shows that she

now fears the answer and wants him never to learn who he is. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Jocasta right that it is better not to know? Argue with evidence from this episode. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Jocasta's view is understandable but the play does not finally support it. She argues that a mortal is "the sport of chance" and should "live a careless life" (lines 991–993), and she begs "mayst thou ne'er discover who thou art" (line 1085). Oedipus answers "Nothing can make me other than I am" (line 1102) and insists on tracing his birth. A strong answer weighs the comfort of not knowing against the play's respect for truth.
   Answer guidance: Jocasta's view is understandable but the play does not finally support it. She argues that a mortal is "the sport of chance" and should "live a careless life" (lines 991–993), and she begs "mayst thou ne'er discover who thou art" (line 1085). Oedipus answers "Nothing can make me other than I am" (line 1102) and insists on tracing his birth. A strong answer weighs the comfort of not knowing against the play's respect for truth.
2. Is Jocasta's advice to "live a careless life from hand to mouth" (line 993) wise or reckless? Argue with evidence from Episode 3. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** It is reckless, though it sounds wise. She argues that a mortal is "the sport of chance, / With no assured foreknowledge" (lines 991–992), which seems humane advice for a frightened man. But she gives it while the messenger's news is about to prove the oracle true, and she soon begs him to "give o'er / This quest" (lines 1076–1077). A strong answer weighs her comfort against the play's insistence that truth cannot be escaped by ignoring it.
   Answer guidance: It is reckless, though it sounds wise. She argues that a mortal is "the sport of chance, / With no assured foreknowledge" (lines 991–992), which seems humane advice for a frightened man. But she gives it while the messenger's news is about to prove the oracle true, and she soon begs him to "give o'er / This quest" (lines 1076–1077). A strong answer weighs her comfort against the play's insistence that truth cannot be escaped by ignoring it.
3. Is Oedipus's claim to be "Fortune's favorite child" (line 1097) a sign of courage or of blindness? Argue with evidence. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** It shows both. He is brave to insist "Let the storm burst, my fixed resolve still holds, / To learn my lineage, be it ne'er so low" (lines 1093–1094), since he will face even a slave's birth. Yet he misreads Jocasta's grief as pride and thinks "Nothing can make me other than I am" (line 1102), just before the truth unmakes him. A strong answer weighs his courage in the search against his blindness to its meaning.
   Answer guidance: It shows both. He is brave to insist "Let the storm burst, my fixed resolve still holds, / To learn my lineage, be it ne'er so low" (lines 1093–1094), since he will face even a slave's birth. Yet he misreads Jocasta's grief as pride and thinks "Nothing can make me other than I am" (line 1102), just before the truth unmakes him. A strong answer weighs his courage in the search against his blindness to its meaning.
4. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): Each piece of good news is a step toward catastrophe. Jocasta understands first; her silence comes before Oedipus understands. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Each piece of good news in the episode moves Oedipus closer to the truth he is looking for. Useful evidence: “She is my mother and the changing moons / My brethren, and with them I wax and wane. / Thus sprung why should I fear to trace my birth? / Nothing can make me other than I am” (Episode 3, lines 1099–1102): Oedipus calls himself the child of Fortune and insists on tracing his birth, a proud claim that no discovery can change him. Theme link: Jocasta urges a life without questions, "Best live a careless life", while Oedipus chooses to know the truth whatever it costs. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Which character in “Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)” acts most wisely in the matter of good news that is not good, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Each piece of good news in the episode moves Oedipus closer to the truth he is looking for. Useful evidence: “But, as they stand, the oracles are dead— / Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus” (Episode 3, lines 985–986): Relief makes Oedipus scorn the oracles, a moment of confidence that the scene quickly reverses. On characterization: Jocasta and Oedipus react to the same facts in opposite ways: she begs him to stop searching, while he insists on knowing his birth even if he turns out to be of low or enslaved parents. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. You are directing “Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of good news that is not good. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Each piece of good news in the episode moves Oedipus closer to the truth he is looking for. Useful evidence: “Why should a mortal man, the sport of chance, / With no assured foreknowledge, be afraid? / Best live a careless life from hand to mouth” (Episode 3, lines 991–993): Jocasta argues that chance rules human life, so worrying about prophecy is pointless. Theme link: Jocasta urges a life without questions, "Best live a careless life", while Oedipus chooses to know the truth whatever it costs. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Write your own questions about “Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Each piece of good news in the episode moves Oedipus closer to the truth he is looking for. Useful evidence: “Be of good cheer; though I be proved the son / Of a bondwoman, aye, through three descents / Triply a slave, thy honor is unsmirched” (Episode 3, lines 1078–1080): Oedipus misreads Jocasta's distress as shame about his birth, which shows how far he is from guessing her real fear. Theme link: Jocasta urges a life without questions, "Best live a careless life", while Oedipus chooses to know the truth whatever it costs. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Connect “Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)”, with its focus on good news that is not good, to pride and fall: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic

circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Each piece of good news in the episode moves Oedipus closer to the truth he is looking for. Useful evidence: “Ah mayst thou ne’er discover who thou art” (Episode 3, line 1085): Jocasta's last plea shows that she now fears the answer and wants him never to learn who he is. Theme link: Jocasta urges a life without questions, "Best live a careless life", while Oedipus chooses to know the truth whatever it costs. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Is the irony in “Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)” effective in presenting good news that is not good, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Each piece of good news in the episode moves Oedipus closer to the truth he is looking for. Useful evidence: “She is my mother and the changing moons / My brethren, and with them I wax and wane. / Thus sprung why should I fear to trace my birth? / Nothing can make me other than I am” (Episode 3, lines 1099–1102): Oedipus calls himself the child of Fortune and insists on tracing his birth, a proud claim that no discovery can change him. On irony: The Corinthian comes with good news, that Polybus has died naturally and Corinth wants Oedipus as king, and every attempt to reassure Oedipus brings the truth about his birth closer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Compare how “Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)” treats good news that is not good with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus Rex see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Each piece of good news in the episode moves Oedipus closer to the truth he is looking for. Useful evidence: “But, as they stand, the oracles are dead— / Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus” (Episode 3, lines 985–986): Relief makes Oedipus scorn the oracles, a moment of confidence that the scene quickly reverses. Theme link: Jocasta urges a life without questions, "Best live a careless life", while Oedipus chooses to know the truth whatever it costs. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Plot**: key events and the causes linking them
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Jocasta carry when she enters at the start of Episode 3?

   A. Wreaths and gifts of incense

   B. A letter from the king of Corinth

C. A cup of wine for the elders

D. The crown of the dead king

Key: A (Wreaths and gifts of incense)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the messenger say the people of the Isthmus have resolved?

A. To go to war against Thebes

B. To make Oedipus their king

C. To send gifts to Apollo's shrine

D. To banish Merope from Corinth

Key: B (To make Oedipus their king)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] According to the messenger from Corinth, where was the infant Oedipus found?

A. Beside the gate of the royal palace at Corinth

B. On the shore of the sea

C. In Cithaeron's wooded glens

D. In a temple of Apollo

Key: C (In Cithaeron's wooded glens)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the Chorus's warning: “From this dead calm will burst a _____ of woes.”

Key: storm

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Jocasta's advice: “Best live a careless life from hand to _____.”

Key: mouth

6. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Jocasta at first rejoice at the news of Polybus's death?

A. She had long disliked the king of Corinth

B. Oedipus will now inherit great wealth and lands

C. The plague in Thebes will now come to an end at last

D. It seems to prove the oracle about Oedipus false

Key: D (It seems to prove the oracle about Oedipus false)

7. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why has Oedipus stayed away from Corinth for so many years?

A. He feared the oracle about his parents

B. He was banished by the Corinthian king

C. He disliked the climate and the people

D. He promised the Sphinx he would stay

Key: A (He feared the oracle about his parents)

8. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How does the messenger try to free Oedipus from his fear of returning to Corinth?

Sample answer: He tells Oedipus that Polybus was no blood relation to him and that the king of Corinth took him as a gift

from the messenger's own hands. He means this as good news, since if Polybus and Merope were not his parents, the oracle cannot touch them. His attempt to comfort the king opens a new and darker question about who his parents were.

9. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Analyze Jocasta's reaction when the Chorus says she can best identify the herdsman.

   Sample answer: She brushes the question aside, calling it idle words, and then begs Oedipus to give over the quest for his life's sake. When he refuses, she cries woe and leaves, saying she will be silent evermore. Her sudden change from calm confidence to anguish suggests that she has understood something terrible that Oedipus has not.

10. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Analyze how Oedipus explains the queen's departure (lines 1095–1098).

    Sample answer: He assumes that she is ashamed because he may turn out to be of low birth, perhaps the son of a slave. He contrasts her pride of ancestry with his own claim to be Fortune's favorite child. His explanation shows how far he is from understanding her fear, and it also shows his pride turning even a low birth into a source of honour.

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] To which god does Jocasta bring her prayers in Episode 3?

    A. Apollo, Lord Lycean
    B. Zeus, king of the gods
    C. Athenè of the city
    D. Artemis of the hunt

    Key: A (Apollo, Lord Lycean)

12. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] How did Polybus die, according to the messenger?

    A. In battle with a rival city
    B. Of old age and sickness
    C. By poison in his wine
    D. By his own hand in grief

    Key: B (Of old age and sickness)

13. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What did the messenger loose from the infant's feet?

    A. A golden chain and lock
    B. A rope of twisted reeds
    C. The pin that riveted them
    D. A leather strap and buckle

    Key: C (The pin that riveted them)

14. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Oedipus's claim: “She is my mother and the changing _____”

    Key: moons

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does the messenger say Oedipus's fears about his parents are baseless?

    A. The oracle at Delphi has now been proved false by events
    B. Polybus forgave him for leaving before he died
    C. Merope has left Corinth and gone to live abroad
    D. Polybus and Merope were not his parents by blood

    Key: D (Polybus and Merope were not his parents by blood)

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Oedipus still fear going home after Polybus's death?

    A. His mother Merope is still alive

    B. The Corinthians want to punish him

    C. The messenger may be lying to him

    D. Creon may seize Thebes while he is gone

    Key: A (His mother Merope is still alive)

17. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Oedipus say of Polybus, "Killed him and so I slew him in a sense"?

    Sample answer: He jokes that Polybus may have died of longing for his absent son, which would make Oedipus the cause of his death in a loose way. The remark shows how relieved he is: the oracle said he would slay his father, and the only way it could be true now is as a figure of speech. He treats the prophecy as empty.

18. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] Analyze the dramatic irony of the messenger calling his news good for the royal house.

    Sample answer: The messenger expects to please Oedipus and be rewarded, and his news first seems to free the king from the oracle. Yet each detail he adds, the gift of the child, the pinned feet, the shepherd of Laius's house, brings Oedipus closer to a truth that will ruin him. The man who comes to give pleasure is the one who brings disaster nearer.

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze Jocasta's advice that a man should live by chance rather than in fear (lines 991–997).

    Sample answer: Jocasta argues that since man is the sport of chance and has no sure foreknowledge, it is foolish to fear the future. She even dismisses the fear of marrying one's mother as a common dream. Her advice is meant to comfort, but it rejects the gods' power to foretell, and its calm tone sits uneasily beside the facts that are emerging.

20. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Compare Jocasta's attitude toward the oracles at the start of Episode 3 with her attitude at the end of Episode 2.

    Sample answer: At the end of Episode 2 she declared that she would look for signs neither to right nor left. Yet at the start of Episode 3 she comes to Apollo's altar with wreaths and incense, praying for relief. Her words scorn prophecy, but her actions show she still turns to the god when fear grows. Then the news from Corinth briefly restores her scorn.

21. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: "My brethren, and with them I _____ and wane."

    Key: wax

22. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Whom does the messenger say gave him the infant?

    A. Another shepherd, one of Laius' house

    B. A priest from the temple at Delphi

    C. A slave woman from the palace of Thebes

    D. A traveller on the way to Corinth

    Key: A (Another shepherd, one of Laius' house)

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Oedipus call himself at the end of the episode?

    A. The son of a great king

    B. Fortune's favorite child

    C. A wanderer without a home

    D. The servant of Apollo

Key: B (Fortune's favorite child)

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Jocasta beg Oedipus to give up the quest?

    A. She is tired of hearing about old oracles

    B. She wants to visit the shrines before night

    C. She seems to fear what his birth will reveal

    D. She believes the messenger from Corinth is a liar

    Key: C (She seems to fear what his birth will reveal)

25. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Oedipus tell his wife that "thy honor is unsmirched" even if he proves the son of a bondwoman?

    Sample answer: He believes she fears that he will be revealed as low-born and that his shame will touch her. He assures her that even if he is a slave's son three generations back, her own noble honour will be untouched. The remark shows that he misreads her terror as pride about rank, while she seems to fear something far worse.

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What is the effect of Oedipus calling the oracles "Dust, ashes, nothing"?

    A. It shows how deep his grief is at the death of Polybus

    B. It shows that he has lost his faith in Jocasta

    C. It shows his fear that the plague will return

    D. It shows his scorn for prophecy in a burst of relief

    Key: D (It shows his scorn for prophecy in a burst of relief)

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze how the messenger's evidence builds step by step in lines 1030–1050.

    Sample answer: He first says Polybus was no kin to Oedipus, then that Polybus took him as a gift, then that he himself found the child in Cithaeron's glens with its feet pinned. Each answer leads to a new question. The proof moves from a claim to a physical mark, the old sore on Oedipus's ankles, which makes the story hard to deny.

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the storm imagery that runs through Episode 3, from Jocasta's prayer to the Chorus's warning.

    Sample answer: Jocasta says the people are cowed like mariners who see their helmsman dumbstruck in the storm. Near the end, the Chorus fears that a storm of woes will burst from the dead calm, and Oedipus answers that the storm may burst. The image moves from fear for the king to his open defiance, showing a ruler who welcomes the danger others dread.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does the arrival of the messenger change the direction of the play's search?

    Sample answer: Until now the search was for the killer of Laius. The messenger's news seems at first to end Oedipus's fear of the oracle, but his further words turn the search toward Oedipus's own birth. By the end of the episode the question is no longer only who killed the old king but who the present king himself is.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Compare Oedipus's confidence at the end of Episode 3 with his fear at the end of Episode 2.

    Sample answer: At the end of Episode 2 he feared that he had killed Laius and that his own curse would fall on him, and he clung to a faint hope. At the end of Episode 3, despite new and stranger evidence, he is defiant and calls himself Fortune's child. His mood swings from fear to bold pride, even as the danger around him grows.

31. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Oedipus's vow: "To bring to light the secret of my _____."

    Key: birth

32. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Jocasta say as she leaves the stage?

    A. She will be silent evermore

    B. She will return with the herdsman

    C. She will pray at Apollo's altar

    D. She will send for her brother Creon

    Key: A (She will be silent evermore)

33. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Oedipus's question "Doth any bystander among you know The herd he speaks of" show about his state of mind?

    A. He is reluctant to learn anything more

    B. He is eager to settle the matter at once

    C. He thinks the elders are hiding the man

    D. He wants the Chorus to put an end to the search

    Key: B (He is eager to settle the matter at once)

34. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Oedipus refuse Jocasta's plea to stop the quest?

    Sample answer: He believes that with such guiding clues he cannot fail to discover the secret of his birth, and he thinks her fear is only pride about his possible low rank. His whole character drives him to solve mysteries and to face facts. He calls her advice tiresome because, for him, not knowing is worse than any truth.

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] What is the dramatic irony of Jocasta's cry "Ah mayst thou ne'er discover who thou art!"?

    A. It curses him for his treatment of Creon

    B. It mocks his boast that he solves riddles

    C. It shows she grasps a horror he does not

    D. It reveals that she has lied about Laius

    Key: C (It shows she grasps a horror he does not)

36. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] Analyze the irony of the messenger's admission that he came in "hope to profit by thy coming home".

    Sample answer: The messenger hopes to be rewarded for news that will bring Oedipus home to Corinth as king. Instead, his eagerness to please leads him to reveal that Oedipus was a foundling, which turns the king's attention away from Corinth and toward the mystery of his birth. His wish for profit produces a story that brings only pain.

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Analyze Oedipus's claim that "Nothing can make me other than I am".

    Sample answer: The line asserts a fixed identity that no birth, high or low, can change. Oedipus means that his worth comes from what he has done, not from his parents. Yet the search he insists on is precisely about who he is, so the claim is both defiant and fragile: he declares himself unchangeable just as his identity is in question.

38. [mc · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Which statement best describes the overall movement of Episode 3?

    A. From open war to a lasting peace in Thebes

    B. From the king's anger to his calm acceptance

    C. From a funeral in Corinth to a wedding in Thebes

    D. From apparent relief to a new and deeper fear

Key: D (From apparent relief to a new and deeper fear)

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate Jocasta's claim that man lives "With no assured foreknowledge". Does the play so far support her?

    Sample answer: The play partly supports her, since no one sees clearly: Oedipus fled Corinth and the oracle still seemed to fail. But the messenger's story suggests the oracles may be working in ways no one expected, which undercuts her view. Her claim looks weaker as the evidence grows, and her own terror at the end shows she no longer believes it.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Episode 3 return to the question of sight and knowledge raised by the seer in Episode 1?

    Sample answer: In Episode 1 the seer said Oedipus had eyes but could not see his own misery and asked if he knew his lineage. In Episode 3 that very question becomes the subject of the search, as the messenger reveals that Polybus was not his father. Oedipus still cannot see what Jocasta seems to see, so the seer's charge of blindness is borne out.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 3, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 2
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 2, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Episode 3 (lines 922–1102) develops the idea of good news that is not good. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and plot shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6; W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)" could deliver about good news that is not good. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6; W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for good news that is not good in "Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to knowledge and blindness and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Episode 3 (lines 922–1102) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of good news that is not good. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)" could deliver about good news that is not good. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for good news that is not good in "Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to knowledge and blindness and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Episode 3 (lines 922–1102) suggests about good news that is not good. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's irony and plot), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)" could deliver about good news that is not good. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for good news that is not good in "Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to knowledge and blindness and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses irony in Episode 3 (lines 922–1102) to complicate the reader's understanding of good news that is not good. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)" could deliver about good news that is not good. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for good news that is not good in "Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to knowledge and blindness and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Out on it, lady! why should one regard The Pythian hearth or birds that scream i' the air? Did they not point at me as doomed to slay My father? but he's dead and in his grave And here am I who ne'er unsheathed a sword; Unless the longing for his absent son Killed him and so I slew him in a sense. But, as they stand, the oracles are dead— Dust, ashes, nothing, dead as Polybus. Say, did not I foretell this long ago? Thou didst: but I was misled by my fear. Then let it no more weigh upon thy soul. Must I not fear my mother's marriage bed? Why should a mortal man, the sport of chance, With no assured foreknowledge, be afraid? Best live a careless life from hand to mouth. This wedlock with thy mother fear not thou. How oft it chances that in dreams a man Has wed his mother! He who least regards Such brainsick fantasies lives most at ease.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)"?

   A. Responsibility, mercy and the end

   B. The curse and the prophet

C. The shadow of a shade

D. Good news that is not good

SAT key: 1. D (Good news that is not good)

Lesson 9: Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)

Focus: a hopeful guess

Objective: Students will summarize what happens in Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114) (a hopeful guess) in 2 sentences and, in a 3-sentence warm-up response, explain how one quoted line from the scene sets up the scene that follows.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1

Teacher only · spoilers

The Chorus joyfully guesses that Oedipus was born on Mount Cithaeron, perhaps the child of a mountain nymph and a god: Pan, Loxias (Apollo), Cyllene's lord or Bacchus.

Background: Greek myths often told of heroes fathered by gods on mountains.

Significance: This brief, happy ode is placed just before the worst discovery, a classic tragic moment of false hope

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why might a writer put a happy moment just before a disaster? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to knowledge and blindness because....
Prompt: Why might a writer put a happy moment just before a disaster?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to knowledge and blindness because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: The Chorus builds a hopeful story about Oedipus's birth out of guesswork, which shows how people fill gaps in knowledge with what they wish were true.

8–16 min · Background and context · I do (8 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Greek myths often told of heroes fathered by gods on mountains. This brief, happy ode is placed just before the worst discovery, a classic tragic moment of false hope Irony: The Chorus celebrates Mount Cithaeron and imagines a divine father for Oedipus at the very moment the inquiry is about to answer the question of his birth. Tone / mood: The ode is brief, excited and hopeful: the elders promise dances and songs and picture Oedipus as the child of a god and a mountain nymph. Allusion: The elders list gods of the wild who might have fathered a child on the mountain (Pan, Loxias, Cyllene's lord and Bacchus), alluding to myths of heroes born of gods. Watch for Mount Cithaeron: The mountain where the infant was found becomes, in the elders' song, a place of divine birth and celebration.

16–20 min · Closure · I do (4 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how irony shapes a hopeful guess. Key takeaway: The Chorus builds a hopeful story about Oedipus's birth out of guesswork, which shows how people fill gaps in knowledge with what they wish were true.

Total: 20 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Irony:** The Chorus celebrates Mount Cithaeron and imagines a divine father for Oedipus at the very moment the inquiry is about to answer the question of his birth.
- **Tone / mood:** The ode is brief, excited and hopeful: the elders promise dances and songs and picture Oedipus as the child of a god and a mountain nymph.
- **Allusion:** The elders list gods of the wild who might have fathered a child on the mountain (Pan, Loxias, Cyllene's lord and Bacchus), alluding to myths of heroes born of gods.

Themes and how they develop

- **knowledge and blindness:** The Chorus builds a hopeful story about Oedipus's birth out of guesswork, which shows how people fill gaps in knowledge with what they wish were true.

Symbols and motifs

- **Mount Cithaeron:** The mountain where the infant was found becomes, in the elders' song, a place of divine birth and celebration.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, / Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, / As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus shall greet / Ere tomorrow's full moon rises, and exalt thee as is meet" (Stasimon 3, lines 1103–1106) The elders promise to honor Cithaeron as Oedipus's nurse, a confident prophecy built on hope rather than knowledge.
- "Dance and song shall hymn thy praises, lover of our royal race" (Stasimon 3, line 1107) The joy and music of the line set a festive mood that contrasts with the danger of the moment.
- "Child, who bare thee, nymph or goddess? sure sire was more than man, / Haply the hill-roamer Pan" (Stasimon 3, lines 1109–1110) The Chorus guesses that Oedipus had a divine parent, turning the mystery of his birth into a sign of greatness.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: This short, joyful ode is placed just before the herdsman arrives, so its hope makes the scene that follows feel more painful.
Evidence: "If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, / Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, / As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus shall greet / Ere tomorrow's full moon rises, and exalt thee as is meet" (Stasimon 3, lines 1103–1106)

Reasoning: The elders promise to "hail" Cithaeron "Ere tomorrow's full moon rises" and guess that Oedipus's father was Pan or another god, while the audience waits for the witness who will answer the question of his birth.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 1103–1106

1103 **Chorus:** If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail,
1104 **Chorus:** Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail,
1105 **Chorus:** As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus shall greet
1106 **Chorus:** Ere tomorrow's full moon rises, and exalt thee as is meet.

Lines 1103–1114

1103 **Chorus:** If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail,
1104 **Chorus:** Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail,
1105 **Chorus:** As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus shall greet
1106 **Chorus:** Ere tomorrow's full moon rises, and exalt thee as is meet.
1107 **Chorus:** Dance and song shall hymn thy praises, lover of our royal race.
1108 **Chorus:** Phoebus, may my words find grace!
1109 **Chorus:** Child, who bare thee, nymph or goddess? sure thy sure was more than man,
1110 **Chorus:** Haply the hill-roamer Pan.
1111 **Chorus:** Of did Loxias beget thee, for he haunts the upland wold;
1112 **Chorus:** Or Cyllene's lord, or Bacchus, dweller on the hilltops cold?
1113 **Chorus:** Did some Heliconian Oread give him thee, a new-born joy?
1114 **Chorus:** Nymphs with whom he love to toy?

Line 1105

1105 **Chorus:** As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus shall greet

Line 1106

1106 **Chorus:** Ere tomorrow's full moon rises, and exalt thee as is meet.

Line 1107

1107 **Chorus:** Dance and song shall hymn thy praises, lover of our royal race.

Line 1109

1109 **Chorus:** Child, who bare thee, nymph or goddess? sure thy sure was more than man,

Lines 1109–1110

1109 **Chorus:** Child, who bare thee, nymph or goddess? sure thy sure was more than man,
1110 **Chorus:** Haply the hill-roamer Pan.

Line 1113

1113 **Chorus:** Did some Heliconian Oread give him thee, a new-born joy?

Line 1114

1114 **Chorus:** Nymphs with whom he love to toy?

Vocabulary

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context

Discussion questions

1. Why might a writer put a happy moment just before a disaster?
2. Where does irony appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with pride and fall?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What will the Chorus do to Cithaeron "ere tomorrow's full moon"? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Hail and exalt it as Oedipus' nurse and foster-mother.
   Answer guidance: Hail and exalt it as Oedipus' nurse and foster-mother.
2. Which god does the Chorus call “the hill-roamer”? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Pan.
   Answer guidance: Pan.
3. How many possible fathers for the child does the Chorus name (lines 1109–1112)? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Four, all of them gods who haunt the hills and uplands.
   Answer guidance: Four, all of them gods who haunt the hills and uplands.
4. Which kind of mother does the Chorus imagine for the child (lines 1109–1114)? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A nymph, perhaps a Heliconian Oread, rather than a mortal woman.
   Answer guidance: A nymph, perhaps a Heliconian Oread, rather than a mortal woman.
5. What place does the Chorus celebrate? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Mount Cithaeron
   Answer guidance: Mount Cithaeron.
6. What do the elders guess about Oedipus' birth? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** He may be the child of a god
   Answer guidance: He may be the child of a god.
7. What mood fills the Chorus as it imagines honouring Cithaeron? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Hopeful and joyful
   Answer guidance: Hopeful and joyful.

8. Why is the ode ironic? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The truth about Cithaeron is the opposite of what they hope
   Answer guidance: The truth about Cithaeron is the opposite of what they hope.
9. What kind of reference is the Chorus's list of Pan, Loxias and Bacchus as possible fathers? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** An allusion to myth
   Answer guidance: An allusion to myth.
10. Retell the most important events of "Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)" in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The Chorus joyfully guesses that Oedipus was born on Mount Cithaeron, perhaps the child of a mountain nymph and a god: Pan, Loxias (Apollo), Cyllene's lord or Bacchus.
    Answer guidance: The Chorus joyfully guesses that Oedipus was born on Mount Cithaeron, perhaps the child of a mountain nymph and a god: Pan, Loxias (Apollo), Cyllene's lord or Bacchus.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does the ode come right before the Herdsman scene? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** To heighten the fall by raising hope first.
   Answer guidance: To heighten the fall by raising hope first.
2. What does "Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)" suggest about a hopeful guess? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** This brief, happy ode is placed just before the worst discovery, a classic tragic moment of false hope
   Answer guidance: This brief, happy ode is placed just before the worst discovery, a classic tragic moment of false hope. Evidence to accept: "If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, / Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, / As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus shall greet / Ere tomorrow's full moon rises, and exalt thee as" (Stasimon 3, lines 1103–1106): The elders promise to honor Cithaeron as Oedipus's nurse, a confident prophecy built on hope rather than knowledge. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
3. Find one example of irony in "Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)". What does it reveal about a hopeful guess that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
   Answer guidance: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true. Evidence to accept: "Dance and song shall hymn thy praises, lover of our royal race" (Stasimon 3, line 1107): The joy and music of the line set a festive mood that contrasts with the danger of the moment. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
4. How does the tone / mood in "Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)" shape what we understand about a hopeful guess? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Look for word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: This short, joyful ode is placed just before the herdsman arrives, so its hope makes the scene that follows feel more painful. Useful evidence: "If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, / Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, / As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus shall greet / Ere tomorrow's full moon rises, and exalt thee as" (Stasimon 3, lines 1103–1106): The elders promise to honor Cithaeron as Oedipus's nurse, a confident prophecy built on hope rather than

knowledge. On tone / mood: The ode is brief, excited and hopeful: the elders promise dances and songs and picture Oedipus as the child of a god and a mountain nymph. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that opens with “If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus shall greet Ere tomorrow’s full moon rises,…”, why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: “Child, who bare thee, nymph or goddess? sure sire was more than man, / Haply the hill-roamer Pan” (Stasimon 3, lines 1109–1110): The Chorus guesses that Oedipus had a divine parent, turning the mystery of his birth into a sign of greatness. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

6. What causes the main turn in “Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Look for: the elders' joyful guess about Oedipus's birth on Cithaeron; the gods they name as possible fathers; the effect, hope that makes the coming truth harder to bear.

   Answer guidance: Look for: the elders' joyful guess about Oedipus's birth on Cithaeron; the gods they name as possible fathers; the effect, hope that makes the coming truth harder to bear. Evidence to accept: “If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, / Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, / As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus shall greet / Ere tomorrow’s full moon rises, and exalt thee as” (Stasimon 3, lines 1103–1106): The elders promise to honor Cithaeron as Oedipus's nurse, a confident prophecy built on hope rather than knowledge. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

7. How does “Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)” build on “Episode 3 (lines 922–1102)”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: This short, joyful ode is placed just before the herdsman arrives, so its hope makes the scene that follows feel more painful. Useful evidence: “Dance and song shall hymn thy praises, lover of our royal race” (Stasimon 3, line 1107): The joy and music of the line set a festive mood that contrasts with the danger of the moment. Theme link: The Chorus builds a hopeful story about Oedipus's birth out of guesswork, which shows how people fill gaps in knowledge with what they wish were true. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. In “Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)”, what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about a hopeful guess, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: This short, joyful ode is placed just before the herdsman arrives, so its hope makes the scene that follows feel more painful. Useful evidence: “Child, who bare thee, nymph or goddess? sure sire was more than man, / Haply the hill-roamer Pan” (Stasimon 3, lines 1109–1110): The Chorus guesses that Oedipus had a divine parent, turning the mystery of his birth into a sign of greatness. Theme link: The Chorus builds a hopeful story about Oedipus's birth out of guesswork, which shows how people fill gaps in knowledge with what they wish were true. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (Why might a writer put a happy moment just before a disaster?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.
   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: “Dance and song shall hymn thy praises, lover of our royal race” (Stasimon 3, line 1107): The joy and music of the line set a festive mood that contrasts with the danger of the moment. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
10. Where does allusion appear in “Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)”, and how does it connect a hopeful guess to the larger concern with pride and fall? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.9, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Look for references to other books, myths, history or religion.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: This short, joyful ode is placed just before the herdsman arrives, so its hope makes the scene that follows feel more painful. Useful evidence: “If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, / Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, / As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus shall greet / Ere tomorrow’s full moon rises, and exalt thee as” (Stasimon 3, lines 1103–1106): The elders promise to honor Cithaeron as Oedipus's nurse, a confident prophecy built on hope rather than knowledge. On allusion: The elders list gods of the wild who might have fathered a child on the mountain (Pan, Loxias, Cyllene’s lord and Bacchus), alluding to myths of heroes born of gods. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Does this ode make the ending more painful or more bearable? Defend your view. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** It makes what follows more painful. The elders promise to "hail" Cithaeron as Oedipus's "foster-mother" (lines 1103–1106) and imagine a god as his father, while the audience waits for the witness who will answer the question of his birth. Their joy, "Dance and song shall hymn thy praises" (line 1107), raises hope just before it falls. A strong answer explains how this contrast shapes the audience's feeling.
   Answer guidance: It makes what follows more painful. The elders promise to "hail" Cithaeron as Oedipus's "foster-mother" (lines 1103–1106) and imagine a god as his father, while the audience waits for the witness who will answer the question of his birth. Their joy, "Dance and song shall hymn thy praises" (line 1107), raises hope just before it falls. A strong answer explains how this contrast shapes the audience's feeling.
2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): This brief, happy ode is placed just before the worst discovery, a classic tragic moment of false hope How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: This short, joyful ode is placed just before the herdsman arrives, so its hope makes the scene that follows feel more painful. Useful evidence: “Child, who bare thee, nymph or goddess? sure sire was more than man, / Haply the hill-roamer Pan” (Stasimon 3, lines 1109–1110): The Chorus guesses that Oedipus had a divine parent, turning the mystery of his birth into a sign of greatness. Theme link: The Chorus builds a hopeful story about Oedipus's birth out of guesswork, which

shows how people fill gaps in knowledge with what they wish were true. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in "Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)" acts most wisely in the matter of a hopeful guess, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: This short, joyful ode is placed just before the herdsman arrives, so its hope makes the scene that follows feel more painful. Useful evidence: "If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, / Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, / As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus shall greet / Ere tomorrow's full moon rises, and exalt thee as" (Stasimon 3, lines 1103–1106): The elders promise to honor Cithaeron as Oedipus's nurse, a confident prophecy built on hope rather than knowledge. Theme link: The Chorus builds a hopeful story about Oedipus's birth out of guesswork, which shows how people fill gaps in knowledge with what they wish were true. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing "Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of a hopeful guess. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: This short, joyful ode is placed just before the herdsman arrives, so its hope makes the scene that follows feel more painful. Useful evidence: "Dance and song shall hymn thy praises, lover of our royal race" (Stasimon 3, line 1107): The joy and music of the line set a festive mood that contrasts with the danger of the moment. Theme link: The Chorus builds a hopeful story about Oedipus's birth out of guesswork, which shows how people fill gaps in knowledge with what they wish were true. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write your own questions about "Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: This short, joyful ode is placed just before the herdsman arrives, so its hope makes the scene that follows feel more painful. Useful evidence: "Child, who bare thee, nymph or goddess? sure sire was more than man, / Haply the hill-roamer Pan" (Stasimon 3, lines 1109–1110): The Chorus guesses that Oedipus had a divine parent, turning the mystery of his birth into a sign of greatness. Theme link: The Chorus builds a hopeful story about Oedipus's birth out of guesswork, which shows how people fill gaps in knowledge with what they wish were true. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect "Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)", with its focus on a hopeful guess, to leadership and the city: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: This short, joyful ode is placed just before the herdsman arrives, so its hope makes the scene that follows feel more painful. Useful evidence: "If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, / Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, / As the nurse and foster-mother of our

Oedipus shall greet / Ere tomorrow's full moon rises, and exalt thee as" (Stasimon 3, lines 1103–1106): The elders promise to honor Cithaeron as Oedipus's nurse, a confident prophecy built on hope rather than knowledge. Theme link: The Chorus builds a hopeful story about Oedipus's birth out of guesswork, which shows how people fill gaps in knowledge with what they wish were true. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the irony in "Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)" effective in presenting a hopeful guess, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: This short, joyful ode is placed just before the herdsman arrives, so its hope makes the scene that follows feel more painful. Useful evidence: "Dance and song shall hymn thy praises, lover of our royal race" (Stasimon 3, line 1107): The joy and music of the line set a festive mood that contrasts with the danger of the moment. On irony: The Chorus celebrates Mount Cithaeron and imagines a divine father for Oedipus at the very moment the inquiry is about to answer the question of his birth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how "Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)" treats a hopeful guess with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus Rex see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: This short, joyful ode is placed just before the herdsman arrives, so its hope makes the scene that follows feel more painful. Useful evidence: "Child, who bare thee, nymph or goddess? sure sire was more than man, / Haply the hill-roamer Pan" (Stasimon 3, lines 1109–1110): The Chorus guesses that Oedipus had a divine parent, turning the mystery of his birth into a sign of greatness. Theme link: The Chorus builds a hopeful story about Oedipus's birth out of guesswork, which shows how people fill gaps in knowledge with what they wish were true. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what "Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: This short, joyful ode is placed just before the herdsman arrives, so its hope makes the scene that follows feel more painful. Useful evidence: "If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, / Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, / As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus shall greet / Ere tomorrow's full moon rises, and exalt thee as" (Stasimon 3, lines 1103–1106): The elders promise to honor Cithaeron as Oedipus's nurse, a confident prophecy built on hope rather than knowledge. Theme link: The Chorus builds a hopeful story about Oedipus's birth out of guesswork, which shows how people fill gaps in knowledge with what they wish were true. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of "Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)" (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about a hopeful guess? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: This short, joyful ode is placed just before the herdsman

arrives, so its hope makes the scene that follows feel more painful. Useful evidence: “Dance and song shall hymn thy praises, lover of our royal race” (Stasimon 3, line 1107): The joy and music of the line set a festive mood that contrasts with the danger of the moment. Theme link: The Chorus builds a hopeful story about Oedipus's birth out of guesswork, which shows how people fill gaps in knowledge with what they wish were true. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling
- Also notice **Allusion**: references to other books, myths, history or religion

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] To which god does the Chorus pray that its words find favour?
   A. Phoebus
   B. Zeus
   C. Poseidon
   D. Hera

   Key: A (Phoebus)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the Chorus say will hymn the mountain's praises?
   A. Trumpets and drums
   B. Dance and song
   C. The priests of Zeus
   D. The people's tears

   Key: B (Dance and song)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which god does the Chorus say “haunts the upland wold”?
   A. Ares
   B. Poseidon
   C. Loxias
   D. Hera

   Key: C (Loxias)
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the question: “Nymphs with whom he loves to _____?”
   Key: toy
5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the question: “Child, who bare thee, nymph or _____?”
   Key: goddess
6. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does the Chorus plan to celebrate the mountain?
   A. They believe the plague first began on its slopes
   B. They think the Sphinx lived there
   C. They think Laius is buried there

D. They think it sheltered the infant king

Key: D (They think it sheltered the infant king)

7. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does the Chorus list several gods and nymphs in the second stanza?

   A. It is guessing who the king's parents might be

   B. It is naming the gods who sent the plague

   C. It is calling the gods to judge the king

   D. It is listing the gods who are worshipped in Corinth

   Key: A (It is guessing who the king's parents might be)

8. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why is the Chorus so hopeful at this point in the play?
   Sample answer: The messenger has just revealed that Oedipus was found as an infant on the mountain. The Chorus, loyal to its king, imagines that such a foundling might be the child of a god or a mountain nymph. Its hope turns the mystery of his birth into a possible honour, and it looks forward to celebrating his origins.

9. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the contrast between the Chorus's mood in Stasimon 3 and Jocasta's mood when she left the stage.
   Sample answer: Jocasta left in anguish, crying woe and saying she would be silent evermore. Moments later the Chorus sings joyfully about Oedipus's birth on the mountain and imagines a divine father. The contrast shows how little the elders have understood of her fear, and it makes the audience uneasy about whose reading of the facts is right.

10. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the Chorus pictures the mountain in the first stanza of the ode.
    Sample answer: The Chorus treats the mountain almost as a person: it will hail it as the nurse and foster-mother of Oedipus and call it a lover of the royal race. By personifying the mountain, the ode turns a wild place where an infant was abandoned into a loving guardian. The image is warm, though the facts behind it are harsh.

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Which god does the Chorus call a dweller on the hilltops?

    A. Bacchus

    B. Apollo

    C. Poseidon

    D. Ares

    Key: A (Bacchus)

12. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does the Chorus call the mountain in relation to the royal family?

    A. Guardian of the city gates

    B. Lover of our royal race

    C. Enemy of the house of Thebes

    D. Witness to an ancient crime

    Key: B (Lover of our royal race)

13. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What kind of nymph does the Chorus imagine handing the child to a god?

    A. A nymph of the sea

    B. A dryad of the oak

C. A Heliconian Oread

D. A naiad of the spring

Key: C (A Heliconian Oread)

14. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: “As the _____ and foster-mother of our Oedipus shall greet”

Key: nurse

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does the Chorus assume the king's father was divine?

A. Oedipus himself has told them so in the palace

B. The messenger from Corinth swore that it was so

C. The seer foretold it in Episode 1

D. A foundling of the hills seems fit for a god

Key: D (A foundling of the hills seems fit for a god)

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which best describes the Chorus's view of Oedipus's unknown birth in this ode?

A. They see it as a sign of glory, not shame

B. They fear that it hides a terrible crime

C. They think it proves he is no true king

D. They want him to stop searching for it at once

Key: A (They see it as a sign of glory, not shame)

17. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the ode answer Oedipus's claim at the end of Episode 3 that he is Fortune's child?

Sample answer: Oedipus called himself the child of Fortune and said that no birth could shame him. The Chorus takes up his hopeful mood and goes further, imagining that a god such as Pan, Loxias or Bacchus might be his father. The ode shares the king's confidence and turns his unknown birth into something to celebrate.

18. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze the questions the Chorus asks in the second stanza (lines 1109–1114).

Sample answer: The Chorus asks a string of questions: who bore the child, whether Pan, Loxias, the lord of Cyllene or Bacchus was his father, and whether a nymph of Helicon gave him away. The questions are eager and playful rather than anxious. They show the elders enjoying the mystery, sure that the answer will bring honour to their king.

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] Analyze the irony of the Chorus claiming the power to foresee the future in the opening line of the ode.

Sample answer: The Chorus begins by claiming that its soul can see what is coming. Yet throughout the play it has doubted prophets and been unsure of the truth. Its confident prediction here is a happy guess about a divine birth, while the real prophecies spoken earlier point elsewhere. The claim to see the future marks how little it sees.

20. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Compare the mood of Stasimon 3 with the mood of Stasimon 2.

Sample answer: Stasimon 2 was anxious and stern, warning that insolence breeds the tyrant and praying that the oracles be proved true. Stasimon 3 is light and eager, celebrating the mountain and guessing at a divine father. The shift follows the news from Corinth, which made the oracles seem empty and the king's birth a mystery worth singing about.

21. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the question: “Did some Heliconian Oread give him thee, a new-born _____?”

    Key: joy

22. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does the Chorus ask Phoebus to grant its words?

    A. Grace
    B. Strength
    C. Speed
    D. Glory

    Key: A (Grace)

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does the Chorus claim to have, in the opening line, that lets it predict the future?

    A. A message from Delphi
    B. A prophetic soul
    C. A dream sent by Zeus
    D. The seer's support

    Key: B (A prophetic soul)

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does the Chorus hope the next day will bring?

    A. The return of the messenger to Corinth
    B. A new oracle from Delphi about the plague
    C. A festival honouring the king's birthplace
    D. The burial of Polybus, the old king of Corinth

    Key: C (A festival honouring the king's birthplace)

25. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does the Chorus expect to learn about Oedipus's birth, and why?

    Sample answer: It expects to learn that he is the child of a god and a mountain nymph. The messenger's story of a foundling on the mountain makes a divine birth seem possible, and the elders want their king's origins to be glorious. Their hope reflects their loyalty to Oedipus far more than any evidence they have actually heard.

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Which device is most at work when the Chorus calls the mountain the “foster-mother” of Oedipus?

    A. Hyperbole
    B. Onomatopoeia
    C. Rhetorical question
    D. Personification

    Key: D (Personification)

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the effect of the many gods named in the second stanza.

    Sample answer: Naming Pan, Loxias, the lord of Cyllene and Bacchus fills the stanza with mountain gods and nymphs. The list makes the guessing playful and grand at once, as if any god might have fathered the king. It also shows the Chorus reaching for the most flattering answer instead of weighing the evidence it has.

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze the shortness of Stasimon 3 compared with the play's earlier odes.

    Sample answer: Stasimon 3 has only two short stanzas, far briefer than the Parodos or Stasimon 2. Its brevity gives it the feel of a quick burst of joy between serious scenes. The short ode keeps the action moving and leaves only a moment of hope before the search resumes, which makes that hope seem fragile.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Stasimon 3 echo the Chorus's earlier faith in Oedipus in Stasimon 1?

    Sample answer: In Stasimon 1 the Chorus refused to accept the seer's charge and remembered how Oedipus proved true like gold. In Stasimon 3 it again chooses the most generous reading of the facts, turning a foundling's story into a tale of divine birth. In both odes, loyalty to the king shapes how the elders read the evidence.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Trace the image of the mountain from Jocasta's story in Episode 2 to Stasimon 3.

    Sample answer: In Episode 2 Jocasta said the infant of the oracle was cast away on the trackless mountain side with its ankles pinned. In Episode 3 the messenger said he found the infant Oedipus in Cithaeron's glens. In Stasimon 3 the Chorus hails that mountain as a loving nurse. The same mountain appears as a place of death, of rescue, and of celebration.

31. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: “Ere tomorrow’s full moon rises, and exalt thee as is _____.”

    Key: meet

32. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does the Chorus say the father of the child surely was?

    A. More than a man
    B. A shepherd of the hills
    C. A king of a far city
    D. A wandering stranger

    Key: A (More than a man)

33. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does the ode suggest about the Chorus's reaction to Jocasta's exit?

    A. It blames her for leaving the king alone
    B. It seems not to share her fear at all
    C. It mourns her as if she had died
    D. It promises to bring her back to him

    Key: B (It seems not to share her fear at all)

34. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does the ode reveal about how the Chorus interprets the messenger's news?

    Sample answer: The Chorus reads the messenger's story as wonderful news: a king found on the mountain may have a divine father. It ignores the danger that Jocasta seemed to sense and the question of the shepherd of Laius's house. The ode shows that the elders hear what they hope to hear, and that they read the facts in the king's favour.

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What is the dramatic effect of placing this joyful ode right after Jocasta's exit?

    A. It gives the actors a pause to change costume
    B. It reports events that happen offstage
    C. It sets the elders' cheer against her dread

D. It ends the play's search for the killer

Key: C (It sets the elders' cheer against her dread)

36. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] Analyze the dramatic irony of Stasimon 3 as a whole.
Sample answer: The Chorus celebrates a birth it believes will prove glorious, imagining Pan or Loxias as the father. But the audience has heard Jocasta's story of an infant cast away on the mountain with pinned ankles and has just watched her leave in horror. The joyful guesses therefore sound hollow, and the ode's hope becomes a measure of how far the elders are from the truth.

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the ode personifies the mountain and what that suggests about nature's role in the play.
Sample answer: The Chorus calls the mountain a nurse, a foster-mother and a lover of the royal race, giving it human care. In the play, the mountain is where an infant was left to die and where Oedipus was found. Personifying it as a loving parent suggests that nature saved the child, though the play has hinted that the mountain was meant to be a grave.

38. [mc · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Which statement best describes the function of Stasimon 3 in the play's structure?
A. A full summary of the plot so far for the audience's benefit
B. A prayer for the plague to end at last
C. A lament for the death of Polybus
D. A brief rise in hope before the questioning resumes

Key: D (A brief rise in hope before the questioning resumes)

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate whether the Chorus's hopeful reading of the evidence is reasonable at this point in the play.
Sample answer: It is partly reasonable: the messenger's story proves only that Oedipus was a foundling, and a divine birth was a common explanation in myth. But the Chorus ignores warning signs, especially Jocasta's terror and her plea to stop the search. Its reading is driven more by loyalty and hope than by the evidence it has just heard.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does Stasimon 3 continue the pattern of hope and fear that began with the plague in the Prologue?
Sample answer: The Prologue opened in fear of the plague and hope in Oedipus as saviour. Each scene since has swung between the two: hope in the oracle, fear of the seer, relief at Jocasta's story, terror at the three roads, relief at the news from Corinth. Stasimon 3 is the highest point of hope, which makes the coming questioning feel like a fall from a height.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 3, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 2
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 2, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114) develops the idea of a hopeful guess. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6; W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)" could deliver about a hopeful guess. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6; W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for a hopeful guess in "Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to knowledge and blindness and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of a hopeful guess. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)" could deliver about a hopeful guess. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for a hopeful guess in "Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to knowledge and blindness and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114) suggests about a hopeful guess. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's irony and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)" could deliver about a hopeful guess. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for a hopeful guess in "Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to knowledge and blindness and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses irony in Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114) to complicate the reader's understanding of a hopeful guess. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)" could deliver about a hopeful guess. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for a hopeful guess in "Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to knowledge and blindness and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *If my soul prophetic err not, if my wisdom aught avail, Thee, Cithaeron, I shall hail, As the nurse and foster-mother of our Oedipus shall greet Ere tomorrow's full moon rises, and exalt thee as is meet. Dance and song shall hymn thy praises, lover of our royal race. Phoebus, may my words find grace! Child, who bare thee, nymph or goddess? sure sire was more than man, Haply the hill-roamer Pan. Or did Loxias beget thee, for he haunts the upland wold; Or Cyllene's lord, or Bacchus, dweller on the hilltops cold? Did some Heliconian Oread give him thee, a new-born joy? Nymphs with whom he loves to toy?*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Stasimon 3 (lines 1103–1114)"?

   A. A king who promises to find the killer

   B. The curse and the prophet

   C. A hopeful guess

   D. The shadow of a shade

SAT key: 1. C (A hopeful guess)

Lesson 10: Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)

Focus: the herdsman and the recognition

Objective: Students will analyze how plot develops in "Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Content note (mature themes): Teacher note: some schools' guidelines may treat this passage differently.
Suggested language: "What does this passage make us notice?"

Teacher only · spoilers

The old herdsman of Laius, once a household slave, arrives. The Corinthian identifies him as the man who gave him the baby. The herdsman tries not to answer; Oedipus orders him threatened until he speaks. He admits that the child came from Laius' house and that the queen gave it to him to destroy because of a prophecy; he pitied it and gave it away. Oedipus recognizes the whole truth.

Background: Threatening an enslaved man to make him speak (lines 1160–1167) shows the power masters held over enslaved people; it is wrong, and the play does not hide its cruelty.

Significance: Aristotle uses this play as his example of reversal: the messenger who comes to cheer Oedipus produces the opposite effect (Aristotle, ca. 335 B.C.E./1999, ch. XI). The investigator finds himself.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Is it ever right to force someone to tell the truth? Why or why not? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to knowledge and blindness because....
Prompt: Is it ever right to force someone to tell the truth? Why or why not?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to knowledge and blindness because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Oedipus chooses to hear the truth even when the Herdsman warns him, and the scene ends with the full recognition he has pursued since the Prologue.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
One key word in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: parricide — the killing of one's father, or the person who does it. "parricide": Origin: possibly Middle French parricide; earlier Latin parricīda.
Words: parricide: the killing of one's father, or the person who does it

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)

Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).

Threatening an enslaved man to make him speak (lines 1160–1167) shows the power masters held over enslaved people; it is wrong, and the play does not hide its cruelty. Aristotle uses this play as his example of reversal: the messenger who comes to cheer Oedipus produces the opposite effect (Aristotle, ca. 335 B.C.E./1999, ch. XI). The investigator finds himself. Plot: The Herdsman is brought in, the Corinthian identifies him as the man who handed him the infant, and step by step Oedipus forces out the answer to the question of his birth. Characterization: The old Herdsman tries every way to avoid answering (he forgets, he begs, he warns), and his pity for the baby long ago shows a decent man trapped by his knowledge. Irony: The Corinthian expects his news to be welcome, yet each detail he adds makes the Herdsman's answer more certain and the truth more terrible. Watch for light: At the moment of recognition Oedipus turns away from the light, so the play's language of seeing and darkness reaches its turning point.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)

Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.

First, meaning. I read "I was, a thrall, not purchased but home-bred" slowly and put it in my own words: In these lines Herdsman speaks at a turning point of the section, which is about the herdsman and the recognition. Next, craft. I notice how the lines use plot, characterization to make the audience feel the pressure of the moment on Herdsman. The strongest word is "purchased": the word "purchased" carries the weight of the lines and points to the section's big idea. Then, effect. What do lines 1131 reveal about the herdsman and the recognition? My answer: Aristotle uses this play as his example of reversal: the messenger who comes to cheer Oedipus produces the opposite effect (Aristotle, ca. 335 B.C.E./1999, ch. XI). The investigator finds himself. These lines show the herdsman and the recognition, and that matters for what follows in the play.

> *I was, a thrall, not purchased but home-bred (Episode 4, line 1131)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "I was, a thrall, not purchased but home-bred" slowly and put it in my own words: In these lines Herdsman speaks at a turning point of the section, which is about the herdsman and the recognition. Next, craft. I notice how the lines use plot, characterization to make the audience feel the pressure of the moment on Herdsman. The strongest word is "purchased": the word "purchased" carries the weight of the lines and points to the section's big idea. Then, effect. What do lines 1131 reveal about the herdsman and the recognition? My answer: Aristotle uses this play as his example of reversal: the messenger who comes to cheer Oedipus produces the opposite effect (Aristotle, ca. 335 B.C.E./1999, ch. XI). The investigator finds himself. These lines show the herdsman and the recognition, and that matters for what follows in the play.

40–50 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (10 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Perilous" and "edge" stand out. The herdsman pictures himself at the brink of a cliff, one word from a fall, so what he is about to say is dangerous for him and for the king. Ask: How does this line connect to knowledge and blindness? Expected student answer: Oedipus chooses to hear the truth even when the Herdsman warns him, and the scene ends with the full recognition he has pursued since the Prologue. (The Herdsman says he is on the brink of saying something terrible, the last pause before the truth.)

> *I stand upon the perilous edge of speech (Episode 4, line 1179)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Perilous" and "edge" stand out. The herdsman pictures himself at the brink of a cliff, one word from a fall, so what he is about to say is dangerous for him and for the king.
Ask: How does this line connect to knowledge and blindness?
Expected student answer: Oedipus chooses to hear the truth even when the Herdsman warns him, and the scene ends with the full recognition he has pursued since the Prologue. (The Herdsman says he is on the brink of saying something terrible, the last pause before the truth.)

50–55 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (5 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for plot, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the herdsman and the recognition? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200) develops the idea of the herdsman and the recognition. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: In this scene the investigator finds that he is the one he has been looking for. When the text says "I stand upon the perilous edge of speech" (Episode 4, line 1179), it shows this directly. The Herdsman stands "upon the perilous edge of speech", Oedipus answers "I still must hear", and his cry "all brought to pass, all true!" shows the reversal and recognition arriving together, as Aristotle says of this play.
Task: Annotate the scene for plot, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the herdsman and the recognition? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200) develops the idea of the herdsman and the recognition. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: In this scene the investigator finds that he is the one he has been looking for. When the text says "I stand upon the perilous edge of speech" (Episode 4, line 1179), it shows this directly. The Herdsman stands "upon the perilous edge of speech", Oedipus answers "I still must hear", and his cry "all brought to pass, all true!" shows the reversal and recognition arriving together, as Aristotle says of this play.

55–60 min · Discussion · We do (5 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Is it ever right to force someone to tell the truth? Why or why not? Ask: Is it ever right to force someone to tell the truth? Why or why not?
Anchor question: Is it ever right to force someone to tell the truth? Why or why not?
Facilitation: Ask: Is it ever right to force someone to tell the truth? Why or why not?

60–67 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the herdsman and the recognition? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: In this scene the investigator finds that he is the one he has been looking for. ("I stand upon the perilous edge of speech", Episode 4, line 1179). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the herdsman and the recognition? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: In this scene the investigator finds that he is the one he has been looking for. ("I stand upon the perilous edge of speech", Episode 4, line 1179). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

67–70 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how plot shapes the herdsman and the recognition. Key takeaway: Oedipus chooses to hear the truth even when the Herdsman warns him, and the scene ends with the full recognition he has pursued since the Prologue.

Total: 70 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Plot:** The Herdsman is brought in, the Corinthian identifies him as the man who handed him the infant, and step by step Oedipus forces out the answer to the question of his birth.
- **Characterization:** The old Herdsman tries every way to avoid answering (he forgets, he begs, he warns), and his pity for the baby long ago shows a decent man trapped by his knowledge.
- **Irony:** The Corinthian expects his news to be welcome, yet each detail he adds makes the Herdsman's answer more certain and the truth more terrible.

Themes and how they develop

- **knowledge and blindness:** Oedipus chooses to hear the truth even when the Herdsman warns him, and the scene ends with the full recognition he has pursued since the Prologue.

Symbols and motifs

- **light:** At the moment of recognition Oedipus turns away from the light, so the play's language of seeing and darkness reaches its turning point.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "I was, a thrall, not purchased but home-bred" (Episode 4, line 1131) The Herdsman was born enslaved in Laius's household, which is why he knows the secret and has no power to refuse.
- "I stand upon the perilous edge of speech" (Episode 4, line 1179) The Herdsman says he is on the brink of saying something terrible, the last pause before the truth.
- "And I of hearing, but I still must hear" (Episode 4, line 1180) Oedipus admits the danger but insists on hearing, a choice of truth over safety.
- "Ah me! ah me! all brought to pass, all true! / O light, may I behold thee nevermore! / I stand a wretch, in birth, in wedlock cursed, / A parricide, incestuously, triply cursed" (Episode 4, lines 1197–1200) Oedipus recognizes that every prophecy has come true and turns from the light, the moment of recognition the whole play has built toward.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: In this scene the investigator finds that he is the one he has been looking for.
Evidence: "I stand upon the perilous edge of speech" (Episode 4, line 1179)
Reasoning: The Herdsman stands "upon the perilous edge of speech", Oedipus answers "I still must hear", and his cry "all brought to pass, all true!" shows the reversal and recognition arriving together, as Aristotle says of this play.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Line 1131
1131 **Herdsman:** I was, a thrall, not purchased but home-bred.

Line 1133
1133 **Herdsman:** The best part of my life I tended sheep.

Lines 1141–1153
1141 **Messenger:** No wonder, master. But I will revive
1142 **Messenger:** His blunted memories. Sure he can recall
1143 **Messenger:** What time together both we drove our flocks,
1144 **Messenger:** He two, I one, on the Cithaeron range,
1145 **Messenger:** For three long summers; I his mate from spring
1146 **Messenger:** Till rose Arcturus; then in winter time
1147 **Messenger:** I led mine home, he his to Laius' folds.
1148 **Messenger:** Did these things happen as I say, or no?
1149 **Herdsman:** 'Tis long ago, but all thou say'st is true.
1150 **Messenger:** Well, thou mast then remember giving me
1151 **Messenger:** A child to rear as my own foster-son?
1152 **Herdsman:** Why dost thou ask this question? What of that?
1153 **Messenger:** Friend, he that stands before thee was that child.

Line 1168
1168 **Herdsman:** But, if I tell it, I am doubly lost.

Line 1179
1179 **Herdsman:** I stand upon the perilous edge of speech.

Line 1180
1180 **Oedipus:** And I of hearing, but I still must hear.

Line 1182
1182 **Herdsman:** But she within, thy consort best could tell.

Line 1197
1197 **Oedipus:** Ah me! ah me! all brought to pass, all true!

Lines 1197–1200
1197 **Oedipus:** Ah me! ah me! all brought to pass, all true!
1198 **Oedipus:** O light, may I behold thee nevermore!
1199 **Oedipus:** I stand a wretch, in birth, in wedlock cursed,
1200 **Oedipus:** A parricide, incestuously, triply cursed. Exit Oedipus.

Line 1198
1198 **Oedipus:** O light, may I behold thee nevermore!

Lines 1199–1200
1199 **Oedipus:** I stand a wretch, in birth, in wedlock cursed,
1200 **Oedipus:** A parricide, incestuously, triply cursed. Exit Oedipus.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
parricide (noun)	the killing of one's father, or the person who does it	*I stand a wretch, in birth, in wedlock cursed, A parricide, incestuously, triply cursed.*	"parricide": Origin: possibly Middle French parricide; earlier Latin parricīda. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/parricide#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. Is it ever right to force someone to tell the truth? Why or why not?
2. Where does plot appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with leadership and the city?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What does the herdsman mean by "the perilous edge of speech"? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** He is about to say something dangerous and terrible.
   Answer guidance: He is about to say something dangerous and terrible.
2. Who was the herdsman before? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A slave born in Laius' household
   Answer guidance: A slave born in Laius' household.
3. Why does the herdsman try not to answer? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** He knows the truth is terrible and dangerous
   Answer guidance: He knows the truth is terrible and dangerous.
4. How does Oedipus make him speak? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** He orders him threatened
   Answer guidance: He orders him threatened.
5. Why did the herdsman not destroy the baby? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** He pitied it
   Answer guidance: He pitied it.
6. What literary term names the moment Oedipus learns the truth? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Recognition
   Answer guidance: Recognition.
7. Retell the most important events of “Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)” in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The old herdsman of Laius, once a household slave, arrives. The Corinthian identifies him as the man who gave him the baby. The herdsman tries not to answer; Oedipus orders him threatened until he speaks. He admits that the child came from Laius' house and that the queen gave it to him to destroy because of a prophecy; he pitied it and gave it away. Oedipus recognizes the whole truth.
   Answer guidance: The old herdsman of Laius, once a household slave, arrives. The Corinthian identifies him as the man who gave him the baby. The herdsman tries not to answer; Oedipus orders him threatened until he speaks. He admits that the child came from Laius' house and that the queen gave it to him to destroy because of a prophecy; he pitied it and gave it away. Oedipus recognizes the whole truth.
8. Who is on stage in “Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
   Answer guidance: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when is “Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)” set? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
   Answer guidance: A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “I stand a wretch, in birth, in wedlock cursed, A parricide, incestuously, triply cursed.” What does “parricide” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss

briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** parricide: the killing of one's father, or the person who does it.

Answer guidance: parricide: the killing of one's father, or the person who does it.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Oedipus insist "I still must hear"? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** He is committed to the truth even if it destroys him.

   Answer guidance: He is committed to the truth even if it destroys him.
2. Why does Oedipus ask the elders to confirm the stranger's identity before he questions him? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** He has never seen the herdsman, so the elders who knew Laius's household must vouch that this is the right witness before the questioning begins.

   Answer guidance: He has never seen the herdsman, so the elders who knew Laius's household must vouch that this is the right witness before the questioning begins.
3. Why does the herdsman tell the Corinthian to hold his wanton tongue (line 1154)? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** He sees that the Corinthian is about to reveal the king's birth, and he knows that this truth will bring ruin on Oedipus and on himself.

   Answer guidance: He sees that the Corinthian is about to reveal the king's birth, and he knows that this truth will bring ruin on Oedipus and on himself.
4. Why does the herdsman say that if he tells the truth he is "doubly lost" (line 1168)? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Silence means death by the king's order, while speaking reveals a secret that ruins the king and condemns the herdsman for his own part in it.

   Answer guidance: Silence means death by the king's order, while speaking reveals a secret that ruins the king and condemns the herdsman for his own part in it.
5. Why does Oedipus cry "O light, may I behold thee nevermore!" at the end of Episode 4 (line 1198)? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** He has seen the whole truth and cannot bear to look on the world, so the play's language of light and sight now turns against the man who prided himself on seeing clearly.

   Answer guidance: He has seen the whole truth and cannot bear to look on the world, so the play's language of light and sight now turns against the man who prided himself on seeing clearly.
6. What does “Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)” suggest about the herdsman and the recognition? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Aristotle uses this play as his example of reversal: the messenger who comes to cheer Oedipus produces the opposite effect (Aristotle, ca. 335 B.C.E./1999, ch. XI). The investigator finds himself.

   Answer guidance: Aristotle uses this play as his example of reversal: the messenger who comes to cheer Oedipus produces the opposite effect (Aristotle, ca. 335 B.C.E./1999, ch. XI). The investigator finds himself. Evidence to accept: “I was, a thrall, not purchased but home-bred” (Episode 4, line 1131): The Herdsman was born enslaved in Laius's household, which is why he knows the secret and has no power to refuse. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
7. Find one example of plot in “Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)”. What does it reveal about the herdsman and the recognition that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the

previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Look for key events and the causes linking them.

Answer guidance: Look for key events and the causes linking them. Evidence to accept: “I stand upon the perilous edge of speech” (Episode 4, line 1179): The Herdsman says he is on the brink of saying something terrible, the last pause before the truth. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

8. How does the characterization in “Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)” shape what we understand about the herdsman and the recognition? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: In this scene the investigator finds that he is the one he has been looking for. Useful evidence: “I was, a thrall, not purchased but home-bred” (Episode 4, line 1131): The Herdsman was born enslaved in Laius's household, which is why he knows the secret and has no power to refuse. On characterization: The old Herdsman tries every way to avoid answering (he forgets, he begs, he warns), and his pity for the baby long ago shows a decent man trapped by his knowledge. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. In the passage that opens with “No wonder, master.”, why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: “And I of hearing, but I still must hear” (Episode 4, line 1180): Oedipus admits the danger but insists on hearing, a choice of truth over safety. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

10. What causes the main turn in “Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Look for: the herdsman's refusal to answer; the threat that forces him to speak; the effect, Oedipus's full recognition of who he is.

    Answer guidance: Look for: the herdsman's refusal to answer; the threat that forces him to speak; the effect, Oedipus's full recognition of who he is. Evidence to accept: “Ah me! ah me! all brought to pass, all true! / O light, may I behold thee nevermore! / I stand a wretch, in birth, in wedlock cursed, / A parricide, incestuously, triply cursed” (Episode 4, lines 1197–1200): Oedipus recognizes that every prophecy has come true and turns from the light, the moment of recognition the whole play has built toward. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Oedipus heroic or reckless in forcing the truth? Argue with evidence. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** He is heroic, though at great cost. The Herdsman warns that he stands "upon the perilous edge of speech" (line 1179), and Oedipus replies, "And I of hearing, but I still must hear" (line 1180): he chooses the truth knowing it may ruin him. He also orders an old enslaved man threatened, which is cruel. A strong answer weighs his courage in seeking the truth against the harm he does in forcing it.

   Answer guidance: He is heroic, though at great cost. The Herdsman warns that he stands "upon the perilous edge of speech" (line 1179), and Oedipus replies, "And I of hearing, but I still must hear" (line 1180): he chooses the truth knowing it may ruin him. He also orders an old enslaved man threatened,

which is cruel. A strong answer weighs his courage in seeking the truth against the harm he does in forcing it.

2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): Aristotle uses this play as his example of reversal: the messenger who comes to cheer Oedipus produces the opposite effect (Aristotle, ca. 335 B.C.E./1999, ch. XI). The investigator finds himself. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: In this scene the investigator finds that he is the one he has been looking for. Useful evidence: "And I of hearing, but I still must hear" (Episode 4, line 1180): Oedipus admits the danger but insists on hearing, a choice of truth over safety. Theme link: Oedipus chooses to hear the truth even when the Herdsman warns him, and the scene ends with the full recognition he has pursued since the Prologue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in "Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)" acts most wisely in the matter of the herdsman and the recognition, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: In this scene the investigator finds that he is the one he has been looking for. Useful evidence: "Ah me! ah me! all brought to pass, all true! / O light, may I behold thee nevermore! / I stand a wretch, in birth, in wedlock cursed, / A parricide, incestuously, triply cursed" (Episode 4, lines 1197–1200): Oedipus recognizes that every prophecy has come true and turns from the light, the moment of recognition the whole play has built toward. On characterization: The old Herdsman tries every way to avoid answering (he forgets, he begs, he warns), and his pity for the baby long ago shows a decent man trapped by his knowledge. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing "Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the herdsman and the recognition. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: In this scene the investigator finds that he is the one he has been looking for. Useful evidence: "I was, a thrall, not purchased but home-bred" (Episode 4, line 1131): The Herdsman was born enslaved in Laius's household, which is why he knows the secret and has no power to refuse. Theme link: Oedipus chooses to hear the truth even when the Herdsman warns him, and the scene ends with the full recognition he has pursued since the Prologue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write your own questions about "Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: In this scene the investigator finds that he is the one he has been looking for. Useful evidence: "I stand upon the perilous edge of speech" (Episode 4, line 1179): The Herdsman says he is on the brink of saying something terrible, the last pause before the truth. Theme link: Oedipus chooses to hear the truth even when the Herdsman warns him, and the scene ends with the full

recognition he has pursued since the Prologue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect "Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)", with its focus on the herdsman and the recognition, to mercy: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: In this scene the investigator finds that he is the one he has been looking for. Useful evidence: "And I of hearing, but I still must hear" (Episode 4, line 1180): Oedipus admits the danger but insists on hearing, a choice of truth over safety. Theme link: Oedipus chooses to hear the truth even when the Herdsman warns him, and the scene ends with the full recognition he has pursued since the Prologue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the plot in "Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)" effective in presenting the herdsman and the recognition, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: In this scene the investigator finds that he is the one he has been looking for. Useful evidence: "Ah me! ah me! all brought to pass, all true! / O light, may I behold thee nevermore! / I stand a wretch, in birth, in wedlock cursed, / A parricide, incestuously, triply cursed" (Episode 4, lines 1197–1200): Oedipus recognizes that every prophecy has come true and turns from the light, the moment of recognition the whole play has built toward. On plot: The Herdsman is brought in, the Corinthian identifies him as the man who handed him the infant, and step by step Oedipus forces out the answer to the question of his birth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how "Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)" treats the herdsman and the recognition with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus Rex see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: In this scene the investigator finds that he is the one he has been looking for. Useful evidence: "I was, a thrall, not purchased but home-bred" (Episode 4, line 1131): The Herdsman was born enslaved in Laius's household, which is why he knows the secret and has no power to refuse. Theme link: Oedipus chooses to hear the truth even when the Herdsman warns him, and the scene ends with the full recognition he has pursued since the Prologue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what "Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: In this scene the investigator finds that he is the one he has been looking for. Useful evidence: "I stand upon the perilous edge of speech" (Episode 4, line 1179): The Herdsman says he is on the brink of saying something terrible, the last pause before the truth. Theme link: Oedipus chooses to hear the truth even when the Herdsman warns him, and the scene ends with the full recognition he has pursued since the Prologue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of "Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)" (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the herdsman and the recognition? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2]
    Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: In this scene the investigator finds that he is the one he has been looking for. Useful evidence: "And I of hearing, but I still must hear" (Episode 4, line 1180): Oedipus admits the danger but insists on hearing, a choice of truth over safety. Theme link: Oedipus chooses to hear the truth even when the Herdsman warns him, and the scene ends with the full recognition he has pursued since the Prologue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Plot:** look for key events and the causes linking them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does the Chorus describe the herdsman when it first sees him?
    A. A simple shepherd, but an honest one
    B. A cunning and dangerous man
    C. A wealthy lord of the hills
    D. A stranger no one has seen

    Key: A (A simple shepherd, but an honest one)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where did Laius's herdsman pasture his flocks?
    A. The green plains outside the walls of Corinth
    B. Cithaeron and the nearby alps
    C. The valleys near Delphi
    D. The shore beside the sea

    Key: B (Cithaeron and the nearby alps)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Oedipus order when the herdsman will not answer?
    A. That he be given a reward
    B. That he be sent back home
    C. That he be seized and bound
    D. That he be taken to the seer

    Key: C (That he be seized and bound)
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Oedipus's cry: "Ah me! ah me! all brought to pass, all _____!"

    Key: true

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the herdsman's answer: “The best part of my life I tended _____.”

   Key: sheep

6. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What did the herdsman expect the messenger to do with the child?

   A. Raise it as a prince of Thebes

   B. Leave it on the mountain

   C. Sell it to a passing merchant

   D. Take it to his own country

   Key: D (Take it to his own country)

7. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does the herdsman beg Oedipus to ask no more?

   A. He knows the answer will ruin the king

   B. He has forgotten everything he once knew

   C. He is afraid the messenger will hurt him

   D. He wants to be paid before he speaks

   Key: A (He knows the answer will ruin the king)

8. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How does the messenger prove to the herdsman that they once knew each other?

   Sample answer: He reminds the herdsman that they drove their flocks together on Cithaeron for three summers, from spring until the rising of Arcturus, and then went home for the winter. These specific details force the herdsman to admit that the story is true. Only then does the messenger reveal that the child they exchanged is now the king.

9. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Analyze how Oedipus forces the truth out of the unwilling herdsman.

   Sample answer: When the herdsman stalls, Oedipus rebukes him, orders him seized and bound, and threatens him with death unless he speaks. Each threat pulls out one more piece of the truth: the child came from Laius's house, and the queen herself gave it away. The scene shows Oedipus using his royal power to wring out a truth that destroys him.

10. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Analyze Oedipus's final speech in the episode (lines 1197–1200).

    Sample answer: In four lines Oedipus moves from a cry of pain to a full judgment on himself. He admits that everything has come to pass and is true, turns away from the light, and calls himself cursed in birth, in marriage, and in the blood he has shed. The short, broken lines show a man who has finally solved his own riddle.

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] How did the herdsman come to serve in Laius's house?

    A. He was born a slave in the house

    B. He was bought in a market at Corinth

    C. He was captured in a war

    D. He came as a free hired man

    Key: A (He was born a slave in the house)

12. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Which star marked the end of the shepherds' season together each year?

    A. The Pleiades

    B. Arcturus

C. Orion

D. The evening star

Key: B (Arcturus)

13. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] From whom did the herdsman say he received the child?

A. Laius's chief steward

B. A priest of Apollo

C. The queen herself

D. A stranger on the way

Key: C (The queen herself)

14. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the herdsman's line: "I stand upon the perilous _____ of speech."

Key: edge

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does the herdsman say, "But, if I tell it, I am doubly lost"?

A. He has already told two different stories

B. He fears the messenger will lie about him

C. He has lost the child and cannot find it

D. Speaking will doom both him and the king

Key: D (Speaking will doom both him and the king)

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What fear led the child's mother to give it away, according to the herdsman?

A. A dread weird that he would slay his sire

B. A sickness that was sweeping the palace

C. A threat from enemies of the royal house

D. A dream that the child would steal the throne

Key: A (A dread weird that he would slay his sire)

17. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does the herdsman cry "A plague upon thee!" at the messenger?

Sample answer: He is horrified because the messenger has just revealed that the child they exchanged is Oedipus himself. The herdsman knows the child's real origin, so he understands at once what this means for the king. He tries to silence the messenger to stop a truth that he has kept hidden for many years from coming out.

18. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze the dramatic effect of the short, rapid exchanges between Oedipus and the herdsman (lines 1183–1190).

Sample answer: The lines shrink to a few words each: she gave it, to make away with it, fearing a dread weird, that he should slay his sire. The broken rhythm makes each fact land like a blow. The audience watches Oedipus pull the truth out piece by piece, and the speed of the exchange matches the speed of his fall.

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Analyze the role the messenger plays in this episode.

Sample answer: The messenger means well throughout; he wants to help the king and perhaps gain a reward. But he is the one who identifies the herdsman, revives his memory, and announces that the king is the child they exchanged. His good intentions drive the revelation forward, which makes him an innocent instrument of the disaster.

20. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Episode 4 fulfil the prophecy Teiresias spoke at the end of Episode 1?

    Sample answer: Teiresias said the murderer of Laius was here, passed for an alien but would prove a Theban, and would be shown as brother and sire to his children and son and husband to his wife. In Episode 4 the herdsman's words prove Oedipus was born in Laius's house and given away by the queen. The riddle the seer spoke is now solved, and every part points to Oedipus.

21. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the herdsman's answer: "I was, a thrall, not purchased but _____."

    Key: home-bred

22. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] For how many summers did the two shepherds share the mountain pastures?

    A. Three
    B. Two
    C. Five
    D. Seven

    Key: A (Three)

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What did the herdsman say the child was "by repute"?

    A. A slave's child
    B. Laius's own son
    C. A foundling from the hills
    D. Creon's nephew

    Key: B (Laius's own son)

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Oedipus say the herdsman's words deserve rebuke more than the messenger's?

    A. He thinks the herdsman is lying for gold
    B. He believes the messenger is a prince
    C. He sees the man is hiding something
    D. He wants to frighten the elders

    Key: C (He sees the man is hiding something)

25. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why did the herdsman hope the messenger would take the child far away?

    Sample answer: He pitied the infant and thought that if the messenger carried it to another country, the child would live and the oracle could not be fulfilled. Instead the messenger raised it to be the prince of Corinth, and the child grew up to return to Thebes. The herdsman's mercy saved the child for the worst of woes, as he says himself.

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] Which best describes the irony of Oedipus threatening the herdsman with death if he does not tell the truth?

    A. The herdsman is actually a prince in disguise
    B. The threat is a joke the elders understand
    C. The truth will set the herdsman free at once
    D. The king forces out the truth that ruins him

Key: D (The king forces out the truth that ruins him)

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Analyze Oedipus's reply "And I of hearing, but I still must hear".

    Sample answer: Oedipus answers the herdsman's fear of speaking with his own fear of hearing, but he insists that he must hear. The reply shows that he knows the danger and goes on anyway. His courage to face the truth, the same drive that made him solve the Sphinx's riddle, now leads him straight to his own ruin.

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze how the episode echoes the earlier scene in which Oedipus questioned Teiresias.

    Sample answer: In Episode 1 Oedipus forced the unwilling seer to speak by insult and threat; in Episode 4 he forces the unwilling herdsman the same way, ordering him bound. In both scenes the man who knows tries to keep silent for the king's sake, and Oedipus's anger drags out the truth. The repeated pattern shows that his own drive to know causes his fall.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Trace how the three oracles mentioned in the play are all fulfilled by the end of Episode 4.

    Sample answer: The oracle to Laius said he would die by his son's hand; the oracle to Oedipus said he would slay his father and wed his mother; the oracle to the city said the plague would end when the killer of Laius was found. The herdsman's account shows that the first two have come to pass, and it names the killer the third demanded.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How has Oedipus changed between his boast at the close of Episode 3 and his last cry in Episode 4?

    Sample answer: At the end of Episode 3 he called himself Fortune's favorite child and said no birth could shame him. At the end of Episode 4 he cries that all has come true and calls himself cursed in birth and in wedlock. The man who boasted of being Fortune's child now sees that his birth was the very source of his ruin.

31. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Oedipus's line: "His time-worn _____ matches with the years"

    Key: aspect

32. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Laius's old herdsman wish when he admits he gave away the child?

    A. That he had died that day
    B. That he had raised it himself
    C. That he had told the queen
    D. That he had left Thebes

    Key: A (That he had died that day)

33. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Laius's herdsman first claim he cannot remember the messenger?

    A. He is so old that his memory has truly failed him
    B. He hopes to avoid revealing a dangerous secret
    C. He has not seen the messenger before in his life
    D. He is angry that the messenger stole sheep

    Key: B (He hopes to avoid revealing a dangerous secret)

34. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does the herdsman tell Oedipus that "she within, thy consort best could tell"?

    Sample answer: He passes the final proof to the queen because she is the one who gave him the child. He may also be trying

to soften the blow or to avoid being the one who says it outright. The words reveal that Jocasta knew the child's fate, and they turn Oedipus's attention to the woman who has just left the stage in anguish.

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What is the effect of the herdsman's words "thou wast to misery born"?

    A. They curse the king for forcing him to speak
    B. They suggest the king's misery will soon come to an end
    C. They show his pity even as he confirms the worst
    D. They mock the king's earlier pride in his birth

    Key: C (They show his pity even as he confirms the worst)

36. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze how the episode turns the play's search into a recognition.

    Sample answer: Until now Oedipus searched for an unknown killer. In Episode 4 the search ends with recognition: the herdsman's answers show that the child given away by the queen is the king himself, and that he is the man he cursed. The hunter and the hunted become one person, and Oedipus sees his whole life in a new light.

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the significance of Oedipus's cry "O light, may I behold thee nevermore!"

    Sample answer: Light in the play has stood for knowledge and sight. Now that Oedipus finally sees the truth, he wishes never to look on the light again. The line reverses his earlier promise to make dark things clear: having brought the truth to light, he cannot bear to see it. It turns the theme of sight and blindness against the king.

38. [mc · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Which statement best describes the function of Episode 4 in the play?

    A. It introduces a new mystery about how and why Polybus died
    B. It settles the quarrel between Oedipus and Creon
    C. It shows the plague ending as the oracle promised
    D. It brings the search to its climax and reveals the truth

    Key: D (It brings the search to its climax and reveals the truth)

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate the herdsman's decision to save the infant out of pity. Was it right?

    Sample answer: His decision was humane: he could not bear to let a baby die. Yet his pity defeated the plan meant to stop the oracle, and the child he saved grew up to fulfil it. The play does not condemn his mercy, but it shows that even kind choices cannot escape fate, which makes his act both good and tragic.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does Episode 4 complete the reversal of Oedipus's role that began when he vowed to find the killer in Episode 1?

    Sample answer: In Episode 1 Oedipus spoke as judge and hunter, cursing the unknown murderer and promising to drive him out. In Episode 4 the herdsman's words show that the hunter is the murderer and that the curse falls on the king himself. The man who led the search is its object, and his own proclamation now condemns him.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 3, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 2

AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 2, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200) develops the idea of the herdsman and the recognition. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)" could deliver about the herdsman and the recognition. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the herdsman and the recognition in "Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to knowledge and blindness and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its plot shape the reader's understanding of the herdsman and the recognition. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)" could deliver about the herdsman and the recognition. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the herdsman and the recognition in "Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to knowledge and blindness and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200) suggests about the herdsman and the recognition. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's plot and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)" could deliver about the herdsman and the recognition. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the herdsman and the recognition in "Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)": each member takes one

passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to knowledge and blindness and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses plot in Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200) to complicate the reader's understanding of the herdsman and the recognition. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)" could deliver about the herdsman and the recognition. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the herdsman and the recognition in "Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to knowledge and blindness and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *No wonder, master. But I will revive His blunted memories. Sure he can recall What time together both we drove our flocks, He two, I one, on the Cithaeron range, For three long summers; I his mate from spring Till rose Arcturus; then in winter time I led mine home, he his to Laius' folds. Did these things happen as I say, or no? 'Tis long ago, but all thou say'st is true. Well, thou mast then remember giving me A child to rear as my own foster-son? Why dost thou ask this question? What of that? Friend, he that stands before thee was that child.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)"?

   A. Good news that is not good

   B. A hopeful guess

   C. A city praying for rescue

   D. The herdsman and the recognition

SAT key: 1. D (The herdsman and the recognition)

Lesson 11: Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)

Focus: the shadow of a shade

Objective: Students will analyze how theme develops in "Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.2; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Content note (mature themes): Teacher note: some schools' guidelines may treat this passage differently.
Suggested language: "What does this passage make us notice?"

Teacher only · spoilers

The Chorus mourns: human happiness is only a shadow, and Oedipus, once the greatest of men, is the proof. All-seeing Time has found him out.

Background: The play's final lines (1539–1544) make the same warning: no one should be called happy until life is over.

Significance: Oedipus becomes an example for everyone. The ode is grief, not a rule for life; the rest of the play shows Oedipus choosing to go on.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Can one person's story stand for everyone? Why might the Chorus think so? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to pride and fall because....
Prompt: Can one person's story stand for everyone? Why might the Chorus think so?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to pride and fall because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Oedipus, once the greatest of men, becomes the example that shows how quickly the highest fortune can fall.

8–18 min · Vocabulary · We do (10 min)
One key word in context.
Today's words: commingled — mixed together.
Words: commingled: mixed together

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The play's final lines (1539–1544) make the same warning: no one should be called happy until life is over. Oedipus becomes an example for everyone. The ode is grief, not a rule for life; the rest of the play shows Oedipus choosing to go on. Theme: The ode draws a general lesson from Oedipus's fall: human happiness is only an appearance, and no fortune is secure. Imagery: The elders picture human life as "the shadow of a shade" and happiness as a vision that pales and fades, images of something unreal and short-lived. Tone / mood: The tone is mournful and reflective; the elders grieve for a man they once honored as the city's savior. Watch for the shadow of a shade: A shadow cast by a ghost is the least solid thing imaginable, so the image makes human happiness seem almost unreal.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade" slowly and put it in my own words: In these lines Chorus speaks at a turning point of the section, which is about the shadow of a shade. Next, craft. I notice how the lines use theme, imagery to make the audience feel the pressure of the moment on Chorus. The strongest word is "mortal": the word "mortal" carries the weight of the lines and points to the section's big idea. Then, effect. What do lines 1201–1203 reveal about the shadow of a shade? My answer: Oedipus becomes an example for everyone. The ode is grief, not a rule for life; the rest of the play shows Oedipus choosing to go on. These lines show the shadow of a shade, and that matters for what follows in the play.

> *Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade (Stasimon 4, lines 1201–1203)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade" slowly and put it in my own words: In these lines Chorus speaks at a turning point of the section, which is about the shadow of a shade. Next, craft. I notice how the lines use theme, imagery to make the audience feel the pressure of the moment on Chorus. The strongest word is "mortal": the word "mortal" carries the weight of the lines and points to the section's big idea. Then, effect. What do lines 1201–1203 reveal about the shadow of a shade? My answer: Oedipus becomes an example for everyone. The ode is grief, not a rule for life; the rest of the play shows Oedipus choosing to go on. These lines show the shadow of a shade, and that matters for what follows in the play.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "All-seeing", "caught" and "justice" stand out. Time is pictured as a watcher that has caught the guilty, so the elders see the hidden truth exposed at last and brought to judgment. Ask: How does this line connect to pride and fall? Expected student answer: Oedipus, once the greatest of men, becomes the example that shows how quickly the highest fortune can fall. (Time is pictured as an all-seeing judge that brings hidden wrongs to light, however long it takes.)

> *All-seeing Time hath caught / Guilt, and to justice brought / The son and sire commingled in one bed*
> *(Stasimon 4, lines 1225–1227)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "All-seeing", "caught" and "justice" stand out. Time is pictured as a watcher that has caught the guilty, so the elders see the hidden truth exposed at last and brought to judgment.
Ask: How does this line connect to pride and fall?
Expected student answer: Oedipus, once the greatest of men, becomes the example that shows how quickly the highest fortune can fall. (Time is pictured as an all-seeing judge that brings hidden wrongs to light, however long it takes.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for theme, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the shadow of a shade? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232) develops the idea of the shadow of a shade. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The ode turns Oedipus's fall into a lesson about all human happiness, but it speaks in grief, not as the play's final word. When the text says "Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade" (Stasimon 4, lines 1201–1203), it shows this directly. The elders call mortals "the shadow of a shade" and say happiness has "but the show", yet the rest of the play shows Oedipus choosing to act and speak after the recognition.
Task: Annotate the scene for theme, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the shadow of a shade? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232) develops the idea of the shadow of a shade. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The ode turns Oedipus's fall into a lesson about all human happiness, but it speaks in grief, not as the play's final word. When the text says "Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade" (Stasimon 4, lines 1201–1203), it shows this directly. The elders call mortals "the shadow of a shade" and say happiness has "but the show", yet the rest of the play shows Oedipus choosing to act and speak after the recognition.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Can one person's story stand for everyone? Why might the Chorus think so? Ask: Can one person's story stand for everyone? Why might the Chorus think so?
Anchor question: Can one person's story stand for everyone? Why might the Chorus think so?
Facilitation: Ask: Can one person's story stand for everyone? Why might the Chorus think so?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the shadow of a shade? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The ode turns Oedipus's fall into a lesson about all human happiness, but it speaks in grief, not as the play's final word. ("Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade", Stasimon 4, lines 1201–1203). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the shadow of a shade? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The ode turns Oedipus's fall into a lesson about all human happiness, but it speaks in grief, not as the play's final word. ("Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade", Stasimon 4, lines 1201–1203). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how theme shapes the shadow of a shade. Key takeaway: Oedipus, once the greatest of men, becomes the example that shows how quickly the highest fortune can fall.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Theme:** The ode draws a general lesson from Oedipus's fall: human happiness is only an appearance, and no fortune is secure.
- **Imagery:** The elders picture human life as "the shadow of a shade" and happiness as a vision that pales and fades, images of something unreal and short-lived.
- **Tone / mood:** The tone is mournful and reflective; the elders grieve for a man they once honored as the city's savior.

Themes and how they develop

- **pride and fall:** Oedipus, once the greatest of men, becomes the example that shows how quickly the highest fortune can fall.

Symbols and motifs

- **the shadow of a shade:** A shadow cast by a ghost is the least solid thing imaginable, so the image makes human happiness seem almost unreal.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade" (Stasimon 4, lines 1201–1203) The Chorus calls human life brief and unreal, drawing a lesson for all people from one man's fall.
- "All-seeing Time hath caught / Guilt, and to justice brought / The son and sire commingled in one bed" (Stasimon 4, lines 1225–1227) Time is pictured as an all-seeing judge that brings hidden wrongs to light, however long it takes.
- "Of bliss, hath but the show; / A moment, and the visions pale and fade" (Stasimon 4, lines 1205–1206) Happiness is only an appearance that vanishes, the ode's central claim about human life.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The ode turns Oedipus's fall into a lesson about all human happiness, but it speaks in grief, not as the play's final word.
Evidence: "Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade" (Stasimon 4, lines 1201–1203)
Reasoning: The elders call mortals "the shadow of a shade" and say happiness has "but the show", yet the rest of the play shows Oedipus choosing to act and speak after the recognition.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 1201–1203
1201 **Chorus:** Races of mortal man
1202 **Chorus:** Whose life is but a span,
1203 **Chorus:** I count ye but the shadow of a shade!

Lines 1201–1216
1201 **Chorus:** Races of mortal man
1202 **Chorus:** Whose life is but a span,
1203 **Chorus:** I count ye but the shadow of a shade!
1204 **Chorus:** For he who most doth know
1205 **Chorus:** Of bliss, hath but the show;
1206 **Chorus:** A moment, and the visions pale and fade.
1207 **Chorus:** Thy fall, O Oedipus, thy piteous fall
1208 **Chorus:** Warns me none born of women blest to call.
1209 **Chorus:** For he of marksmen best,
1210 **Chorus:** O Zeus, outshot the rest,
1211 **Chorus:** And won the prize supreme of wealth and power.
1212 **Chorus:** By him the vulture maid
1213 **Chorus:** Was quelled, her witchery laid;

1214 **Chorus:** He rose our saviour and the land's strong tower.
1215 **Chorus:** We hailed thee king and from that day adored
1216 **Chorus:** Of mighty Thebes the universal lord.

Line 1202
1202 **Chorus:** Whose life is but a span,

Lines 1205–1206
1205 **Chorus:** Of bliss, hath but the show;
1206 **Chorus:** A moment, and the visions pale and fade.

Line 1206
1206 **Chorus:** A moment, and the visions pale and fade.

Lines 1209–1211
1209 **Chorus:** For he of marksmen best,
1210 **Chorus:** O Zeus, outshot the rest,
1211 **Chorus:** And won the prize supreme of wealth and power.

Lines 1212–1213
1212 **Chorus:** By him the vulture maid
1213 **Chorus:** Was quelled, her witchery laid;

Lines 1218–1219
1218 **Chorus:** Who now more desolate,
1219 **Chorus:** Whose tale more sad than thine, whose lot more dire?

Line 1221
1221 **Chorus:** Thy cradle was thy marriage bed;

Line 1222
1222 **Chorus:** One harbourage sufficed for son and sire.

Lines 1225–1227
1225 **Chorus:** All-seeing Time hath caught
1226 **Chorus:** Guilt, and to justice brought
1227 **Chorus:** The son and sire commingled in one bed.

Vocabulary

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context
commingled (adjective)	mixed together	*All-seeing Time hath caught Guilt, and to justice brought The son and sire commingled in one bed.*

Discussion questions

1. Can one person's story stand for everyone? Why might the Chorus think so?
2. Where does theme appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with mercy?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What is "a span" in line 1202? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A very short length: life is brief.
   Answer guidance: A very short length: life is brief.
2. What does the Chorus say the king's fall warns it against? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Calling any mortal blest
   Answer guidance: Calling any mortal blest.
3. Who is the Chorus's example? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Oedipus
   Answer guidance: Oedipus.
4. What has "All-seeing Time" done? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Brought the hidden guilt to light
   Answer guidance: Brought the hidden guilt to light.
5. What is the tone of the ode? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Mournful
   Answer guidance: Mournful.
6. According to the lesson's Significance note, how is the ode framed? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** As the grief of the Chorus at this moment, open to debate against the ending
   Answer guidance: As the grief of the Chorus at this moment, open to debate against the ending.
7. Retell the most important events of “Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)” in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The Chorus mourns: human happiness is only a shadow, and Oedipus, once the greatest of men, is the proof. All-seeing Time has found him out.
   Answer guidance: The Chorus mourns: human happiness is only a shadow, and Oedipus, once the greatest of men, is the proof. All-seeing Time has found him out.
8. Who is on stage in “Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
   Answer guidance: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.

9. Where and when is “Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)” set? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
   Answer guidance: A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “All-seeing Time hath caught Guilt, and to justice brought The son and sire commingled in one bed.” What does “commingled” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** commingled: mixed together.
    Answer guidance: commingled: mixed together.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why do the elders call Time "all-seeing"? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Time reveals what people hide.
   Answer guidance: Time reveals what people hide.
2. What does “Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)” suggest about the shadow of a shade? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Oedipus becomes an example for everyone. The ode is grief, not a rule for life; the rest of the play shows Oedipus choosing to go on.
   Answer guidance: Oedipus becomes an example for everyone. The ode is grief, not a rule for life; the rest of the play shows Oedipus choosing to go on. Evidence to accept: “Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade” (Stasimon 4, lines 1201–1203): The Chorus calls human life brief and unreal, drawing a lesson for all people from one man's fall. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
3. Find one example of theme in “Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)”. What does it reveal about the shadow of a shade that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
   Answer guidance: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas. Evidence to accept: “All-seeing Time hath caught / Guilt, and to justice brought / The son and sire commingled in one bed” (Stasimon 4, lines 1225–1227): Time is pictured as an all-seeing judge that brings hidden wrongs to light, however long it takes. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
4. How does the imagery in “Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)” shape what we understand about the shadow of a shade? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode turns Oedipus's fall into a lesson about all human happiness, but it speaks in grief, not as the play's final word. Useful evidence: “Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade” (Stasimon 4, lines 1201–1203): The Chorus calls human life brief and unreal, drawing a lesson for all people from one man's fall. On imagery: The elders picture human life as "the shadow of a shade" and happiness as a vision that pales and fades, images of something unreal and short-lived. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that opens with “Races of mortal man Whose life is but a span, I count ye but the shadow of a shade!”, why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their

connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: “Of bliss, hath but the show; / A moment, and the visions pale and fade” (Stasimon 4, lines 1205–1206): Happiness is only an appearance that vanishes, the ode's central claim about human life. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

6. What causes the main turn in “Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Look for: happiness described as a shadow; Oedipus as the proof; the effect, a turn from one man's fall to a lesson about all people.

   Answer guidance: Look for: happiness described as a shadow; Oedipus as the proof; the effect, a turn from one man's fall to a lesson about all people. Evidence to accept: “Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade” (Stasimon 4, lines 1201–1203): The Chorus calls human life brief and unreal, drawing a lesson for all people from one man's fall. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

7. How does “Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)” build on “Episode 4 (lines 1115–1200)”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode turns Oedipus's fall into a lesson about all human happiness, but it speaks in grief, not as the play's final word. Useful evidence: “All-seeing Time hath caught / Guilt, and to justice brought / The son and sire commingled in one bed” (Stasimon 4, lines 1225–1227): Time is pictured as an all-seeing judge that brings hidden wrongs to light, however long it takes. Theme link: Oedipus, once the greatest of men, becomes the example that shows how quickly the highest fortune can fall. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. In “Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)”, what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about the shadow of a shade, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode turns Oedipus's fall into a lesson about all human happiness, but it speaks in grief, not as the play's final word. Useful evidence: “Of bliss, hath but the show; / A moment, and the visions pale and fade” (Stasimon 4, lines 1205–1206): Happiness is only an appearance that vanishes, the ode's central claim about human life. Theme link: Oedipus, once the greatest of men, becomes the example that shows how quickly the highest fortune can fall. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (Can one person's story stand for everyone? Why might the Chorus think so?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.

   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: “All-seeing Time hath caught / Guilt, and to justice brought / The son and sire commingled in one bed” (Stasimon 4, lines 1225–1227): Time is pictured as an all-seeing judge that brings hidden wrongs to light, however long it takes. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

10. Where does tone / mood appear in “Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)”, and how does it connect the shadow of a shade to the larger concern with mercy? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Look for word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode turns Oedipus's fall into a lesson about all human happiness, but it speaks in grief, not as the play's final word. Useful evidence: “Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade” (Stasimon 4, lines 1201–1203): The Chorus calls human life brief and unreal, drawing a lesson for all people from one man's fall. On tone / mood: The tone is mournful and reflective; the elders grieve for a man they once honored as the city's savior. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is this ode the play's view of life? Compare it with the ending. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** No, the ode is grief at one moment, not the whole view of the play. The elders call mortals "the shadow of a shade" (line 1203) and say happiness has "but the show" (line 1205). In the Exodos, though, Oedipus speaks, takes responsibility and cares for his daughters, so the play goes on past despair. A strong answer compares the ode with that ending.
    Answer guidance: No, the ode is grief at one moment, not the whole view of the play. The elders call mortals "the shadow of a shade" (line 1203) and say happiness has "but the show" (line 1205). In the Exodos, though, Oedipus speaks, takes responsibility and cares for his daughters, so the play goes on past despair. A strong answer compares the ode with that ending.
2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): Oedipus becomes an example for everyone. The ode is grief, not a rule for life; the rest of the play shows Oedipus choosing to go on. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode turns Oedipus's fall into a lesson about all human happiness, but it speaks in grief, not as the play's final word. Useful evidence: “Of bliss, hath but the show; / A moment, and the visions pale and fade” (Stasimon 4, lines 1205–1206): Happiness is only an appearance that vanishes, the ode's central claim about human life. On theme: The ode draws a general lesson from Oedipus's fall: human happiness is only an appearance, and no fortune is secure. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in “Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)” acts most wisely in the matter of the shadow of a shade, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode turns Oedipus's fall into a lesson about all human happiness, but it speaks in grief, not as the play's final word. Useful evidence: “Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade” (Stasimon 4, lines 1201–1203): The Chorus calls human life brief and unreal, drawing a lesson for all people from one man's fall. Theme link: Oedipus, once the greatest of men, becomes the example that shows how quickly the highest fortune can

fall. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing "Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the shadow of a shade. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode turns Oedipus's fall into a lesson about all human happiness, but it speaks in grief, not as the play's final word. Useful evidence: "All-seeing Time hath caught / Guilt, and to justice brought / The son and sire commingled in one bed" (Stasimon 4, lines 1225–1227): Time is pictured as an all-seeing judge that brings hidden wrongs to light, however long it takes. Theme link: Oedipus, once the greatest of men, becomes the example that shows how quickly the highest fortune can fall. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write your own questions about "Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode turns Oedipus's fall into a lesson about all human happiness, but it speaks in grief, not as the play's final word. Useful evidence: "Of bliss, hath but the show; / A moment, and the visions pale and fade" (Stasimon 4, lines 1205–1206): Happiness is only an appearance that vanishes, the ode's central claim about human life. On theme: The ode draws a general lesson from Oedipus's fall: human happiness is only an appearance, and no fortune is secure. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect "Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)", with its focus on the shadow of a shade, to knowledge and blindness: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode turns Oedipus's fall into a lesson about all human happiness, but it speaks in grief, not as the play's final word. Useful evidence: "Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade" (Stasimon 4, lines 1201–1203): The Chorus calls human life brief and unreal, drawing a lesson for all people from one man's fall. On theme: The ode draws a general lesson from Oedipus's fall: human happiness is only an appearance, and no fortune is secure. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the theme in "Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)" effective in presenting the shadow of a shade, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode turns Oedipus's fall into a lesson about all human happiness, but it speaks in grief, not as the play's final word. Useful evidence: "All-seeing Time hath caught / Guilt, and to justice brought / The son and sire commingled in one bed" (Stasimon 4, lines 1225–1227): Time is pictured as an all-seeing judge that brings hidden wrongs to light, however long it takes. On

theme: The ode draws a general lesson from Oedipus's fall: human happiness is only an appearance, and no fortune is secure. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how "Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)" treats the shadow of a shade with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus Rex see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode turns Oedipus's fall into a lesson about all human happiness, but it speaks in grief, not as the play's final word. Useful evidence: "Of bliss, hath but the show; / A moment, and the visions pale and fade" (Stasimon 4, lines 1205–1206): Happiness is only an appearance that vanishes, the ode's central claim about human life. On theme: The ode draws a general lesson from Oedipus's fall: human happiness is only an appearance, and no fortune is secure. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what "Exodos (lines 1233–1544)" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode turns Oedipus's fall into a lesson about all human happiness, but it speaks in grief, not as the play's final word. Useful evidence: "Races of mortal man / Whose life is but a span, / I count ye but the shadow of a shade" (Stasimon 4, lines 1201–1203): The Chorus calls human life brief and unreal, drawing a lesson for all people from one man's fall. Theme link: Oedipus, once the greatest of men, becomes the example that shows how quickly the highest fortune can fall. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of "Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)" (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the shadow of a shade? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ode turns Oedipus's fall into a lesson about all human happiness, but it speaks in grief, not as the play's final word. Useful evidence: "All-seeing Time hath caught / Guilt, and to justice brought / The son and sire commingled in one bed" (Stasimon 4, lines 1225–1227): Time is pictured as an all-seeing judge that brings hidden wrongs to light, however long it takes. On theme: The ode draws a general lesson from Oedipus's fall: human happiness is only an appearance, and no fortune is secure. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Theme:** look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Stasimon 4, by what name does the Chorus remember the monster that Oedipus defeated?
   A. The vulture maid
   B. The winged lioness
   C. The singing beast
   D. The riddling queen

   Key: A (The vulture maid)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which god does the Chorus call on when it recalls Oedipus's skill as a marksman?
   A. Apollo
   B. Zeus
   C. Ares
   D. Hades

   Key: B (Zeus)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the Chorus say Oedipus won by outshooting the rest?
   A. A crown of laurel from the Delphic games
   B. The hand of a princess from far-off Corinth
   C. The prize supreme of wealth and power
   D. A temple built in his honour by the city

   Key: C (The prize supreme of wealth and power)
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the line: "Thy fall, O Oedipus, thy _____ fall"

   Key: piteous
5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the line: "I raise for thee a _____ as o'er the dead."

   Key: dirge
6. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Why does the Chorus say no one born of women should be called blest?
   A. The gods have cursed every family in Thebes
   B. Women have brought ruin on the royal house
   C. The plague has killed the happiest citizens
   D. Oedipus's fall shows joy can vanish

   Key: D (Oedipus's fall shows joy can vanish)
7. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] What does the Chorus mean by calling Oedipus a "discrownèd head"?
   A. He has lost his standing as a king
   B. He has given his crown to his son
   C. He was crowned for only a day
   D. He has hidden his crown from Creon

   Key: A (He has lost his standing as a king)

8. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Stasimon 4 look back to the day when Oedipus saved Thebes?

   Sample answer: The Chorus remembers how Oedipus outshot every rival, defeated the vulture maid and became the saviour of Thebes. Recalling that glory makes his present ruin seem even greater. The memory shows how high he stood before his fall, which supports the ode's point that no mortal can be sure of happiness.

9. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Analyze the contrast between the two halves of the ode.

   Sample answer: The first half looks back on Oedipus's greatness: his skill, his defeat of the Sphinx and the city's love for its king. The second half turns to the present, crying out against the heavy hand of fate and the horror of his marriage. Placing glory and ruin side by side makes the fall feel sudden and complete.

10. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the image "Thy cradle was thy marriage bed" (line 1221).

    Sample answer: The image joins the beginning of Oedipus's life with his marriage in a single place. The house and bed he was born into are the ones he married into, so the line states the horror of his union in a few plain words. Its shortness and its rhyme make the terrible fact impossible for the audience to ignore.

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does the Chorus wish about Oedipus's face?

    A. That it had never seen it
    B. That it could see it once more
    C. That it might be veiled from the gods
    D. That it would shine again with joy

    Key: A (That it had never seen it)

12. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does the Chorus say Oedipus became for the land after defeating the Sphinx?

    A. Its high priest and its prophet
    B. Its saviour and strong tower
    C. Its lawgiver and its stern judge
    D. Its general in time of war

    Key: B (Its saviour and strong tower)

13. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Whose soil does the Chorus say has borne Oedipus's wrong in silence?

    A. Creon's
    B. Polybus's
    C. His father's
    D. The herdsman's

    Key: C (His father's)

14. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the cry: "O heavy hand of _____!"

    Key: fate

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the Chorus mean when it says it "drew new breath" through Oedipus?

    A. He taught the elders how to sing
    B. He healed the Chorus of an old wound
    C. He brought fresh air to the stricken palace

D. He once saved the city and revived it

Key: D (He once saved the city and revived it)

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Which best describes the Chorus's feeling toward Oedipus in this ode?

A. Pity mixed with horror

B. Scorn and quiet satisfaction

C. Fear that he will punish them

D. Indifference to what happens

Key: A (Pity mixed with horror)

17. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Why does the Chorus raise a dirge "as o'er the dead" for a king who is still alive?

Sample answer: A dirge is a song for the dead, and the Chorus feels that the Oedipus it knew is gone. His greatness, his crown and his good name have been destroyed by the truth. Mourning him as if he had died shows how complete his ruin seems to the elders, even though he still lives.

18. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the archery image in lines 1209–1211.

Sample answer: The Chorus calls Oedipus the best of marksmen, who outshot the rest and won the prize supreme of wealth and power. The image turns his rise into a contest that he won by skill and aim. Recalling his success in such vivid terms makes the fall that follows seem even sharper and more painful to the audience.

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Analyze the Chorus's question about the soil Oedipus's father tilled (lines 1223–1224).

Sample answer: The Chorus asks how the land that Laius ploughed for so long could bear such a wrong in silence. The question gives the earth feeling, as if it should have cried out against the crime. It suggests that the wrong was so unnatural that even nature seemed to share in hiding it for many years.

20. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Compare the Chorus's view of Oedipus in Stasimon 4 with its hopes in Stasimon 3.

Sample answer: In Stasimon 3 the Chorus imagined that Oedipus might be the child of a god and planned to celebrate the mountain as his nurse. In Stasimon 4 it calls him the child of Laius's ill-starred race and mourns him. The hope of a glorious birth has turned into grief over a cursed one, a complete reversal in a single scene.

21. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the lines: "By him the vulture maid Was quelled, her _____ laid;"

Key: witchery

22. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] How does the Chorus describe the family of Laius in this ode?

A. An ill-starred race

B. A blessed house

C. A line of proud tyrants

D. A race of heroes

Key: A (An ill-starred race)

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does the Chorus say Thebes did "from that day" after Oedipus became king?

A. Feared him as a stern master

B. Adored him as universal lord

C. Doubted his right to the throne of Thebes

D. Asked him to marry the queen

Key: B (Adored him as universal lord)

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Why does the Chorus describe Oedipus as the best of marksmen?

A. He was famous as a hunter in the hills

B. He won an archery contest at Delphi

C. His wit hit a mark the others missed

D. He killed the Sphinx with a single arrow

Key: C (His wit hit a mark the others missed)

25. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the Chorus mean by "One harbourage sufficed for son and sire"?

Sample answer: A harbourage is a shelter or haven. The Chorus means that the same bed, and the same woman, received both Laius and his son Oedipus. The line names the unnatural marriage indirectly, through an image of a harbour that should have held only one, which lets the elders speak of a horror they can hardly bear to say plainly.

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Which device does the Chorus use in asking "Who now more desolate, Whose tale more sad than thine?"

A. Onomatopoeia

B. Personification

C. An extended metaphor

D. Rhetorical question

Key: D (Rhetorical question)

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze the effect of the ode's final couplet (lines 1231–1232).

Sample answer: The couplet balances two lines built on the same phrase, through thee: once the Chorus drew new breath through Oedipus, and now it feels a second death. The parallel shows that the same man brought the city both life and ruin. Ending on death leaves the elders' grief as the last word of the ode.

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze how the ode moves from a statement about all humanity to the case of Oedipus.

Sample answer: The ode opens with the races of mortal man and the claim that bliss is only a show that fades in a moment. It then names Oedipus as the warning that proves the claim. Moving from the general to the particular turns one man's story into a lesson about all human life, which is how the Chorus makes sense of the disaster.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Trace how the image of Oedipus as saviour changes from the Prologue to Stasimon 4.

Sample answer: In the Prologue the Priest begs Oedipus, who once freed Thebes from the Sphinx, to be the city's saviour again. In Stasimon 4 the Chorus recalls that he rose as saviour and strong tower, but only to mourn him. The saviour the city trusted has been revealed as the source of its pollution, and the title now measures his fall.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Stasimon 4 answer the Chorus's prayer in Stasimon 2 that the oracles be proved true?

Sample answer: In Stasimon 2 the Chorus feared that if the oracles failed, the worship of the gods would wither, and it

prayed for them to be fulfilled. In Stasimon 4 it learns that they have come true in the worst possible way. Its prayer has been answered, but the answer is the ruin of the king it loved.

31. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: "A moment, and the visions pale and _____."
    Key: fade

32. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does the Chorus say it now feels through Oedipus?
    A. A second death
    B. A new hope
    C. A deep rage
    D. A sudden and strange calm

    Key: A (A second death)

33. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the Chorus imply by saying the happiest man "hath but the show" of bliss?
    A. Happy men hide their joy from the gods
    B. Happiness is only an outward look
    C. Only kings can know true happiness
    D. Joy is a show that kings put on for crowds

    Key: B (Happiness is only an outward look)

34. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does the Chorus's wish that it had never seen Oedipus's face suggest about its relationship with him?
    Sample answer: The wish shows how closely the elders tied themselves to their king. They loved and trusted him, and now his ruin feels like their own. Wishing they had never seen him is a way of wishing the whole bond away, which reveals both their horror at the truth and the depth of the loyalty they once gave him.

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What is the effect of the Chorus addressing Oedipus directly through much of the ode?
    A. It shows that the elders are giving orders to him
    B. It suggests they believe he cannot hear them
    C. It makes the lament personal and intimate
    D. It marks the ode as a prayer to a god

    Key: C (It makes the lament personal and intimate)

36. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze the shift in the ode from "We hailed thee king" to "O heavy hand of fate!"
    Sample answer: The first phrase ends a stanza of memory, in which the city adored its lord; the second opens a stanza of lament. The sudden cry breaks off the praise and names fate as the force that has crushed him. The turn marks the line between Oedipus's past glory and his present ruin, and it shapes the ode around that fall.

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] Analyze the irony of the Chorus calling Oedipus the land's "strong tower" in an ode of mourning.
    Sample answer: A tower protects a city, and Oedipus once did protect Thebes by defeating the Sphinx. Yet the truth now shows that the plague came because of him, so the tower was also the danger. The praise, sung in a lament, carries a bitter irony: the man who guarded the city was the source of its suffering all along.

38. [mc · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What role does Stasimon 4 play at this point in the drama?
    A. It predicts a happy ending for the royal house

B. It retells the events of the plague in detail

C. It argues that the oracles were false all along

D. It mourns the truth before the final scene

Key: D (It mourns the truth before the final scene)

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate the Chorus's claim that no one born of women should be called blest. Does one man's fall justify it?

Sample answer: The claim goes beyond the evidence, since one man's fall cannot prove a rule for everyone. Yet Oedipus was the most fortunate and gifted of men, so if he can fall, the Chorus reasons, no one is safe. The claim is persuasive as an expression of grief and fear, though it is a judgment made in the moment rather than a proof.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Stasimon 4 reverse the Chorus's praise of Oedipus in Stasimon 1?

Sample answer: In Stasimon 1 the Chorus refused to believe the seer and recalled how Oedipus proved true, like tested gold, when he saved the city. In Stasimon 4 it recalls the same victory only to mourn the man who won it. The loyalty that once defended him now expresses grief, and the old praise becomes a measure of how far he has fallen.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 3, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 2
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 2, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.2; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232) develops the idea of the shadow of a shade. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.2; W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)” could deliver about the shadow of a shade. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.2; W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the shadow of a shade in “Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to knowledge and blindness and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its theme shape the reader's understanding of the shadow of a shade. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)” could deliver about the shadow of a shade.

Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the shadow of a shade in "Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to knowledge and blindness and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232) suggests about the shadow of a shade. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's theme and imagery), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)" could deliver about the shadow of a shade. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the shadow of a shade in "Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to knowledge and blindness and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses theme in Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232) to complicate the reader's understanding of the shadow of a shade. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)" could deliver about the shadow of a shade. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the shadow of a shade in "Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to knowledge and blindness and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Races of mortal man Whose life is but a span, I count ye but the shadow of a shade! For he who most doth know Of bliss, hath but the show; A moment, and the visions pale and fade. Thy fall, O Oedipus, thy piteous fall Warns me none born of women blest to call. For he of marksmen best, O Zeus, outshot the rest, And won the prize supreme of wealth and power. By him the vulture maid Was quelled, her witchery laid; He rose our saviour and the land's strong tower. We hailed thee king and from that day adored Of mighty Thebes the universal lord.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)"?

   A. The curse and the prophet

B. Pride breeds the tyrant

C. The shadow of a shade

D. A king who promises to find the killer

SAT key: 1. C (The shadow of a shade)

Lesson 12: Exodos (lines 1233–1544)

Focus: responsibility, mercy and the end

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in "Exodos (lines 1233–1544)" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Content note (suicide or self-harm (reported), alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): Teacher note: some schools' guidelines may treat this passage differently. Cite method lines by number only. This section mentions drinking or a drug ("…ver sat beside me at the board Sharing my viands, drinking of my cup, For them, I pray thee, care,…"). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Suggested language: "What does the play show about the cost of this loss?"

Teacher only · spoilers

A second messenger reports offstage events at the palace. The blinded Oedipus enters and laments. He names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent (lines 1343–1346; the blinding is self-harm reported offstage, taught as drama with context), and accepts the guilt as his alone to bear (lines 1418–1420). Creon arrives, does not mock him, and brings his daughters to him. Oedipus asks to be sent into exile and commends his daughters to Creon. The Chorus ends: count no one happy until his life is over.

Background: In Greek tragedy violent events happen offstage and are reported. Suicide-method lines (1278–1281, Jocasta) are cited by line number only and never quoted or asked about; the self-blinding may be quoted and taught as drama with context.

Significance: Oedipus takes responsibility while naming fate. Creon's restraint models mercy. The ending is grief with care, not despair.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What does it mean to take responsibility for something you did not intend? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and responsibility because....
Prompt: What does it mean to take responsibility for something you did not intend?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to fate and responsibility because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Oedipus names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent, and he insists that the guilt is his alone to bear.

8–18 min · Vocabulary · We do (10 min)
One key word in context.
Today's words: derision — mockery; scornful laughter.
Words: derision: mockery; scornful laughter

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
In Greek tragedy violent events happen offstage and are reported. Suicide-method lines (1278–1281, Jocasta) are cited by line number only and never quoted or asked about; the self-blinding may be quoted and taught as drama with context. Oedipus takes responsibility while naming fate. Creon's restraint models mercy. The ending is grief with care, not despair. Characterization: In the Exodos Oedipus is changed: he still speaks with force, but he now accepts the guilt as his own, asks for exile, and speaks to his daughters with tenderness. Theme: The ending holds two ideas together: Apollo brought the disaster to pass, and Oedipus's own hand acted, so fate and responsibility are both kept in view. Structure: The Exodos begins with a messenger's report of offstage events, continues with Oedipus's laments and his exchange with Creon, and ends with the Chorus's warning to count no one happy until life is over. Watch for sight and blindness: At the end, the man who mocked a blind prophet speaks of the truth he now sees, closing the play's long pattern of sight and understanding.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Not Ister nor all Phasis' flood, I ween, / Could wash away the blood-stains from this house, / The ills it shrouds or soon will bring to..." slowly and put it in my own words: In these lines Second Messenger speaks at a turning point of the section, which is about responsibility, mercy and the end. Next, craft. I notice how the lines use characterization, theme to make the audience feel the pressure of the moment on Second Messenger. The strongest word is "unwittingly": the word "unwittingly" carries the weight of the lines and points to the section's big idea. Then, effect. What do lines 1237–1240 reveal about responsibility, mercy and the end? My answer: Oedipus takes responsibility while naming fate. Creon's restraint models mercy. The ending is grief with care, not despair. These lines show responsibility, mercy and the end, and that matters for what follows in the play.

> *Not Ister nor all Phasis' flood, I ween, / Could wash away the blood-stains from this house, / The ills it shrouds or soon will bring to light, / Ills wrought of malice, not unwittingly* (Exodos, lines 1237–1240)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Not Ister nor all Phasis' flood, I ween, / Could wash away the blood-stains from this house, / The ills it shrouds or soon will bring to…" slowly and put it in my own words: In these lines Second Messenger speaks at a turning point of the section, which is about responsibility, mercy and the end. Next, craft. I notice how the lines use characterization, theme to make the audience feel the pressure of the moment on Second Messenger. The strongest word is "unwittingly": the word "unwittingly" carries the weight of the lines and points to the section's big idea. Then, effect. What do lines 1237–1240 reveal about responsibility, mercy and the end? My answer: Oedipus takes responsibility while naming fate. Creon's restraint models mercy. The ending is grief with care, not despair. These lines show responsibility, mercy and the end, and that matters for what follows in the play.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Apollo", "right hand" and "mine" stand out. Oedipus names the god as the cause of his suffering but claims the blow as his own act, so he accepts responsibility even while he sees fate at work. Ask: How does this line connect to fate and responsibility? Expected student answer: Oedipus names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent, and he insists that the guilt is his alone to bear. (Oedipus holds both the god and himself responsible, the play's clearest statement of fate and responsibility together.)

> *Apollo, friend, Apollo, he it was / That brought these ills to pass; / But the right hand that dealt the blow / Was mine, none other (Exodos, lines 1343–1346)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Apollo", "right hand" and "mine" stand out. Oedipus names the god as the cause of his suffering but claims the blow as his own act, so he accepts responsibility even while he sees fate at work.
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and responsibility?
Expected student answer: Oedipus names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent, and he insists that the guilt is his alone to bear. (Oedipus holds both the god and himself responsible, the play's clearest statement of fate and responsibility together.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, theme (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about responsibility, mercy and the end? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Exodos (lines 1233–1544) develops the idea of responsibility, mercy and the end. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The Exodos shows Oedipus taking responsibility for his acts while still naming the god's part in them. When the text says "Not in derision, Oedipus, I come / Nor to upbraid thee with thy past misdeeds" (Exodos, lines 1427–1428), it shows this directly. He says "Apollo ... brought these ills to pass; / But the right hand ... / Was mine", and he asks others to draw near because he alone "must bear / The load of guilt", while Creon comes "Not in derision", so the ending joins guilt and mercy.
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, theme (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about responsibility, mercy and the end? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Exodos (lines 1233–1544) develops the idea of responsibility, mercy and the end. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The Exodos shows Oedipus taking responsibility for his acts while still naming the god's part in them. When the text says "Not in derision, Oedipus, I come / Nor to upbraid thee with thy past misdeeds" (Exodos, lines 1427–1428), it shows this directly. He says "Apollo ... brought these ills to pass; / But the right hand ... / Was mine", and he asks others to draw near because he alone "must bear / The load of guilt", while Creon comes "Not in derision", so the ending joins guilt and mercy.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: What does it mean to take responsibility for something you did not intend? Ask: What does it mean to take responsibility for something you did not intend?
Anchor question: What does it mean to take responsibility for something you did not intend?
Facilitation: Ask: What does it mean to take responsibility for something you did not intend?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about responsibility, mercy and the end? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The Exodos shows Oedipus taking responsibility for his acts while still naming the god's part in them. ("Not in derision, Oedipus, I come / Nor to upbraid thee with thy past misdeeds", Exodos, lines 1427–1428). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about responsibility, mercy and the end? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The Exodos shows Oedipus taking responsibility for his acts while still naming the god's part in them. ("Not in derision, Oedipus, I come / Nor to upbraid thee with thy past misdeeds", Exodos, lines 1427–1428). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes responsibility, mercy and the end. Key takeaway: Oedipus names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent, and he insists that the guilt is his alone to bear.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** In the Exodos Oedipus is changed: he still speaks with force, but he now accepts the guilt as his own, asks for exile, and speaks to his daughters with tenderness.
- **Theme:** The ending holds two ideas together: Apollo brought the disaster to pass, and Oedipus's own hand acted, so fate and responsibility are both kept in view.
- **Structure:** The Exodos begins with a messenger's report of offstage events, continues with Oedipus's laments and his exchange with Creon, and ends with the Chorus's warning to count no one happy until life is over.

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and responsibility:** Oedipus names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent, and he insists that the guilt is his alone to bear.

Symbols and motifs

- **sight and blindness:** At the end, the man who mocked a blind prophet speaks of the truth he now sees, closing the play's long pattern of sight and understanding.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Not Ister nor all Phasis' flood, I ween, / Could wash away the blood-stains from this house, / The ills it shrouds or soon will bring to light, / Ills wrought of malice, not unwittingly" (Exodos, lines 1237–1240) The Second Messenger says no river could cleanse the house, which prepares the audience for a report of terrible offstage events.
- "Apollo, friend, Apollo, he it was / That brought these ills to pass; / But the right hand that dealt the blow / Was mine, none other" (Exodos, lines 1343–1346) Oedipus holds both the god and himself responsible, the play's clearest statement of fate and responsibility together.
- "Come hither, deign to touch an abject wretch; / Draw near and fear not; I myself must bear / The load of guilt that none but I can share" (Exodos, lines 1418–1420) Oedipus accepts the guilt as his alone and tells others not to fear contamination from him.
- "Not in derision, Oedipus, I come / Nor to upbraid thee with thy past misdeeds" (Exodos, lines 1427–1428) Creon comes without mockery or blame, a restraint that contrasts with the way Oedipus once treated him.
- "To you, my children I had much to say, / Were ye but ripe to hear. Let this suffice: / Pray ye may find some home and live content, / And may your lot prove happier than your sire's" (Exodos, lines 1518–1521) Oedipus's farewell to his daughters is humble and loving: he wishes them a better life than his own.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The Exodos shows Oedipus taking responsibility for his acts while still naming the god's part in them.
Evidence: "Not in derision, Oedipus, I come / Nor to upbraid thee with thy past misdeeds" (Exodos, lines 1427–1428)
Reasoning: He says "Apollo ... brought these ills to pass; / But the right hand ... / Was mine", and he asks others to draw near because he alone "must bear / The load of guilt", while Creon comes "Not in derision", so the ending joins guilt and mercy.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 1237–1240

1237 **Second Messenger:** Not Ister nor all Phasis' flood, I ween,
1238 **Second Messenger:** Could wash away the blood-stains from this house,
1239 **Second Messenger:** The ills it shrouds or soon will bring to light,
1240 **Second Messenger:** Ills wrought of malice, not unwittingly.

Line 1241

1241 **Second Messenger:** The worst to bear are self-inflicted wounds.

Line 1296

1296 **Second Messenger:** Such evils, issuing from the double source,

Lines 1298–1301

1298 **Second Messenger:** Till now the storied fortune of this house
1299 **Second Messenger:** Was fortunate indeed; but from this day
1300 **Second Messenger:** Woe, lamentation, ruin, death, disgrace,
1301 **Second Messenger:** All ills that can be named, all, all are theirs.

Line 1313

1313 **Second Messenger:** That he who must abhorred would pity it.

Lines 1343–1346

1343 **Oedipus:** Apollo, friend, Apollo, he it was
1344 **Oedipus:** That brought these ills to pass;
1345 **Oedipus:** But the right hand that dealt the blow
1346 **Oedipus:** Was mine, none other. How,

Lines 1343–1355

1343 **Oedipus:** Apollo, friend, Apollo, he it was
1344 **Oedipus:** That brought these ills to pass;
1345 **Oedipus:** But the right hand that dealt the blow
1346 **Oedipus:** Was mine, none other. How,
1347 **Oedipus:** How, could I longer see when sight
1348 **Oedipus:** Brought no delight?
1349 **Chorus:** Alas! 'tis as thou sayest.
1350 **Oedipus:** Say, friends, can any look or voice
1351 **Oedipus:** Or touch of love henceforth my heart rejoice?
1352 **Oedipus:** Haste, friends, no fond delay.
1353 **Oedipus:** Take the twice cursed away
1354 **Oedipus:** Far from all ken,
1355 **Oedipus:** The man abhorred of gods, accursed of men.

Lines 1395–1414

1395 **Oedipus:** Why didst thou harbour me, Cithaeron, why
1396 **Oedipus:** Didst thou not take and slay me? Then I never
1397 **Oedipus:** Had shown to men the secret of my birth.
1398 **Oedipus:** O Polybus, O Corinth, O my home,
1399 **Oedipus:** Home of my ancestors (so wast thou called)
1400 **Oedipus:** How fair a nursling then I seemed, how foul
1401 **Oedipus:** The canker that lay festering in the bud!
1402 **Oedipus:** Now is the blight revealed of root and fruit.
1403 **Oedipus:** Ye triple high-roads, and thou hidden glen,
1404 **Oedipus:** Coppice, and pass where meet the three-branched ways,
1405 **Oedipus:** Ye drank my blood, the life-blood these hands spilt,
1406 **Oedipus:** My father's; do ye call to mind perchance
1407 **Oedipus:** Those deeds of mine ye witnessed and the work
1408 **Oedipus:** I wrought thereafter when I came to Thebes?

1409 **Oedipus:** O fatal wedlock, thou didst give me birth,
1410 **Oedipus:** And, having borne me, sowed again my seed,
1411 **Oedipus:** Mingling the blood of fathers, brothers, children,
1412 **Oedipus:** Brides, wives and mothers, an incestuous brood,
1413 **Oedipus:** All horrors that are wrought beneath the sun,
1414 **Oedipus:** Horrors so foul to name them were unmeet.

Line 1403
1403 **Oedipus:** Ye triple high-roads, and thou hidden glen,

Lines 1418–1420
1418 **Oedipus:** Come hither, deign to touch an abject wretch;
1419 **Oedipus:** Draw near and fear not; I myself must bear
1420 **Oedipus:** The load of guilt that none but I can share.

Line 1425
1425 **Oedipus:** What cause has he to trust me? In the past

Lines 1427–1428
1427 **Creon:** Not in derision, Oedipus, I come
1428 **Creon:** Nor to upbraid thee with thy past misdeeds.

Lines 1518–1521
1518 **Oedipus:** To you, my children I had much to say,
1519 **Oedipus:** Were ye but ripe to hear. Let this suffice:
1520 **Oedipus:** Pray ye may find some home and live content,
1521 **Oedipus:** And may your lot prove happier than your sire's.

Line 1538
1538 **Creon:** For the mastery that raised thee was thy bane and wrought thy fall.

Vocabulary

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context
derision (noun)	mockery; scornful laughter	*Not in derision, Oedipus, I come Nor to upbraid thee with thy past misdeeds.*

Discussion questions

1. What does it mean to take responsibility for something you did not intend?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with knowledge and blindness?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What does Creon say in lines 1427–1428? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** He has not come to mock or blame Oedipus.
   Answer guidance: He has not come to mock or blame Oedipus.
2. How does the audience learn of the events in the palace? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A messenger reports them
   Answer guidance: A messenger reports them.
3. Who must bear the load of guilt, Oedipus says in lines 1418–1420? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** He himself, and no one else
   Answer guidance: He himself, and no one else.
4. How does Creon treat Oedipus? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Without mocking or blaming him
   Answer guidance: Without mocking or blaming him.
5. What does Oedipus ask Creon to do? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Send him into exile and care for his daughters
   Answer guidance: Send him into exile and care for his daughters.
6. What is the Chorus's final warning? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Count no one happy until life is over
   Answer guidance: Count no one happy until life is over.
7. Retell the most important events of "Exodos (lines 1233–1544)" in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A second messenger reports offstage events at the palace. The blinded Oedipus enters and laments. He names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent (lines 1343–1346; the blinding is self-harm reported offstage, taught as drama with context), and accepts the guilt as his alone to bear (lines 1418–1420). Creon arrives, does not mock him, and brings his daughters to him. Oedipus asks to be…
   Answer guidance: A second messenger reports offstage events at the palace. The blinded Oedipus enters and laments. He names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent (lines 1343–1346; the blinding is self-harm reported offstage, taught as drama with context), and accepts the guilt as his alone to bear (lines 1418–1420). Creon arrives, does not mock him, and brings his daughters to him. Oedipus asks to be…
8. Who is on stage in "Exodos (lines 1233–1544)", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
   Answer guidance: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.

9. Where and when is "Exodos (lines 1233–1544)" set? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
   Answer guidance: A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Not in derision, Oedipus, I come Nor to upbraid thee with thy past misdeeds." What does "derision" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** derision: mockery; scornful laughter.
    Answer guidance: derision: mockery; scornful laughter.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does Oedipus' farewell to his daughters (1518–1521) show about him now? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Care and humility; he wishes them a happier life than his.
   Answer guidance: Care and humility; he wishes them a happier life than his.
2. What does "Exodos (lines 1233–1544)" suggest about responsibility, mercy and the end? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Oedipus takes responsibility while naming fate. Creon's restraint models mercy. The ending is grief with care, not despair.
   Answer guidance: Oedipus takes responsibility while naming fate. Creon's restraint models mercy. The ending is grief with care, not despair. Evidence to accept: "Not Ister nor all Phasis' flood, I ween, / Could wash away the blood-stains from this house, / The ills it shrouds or soon will bring to light, / Ills wrought of malice, not unwittingly" (Exodos, lines 1237–1240): The Second Messenger says no river could cleanse the house, which prepares the audience for a report of terrible offstage events. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
3. Find one example of characterization in "Exodos (lines 1233–1544)". What does it reveal about responsibility, mercy and the end that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
   Answer guidance: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them. Evidence to accept: "Apollo, friend, Apollo, he it was / That brought these ills to pass; / But the right hand that dealt the blow / Was mine, none other" (Exodos, lines 1343–1346): Oedipus holds both the god and himself responsible, the play's clearest statement of fate and responsibility together. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
4. How does the theme in "Exodos (lines 1233–1544)" shape what we understand about responsibility, mercy and the end? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Exodos shows Oedipus taking responsibility for his acts while still naming the god's part in them. Useful evidence: "Not Ister nor all Phasis' flood, I ween, / Could wash away the blood-stains from this house, / The ills it shrouds or soon will bring to light, / Ills wrought of malice, not unwittingly" (Exodos, lines 1237–1240): The Second Messenger says no river could cleanse the house, which prepares the audience for a report of terrible offstage events. On theme: The ending holds two ideas together: Apollo brought the disaster to pass, and Oedipus's own hand acted, so fate

and responsibility are both kept in view. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that opens with “Apollo, friend, Apollo, he it was That brought these ills to pass; But the right hand that dealt the blow Was mine, none other.”, why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: “Come hither, deign to touch an abject wretch; / Draw near and fear not; I myself must bear / The load of guilt that none but I can share” (Exodos, lines 1418–1420): Oedipus accepts the guilt as his alone and tells others not to fear contamination from him. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
6. What causes the main turn in “Exodos (lines 1233–1544)”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Look for: Oedipus naming Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent (lines 1343–1346); his acceptance of the guilt as his alone (lines 1418–1420); the effect, Creon's mercy and Oedipus's plea for exile.
   Answer guidance: Look for: Oedipus naming Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent (lines 1343–1346); his acceptance of the guilt as his alone (lines 1418–1420); the effect, Creon's mercy and Oedipus's plea for exile. Evidence to accept: “Not in derision, Oedipus, I come / Nor to upbraid thee with thy past misdeeds” (Exodos, lines 1427–1428): Creon comes without mockery or blame, a restraint that contrasts with the way Oedipus once treated him. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
7. How does “Exodos (lines 1233–1544)” build on “Stasimon 4 (lines 1201–1232)”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Exodos shows Oedipus taking responsibility for his acts while still naming the god's part in them. Useful evidence: “Apollo, friend, Apollo, he it was / That brought these ills to pass; / But the right hand that dealt the blow / Was mine, none other” (Exodos, lines 1343–1346): Oedipus holds both the god and himself responsible, the play's clearest statement of fate and responsibility together. On structure: The Exodos begins with a messenger's report of offstage events, continues with Oedipus's laments and his exchange with Creon, and ends with the Chorus's warning to count no one happy until life is over. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. In “Exodos (lines 1233–1544)”, what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about responsibility, mercy and the end, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Exodos shows Oedipus taking responsibility for his acts while still naming the god's part in them. Useful evidence: “Come hither, deign to touch an abject wretch; / Draw near and fear not; I myself must bear / The load of guilt that none but I can share” (Exodos, lines 1418–1420): Oedipus accepts the guilt as his alone and tells others not to fear contamination from him. On characterization: In the Exodos Oedipus is changed: he still speaks with force, but he now accepts the guilt as his own, asks for exile, and speaks to his daughters with tenderness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (What does it mean to take responsibility for something you did not intend?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed

your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.

Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: “To you, my children I had much to say, / Were ye but ripe to hear. Let this suffice: / Pray ye may find some home and live content, / And may your lot prove happier than your sire’s” (Exodos, lines 1518–1521): Oedipus's farewell to his daughters is humble and loving: he wishes them a better life than his own. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

10. Where does structure appear in “Exodos (lines 1233–1544)”, and how does it connect responsibility, mercy and the end to the larger concern with knowledge and blindness? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Exodos shows Oedipus taking responsibility for his acts while still naming the god's part in them. Useful evidence: “Not in derision, Oedipus, I come / Nor to upbraid thee with thy past misdeeds” (Exodos, lines 1427–1428): Creon comes without mockery or blame, a restraint that contrasts with the way Oedipus once treated him. On structure: The Exodos begins with a messenger's report of offstage events, continues with Oedipus's laments and his exchange with Creon, and ends with the Chorus's warning to count no one happy until life is over. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Oedipus guilty? Write a literary argument using lines 1418–1420 and one earlier scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A strong answer argues that he is responsible but not simply guilty. In the Exodos he says, "I myself must bear / The load of guilt that none but I can share" (lines 1418–1420), accepting the deed as his. Earlier, Jocasta's story and his own account (lines 827–830) show he acted without knowing who the old man was. A strong answer distinguishes knowing guilt from responsibility for an act, and uses both passages.

    Answer guidance: A strong answer argues that he is responsible but not simply guilty. In the Exodos he says, "I myself must bear / The load of guilt that none but I can share" (lines 1418–1420), accepting the deed as his. Earlier, Jocasta's story and his own account (lines 827–830) show he acted without knowing who the old man was. A strong answer distinguishes knowing guilt from responsibility for an act, and uses both passages.

2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): Oedipus takes responsibility while naming fate. Creon's restraint models mercy. The ending is grief with care, not despair. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Exodos shows Oedipus taking responsibility for his acts while still naming the god's part in them. Useful evidence: “Not Ister nor all Phasis’ flood, I ween, / Could wash away the blood-stains from this house, / The ills it shrouds or soon will bring to light, / Ills wrought of malice, not unwittingly” (Exodos, lines 1237–1240): The Second Messenger says no river could cleanse the house, which prepares the audience for a report of terrible offstage events. On theme: The ending holds two ideas together: Apollo brought the disaster to pass, and Oedipus's own hand acted, so fate

and responsibility are both kept in view. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in "Exodos (lines 1233–1544)" acts most wisely in the matter of responsibility, mercy and the end, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Exodos shows Oedipus taking responsibility for his acts while still naming the god's part in them. Useful evidence: "Apollo, friend, Apollo, he it was / That brought these ills to pass; / But the right hand that dealt the blow / Was mine, none other" (Exodos, lines 1343–1346): Oedipus holds both the god and himself responsible, the play's clearest statement of fate and responsibility together. On characterization: In the Exodos Oedipus is changed: he still speaks with force, but he now accepts the guilt as his own, asks for exile, and speaks to his daughters with tenderness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing "Exodos (lines 1233–1544)". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of responsibility, mercy and the end. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Exodos shows Oedipus taking responsibility for his acts while still naming the god's part in them. Useful evidence: "Come hither, deign to touch an abject wretch; / Draw near and fear not; I myself must bear / The load of guilt that none but I can share" (Exodos, lines 1418–1420): Oedipus accepts the guilt as his alone and tells others not to fear contamination from him. On structure: The Exodos begins with a messenger's report of offstage events, continues with Oedipus's laments and his exchange with Creon, and ends with the Chorus's warning to count no one happy until life is over. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write your own questions about "Exodos (lines 1233–1544)": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Exodos shows Oedipus taking responsibility for his acts while still naming the god's part in them. Useful evidence: "Not in derision, Oedipus, I come / Nor to upbraid thee with thy past misdeeds" (Exodos, lines 1427–1428): Creon comes without mockery or blame, a restraint that contrasts with the way Oedipus once treated him. On theme: The ending holds two ideas together: Apollo brought the disaster to pass, and Oedipus's own hand acted, so fate and responsibility are both kept in view. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect "Exodos (lines 1233–1544)", with its focus on responsibility, mercy and the end, to fate and responsibility: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Exodos shows Oedipus taking responsibility for his acts while still naming the god's part in them. Useful evidence: "To you, my children I had much to say, /

Were ye but ripe to hear. Let this suffice: / Pray ye may find some home and live content, / And may your lot prove happier than your sire's" (Exodos, lines 1518–1521): Oedipus's farewell to his daughters is humble and loving: he wishes them a better life than his own. On theme: The ending holds two ideas together: Apollo brought the disaster to pass, and Oedipus's own hand acted, so fate and responsibility are both kept in view. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in "Exodos (lines 1233–1544)" effective in presenting responsibility, mercy and the end, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Exodos shows Oedipus taking responsibility for his acts while still naming the god's part in them. Useful evidence: "Not Ister nor all Phasis' flood, I ween, / Could wash away the blood-stains from this house, / The ills it shrouds or soon will bring to light, / Ills wrought of malice, not unwittingly" (Exodos, lines 1237–1240): The Second Messenger says no river could cleanse the house, which prepares the audience for a report of terrible offstage events. On characterization: In the Exodos Oedipus is changed: he still speaks with force, but he now accepts the guilt as his own, asks for exile, and speaks to his daughters with tenderness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how "Exodos (lines 1233–1544)" treats responsibility, mercy and the end with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus Rex see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Exodos shows Oedipus taking responsibility for his acts while still naming the god's part in them. Useful evidence: "Apollo, friend, Apollo, he it was / That brought these ills to pass; / But the right hand that dealt the blow / Was mine, none other" (Exodos, lines 1343–1346): Oedipus holds both the god and himself responsible, the play's clearest statement of fate and responsibility together. On theme: The ending holds two ideas together: Apollo brought the disaster to pass, and Oedipus's own hand acted, so fate and responsibility are both kept in view. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. As the final scene, does this ending resolve knowledge and blindness? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Exodos shows Oedipus taking responsibility for his acts while still naming the god's part in them. Useful evidence: "Come hither, deign to touch an abject wretch; / Draw near and fear not; I myself must bear / The load of guilt that none but I can share" (Exodos, lines 1418–1420): Oedipus accepts the guilt as his alone and tells others not to fear contamination from him. Theme link: Oedipus names Apollo as the cause and his own hand as the agent, and he insists that the guilt is his alone to bear. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of "Exodos (lines 1233–1544)" (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about responsibility, mercy and the end? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:**

A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Exodos shows Oedipus taking responsibility for his acts while still naming the god's part in them. Useful evidence: “Not in derision, Oedipus, I come / Nor to upbraid thee with thy past misdeeds” (Exodos, lines 1427–1428): Creon comes without mockery or blame, a restraint that contrasts with the way Oedipus once treated him. On theme: The ending holds two ideas together: Apollo brought the disaster to pass, and Oedipus's own hand acted, so fate and responsibility are both kept in view. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Oedipus call the Chorus when he knows it by its voice?

   A. A loyal and constant friend

   B. A crowd of curious strangers

   C. His harshest judges

   D. Creon's servants

   Key: A (A loyal and constant friend)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which two rivers does the Second Messenger say could not wash the house clean?

   A. Nile and Tigris

   B. Ister and Phasis

   C. Alpheus and Ismenus

   D. Achelous and Peneus

   Key: B (Ister and Phasis)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who arrives to take charge as guardian of the State?

   A. Teiresias

   B. The Priest

   C. Creon

   D. The herdsman

   Key: C (Creon)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the Second Messenger's line: “The worst to bear are self-inflicted _____.”

   Key: wounds

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Oedipus's cry: “Dark, dark! The horror of _____, like a shroud,”

   Key: darkness

6. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Oedipus say he could not bear the sight of his children?

   A. They have turned against him in anger

   B. They look too much like Creon

   C. They are too young to understand

   D. Their birth reminds him of his crime

   Key: D (Their birth reminds him of his crime)

7. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] What does the Chorus mean by saying it must turn away “Horror-struck”?

   A. The sight of Oedipus is too painful to watch

   B. The elders are afraid Oedipus will attack them

   C. The elders are ashamed of their own past

   D. The Chorus has been ordered to leave the stage

   Key: A (The sight of Oedipus is too painful to watch)

8. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Oedipus blame Apollo for his ills but also say that his own hand dealt the blow?

   Sample answer: Oedipus believes the god brought about the terrible events foretold by the oracles, so Apollo is the cause of his suffering. But the act of blinding himself was his own choice, and he refuses to hide behind the god. His answer shows that he accepts responsibility for what he did even while he sees fate at work.

9. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Analyze the Second Messenger's claim that no river could wash the house clean (lines 1237–1241).

   Sample answer: The messenger names two great rivers, the Ister and the Phasis, and says even their floods could not wash away the blood-stains from the house. The exaggeration shows how deep the pollution runs. His words also prepare the audience for terrible news before he tells it, so the scene opens in dread.

10. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Analyze how Creon's treatment of Oedipus in the Exodos contrasts with the way Oedipus treated him in Episode 2.

    Sample answer: In Episode 2 Oedipus accused Creon of plotting with the seer to steal the throne and even wanted him put to death. In the Exodos Creon comes with restraint, protects Oedipus from the public gaze and brings his daughters to him. The contrast makes Creon look generous and shows how completely the roles of the two men have changed.

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Oedipus say Cithaeron should have done when he was an infant?

    A. Taken and slain him

    B. Sheltered him forever

    C. Sent him back to Thebes

    D. Hidden him from Polybus

    Key: A (Taken and slain him)

12. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Oedipus say he would have done if he could have stopped his hearing too?

    A. Asked the gods to restore his eyes

    B. Shut out sound as well as sight

    C. Fled from Thebes the same day

    D. Sung a dirge for the dead queen

    Key: B (Shut out sound as well as sight)

13. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Whose son does Oedipus call Creon when he begs him to care for the girls?

    A. Laius's

    B. Polybus's

    C. Menoeceus'

    D. Labdacus's

    Key: C (Menoeceus')

14. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Creon's line: "For the mastery that raised thee was thy bane and wrought thy _____."

    Key: fall

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Creon want Oedipus taken back into the palace?

    A. He wants to put Oedipus on trial

    B. He fears the people will riot at the sight

    C. The god has ordered it at once

    D. Such a sight should be seen only by kin

    Key: D (Such a sight should be seen only by kin)

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Creon not grant Oedipus's request to leave the land at once?

    A. He wants to consult the god first

    B. He wants revenge for the past quarrel

    C. He hopes Oedipus will regain his sight

    D. He has no authority to do so

    Key: A (He wants to consult the god first)

17. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Oedipus mean when he says that by his own proclamation he is cut off from the sights of Thebes?

    Sample answer: In Episode 1 Oedipus proclaimed that the murderer of Laius must be shut out from every home and rite in the city. Now he knows he is that man, so his own decree condemns him. He cannot look on the temples and statues of Thebes because his own words have made him an outcast from them.

18. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the image of the canker in the bud (lines 1400–1402).

    Sample answer: Oedipus says he seemed a fair nursling in Corinth, but a canker lay festering in the bud, and now the blight is revealed in root and fruit. The plant image suggests that the corruption was there from the start, hidden beneath his promise. His whole life, not just his recent deeds, now looks diseased to him.

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Analyze Oedipus's address to the three roads (lines 1403–1408).

    Sample answer: Oedipus speaks to the triple high-roads, the hidden glen and the coppice as if they were witnesses who drank his father's blood and remember what he did. Addressing the places makes the past vivid and present. It also shows him going back over every step of his life, now that he understands what each one meant.

20. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Compare the Chorus's final words with its claim in Stasimon 4 that no one born of women should be called blest.

    Sample answer: In Stasimon 4 the Chorus took Oedipus's fall as a warning that no mortal can be called blessed. In its final words it turns that warning into advice: wait until a life has ended free of pain before judging it happy. The play ends by repeating its lesson, now spoken to the whole audience rather than to Oedipus alone.

21. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the Second Messenger's line: "Such evils, issuing from the double _____,"

    Key: source

22. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] To what does the Chorus compare the force that drove Oedipus to ruin?

    A. A demon leaping on him
    B. A storm out of the sea
    C. A lion in the hills
    D. A wolf hunting by night

    Key: A (A demon leaping on him)

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Where does Oedipus ask to live out his days?

    A. In the city of Corinth
    B. On mount Cithaeron
    C. At the shrine of Delphi
    D. On an island far at sea

    Key: B (On mount Cithaeron)

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does the Second Messenger refuse to repeat the word Oedipus cried at the doors?

    A. He has forgotten what was said
    B. Creon ordered him to keep silent
    C. It is too shameful to say aloud
    D. The word was spoken in a foreign tongue

    Key: C (It is too shameful to say aloud)

25. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Why does Oedipus believe he was saved from death as an infant only for some awful doom (lines 1465–1468)?

    Sample answer: He reasons that no ordinary disease or chance will end his life, because he would never have been snatched from death on the mountain unless a special fate awaited him. His survival, which once seemed lucky, now looks like part of a larger design. The belief shows him reading his whole life as shaped by forces beyond him.

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Which device is most at work in "Ye triple high-roads, and thou hidden glen" and the lines that follow?

    A. Understatement

B. Onomatopoeia

C. Allusion

D. Apostrophe

Key: D (Apostrophe)

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze the significance of Oedipus blinding himself rather than choosing death.

Sample answer: Oedipus explains that he could not face his father and mother among the dead, nor bear to see his children or the city. Blinding lets him live and suffer while shutting out every sight that shames him. The choice is a punishment he carries out on himself, and it keeps him alive to bear the full weight of what he has learned.

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze the Second Messenger's description of the fortune of the house in lines 1298–1301.

Sample answer: He says that until now the storied fortune of the house was fortunate indeed, but from this day woe, lamentation, ruin, death and disgrace are theirs. The long list piles up every kind of misery. Placing the past good fortune beside the present ruin shows how complete and sudden the reversal has been.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Trace the theme of sight and blindness from Teiresias's prophecy in Episode 1 to the Exodos.

Sample answer: In Episode 1 the blind seer told Oedipus that though he had eyes he could not see his own state, and that he would one day grope his way in darkness. Through the middle of the play Oedipus searched with open eyes and saw nothing. In the Exodos he finally sees the truth and blinds himself, fulfilling the seer's words exactly.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the Exodos fulfil the curse Oedipus laid on the murderer of Laius in Episode 1?

Sample answer: In Episode 1 Oedipus cursed the unknown murderer to a wretched life and banned him from every home and rite in Thebes. In the Exodos he recognizes that his own proclamation now condemns him, calls himself branded as a felon by himself, and begs to be thrust from the land. The curse he spoke as king falls fully on his own head.

31. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the Second Messenger's line: "That he who most abhorred would _____ it."

Key: pity

32. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Oedipus ask Creon to do for the woman who lies within?

A. Bury her with fitting rites

B. Bring her body out to the people

C. Send her home to her father's house

D. Keep her death a secret from Thebes

Key: A (Bury her with fitting rites)

33. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Oedipus's question "What cause has he to trust me?" reveal?

A. He suspects Creon of a new plot

B. He sees he wronged Creon

C. He thinks Creon has come to kill him

D. He wants Creon to beg his pardon

Key: B (He sees he wronged Creon)

34. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Oedipus insist “What’s done was well done” when the Chorus says he would be better dead than blind?

    Sample answer: He argues that death would not have freed him, since he could not have faced his father and mother among the shades. Blindness spares him the sight of his children, the city and its temples, all of which shame him now. His firm reply shows that the blinding was a deliberate judgment on himself, not a moment of madness.

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What is the effect of Creon's remark that mastery was Oedipus's bane?

    A. It shows Creon gloating over his rival's fall

    B. It suggests Oedipus will soon be king again

    C. It names his will to rule as part of his fall

    D. It blames the elders for the king's ruin

    Key: C (It names his will to rule as part of his fall)

36. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze the structure of Oedipus's lament in lines 1395–1414, which addresses one place after another.

    Sample answer: Oedipus calls in turn on Cithaeron, on Polybus and Corinth, on the triple high-roads and on the fatal wedlock. Each address marks a stage of his life, from infancy to his marriage in Thebes. The sequence retraces his whole history in order, and each step reveals the horror that was hidden in it.

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Analyze how Oedipus's words to his daughters about their future (lines 1494–1510) show what his crimes mean for others.

    Sample answer: Oedipus imagines the slights and gibes the girls will face at every festival and the wooers who will refuse to marry them. He even quotes the cruel words men will say about their father. The speech shows him seeing his guilt through its effect on innocent children, which deepens his grief beyond his own suffering.

38. [mc · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Which statement best describes how the Exodos resolves the play?

    A. It restores Oedipus to the throne after his punishment

    B. It reveals a new mystery about the death of Laius

    C. It shows the gods forgiving Oedipus publicly

    D. It completes his fall but leaves his end open

    Key: D (It completes his fall but leaves his end open)

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate Oedipus's claim that “Apollo” brought these ills to pass. Does the play support blaming the god, Oedipus, or both?

    Sample answer: The oracles foretold every step of the disaster, which supports Oedipus's claim that Apollo brought it about. Yet Oedipus chose to kill the stranger at the crossroads, to press the search and to blind himself. The strongest reading holds both responsible: the god's prophecy set the frame, and Oedipus's own acts filled it in.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the final choral warning (lines 1539–1544) answer the Priest's praise of Oedipus in the Prologue?

    Sample answer: In the Prologue the Priest hailed Oedipus as the first of men, who freed the city from the Sphinx. The final chorus recalls the same fame, the man who knew the Sphinx's riddle and was mightiest in the state, and then shows him sunk in a sea of troubles. The play ends by turning its first praise into a warning.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 0

HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 3, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 2
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 2, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Exodos (lines 1233–1544) develops the idea of responsibility, mercy and the end. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Exodos (lines 1233–1544)" could deliver about responsibility, mercy and the end. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for responsibility, mercy and the end in "Exodos (lines 1233–1544)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to knowledge and blindness and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Exodos (lines 1233–1544) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of responsibility, mercy and the end. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Exodos (lines 1233–1544)" could deliver about responsibility, mercy and the end. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for responsibility, mercy and the end in "Exodos (lines 1233–1544)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to knowledge and blindness and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Exodos (lines 1233–1544) suggests about responsibility, mercy and the end. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Exodos (lines 1233–1544)" could deliver about responsibility, mercy and the end. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for responsibility, mercy and the end in "Exodos (lines 1233–1544)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to knowledge and blindness and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses characterization in Exodos (lines 1233–1544) to complicate the reader's understanding of responsibility, mercy and the end. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Exodos (lines 1233–1544)" could deliver about responsibility, mercy and the end. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for responsibility, mercy and the end in "Exodos (lines 1233–1544)": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to knowledge and blindness and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Apollo, friend, Apollo, he it was That brought these ills to pass; But the right hand that dealt the blow Was mine, none other. How, How, could I longer see when sight Brought no delight? Alas! 'tis as thou sayest. Say, friends, can any look or voice Or touch of love henceforth my heart rejoice? Haste, friends, no fond delay. Take the twice cursed away Far from all ken, The man abhorred of gods, accursed of men.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Exodos (lines 1233–1544)"?

   A. The herdsman and the recognition
   B. Pride breeds the tyrant
   C. Good news that is not good
   D. Responsibility, mercy and the end

SAT key: 1. D (Responsibility, mercy and the end)

Unit test

Oedipus Rex: unit test · 90 minutes · 50 questions per rigor version (multiple choice, fill in the blank, short answer). The class rigor level picks the version; student auto-adjust applies.

Short-answer scoring guides

Scaffolded support and HS Freshman (2 points): correct answer in a complete sentence with a detail from the text. HS Sophomore to HS Senior (3 points): claim, one accurate quotation, one sentence of explanation. AP to College Sophomore (4 points): precise claim, two embedded quotations, commentary on word choice or structure, link to theme. College Junior to Graduate (5 points): nuanced thesis, close reading of two passages, synthesis across sections, a competing reading answered. Each item lists a sample answer; partial credit is described in the app.

Unit test: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What do the suppliants carry when Oedipus first sees them, and what does it show?
   Sample answer: Olive branches wound with wool, the sign of people who come to beg for help; Oedipus asks why they sit “in your hands / Branches of olive filleted with wool” (lines 2–3). It shows the city has come as humble petitioners. The branches turn the opening into a ritual of supplication, so Oedipus is cast at once as the ruler on whom the whole city depends.
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What sign tells the Priest that Creon is bringing welcome news before he speaks?
   A. His head is crowned with a wreath of berry-laden bay
   B. He runs toward the palace calling out the god's name
   C. He carries a sealed tablet from the shrine
   D. A procession of singing priests follows him
   Key: A (His head is crowned with a wreath of berry-laden bay)
3. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] The Priest warns Oedipus not to let his reign be remembered as one that raised the city up only to cast it down. What is the purpose of this warning?
   A. To suggest that he should give up the throne to a better ruler
   B. To press him to act by appealing to his reputation
   C. To suggest that he should give up the throne
   D. To remind him that kings are judged only by gods
   Key: B (To press him to act by appealing to his reputation)
4. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How does the Prologue show that Oedipus had begun to act before the suppliants came to him, and why does that matter for how we judge him? Use two details.
   Sample answer: He says he has wept many tears and “threaded many a maze of weary thought”, and that he has already sent Creon to Delphi to learn “How I might save the State by act or word” (line 78). The Priest's request is answered before it is made, which shows a ruler who anticipates his people's needs, so the Prologue invites us to judge him as diligent.

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In the opening lines of the Parodos, what does the Chorus call the message from Delphi?

   A. A herald sent by the Fates

   B. A torch carried from Apollo's hearth

   C. The sweet-voiced daughter of Zeus

   D. A riddle left behind by the Sphinx

   Key: C (The sweet-voiced daughter of Zeus)

6. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] What does the Parodos add to the audience's picture of the plague after the Prologue?

   A. A cure promised by the oracle

   B. The name of the murderer

   C. News from the palace at Corinth

   D. The citizens' own lament

   Key: D (The citizens' own lament)

7. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] In the Parodos, why is the Chorus afraid of the message from Delphi even before it hears it?

   Sample answer: The Chorus does not know whether the god will demand some new pain or renew an old penance, so its soul is racked with fear. The city has suffered so much that any word from the gods feels like a threat as well as a hope. The opening lines show a people waiting helplessly for a judgment they cannot control.

8. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the Parodos uses fire both for the plague and for the help the city wants from the gods.

   Sample answer: The plague strikes swifter than the Fire-God's might, and Ares comes with hot breath, so fire stands for destruction. Yet the Chorus also begs for Apollo's arrows, the flashing lights of Artemis and the bright torch of Bacchus. The same image of fire becomes both the disease and the cure the city prays for.

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Episode 1, what does Oedipus promise anyone who names the killer, even a foreigner?

   A. A reward and the king's thanks

   B. A seat on the royal council

   C. Freedom from all taxes

   D. A share of the Sphinx's treasure

   Key: A (A reward and the king's thanks)

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who guides the blind prophet onto the stage in Episode 1?

    A. Creon's chief servant

    B. A boy who leads him

    C. A priest of Zeus

    D. His own daughter

    Key: B (A boy who leads him)

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Oedipus grow angry when the seer refuses to speak?

    A. He thinks the seer is asking for money

B. He believes the seer is too old to remember

C. He sees the silence as betrayal of the city

D. He wants the seer to leave Thebes

Key: C (He sees the silence as betrayal of the city)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does the Chorus think the seer is the best person to help find the killer?

Sample answer: The Chorus believes that the seer sees what Apollo sees, so after the god himself he is the surest source of the truth. Thebes honours him as a prophet, and the oracle has already said the killer must be found. Turning to him seems the wisest step for a city that has no other witness to the crime.

13. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Analyze how Oedipus's language changes from his proclamation to his attack on the seer in Episode 1.

Sample answer: In the proclamation Oedipus speaks formally and calmly, as a king laying down the law for the whole city. When the seer will not answer, his language turns to insults, threats and accusations of a plot. The change shows how quickly his confidence turns to anger when anyone resists his search.

14. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the Chorus's picture of the hunted killer: “And vainly seeks to fly The _____ that ever nigh Flits o’er his head”

Key: doom

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Why is it ironic that the Chorus calls its ruler “Polybus’ son” in Stasimon 1?

A. Polybus has disowned him in public

B. Polybus is the name of a god

C. The Chorus means it as an insult

D. He is really the son of Laius

Key: D (He is really the son of Laius)

16. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What kind of proof would the Chorus of Stasimon 1 need before it turned against Oedipus?

Sample answer: The Chorus says there is no proof and no sign, and that a mortal seer's word is not enough to condemn a king. It would need clear evidence, the kind of public test that proved Oedipus true like gold when he saved the city from the Sphinx. Until then, loyalty and his past service outweigh the accusation.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] According to Jocasta, when was Laius killed in relation to Oedipus becoming king?

A. Shortly before he took the throne

B. Twenty years after he became king

C. On the day of his wedding feast

D. In the first year of the plague

Key: A (Shortly before he took the throne)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What did the man in the carriage strike Oedipus with at the crossroads?

A. A heavy wooden staff

B. A double-pointed goad

C. A sharp bronze hunting sword

D. A rock from the road

Key: B (A double-pointed goad)

19. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Oedipus cry "'tis clear as noonday now" in Episode 2?

A. Jocasta has just confessed that the old oracle came true

B. The herdsman has already named the killer

C. The details of Laius's party match his own memory

D. Creon has admitted bribing the seer

Key: C (The details of Laius's party match his own memory)

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does the Chorus beg Oedipus to respect Creon's oath in Episode 2?

Sample answer: Creon has sworn before the gods that he is innocent of any plot, and the elders believe such an oath deserves respect. They fear that a quarrel between the two leading men will add one more disaster to a city already stricken by plague. Their plea shows them trying to protect both the king and the peace of Thebes.

21. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Analyze how Jocasta's arrival changes the quarrel between Oedipus and Creon.

Sample answer: Jocasta scolds both men for airing private grievances while the whole land lies stricken. Her rebuke shifts the scene from shouting to persuasion, and with the Chorus she wins Creon's release. Her authority as queen and sister lets her calm the conflict, though she then turns the talk to the oracle and opens a deeper danger.

22. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Stasimon 2, what does the Chorus call God in the line that ends its second stanza?

A. Its judge and master

B. Its father and king

C. Its shield and sword

D. Its help and hope

Key: D (Its help and hope)

23. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Which recent event in Episode 2 lies behind the Chorus's fear in Stasimon 2 that "faith grows cold"?

A. Jocasta's scorn for the oracles

B. Creon's oath before the gods

C. The arrival of the seer

D. The news of Polybus's death from Corinth

Key: A (Jocasta's scorn for the oracles)

24. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] How does the Chorus's view of the "true patriot" in Stasimon 2 differ from its view of the tyrant?

Sample answer: The true patriot burns with eager zeal to serve the state, and the Chorus prays that Heaven will protect him. The tyrant, bred by insolence and swollen with empty riches, climbs to the throne only to topple. One serves the city and the other serves himself, so the ode sets public duty against private pride.

25. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Analyze how Stasimon 2 links religion and politics.

Sample answer: The ode moves from the eternal laws of the gods to the tyrant who seizes a throne, and then to the shrines

the Chorus will abandon if the oracles fail. A ruler's pride and the people's worship are treated as parts of one order. If impiety goes unpunished in a king, the ode suggests, the city's whole faith collapses.

26. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What was the Corinthian messenger's work in the days when the infant was handed over?

    A. Guarding the gates of the royal city

    B. Tending the mountain flocks for hire

    C. Serving as a herald to the king

    D. Carrying offerings to the shrine at Delphi

    Key: B (Tending the mountain flocks for hire)

27. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does the messenger from Corinth expect a reward for his news?

    A. He has captured the killer of Laius

    B. He has brought gold from Polybus

    C. His news offers Oedipus a new crown

    D. He has found a cure for the plague

    Key: C (His news offers Oedipus a new crown)

28. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why did Polybus take the child as his own, according to the messenger?

    A. The oracle at Delphi had commanded it

    B. He wished to anger the king of Thebes

    C. He needed a servant for the palace

    D. He was a childless man until then

    Key: D (He was a childless man until then)

29. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does the Chorus tell Oedipus that the queen could best say who the shepherd was?

    A. She knows Laius's household

    B. She was present at the killing

    C. She is a prophet like the seer

    D. She has spoken with the messenger

    Key: A (She knows Laius's household)

30. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Jocasta send for Oedipus as soon as the messenger reports that Polybus is dead?

    Sample answer: Jocasta believes the news proves the oracle false, since Oedipus feared he would kill his father and Polybus has died naturally. She wants him to hear at once that his fear was groundless. Her eagerness shows how much she wants to free him from prophecy, and it sets up the reversal that follows.

31. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Analyze how Episode 3 begins with prayer and ends with defiance.

    Sample answer: Jocasta opens the episode with wreaths and incense, praying to Apollo to cleanse the city. By the end, Oedipus declares that he is the child of Fortune and that nothing will stop him learning his birth. The episode moves from humble appeal to the gods to proud self-assertion, which makes the coming fall more striking.

32. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Analyze how Episode 3 makes the audience watch two characters learn the truth at different speeds.

    Sample answer: As the messenger reveals that he received the infant from Laius's shepherd, Jocasta understands what this means and begs Oedipus to stop. Oedipus, still thinking of low birth, presses on. The audience watches her horror and his confidence side by side, and the gap between them creates intense dramatic tension.

33. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Stasimon 3, when does the Chorus plan to honour Cithaeron?

    A. At the next harvest feast
    B. Before the next full moon
    C. On the anniversary of the Sphinx's defeat
    D. When the plague has ended

    Key: B (Before the next full moon)

34. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which kind of parent does the Chorus of Stasimon 3 hope Oedipus had?

    A. A rich merchant of Corinth
    B. A famous warrior of Thebes
    C. A god or a mountain nymph
    D. A wise priest of Delphi

    Key: C (A god or a mountain nymph)

35. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Why is the mood of Stasimon 3 surprising after Episode 3?

    A. The elders weep though the news was good
    B. The elders attack the king they once praised
    C. The elders leave the stage in silence
    D. They rejoice after the queen's anguish

    Key: D (They rejoice after the queen's anguish)

36. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Why does the Chorus of Stasimon 3 think a foundling from the mountain might have divine parents?

    Sample answer: In myths, gods and nymphs who haunt the hills often leave their children to be found and raised by others. The messenger has just said that Oedipus was found in the glens of Cithaeron, so the elders reach for the most glorious explanation. Their loyalty to the king makes them hope his mystery hides an honour rather than a shame.

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Analyze the dramatic irony of the Chorus planning a festival for the mountain in Stasimon 3.

    Sample answer: The Chorus imagines dancing and singing in honour of Cithaeron as the king's nurse. The audience knows the mountain was where the infant was left to die so that the oracle could not come true. The festival the elders plan is a celebration of the very evidence that will destroy the king, so their joy is painful to watch.

38. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Analyze how Stasimon 3 keeps the audience in suspense just before the herdsman arrives.

    Sample answer: The brief, joyful ode delays the questioning that everyone expects. Its hope that the king's birth will prove divine stands against the dread Jocasta showed. The audience waits between the elders' cheer and the truth it suspects, so the short pause raises the tension before the final evidence is heard.

39. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why has the herdsman been brought to the palace in Episode 4?

    A. He is the last witness to the truth

    B. He has come to claim a reward from the king

    C. He wants to report a new outbreak of plague

    D. He has been accused of stealing royal sheep

    Key: A (He is the last witness to the truth)

40. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Oedipus threaten when the old herdsman tries to avoid answering?

    A. Exile to Corinth

    B. Torture and death

    C. A heavy fine

    D. Loss of his flocks

    Key: B (Torture and death)

41. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does the herdsman try so hard to avoid answering Oedipus's questions?

    Sample answer: He knows that the child he gave away was the king himself, born to Laius and the queen. Telling the truth will destroy Oedipus and may endanger his own life. He hopes that by silence and denial he can keep the secret buried, but the king's threats force each fact out of him.

42. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Analyze how Episode 4 brings the play's search to its climax.

    Sample answer: Every earlier clue, from the seer's charge to Jocasta's story and the messenger's news, leads to the one witness who knows both secrets. In a short, tense exchange the herdsman confirms that the infant came from Laius's house and was given by the queen. The search ends in recognition, and Oedipus leaves the stage knowing who he is.

43. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] What mood does the Chorus express in Stasimon 4?

    A. Quiet joy at the end of the plague

    B. Anger at the herdsman's lies

    C. Deep grief at the king's ruin

    D. Hope for a happy ending

    Key: C (Deep grief at the king's ruin)

44. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Which event that has just taken place does Stasimon 4 respond to?

    A. The death of Polybus

    B. Creon's arrival as ruler

    C. The seer's first prophecy

    D. The herdsman's revelation

    Key: D (The herdsman's revelation)

45. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] In Stasimon 4, what earlier service does the Chorus remember Oedipus giving the city?

    A. Freeing it from the Sphinx

    B. Teaching the elders to sing

C. Curing them of the plague

D. Making every citizen rich

Key: A (Freeing it from the Sphinx)

46. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Why does the Chorus treat Oedipus's fall in Stasimon 4 as a lesson for all people?

Sample answer: Oedipus was the greatest and most fortunate of men, the saviour of Thebes and its adored king. If such a man can fall so low, the Chorus reasons, no one's happiness is secure. His story becomes a warning that mortal joy is brief and that no one should be called blessed while fortune can still change.

47. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Analyze how Stasimon 4 contrasts Oedipus's past glory with his present misery.

Sample answer: The first half recalls how he outshot every rival, defeated the vulture maid and was hailed as lord of Thebes. The second half cries out at the heavy hand of fate and the horror of his marriage. The ode sets the height and the depth side by side, so the scale of his fall is measured by the greatness he once had.

48. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where does Oedipus first ask Creon to thrust him?

A. Into the palace, where no one will see him

B. Into a desert where no voice will greet him

C. Back to the house of Polybus in the city of Corinth

D. Down to the harbour to sail away on a ship

Key: B (Into a desert where no voice will greet him)

49. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Oedipus ask that his daughters be brought to him in the Exodos?

A. He wants them to lead him to Corinth

B. He plans to make them rulers

C. He longs to touch them once more

D. He wants them to bury the queen

Key: C (He longs to touch them once more)

50. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Oedipus say he cannot bear to look upon the city and its temples in the Exodos?

Sample answer: By his own proclamation he condemned the killer of Laius to be shut out from every home and rite in Thebes. Now he knows he is that man, so the sights of the city and its gods remind him of his guilt and his own sentence. He feels that he has no right to see what he has polluted.

51. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Oedipus's words: “Right worthy the concern Of Phoebus, worthy thine too, for the _____”

Key: dead

52. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Creon offer to do before he gives the oracle's message?

A. Tell it privately within, if the king prefers

B. Wait until the Priest has offered a sacrifice

C. Write it down so that no one can twist it

D. Give it first to the city's council of elders

Key: A (Tell it privately within, if the king prefers)

53. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] How does Oedipus say his own grief compares with that of the suppliants?

    A. It is smaller, because the plague has so far spared the palace

    B. It is greater, for he grieves for the whole city at once

    C. It is the same as that of any other citizen

    D. He feels none, since the gods protect their kings

    Key: B (It is greater, for he grieves for the whole city at once)

54. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Creon opens his report by calling it good news before he says what the god demands. What is the effect of this opening?

    A. It proves that the plague is already ending throughout the city

    B. It shows Creon is trying to deceive the suppliants

    C. It raises hope, though the command will require a hard search

    D. It means the god has already forgiven the city

    Key: C (It raises hope, though the command will require a hard search)

55. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In the Parodos, where does the Chorus hope Ares will be sent?

    A. To the high snowy peak of Mount Olympus

    B. To the plains outside Corinth

    C. To the caves of Cithaeron

    D. To the unharboured Thracian waters

    Key: D (To the unharboured Thracian waters)

56. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the Chorus's cry to the archer god: “Lord of the death-winged _____!”

    Key: dart

57. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Why does the Chorus of the Parodos call on Bacchus “whom we adore” against “The god whom gods abhor”?

    A. It sets a god Thebes loves against a hated one

    B. It hopes Bacchus will make a lasting peace with Ares

    C. It blames Bacchus for the city's suffering

    D. It asks Bacchus to bring wine to the mourners

    Key: A (It sets a god Thebes loves against a hated one)

58. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the Parodos's picture of the gods as warriors in its final stanzas (lines 190–213).

    Sample answer: The Chorus imagines Ares stalking the city with a voice like a battle shout, and it calls on Zeus to slay him with lightning, on Apollo to loose his arrows and on Artemis and Bacchus to bring their fire. The plague becomes a war among gods. Picturing it this way shows that the people feel only divine power can save them.

59. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Teiresias ask for when he first realizes why he has been summoned?

    A. To be paid in gold first

    B. To be sent home again

    C. To speak with Creon

D. To see the queen

Key: B (To be sent home again)

60. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In what one respect does Teiresias claim to be the king's equal?

A. His wealth and his lands in Thebes

B. His noble birth and ancient family

C. His right to speak freely in reply

D. His skill as a soldier in war

Key: C (His right to speak freely in reply)

61. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Oedipus's offer of mercy to a confessing killer reveal about his aims?

A. He secretly hopes the killer will escape

B. He fears the killer more than the plague

C. He wants to look generous to the gods

D. He puts ending the plague before revenge

Key: D (He puts ending the plague before revenge)

62. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does the seer finally speak the truth in Episode 1 after refusing for so long?

Sample answer: Oedipus provokes him by calling him a plotter and even suggesting that he helped plan the murder. Stung by the insult, the seer answers that the king himself is the polluter of the land. His anger drives out the words that pity and caution had kept back, so the king's own rage forces the truth into the open.

63. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] Analyze the dramatic irony of Oedipus cursing the killer, whoever he may be, in Episode 1.

Sample answer: Oedipus calls down misery on the unknown murderer and orders every citizen to shun him. The audience knows that he is describing himself. Every word of the curse therefore falls back on the speaker, and his confident tone makes the irony sharper, because he believes he is protecting the city when he is condemning its king.

64. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does the phrase “Earth’s mid shrine” tell the audience about the summons in Stasimon 1?

A. It came from Delphi

B. It came from a temple in Thebes

C. It came from the underworld

D. It came from the sea god

Key: A (It came from Delphi)

65. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Which best describes the shift in tone between the two halves of Stasimon 1?

A. From joy to anger at the king

B. From grim certainty to unease

C. From prayer to open rebellion

D. From grief to calm acceptance

Key: B (From grim certainty to unease)

66. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does the Chorus's refusal to blame Oedipus in Stasimon 1 contrast with its lament for him in Stasimon 4?

    Sample answer: In Stasimon 1 the Chorus will not challenge the king's good name without proof and remembers how he saved the city. In Stasimon 4 the proof has come, and the same elders mourn him as the most wretched of men and call themselves dead through him. Their loyalty stays, but it changes from defence into grief once the truth is known.

67. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Creon's oath in Episode 2 show about how he wants to be judged?

    A. He wants the people to vote on his fate
    B. He hopes to frighten the king into silence
    C. He trusts the gods to prove him honest
    D. He thinks oaths do not matter

    Key: C (He trusts the gods to prove him honest)

68. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Jocasta scold the two men for quarrelling in public?

    A. She fears Creon will win the argument
    B. She wants to hear the charge herself
    C. She thinks the Chorus will take sides
    D. It is shameful while the land suffers

    Key: D (It is shameful while the land suffers)

69. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Which best describes the change in Oedipus's tone between his quarrel with Creon and his story to Jocasta?

    A. From anger to anxious confession
    B. From quiet joy to weary boredom at court
    C. From private fear to open public boasting
    D. From calm to sudden madness

    Key: A (From anger to anxious confession)

70. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze the role of the survivor of the attack on Laius in the structure of the play.

    Sample answer: Jocasta mentions the one servant who escaped and later begged to be sent to the pastures, and Oedipus sends for him as his last hope. The same man returns in Episode 4 as the herdsman who once received the infant from the queen. One witness links the killing and the abandoned child, so his arrival brings both mysteries together.

71. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does Oedipus's account of the crossroads in Episode 2 prepare for the herdsman's evidence in Episode 4?

    Sample answer: In Episode 2 Oedipus admits that he killed an old man and his servants where three roads meet, and he rests his hope on the report of robbers. In Episode 4 the herdsman never needs to speak of the killing, because his account of the child proves who Oedipus is. The earlier confession means that the final evidence completes a picture the audience has already half seen.

72. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Why does the Chorus call on Zeus “if thou’rt named aright Omnipotent” in Stasimon 2?

    A. It doubts that the god exists at all, in any form
    B. It challenges the god to prove his power

C. It thanks Zeus for ending the plague

D. It asks Zeus to forgive Oedipus

Key: B (It challenges the god to prove his power)

73. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the Chorus's phrase "lays an impious hand on holiest things" describe?

A. A thief stealing from a market

B. A king touching a beggar

C. An attack on what is sacred

D. A priest blessing the altar

Key: C (An attack on what is sacred)

74. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the tone of the final stanza of Stasimon 2 (lines 911–921).

Sample answer: The stanza mixes anxiety with defiance. The Chorus threatens to stop visiting Delphi, Abae and Olympia unless the god's truth is made plain, and it calls on Zeus to show his might. Its fear that Apollo is forsaken and faith grows cold gives the prayer an urgent, almost desperate edge.

75. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Stasimon 2's warning about the tyrant look ahead to Creon's final words to Oedipus in the Exodos?

Sample answer: Stasimon 2 warns that insolence lifts a man to a dizzy height from which he topples. In the Exodos Creon tells Oedipus not to crave mastery in everything, since the mastery that raised him also wrought his fall. Both passages link the drive for power with ruin, so the ode's general warning returns as a personal verdict.

76. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What point does Jocasta make when she says that many men have dreamed of marrying their mothers?

A. Such dreams are warnings from Apollo

B. Such dreams come only to kings

C. Such dreams must be told to priests

D. Such dreams mean nothing

Key: D (Such dreams mean nothing)

77. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does the Corinthian messenger's admission that he was a hired shepherd suggest about his story?

A. He knows the mountain pastures

B. He is lying to win a reward

C. He is a nobleman in disguise

D. He served the royal house of Thebes

Key: A (He knows the mountain pastures)

78. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] Which best describes the irony of the messenger trying to free Oedipus from fear?

A. His news is false and quickly disproved

B. His comfort exposes what Oedipus fears

C. He is secretly working for Creon

D. He wants Oedipus to stay in Thebes

Key: B (His comfort exposes what Oedipus fears)

79. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Which best describes how Episode 3 reverses the hope it creates?

    A. Fear of the plague becomes joy at a cure

    B. Anger at Creon becomes trust in him

    C. Relief at a death turns to dread

    D. Doubt of the seer becomes belief in him

    Key: C (Relief at a death turns to dread)

80. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does the news that Polybus died of old age seem to Oedipus to disprove the oracle?

    Sample answer: The oracle said that Oedipus would kill his father, and he believed Polybus was that father. Polybus has died of sickness and age while Oedipus was far away, so the prophecy seems to have failed. His relief rests on a mistaken belief about who his parents are, which the messenger soon overturns.

81. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze how Oedipus's claim to be the child of Fortune at the end of Episode 3 answers Jocasta's earlier faith in chance.

    Sample answer: Jocasta urged him to live at random, since chance rules all. Oedipus turns that idea into pride, calling Fortune his mother and the giver of good gifts. Both reject the oracles in favour of chance, but where Jocasta now dreads the truth, Oedipus embraces it, confident that Fortune will not shame him.

82. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the messenger from Corinth in Episode 3 link the play's two mysteries, the killer of Laius and the birth of Oedipus?

    Sample answer: The messenger reveals that Oedipus was a foundling given to him by a shepherd of Laius's house. That shepherd is the same man who survived the attack on Laius. One witness can now answer both questions, so the search for the killer and the search for Oedipus's parents become a single search.

83. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the Chorus mean by calling the infant “a new-born joy” in Stasimon 3?

    A. A child born on a feast day

    B. A baby who laughed when found

    C. A gift that brought peace to Corinth

    D. A delight sent by a god

    Key: D (A delight sent by a god)

84. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Which best describes the relationship between Stasimon 3 and Stasimon 4?

    A. Joyful hope gives way to mourning

    B. Mourning gives way to joyful hope

    C. Each ode praises the king's birth

    D. Each ode curses the oracle

    Key: A (Joyful hope gives way to mourning)

85. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why do the elders in Stasimon 3 ignore Jocasta's warning signs?

    Sample answer: The elders hear the messenger's story as good news, a mystery that might end in glory. They are loyal to

Oedipus and want his birth to honour him. Their hope blinds them to the meaning of Jocasta's despair, just as Oedipus misreads it as pride, so the ode shows how hope can close the eyes.

86. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how Stasimon 3 uses the names of gods to create its mood.

Sample answer: The ode calls on Pan the hill-roamer, Loxias, the lord of Cyllene and Bacchus, all gods linked with the wild uplands. These names bring music, dancing and the freedom of the hills into the play. The light, festive mood they create stands against the darkness of the surrounding scenes and makes the elders' hope seem fragile.

87. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does Stasimon 3 set up the reversal in Episode 4?

Sample answer: Stasimon 3 raises the hope that Oedipus is the child of a god found on the mountain. In Episode 4 the herdsman reveals that he was born in Laius's house and given away by the queen. The higher the elders raise his birth in hope, the further it falls in truth, so the ode makes the reversal more crushing.

88. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Oedipus ask whether the child was “Slave-born or one of Laius’ own race?”?

A. He hopes to catch the herdsman in a lie

B. He still fears that his own birth was low

C. He wants to spare the herdsman any blame

D. He believes Laius had no children of his own

Key: B (He still fears that his own birth was low)

89. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Which best describes the shift in the herdsman's behaviour during Episode 4?

A. From boasting to sudden silence

B. From anger to calm agreement

C. From denial to confession

D. From joy to open laughter

Key: C (From denial to confession)

90. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does the old messenger from Corinth seem pleased while the herdsman is terrified in Episode 4?

Sample answer: The messenger believes he is helping the king and proving his own story, so he expects thanks. The herdsman understands what the story means: the child they exchanged is the king, born to the house of Laius. One man sees only a happy reunion of witnesses, while the other sees the ruin of the royal house.

91. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does Episode 4 resolve the question Oedipus asked at the end of Episode 2 about whether one man or many killed Laius?

Sample answer: In Episode 2 Oedipus pinned his hope on the report that robbers, many men, killed Laius. In Episode 4 Oedipus never even asks the herdsman about the killing, because the story of the child proves who he is and makes the answer clear. The question of one or many simply falls away once his birth is known.

92. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Stasimon 4 suggest about the elders' loyalty to Oedipus after the truth is known?

A. They turn against him at once

B. They no longer care about him

C. They demand his death

D. They still grieve for him

Key: D (They still grieve for him)

93. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Stasimon 4 moves from a general reflection to speaking to Oedipus himself. What is the effect of this shift?

    A. It turns the lament into a personal address

    B. It gives him orders as a judge would give a prisoner

    C. It keeps him at a cold distance

    D. It mocks his fall from power

    Key: A (It turns the lament into a personal address)

94. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Why does the Chorus call Time all-seeing in Stasimon 4, and how does the play support that idea?

    Sample answer: Time has finally revealed a crime hidden for many years, the killing of Laius and the marriage of mother and son. The play shows the truth coming out slowly through witnesses who had kept silent for a generation. Time is all-seeing because nothing stays hidden forever, however long it is buried.

95. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Analyze the paradox in the Chorus's claim that Oedipus brought it both new life and a second death.

    Sample answer: Oedipus gave the city new life when he freed it from the Sphinx and became its king. Now the truth about him brings the elders a grief like dying again. The paradox shows that the same man was both the city's saviour and the source of its suffering, which is the heart of his tragedy.

96. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the language of Stasimon 4 echo the warnings about the tyrant in Stasimon 2?

    Sample answer: Stasimon 2 warned that a man who climbs too high will topple from a dizzy height. Stasimon 4 describes Oedipus's piteous fall from wealth and power to desolation. The earlier general warning now has a particular example, though the Chorus mourns rather than condemns him, which complicates the idea that he fell because of pride alone.

97. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Evaluate whether the Chorus's grief in Stasimon 4 or its warning in the final chorus is the play's last word on Oedipus.

    Sample answer: Stasimon 4 is pure lament, mourning the king as if he were dead. The final chorus turns that grief into a general warning to wait for the end of a life before judging it. A strong answer argues that the warning is the last word, but that it carries the grief within it, so the play ends with both sorrow and a lesson.

98. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Oedipus fear most for his daughters' future in the Exodos?

    A. Poverty after Creon takes the throne

    B. Shame that will drive off suitors

    C. Exile to a distant land

    D. Illness from the plague

    Key: B (Shame that will drive off suitors)

99. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Creon's insistence on consulting the god in the Exodos show about him as a ruler?

    Sample answer: Creon says that he must first consult the god before acting, even though the oracle has already spoken. His caution shows a ruler who will not act on his own authority in so grave a matter. It also leaves the end of Oedipus's story unsettled, waiting on the will of the gods rather than the wish of men.

100. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze how the Exodos shows Oedipus taking responsibility for his fate.

Sample answer: Oedipus admits that Apollo brought the ills to pass but insists that his own hand struck the blow. He accepts the sentence he once laid on the killer and asks to be cast out. Even in ruin he acts as a judge of himself, choosing his punishment rather than waiting for others to impose it.

101. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Which god does the Priest say he serves?

A. Zeus

B. Pallas

C. Pluto

D. Phoebus

Key: A (Zeus)

102. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Besides the palace altars, where does the Priest say the townspeople have gathered to pray?

A. At the city gates and all along the walls of the harbour

B. In the two market-places and at the shrines of Pallas

C. On the hills outside the city's walls

D. In the royal treasury and the soldiers' barracks

Key: B (In the two market-places and at the shrines of Pallas)

103. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Oedipus tell the suppliants to do as he goes off the stage?

Sample answer: He tells them to quit the altar steps, take away their suppliant branches and summon the Theban commons: "Up, children, haste ye, quit these altar stairs" (line 148). Their plea has been answered, so the whole people can now be called together. The order turns the private appeal at the altar into a public matter for all of Thebes, which prepares for his proclamation in Episode 1.

104. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Oedipus's greeting to the old man: "Ho! aged sire, whose venerable locks Proclaim thee _____ of this company"

Key: spokesman

105. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In the Parodos, what does the Chorus say is wasted "by death on death"?

A. The royal house

B. The flocks on the hills

C. The whole city

D. The army at the gates

Key: C (The whole city)

106. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the Chorus mean by "what night leaves undone, Smit by the morrow's sun Perisheth"?

A. The sun is the source of the sickness

B. The people bury the dead only at night

C. The night brings rest and hope to the city

D. The plague goes on striking day and night

Key: D (The plague goes on striking day and night)

107. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the Chorus's lament for the mothers of Thebes in the Parodos connect to the blight the Priest reported in the Prologue?

Sample answer: The Priest said that wives in travail bring forth no living children, and the Chorus echoes him when it says women wail in barren throes. Both speeches show that the plague attacks the future of the city as well as the living. The repetition stresses that Thebes cannot renew itself until the cause of the sickness is found.

108. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] Analyze the irony of the Chorus praying to the gods for a cure in the Parodos while the cause of the plague sits on the throne.

Sample answer: The Chorus begs Athenè, Artemis, Apollo, Zeus and Bacchus to drive the plague away, trusting in Oedipus as the king who will lead the search. The audience knows that the pollution comes from Oedipus himself. The prayers are sincere, but the answer the gods will give is the ruin of the man the city most relies on.

109. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Trace how the Chorus's prayers in the Parodos are answered, or left unanswered, by the end of the play.

Sample answer: In the Parodos the Chorus asks the gods to save the city from death and ruin. The oracle's answer is that the killer of Laius must be found, and the play follows that search until Oedipus is revealed as the killer. The gods answer through the truth rather than through a miracle, and the end of the plague is implied but never shown on stage.

110. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] According to the seer, what will Oedipus be shown to be to his own children?

A. Brother and father

B. Uncle and guardian

C. Master and judge

D. Stranger and enemy

Key: A (Brother and father)

111. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Oedipus mock the seer's blindness in Episode 1?

A. To make the Chorus laugh at the old man

B. To discredit the charge

C. To persuade the seer to accept a reward

D. To show pity for the seer's suffering

Key: B (To discredit the charge)

112. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What evidence does Oedipus have for linking Creon to the seer, and how strong is it?

Sample answer: Oedipus knows that it was Creon who advised him to send for the seer, and he reasons that Creon would gain the throne if the king were disgraced. That is a possible motive, but there is no proof of any plot. His case rests on suspicion and anger rather than evidence, which shows how fear is clouding his judgment.

113. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Which best describes how the quarrel between Oedipus and the seer develops?

A. Anger turns slowly into calm agreement

B. It ends with the seer begging forgiveness

C. Refusal escalates to open accusation

D. It stays polite from beginning to end

Key: C (Refusal escalates to open accusation)

114. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does Teiresias's prophecy of a man who will grope his way to a strange land shape the audience's response to the Exodos?

Sample answer: The seer foretold that the murderer, now rich and seeing, would go blind and poor, feeling his way with a staff. When the Exodos shows Oedipus blinded and begging to be sent from Thebes, the audience recognizes the prophecy coming true. The earlier words make the ending feel fated, and they turn the final scene into the fulfilment of a warning the king refused to hear.

115. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate the seer's choice to stay silent at first. Would the city have been better served if he had spoken at once?

Sample answer: Speaking at once might have saved time, but Oedipus would hardly have believed a charge made without cause, as his later anger shows. The seer's silence was meant to spare the king, yet it made him look guilty of a plot. A strong answer argues that no timing would have made the truth welcome, so his reluctance changed little.

116. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Why does the Chorus picture the Fates as “sleuth-hounds” in Stasimon 1?

A. Fate guards the king like a watchdog

B. Fate hunts only animals, not men

C. Fate is lazy and easily misled

D. Fate tracks the killer down

Key: D (Fate tracks the killer down)

117. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Why does the Chorus admit that “nor present nor future is clear” in Stasimon 1, and what does this reveal about its state of mind?

Sample answer: The seer's charge has shaken the elders, but they cannot tell whether it is true or false. They see neither what is happening now nor what will come, so they hold back from judging. The line reveals a mind caught between respect for prophecy and loyalty to the king, unable to move in either direction.

118. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the image of the hunted killer in Stasimon 1 is echoed in the Exodos.

Sample answer: Stasimon 1 pictures the killer as a lonely bull roaming forest and upland, pursued by Apollo and the Fates. In the Exodos the blinded Oedipus asks to be cast out and to live on the hills of Cithaeron, cut off from all men. The outcast the Chorus imagined becomes the king himself, so the early image turns into a portrait of his end.

119. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Compare the Chorus's demand for proof in Stasimon 1 with its demand in Stasimon 2 that the oracles be proved true.

Sample answer: In Stasimon 1 the Chorus refuses to condemn Oedipus because the seer's word has not been proved. In Stasimon 2 it asks the gods to prove their oracles true, or else it will stop honouring them. In both odes the elders want evidence, but their loyalty shifts from the king toward the gods as the doubts about Jocasta's story of the oracle grow.

120. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] According to Jocasta, what did Laius look like?

A. Tall and greying, like Oedipus

B. Short, stout and dark-bearded

C. Young, slim and fair-haired

D. Bent with age and blind in one eye

Key: A (Tall and greying, like Oedipus)

121. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Oedipus's account of the fight at the crossroads, where he slew the travellers, reveal about him?

A. He acted only to protect a friend

B. His temper could turn deadly

C. He was ordered by the god to kill

D. He was too young to know what he did

Key: B (His temper could turn deadly)

122. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Oedipus agree to wait for the survivor instead of accepting his own guilt at once?

Sample answer: The survivor reported that robbers, not a single man, killed Laius. Oedipus reasons that one man cannot be many, so if the servant repeats the same story, he himself must be innocent. This slender hope lets him delay the conclusion that the details of time, place and appearance already point toward.

123. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Which best explains why Sophocles has Jocasta, not a prophet, reveal where Laius died?

A. She is the only one who saw the killing

B. The seer has left Thebes for good

C. Her denial of prophecy exposes the truth

D. Creon has forbidden anyone else to speak

Key: C (Her denial of prophecy exposes the truth)

124. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] Analyze the irony of Jocasta's claim that no mortal has the art of prophecy, made just before her own words point to Oedipus's guilt.

Sample answer: Jocasta tells the story of the oracle given to Laius to prove that prophecy fails. Yet the details she adds, the meeting of three roads in Phocis and the time of the killing, are exactly what alarm Oedipus. Her attempt to free him from fear supplies the evidence against him, so the speech meant to discredit prophecy helps fulfil it.

125. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Trace the role of Creon from his report in the Prologue through the quarrel in Episode 2 to his authority in the Exodos.

Sample answer: In the Prologue Creon loyally brings the oracle from Delphi. In Episode 2 he is falsely accused of treason and defends himself with reason and an oath. In the Exodos he becomes the city's guardian, treating the fallen Oedipus with restraint. His steady conduct throughout makes him a measure of how far Oedipus swings from power to ruin.

126. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Which device is most at work in “No foothold on that dizzy steep”?

A. Onomatopoeia

B. Apostrophe

C. Understatement

D. Metaphor

Key: D (Metaphor)

127. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Why does the Chorus of Stasimon 2 tie the fate of the oracles to its own worship?

Sample answer: The elders reason that if the oracles about Laius fail, the gods' words cannot be trusted, and worship becomes empty. So they say they will no longer go to the great shrines unless the truth is made plain. Their faith depends on the oracles proving true, even though that outcome would bring ruin on the royal house.

128. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the word “surfeited” (line 892) and what it suggests about the tyrant.

Sample answer: To be surfeited is to be stuffed beyond need, overfed until sick. Applied to the tyrant swollen with empty

riches, the word suggests greed that cannot be satisfied and wealth that does no good. It prepares for the image of his fall, as if his excess makes him top-heavy on the dizzy height he has climbed.

129. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate whether Oedipus fits the Chorus's portrait of the proud sinner who will not heed Justice.

Sample answer: Oedipus has been harsh and proud, insulting the seer and threatening Creon, and he scorns the oracles at times. Yet he has also sought justice for Laius tirelessly and acted for the city's good. A strong answer argues that the portrait fits parts of his behaviour but not his central aim, which makes his fall more tragic than deserved.

130. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Oedipus's question whether he was “A foundling or a purchased slave” reveal?

A. He fears his origins are humble, not royal

B. He believes he was born a god

C. He is certain that he is the true son of Polybus

D. He wants to buy his freedom

Key: A (He fears his origins are humble, not royal)

131. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does the messenger say the infant's ankles are “evidence enow”?

A. The ankles show the king is lame

B. The scars match his story

C. The ankles prove the child was a slave

D. The scars were made at the crossroads

Key: B (The scars match his story)

132. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Which best explains why Sophocles brings news of Polybus's death before revealing Oedipus's birth?

A. It explains how the plague began

B. It sets up a war with Corinth

C. False relief sharpens the fall

D. It shows Creon's plot at last

Key: C (False relief sharpens the fall)

133. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Jocasta realize the truth before Oedipus does in Episode 3?

Sample answer: Jocasta knows that her own infant was given away with its ankles pinned and handed to a servant of Laius's house. When the messenger describes the pinned feet and the shepherd who gave him the child, she can join the pieces at once. Oedipus does not know the details of her story, so he misreads her terror.

134. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the name Oedipus is explained in Episode 3 and why that matters.

Sample answer: The messenger says that he loosed the pin that riveted the infant's feet, and that this is the source of the name Oedipus still bears. The name, which means swollen foot, has carried the evidence of his birth all his life. The detail shows that the truth was always present, written into his identity, waiting to be read.

135. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Compare the messenger's good intentions in Episode 3 with the herdsman's pity in Episode 4. How does each kindness contribute to the disaster?

Sample answer: The messenger wants to free Oedipus from fear and perhaps earn a reward, so he reveals the story of the

foundling. Years before, the herdsman pitied the infant and gave it away instead of leaving it to die. Each act is kind, yet one saved the child to fulfil the oracle and the other exposes the truth that ruins him.

136. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate Oedipus's decision to keep questioning after Jocasta begs him to stop. Is it courage or recklessness?

Sample answer: His refusal shows courage, because he insists on knowing the truth whatever it costs, the same drive that saved Thebes from the Sphinx. Yet he ignores clear warnings and misreads Jocasta's terror as snobbery. A strong answer argues that the decision is both, and that the play honours his courage while showing its terrible price.

137. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Stasimon 3 suggest about how the Chorus reads uncertain evidence?

A. It waits patiently for more proof

B. It assumes the worst at once

C. It leaves all judgment to the king

D. It picks the most hopeful reading

Key: D (It picks the most hopeful reading)

138. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Why does the Chorus of Stasimon 3 pray that Phoebus will favour its words?

Sample answer: The elders have just made a hopeful prediction about the king's birth, and they know that only the god can confirm it. Their prayer admits that their guess may be wrong. It also shows that even in joy they look to Apollo, whose oracles have hung over the whole play and will decide whether their hope is right.

139. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What is the main effect of the shortness of Stasimon 3 in the structure of the play?

A. A brief burst of joy before ruin

B. A long pause that slows the action

C. A summary of the plot for latecomers

D. A farewell to Jocasta

Key: A (A brief burst of joy before ruin)

140. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the image of Cithaeron in Stasimon 3 as a symbol of Oedipus's origins.

Sample answer: The Chorus imagines the mountain as a loving nurse and foster-mother of the king. In truth Cithaeron is where his parents meant him to die and where he was saved by chance. The symbol therefore holds both his rescue and his doom, and in the Exodos he asks to return there to the tomb his parents chose.

141. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Compare the Chorus's hopes in Stasimon 3 with Oedipus's boast at the end of Episode 3.

Sample answer: Oedipus called himself the child of Fortune and said no birth could shame him. The Chorus goes further, imagining that a god fathered him on the mountain. Both readings turn uncertainty into glory, and both are about to be overturned by the herdsman, so the king and the elders share a hope the audience knows is false.

142. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Evaluate whether Stasimon 3 is a moment of comic relief or of deepening tragedy.

Sample answer: On the surface the ode is light, with dancing, music and playful questions about gods and nymphs. Yet the audience knows what Cithaeron means, so every hopeful line sharpens the coming pain. A strong answer argues that the ode works as tragic irony more than relief, because its joy makes the fall harder to bear.

143. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Oedipus press the herdsman with threats in Episode 4 even after he senses the answer may ruin him?

Sample answer: Oedipus has vowed to learn his birth whatever the cost, and he will not let a frightened servant stand in the way. His threats come from the same determination that drove his whole search. He chooses knowledge over safety, a choice that defines him as a tragic hero who would rather know the truth than live in comfortable ignorance.

144. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Evaluate the claim that Episode 4 is the turning point of the play rather than its climax.

Sample answer: Episode 4 holds the moment of recognition, when Oedipus learns who he is, which is the play's climax. It is also the turning point, since his fortunes reverse with that knowledge. A strong answer argues that in this play the two coincide, because the discovery and the reversal happen in the same instant.

145. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which theme does Stasimon 4 state most directly?

A. Kings should obey the people

B. Human happiness is fragile

C. Oracles are usually false

D. Wealth brings lasting joy

Key: B (Human happiness is fragile)

146. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Why does the Chorus call Oedipus a child of Laius's ill-starred race in Stasimon 4?

Sample answer: The truth has shown that Oedipus is not the son of Polybus but of Laius, whose house has been cursed by the oracle. Calling him a child of an ill-starred race ties his ruin to his family as well as to his own acts. The phrase reminds the audience that his fate began before his birth.

147. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze how Stasimon 4 uses rhyme and short lines to express grief.

Sample answer: The ode is built of short, rhyming lines that fall into regular couplets, such as the cradle that was the marriage bed. The tight form gives the lament a solemn, chant-like rhythm, like a dirge. Its regularity contains the horror it describes, as if the elders can bear to speak of it only in a measured, ritual form.

148. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate whether Stasimon 4 presents Oedipus as guilty, unlucky or both.

Sample answer: The ode speaks of guilt brought to justice by Time and of a wrong the soil should not have endured, which suggests real guilt. Yet it also blames the heavy hand of fate and pities his piteous fall. A strong answer argues that the Chorus sees him as both guilty and unlucky, a man whose deeds were terrible but not knowingly chosen.

149. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Oedipus say that his sons can fend for themselves but his daughters cannot?

Sample answer: His sons are men and can make their own way, while his daughters are young and depend on others for protection and marriage. In their society unmarried girls of a disgraced house would face shame and poverty. His concern shows a father who, even in his own ruin, thinks about who will suffer most from his crimes.

150. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate how far the Exodos offers any consolation after the catastrophe.

Sample answer: The Exodos offers small consolations: Creon's restraint, the daughters brought to their father and Oedipus's acceptance of responsibility. Yet his future is uncertain and the final chorus warns that no one is happy until death. A strong answer argues that the play offers dignity and compassion rather than comfort, which is its kind of consolation.

151. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Oedipus's question: “Where in the wide world to find The far, faint traces of a bygone _____?”

Key: crime

152. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Where does the Priest say oracles are delivered “by fire”?

A. Where Ismenus gives them

B. At the hearth of the palace

C. At the altar of Pluto

D. In the house of Cadmus

Key: A (Where Ismenus gives them)

153. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] According to Creon, when did Laius rule Thebes?

A. While Creon was away consulting the god at Delphi

B. Before Oedipus took the helm of State

C. While Creon was away at Delphi

D. After the Sphinx had left the city

Key: B (Before Oedipus took the helm of State)

154. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] The Priest asks for help that might come from the gods or from human cleverness. How does this double request shape the scene?

A. It suggests that Oedipus has offended the gods by trusting in his own wit and cleverness

B. It suggests Oedipus has offended the gods by trusting his wit

C. It sets divine knowledge and human reason side by side as ways to save the city

D. It proves that the oracle will not be needed at all

Key: C (It sets divine knowledge and human reason side by side as ways to save the city)

155. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze how Oedipus's final speech in the Prologue (lines 138–151) moves from reflection to command.

Sample answer: He opens by reflecting and vowing: “Well, I will start afresh and once again / Make dark things clear”, and he weighs why the cause matters to Phoebus, to Creon and to himself. He ends with orders: “Up, children, haste ye, quit these altar stairs”, sending the suppliants to summon the commons. The speech turns private resolve into public action and closes with a confident promise, “Success is sure”.

156. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does the Chorus call Apollo in the brief aside near the start of the Parodos?

A. Lord of the silver bow

B. Son of Leto

C. Prince of the Muses

D. Healer of Delos

Key: D (Healer of Delos)

157. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Why does the Chorus call the oracle “Offspring of golden Hope” even while it trembles?

A. It still hopes the god's word will save the city

B. It knows the oracle has already ended the plague

C. It is mocking the oracle as false

D. It thinks Hope is a goddess at Delphi

Key: A (It still hopes the god's word will save the city)

158. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Which best describes the effect of the repeated cry “Slay him, O slay!” (line 201)?

A. It shows calm trust in the gods' long-term plan

B. It turns the prayer into a desperate demand

C. It suggests the Chorus wants Oedipus punished

D. It marks a pause before a new topic

Key: B (It turns the prayer into a desperate demand)

159. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Analyze the role of Artemis in the Parodos, from “Lady of Thebes” to the huntress with “flashing lights”.

Sample answer: Artemis first appears as a protector seated in the city's market place, a goddess close to the daily life of Thebes. At the end she returns as a huntress sweeping the Lycian hills with flashing lights, an active warrior against the plague. The change shows the Chorus moving from asking for protection to demanding that the gods fight for the city.

160. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the Parodos prepare the audience for the Chorus's role as the voice of the city in later odes such as Stasimon 1 and Stasimon 4?

Sample answer: In the Parodos the Chorus speaks for all of Thebes, sharing its fear, its suffering and its faith in the gods. In Stasimon 1 it speaks again for the city when it refuses to condemn its king without proof, and in Stasimon 4 it mourns him as the city's fallen saviour. The first ode establishes the elders as the people's voice, so their later judgments carry public weight.

161. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate whether the Chorus's trust in the gods in the Parodos is rewarded by the end of the play.

Sample answer: In one sense it is rewarded: the oracles prove true and the hidden cause of the plague is brought to light, as the Chorus hoped. But the cost is terrible, since the truth destroys the king and his house. A strong answer weighs both sides and concludes that the gods keep their word without granting the gentle rescue the Chorus first imagined.

162. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Teiresias say he will do before he leaves at the end of Episode 1?

A. Bless the city's altars

B. Ask the Chorus for help

C. Say what he came to say

D. Wait for Creon to arrive

Key: C (Say what he came to say)

163. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does the Chorus's response to the quarrel between king and seer show about its position?

A. It sides openly with the seer against the king

B. It plans to overthrow the king

C. It no longer cares who killed Laius

D. It tries to stay loyal to both men

Key: D (It tries to stay loyal to both men)

164. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What is the effect of placing the seer's open accusation in the very first episode?

A. Truth is spoken and then rejected

B. The mystery of the killer is spoiled for good

C. The audience is sure the seer is lying

D. The play loses all suspense about the ending

Key: A (Truth is spoken and then rejected)

165. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze how Episode 1 sets Oedipus's reason against the seer's prophetic knowledge.

Sample answer: Oedipus trusts his own wit, the same intelligence that answered the Sphinx, and he scorns the seer's art as useless. The seer, blind but inspired, knows the truth without searching for it. The episode shows human reason failing to see what prophecy already knows, and that contrast runs through the rest of the play.

166. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does Episode 1 establish the pattern of a reluctant witness that recurs with Jocasta and the herdsman later in the play?

Sample answer: The seer begs to be sent home and speaks only when Oedipus provokes him. Later Jocasta pleads with Oedipus to stop asking, and the herdsman denies his memory until he is threatened. Each time, the person who knows tries to protect the king by silence, and each time his determination drags out the truth, so the pattern makes his search the engine of his fall.

167. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate Oedipus as a ruler in Episode 1. Which of his actions serve the city, and which serve his pride?

Sample answer: His proclamation, his offer of mercy to a confessing killer and his quick consultation of the seer all serve the city's need to end the plague. His insults to the seer and his charge against Creon serve his pride, since he cannot bear to be accused. A balanced answer shows a capable ruler whose anger undermines his own good aims.

168. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In Stasimon 1, from where does the Chorus say the voice naming the killer came?

A. The altar of Zeus

B. Pythia's rocky cell

C. The palace hearth

D. The seer's own house

Key: B (Pythia's rocky cell)

169. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Why does Stasimon 1 come directly after the seer leaves the stage?

A. To give Oedipus time to visit Delphi

B. To announce Creon's arrest

C. To let the city weigh his charge

D. To mourn the death of Laius again

Key: C (To let the city weigh his charge)

170. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does the Chorus's comparison of Oedipus to tested gold suggest about how it judges character?

A. By wealth and royal birth

B. By what the oracles say

C. By how kindly a man speaks

D. By proven public deeds

Key: D (By proven public deeds)

171. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze how Stasimon 1 portrays Apollo as both the source of the oracle and the hunter of the guilty.

Sample answer: The voice naming the killer comes from Pythia's rocky cell, so Apollo is the one who demands the search. Yet the same god follows on the killer's heels armed with his father's lightning. The ode makes Apollo both judge and pursuer, which suggests that divine justice will not stop at a command but will hunt the guilty down.

172. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does Stasimon 1 show the Chorus caught between the oracle's command and its loyalty to the king, and how is that tension resolved later in the play?

Sample answer: The first half of the ode accepts the oracle's command that the killer be hunted, while the second half refuses to accept that the killer is Oedipus. The elders hold both loyalties at once. The tension is resolved in Episode 4, when the herdsman's answers prove the oracle right, and the Chorus's loyalty turns into the mourning of Stasimon 4.

173. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate the Chorus's claim that no one has proved a mortal seer knows more than other men. Does the play bear it out?

Sample answer: The claim is reasonable in general, since prophets can be wrong and the Chorus asks only for evidence. But in this play the seer is right about everything, from the killer's identity to his blindness and his exile. The play therefore tests the Chorus's caution and finds it mistaken, suggesting that true prophecy comes from the god and does not depend on proof.

174. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does Stasimon 1 use the memory of the Sphinx to measure Oedipus's standing, and how does the play revisit that memory later?

Sample answer: Stasimon 1 recalls that Oedipus saved the state when the winged songstress came, using that victory as proof of his worth. Stasimon 4 returns to the same triumph only to mourn the man who won it, and the final chorus names him as the one who knew the Sphinx's riddle before showing his ruin. The memory that defended him becomes the measure of his fall.

175. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Oedipus wish he might vanish from the world before he is proved the killer?

A. His own decree would condemn him

B. He fears the people's laughter

C. He has heard the plague is ending

D. He longs to return to Delphi

Key: A (His own decree would condemn him)

176. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Which choice best explains why the drunken guest's taunt matters to the plot?

A. It made Polybus banish him from Corinth

B. It sent Oedipus to Delphi and beyond

C. It revealed his true parents at once

D. It caused the plague in Thebes

Key: B (It sent Oedipus to Delphi and beyond)

177. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze how Episode 2 moves Oedipus from accuser to suspect.

Sample answer: The episode opens with Oedipus charging Creon with treason and demanding his death. After Jocasta's story of the crossroads, he begins to question himself, and by the end he fears that his own curse falls on him. The accuser has become the suspect, and the investigation has turned inward toward the man who leads it.

178. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Jocasta's scorn for prophecy in Episode 2 lead, by the end of the play, to the very outcome she denies?

Sample answer: Jocasta argues that the oracle to Laius failed, and she tells the story to comfort Oedipus. Her details start the inquiry that leads to the herdsman, whose answers prove that the oracle was fulfilled in every part. Her denial of prophecy therefore becomes the first link in the chain that shows the gods were right.

179. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate Creon's defence in Episode 2. Is reasoning about motive enough to clear a man of treason?

Sample answer: Creon argues that he already has power without the fears of kingship, so he has no reason to plot, and he offers to swear an oath and let the oracle be checked. His reasoning is persuasive but proves only that he lacks a motive, not that he is innocent. A strong answer notes that the play vindicates him, though his argument alone could not settle the question.

180. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What is the effect of the Chorus naming three great shrines in Stasimon 2?

A. It lists places Oedipus has visited

B. It proves the Chorus has travelled widely

C. It shows how much worship is at stake

D. It names the sources of the plague

Key: C (It shows how much worship is at stake)

181. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze how Stasimon 2 turns the investigation from a search for a criminal into a test of the gods.

Sample answer: Before this ode the question was who killed Laius. Here the Chorus says that if the oracles are not fulfilled, Apollo is forsaken and worship has no point. The search now decides whether the gods can be trusted at all, so the stakes rise from punishing one man to preserving the city's faith.

182. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Across Stasimon 1, Stasimon 2 and Stasimon 4, how does the Chorus's faith in the oracles develop?

Sample answer: In Stasimon 1 the Chorus reveres the gods but doubts the human seer. In Stasimon 2 it demands that the oracles be proved true, or its worship will end. In Stasimon 4 the oracles have come true, and the Chorus learns that the gods are right at the cost of its king. Faith survives, but it is joined to grief.

183. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Which choice best describes the messenger's attitude throughout Episode 3?

A. Cold and scheming, hoping to ruin the king

B. Fearful and silent, forced to speak

C. Bored and careless, eager to leave

D. Eager to help, blind to the harm

Key: D (Eager to help, blind to the harm)

184. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze how Episode 3 makes Jocasta's last speech a turning point for the audience's understanding.

Sample answer: Her desperate plea that Oedipus never discover who he is shows that she has understood everything. For

the audience, her words remove any doubt about where the search will end. From this point the drama lies not in what will be revealed but in when and how Oedipus will see it.

185. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the theme of Fortune in Episode 3 connect to the Chorus's warning at the end of the play?

Sample answer: In Episode 3 Oedipus calls himself Fortune's favourite child and trusts her to bring him good gifts. The final chorus warns that no mortal should be counted blessed until he has ended his life free from pain. The ending answers his boast directly: Fortune raised him high only to sink him in a sea of troubles.

186. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate whether Jocasta's attempt to stop the search is an act of love, fear or self-protection.

Sample answer: Jocasta's plea that Oedipus never learn who he is may come from love, since she wants to spare him the truth. It also comes from fear, because she understands what the truth means for both of them. A strong answer weighs these motives and argues that her plea is chiefly protective of him, even as it reveals her own horror.

187. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] What is the effect of the Chorus calling Cithaeron a lover of the royal race?

A. It makes a place of exposure loving

B. It shows the mountain belongs to the king

C. It warns the king to avoid the mountain

D. It explains how the plague began there

Key: A (It makes a place of exposure loving)

188. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Which statement best describes how Stasimon 3 positions the audience?

A. As uncertain as the elders are

B. Aware of truths the elders miss

C. Convinced that the elders are right

D. Indifferent to the king's birth

Key: B (Aware of truths the elders miss)

189. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze how Stasimon 3 transforms the evidence of exposure into a myth of divine birth.

Sample answer: The facts are grim: an infant left on a mountain with pinned feet. The Chorus turns them into a story of nymphs and gods who might leave a child to be found. The ode shows how the elders reshape painful evidence into a flattering myth, a habit of mind the play exposes when the truth arrives.

190. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does Stasimon 3 continue the play's pattern of misplaced hope that began with Jocasta's comfort in Episode 2?

Sample answer: In Episode 2 Jocasta's story meant to comfort Oedipus raised new fears. In Episode 3 the news of Polybus brought relief that turned to dread. Stasimon 3 is the last and highest hope, imagining a divine birth just before the herdsman proves the truth. Each hope leads closer to the disaster, so hope itself becomes part of the tragic pattern.

191. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate the Chorus's reasoning in Stasimon 3. Is its hopeful guess about the king's birth a failure of judgment?

Sample answer: The guess is not unreasonable, since a foundling's parents are unknown and divine births were part of Greek myth. But the elders ignore Jocasta's terror and the question of the shepherd of Laius's house. A strong answer concludes that the guess is a failure of attention more than of logic, driven by loyalty rather than evidence.

192. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Across Stasimon 3 and the Exodos, how does Cithaeron change in meaning for Oedipus?

Sample answer: In Stasimon 3 the Chorus celebrates the mountain as the king's nurse and plans to honour it with song. In the Exodos Oedipus curses Cithaeron for sheltering him and then asks to live there and die in the tomb his parents meant for him. The mountain turns from a symbol of joyful origins into the place of his chosen end.

193. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze how Episode 4 presents the herdsman as a mirror of the seer in Episode 1.

Sample answer: Both men know the truth and try to keep silent for the king's sake, and both are forced to speak by his anger and threats. The seer spoke in riddles, while the herdsman speaks in plain, broken answers. Together they frame the search, showing that whether truth comes from prophecy or from a humble witness, it leads to the same place.

194. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate whether the recognition in Episode 4 is caused by fate or by human choices.

Sample answer: The oracles foretold what would happen, so in one sense fate determines the outcome. But the recognition comes about through a chain of human choices: the herdsman's pity, the messenger's helpfulness and Oedipus's refusal to stop asking. A strong answer argues that the play joins the two, with fate working through what people freely choose to do.

195. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze how Stasimon 4 shifts the play's focus from the investigation to its meaning.

Sample answer: Until Episode 4 the play asked who killed Laius and who Oedipus is. Once those questions are answered, Stasimon 4 asks what his story means for human life. The ode steps back from events to reflect on fortune, time and justice, turning the solved mystery into a meditation on the limits of mortal happiness.

196. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Across the Parodos and Stasimon 4, how does the Chorus's understanding of the source of the city's suffering change?

Sample answer: In the Parodos the Chorus blames the plague on Ares, a hostile god, and begs the other gods to drive him out. In Stasimon 4 it understands that the suffering came from a hidden human crime now exposed by Time. The source moves from an outside enemy to the king at the centre of the city, which deepens the tragedy.

197. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What is the effect of Creon's restraint toward Oedipus in the Exodos?

A. It shows Creon is afraid of Oedipus

B. It hides Creon's plan to punish him

C. It sets off Oedipus's past rage

D. It proves Creon did not want power

Key: C (It sets off Oedipus's past rage)

198. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the Exodos turns the play's imagery of sight and blindness into action.

Sample answer: Throughout the play sight stood for knowledge, and the blind seer saw what the king could not. In the Exodos Oedipus, having finally seen the truth, puts out his own eyes so he will not see what shames him. The imagery becomes physical, and his blindness marks the knowledge he gained at so terrible a price.

199. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the ending of the play leave the final fate of Oedipus open, and why might Sophocles have chosen this?

Sample answer: Oedipus asks to be sent away to Cithaeron, but Creon will act only after consulting the god, and the play ends before any decision is carried out. Leaving the end open keeps the focus on his suffering and acceptance rather than on punishment. It also supports the final warning that no life can be judged until it is over.

200. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate whether Oedipus is a hero or a victim at the end of the play.

Sample answer: He is a victim of oracles that shaped his life before his birth and of a truth he could not have known. Yet he acts heroically by pursuing the truth, accepting responsibility and choosing his own punishment. A strong answer argues that he is both, and that the play's tragic power comes from a great man being destroyed while keeping his greatness.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30, 31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40, 41, 42, 43, 44, 45, 46, 47, 48, 49, 50	recall 14, inference 24, analysis 11, synthesis 1
HS Junior	51, 52, 53, 54, 55, 56, 57, 58, 59, 60, 61, 62, 63, 64, 65, 66, 67, 68, 69, 70, 71, 72, 73, 74, 75, 76, 77, 78, 79, 80, 81, 82, 83, 84, 85, 86, 87, 88, 89, 90, 91, 92, 93, 94, 95, 96, 97, 98, 99, 100	recall 7, inference 19, analysis 16, synthesis 8
HS Senior	101, 102, 103, 104, 105, 106, 107, 108, 109, 110, 111, 112, 113, 114, 115, 116, 117, 118, 119, 120, 121, 122, 123, 124, 125, 126, 127, 128, 129, 130, 131, 132, 133, 134, 135, 136, 137, 138, 139, 140, 141, 142, 143, 144, 145, 146, 147, 148, 149, 150	recall 7, inference 18, analysis 12, synthesis 13
AP	151, 152, 153, 154, 155, 156, 157, 158, 159, 160, 161, 162, 163, 164, 165, 166, 167, 168, 169, 170, 171, 172, 173, 174, 175, 176, 177, 178, 179, 180, 181, 182, 183, 184, 185, 186, 187, 188, 189, 190, 191, 192, 193, 194, 195, 196, 197, 198, 199, 200	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 21, synthesis 19

Final paper

Oedipus Rex: final paper (formal literary analysis). Choose one prompt.

1. Analyze how Sophocles develops knowledge and blindness across Oedipus Rex. Trace the idea through at least three moments (beginning, middle and end) and argue what the ending finally suggests.
2. Choose one recurring symbol, image or motif in Oedipus Rex and argue how its meaning changes over the play and why that change matters to fate and responsibility.
3. Analyze a central character's choices in Oedipus Rex. Argue whether the play judges that character, and how its structure or point of view shapes your answer.
4. Two readers disagree about whether Oedipus Rex finally endorses or criticizes its society's view of pride and fall. Weigh both readings and argue for one, answering the strongest objection.

Length: HS Sophomore 900-1,100 words; HS Junior 1,000-1,300 words; HS Senior 1,200-1,500 words; AP 1,300-1,600 words

Evidence requirement: at least 6 quotations from at least three sections, from the beginning, middle and end. Quote the reading text exactly and cite the act, scene and line (MLA style). HS Senior and above: one scholarly or historical source; College Sophomore and above: two, cited in MLA.

Criterion	Points	Descriptor	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Thesis	20	A specific, arguable claim that answers the prompt and organizes the paper.	Specific, arguable and precise; it organizes every section.	Clear and arguable, but broad in places.	States a topic or a summary more than an argument.	Missing, or restates the prompt.
Evidence	25	Well-chosen, accurately quoted and cited passages from across the work, meeting the evidence requirement.	Accurate, well-chosen quotations from across the work, all cited; meets the requirement.	Accurate and cited, but clustered in one part of the work.	Too few quotations, or some inaccurate or uncited.	Little or no quoted evidence.
Analysis	30	Explains how language, structure and literary elements create meaning; goes beyond summary.	Explains how specific words, structure and devices create meaning; weighs a competing reading.	Explains the evidence, with some close reading.	Mostly summary; the link to the claim is asserted, not shown.	Summary only.
Organization	15	Logical progression, clear topic sentences and	Each paragraph advances the argument;	Logical order with minor jumps.	Order is loose; paragraphs repeat or drift.	No discernible structure.

		transitions; introduction and conclusion frame the argument.	transitions show logic.			
Style and conventions	10	Formal academic voice, present tense for literature, correct grammar and MLA format.	Formal, precise, present tense; MLA format; virtually error-free.	Formal with a few errors that do not obscure meaning.	Informal or error-prone in ways that distract.	Errors obscure meaning.

Exemplar paragraph: Oedipus opens the play as a confident, caring king who acts quickly for his city. The text makes this visible when it says “Well, I will start afresh and once again / Make dark things clear” (Prologue, lines 138–139). He has sent Creon to Delphi before the suppliants arrive, he calls the people his children, and he promises to start afresh and "make dark things clear", so his first acts are those of a leader who takes the city's pain on himself. A full paper would carry this reading through the beginning, middle and end, and answer the strongest competing reading.

Essay assignments

Essay: Knowledge and blindness

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Sophocles develops knowledge and blindness across Oedipus Rex. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Oedipus Rex (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of knowledge and blindness. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of knowledge and blindness in Oedipus Rex. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Sophocles's choices in Oedipus Rex (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of knowledge and blindness, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Fate and responsibility

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Sophocles develops fate and responsibility across Oedipus Rex. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Oedipus Rex (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of fate and responsibility. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of fate and responsibility in Oedipus Rex. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Sophocles's choices in Oedipus Rex (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of fate and responsibility, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Pride and fall

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Sophocles develops pride and fall across Oedipus Rex. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Oedipus Rex (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of pride and fall. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of pride and fall in Oedipus Rex. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Sophocles's choices in Oedipus Rex (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of pride and fall, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Leadership and the city

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Sophocles develops leadership and the city across Oedipus Rex. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Oedipus Rex (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of leadership and the city. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of leadership and the city in Oedipus Rex. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Sophocles's choices in Oedipus Rex (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of leadership and the city, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Mercy

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Sophocles develops mercy across Oedipus Rex. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Oedipus Rex (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of mercy. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of mercy in Oedipus Rex. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Sophocles's choices in Oedipus Rex (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of mercy, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

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